WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 28, 2026

The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 24 PAGES

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Happening today

● **THE CHIEFS OF NEPAL** and India's paramilitary forces will meet in Kathmandu to discuss cross-border crime and security. During the two-day meeting, the two sides will also discuss human trafficking and coordination in border areas.

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Privacy law can shut newsrooms: media body; SC notice to Centre

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, October 27

UNDERLINING THE need to balance citizens' privacy rights with press freedom, the Supreme Court issued notice to the Centre Tuesday on a petition by the Digital News Publishers Association challenging data protection provisions for failing to exempt journalistic activities.

A three-judge bench, comprising Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, Justice Joymalya Bagchi and Justice V Mohana, also issued notice on an application seeking a stay on the challenged provisions of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 and Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025.

The bench listed the matter for hearing on November 17.

The petition, filed through Advocate Anuj Tiwari, said the Act and the Rules, by not granting any exemption for journalistic purposes, are "in complete contravention" of the 2017 law laid down by the Supreme Court in *K S Puttaswamy vs Union of India (I)* and "impermissibly restrict the fundamental right to information and freedom of

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

THE BIG PICTURE

THE MANY WARS OF MATTHEW VANDYKE
PAGE 12

NATION PAGE 7

CYCLONE ROARS TOWARDS ANDHRA, LANDFALL ADVANCES

CIVILISATIONAL DIALOGUE FORUM ON NOVEMBER 20-21

First after Op Sindoor: India invites Pak to SCO meeting in Delhi

If Pak minister travels to India, will be first since Bilawal in 2023

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, October 27

INDIA HAS invited Pakistan's National Heritage and Culture Minister Aurangzeb Khan Khichi for the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO)'s Civilisational Dialogue Forum in New Delhi on November 20-21, sources told *The Indian Express* Tuesday.

This is the first such invitation by India to a senior minister of Pakistan ever since the military hostilities between the two countries in the wake of Operation Sindoor in May 2025 following the Pahalgam terror attack.

The last time India hosted a senior minister of Pakistan was in May 2023 when Bilawal Bhutto, who was then the Foreign Minister of his country, travelled to Goa for a meeting of the SCO Foreign Ministers.

The invitation to Pakistan's minister is part of Delhi's obligation to invite representatives from all SCO member countries since it had proposed to host the SCO civilisational dialogue forum. Pakistan is scheduled to host the summit of SCO leaders

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

e EXPLAINED

Why the invitation

Bilateral relations between India and Pakistan, frozen for a decade over Islamabad's state policy of terror, were downgraded further in 2019 when the two countries recalled their envoys. The two countries run into each other in multilateral fora like the SCO. As host of an SCO event, Delhi is obligated to extend an invitation to Islamabad. Pakistan is due to host the SCO summit next year.

Karnataka final roll sees 18% dip after SIR, slide second steepest

Akram M & Damini Nath
Bengaluru, New Delhi, October 27

THE FINAL electoral roll for Karnataka published by the Election Commission on Tuesday saw nearly one crore deletions. At 17.92 per cent, this is the second highest decrease among the 24 States/ Union Territories where final rolls have been published so far, including in the first two phases of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) in 2025 and earlier this year.

Arunachal Pradesh has recorded the highest decrease so far at 22 per cent. Gujarat and Uttar Pradesh, which were covered in the second phase of the SIR started in October 2025 and completed earlier this year, saw their electoral rolls shrink by 13 per cent each, followed by Chhattisgarh with 12 per cent.

Overall, the electoral rolls in the 24 States/ Union Territories have contracted by nearly 10%, with the total numbers being reduced by 7.04 crore, according

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

● THE TOP FIVE

State	Decrease*
Arunachal Pradesh	-22%
Karnataka	-18%
Gujarat	-13%
Uttar Pradesh	-13%
Chhattisgarh	-12%

*from pre-SIR to final roll

Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



'WE KNOW EVERYTHING': TOP COURT ON PLEAS OVER EC DECISIONS P 6

In relief for actor Imran Khan, HC puts 'Leave India' notice on hold until Nov 2

Omkar Gokhale
Mumbai, October 27

THE BOMBAY High Court on Tuesday kept "in abeyance" until November 2 a notice issued by the Foreigners Regional Registration Office (FRRO) to actor Imran Khan, asking him to leave India by October 28.

Khan, a US citizen and Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) cardholder, was issued the notice on October 14, days after he was detained at a protest against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar in Mumbai on October 10. The actor had challenged the FRRO notice in the Bombay High Court on October 17.

While the court was to hear the plea on Tuesday, Additional Solicitor General (ASG) Anil Singh, who represented the Centre, sought time. With Khan's lawyers citing the October 28 deadline, Singh gave an oral assurance that "nothing will happen" until the next date of hearing. The HC posted the next hearing for November 2.

"In light of the above, the impugned 'Leave India Notice' dated October 14 issued to the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Kuno cheetah cub dies after being shot, doctors find pellets in body

First such incident since launch of cheetah project in 2022

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, October 27

A 19-MONTH-OLD male cheetah cub at Kuno National Park died from pellet wounds after it was found injured in the forests of Madhya Pradesh's Morena district, marking the first such incident in the country since the reintroduction project was launched in 2022.

Born to Nirva last year, the cub, KNG22, died early on Tuesday, three days after it was rescued with severe injuries.

Madhya Pradesh Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (Wildlife) and Chief Wildlife Warden Sameeta Rajoura said: "Subsequent CT scan showed that foreign bodies had damaged the cheetah's internal organs, musculoskeletal system and nervous system."

She said: "Emergency surgery was performed, during which five firearm pellets were recovered from its body. Despite the intervention and sustained efforts by the veterinary team, the cheetah could not be saved."

Kuno National Park director Uttam Kumar Sharma refused

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

INSIDE PAGES 14, 15



NETANYAHU FACES TOUGHEST BATTLE AS ISRAEL VOTES IN GAZA BACKDROP

● ONE HELD WHILE BOARDING AUTO HOURS LATER, EIGHT FOUND IN FOREST; SEARCH ON FOR FOUR

Bold escape, brief freedom: 13 who broke out of Tamil Nadu jail back behind bars

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, October 27

ONE WAS found in the bushes behind the prison. Three were caught walking along the road. Another was apprehended while boarding an autorickshaw. Eight more were tracked to a forest area near Tamil Nadu's Theni town, where drones and more than 300 police personnel joined the search.

By Tuesday evening, 13 of the 17 undertrial prisoners who escaped from the Thekkampatti jail in the Theni district were back in custody. An escape that began with a feigned epileptic fit had ended, for most, within a day of leaving through the main gate.

Director General of Prisons Sandeep Rai Rathore, who reached the jail and reviewed the operation, confirmed that 13 had been caught and said the remaining four would be apprehended soon. Nine prison staff members, including three head constables, have been suspended.

The escape began late on

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



One of the 17 undertrial prisoners who escaped from Thekkampatti jail in Tamil Nadu's Theni district being brought back, Tuesday. ANI

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J&K L-G Manoj Sinha with CM Omar Abdullah during the swearing-in ceremony of new cabinet ministers in Srinagar on Tuesday. PTI

Cabinet shake-up leaves Jammu's Dogra heartland without a minister

Bashaarat Masood & Arun Sharma
Srinagar, Jammu, Oct 27

THE DOGRA heartland of Jammu has been left without representation after Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah Tuesday reshuffled his Cabinet, dropping Independent MLA Satish Sharma while inducting four NC MLAs from the Kashmir Valley.

The move has tilted the Cabinet's regional balance towards Kashmir, with seven of the nine ministers, including the CM, representing the Valley, while the remaining two are from the Pir Panjal region of Jammu.

The induction of four leaders is seen as an attempt by Omar to consolidate the party's support base in the Valley and strengthen its position against the BJP in Jammu and the PDP in Kashmir.

The new ministers include NC veterans Ali Mohammad Sagar, Shameem Firdous and Mir Saifullah, along with Altaf Ahmad Wani, also known as Altaf Kaloo, who represents Pahalgam in south Kashmir. They join Deputy CM Surinder Choudhary and ministers Sakina Itoo, Javed Rana and Javed Ahmad Dar, who have been retained.

Under the J&K Reorganisation Act, the Union Territory can have a maximum of nine ministers, including the CM.

Sharma, who represents Chhamb in Jammu district, was the only minister from the region outside Pir Panjal. His exit has left Jammu, Samba, Kathua and Udhampur districts without representation in the Cabinet. Jammu's Chenab Valley region of also remains unrepresented.

Sharma, son of former Congress leader Madan Lal Sharma, won the election as an Independent but supported the NC government and was later inducted into the Cabinet.

Sagar, 66, is a seven-time MLA from Khanyar in Srinagar and a former NC general secretary. He served as Rural Development and Panchayati Raj Minister in Omar's government from 2008 to 2014.

Firdous, 58, a three-time MLA from Habba Kadal, becomes the second woman in the Cabinet. She previously chaired the J&K State Commission for Women and currently heads the NC's women's wing.

Saifullah, a law graduate from Kupwara district, has been elected to the Assembly four times. He represented Kupwara from 1996 to 2008 and won the newly carved Trehgam constituency in the 2024 Assembly elections. He served as Law Minister in 2008-2014 government.

Wani, an engineering graduate, won the Pahalgam seat in 2014 and 2024. Deputy Chief Whip in the Assembly, he is the only one among the four new inductees who had not previously held ministerial office.

The reshuffle comes amid political uncertainty over NC MP Ruhullah Mehdi, who has announced plans to resign from the Lok Sabha and quit the party on November 3. It is also being viewed as an effort to limit any fallout from the expected exit and prevent the PDP from gaining ground in the Valley.

Kashmiri Pandit activist held over online threat posters targeting community

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, October 27

J&K POLICE have arrested a Haryana-based Kashmiri Pandit activist for alleged "cyber terrorism" following a complaint with regard to threatening online posters directed at members of the community posted in various government jobs in the Valley.

Rakesh Handoo was picked up from his Faridabad home earlier this month following a complaint by a fellow Kashmiri Pandit, who alleged that posters shared by the activist online had put him in a "vulnerable position".

Police say they arrested Handoo after he failed to appear when summoned in an investigation related to the posters. However, his family members said Handoo drove to Kashmir after a police team came to Haryana looking for him.

Handoo has been booked under Section 66F (which defines and penalises the offence of cyber terrorism) and Section 84C of the Information Technology Act based on a complaint filed by the Pandit employee with the Baramulla police.

In its grounds of detention handed to the family, police cited Handoo's X account repeatedly circulating "threat-related electronic material purporting to originate from Soldiers of Resistance United Liberation Council which in its original form (referred) to another person bearing a similar name. There (is) deliberate alteration and commission of the (offence through) electronic material..."

Sources said the complainant had told the police that the threat posters bore the name of another person with a similar name to his, but Handoo deliberately referred to him and thus "made him vulnerable".

Handoo's family said the police team arrived at their Faridabad home on October 17. "They (police) said that he (Handoo) needs to present himself before the police just for a day," his son Sahil said. "They didn't tell us anything about the charges. He (Handoo) drove to Srinagar in his own car with the policemen."

Sahil said his father's statements are publicly available on social media platforms. "He used to say there should be an investigation into who is issuing these threats to the Kashmiri Pandits," he said. "He was asking for an investigation. Isn't this (the arrest) stifling the voice of people?"

On Tuesday, Handoo was sent on a 5-day police remand. "He has been booked under 66F, which is a scheduled offence and is tried in NIA court," Handoo's lawyer Aazim Pandit told *The Indian Express*.

In August this year, a series of posters threatening Kashmiri Pandit employees working in the Valley had appeared on social media. The posters published in the name of a group called United Liberation Council asked the Pandits working in the Valley to "change their ways".

The letters also had the names and phone numbers of some migrant employees, mostly working in the revenue department.

While police had said that they were verifying the authenticity of these posters, the J&K government had sent the Kashmiri Pandit employees working in the Valley on administrative leave for two weeks.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

India invites Pak to SCO meeting in Delhi

next year.

For Delhi, the diplomatic task is cut out. While it has kept bilateral ties frozen for a decade now after the Pathankot and Uri attacks in 2016, it has to engage with Pakistan at the multilateral level.

The civilisational dialogue, expected to be held in one of Delhi's iconic monuments in November, was first proposed by Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the SCO Council of Heads of State summit in Tianjin in September 2025. Defence Minister Rajnath Singh formally announced that India would host the event while addressing the 25th SCO Council of Heads of Government meeting in Dushanbe, Tajikistan, on October 20, 2026.

The key goals are to strengthen people-to-people ties and cultural engagement across Eurasian member states, and showcase the shared heritage, art, literature and traditions of ancient civilisations.

The engagement between India and Pakistan under the rubric of SCO began last month when a senior Indian official visited Islamabad and flagged the issues of "connectivity, regional connectivity, transit and trade".

Alok Dimri, India's national coordinator for the grouping, told Pakistan's public broadcaster PTV that the SCO had come to the neighbourhood after traversing East Asia and Central Asia – the last two summits took place in Bishkek (Kyrgyzstan) and Tianjin (China).

A senior official with the rank of Additional Secretary in the Ministry of External Affairs, Dimri led the Indian delegation at the SCO national coordinators' meeting in Islamabad. Recalling that Prime Minister Modi had proposed a civilisational dialogue among SCO member countries, he said it had been decided that it will be held in New Delhi on November 20.

"This is a journey where Eurasian and Asian landmass member states have come together on the SCO platform," he had said. The SCO member states include Russia, India, Iran, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Pakistan, Tajikistan, Uzbekistan, Belarus and China.

The Indian delegation's presence at a SCO meeting in Pakistan was the first in almost two years. In October 2024, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar went to Islamabad for the SCO Council of Heads of Government meeting. During that visit, Jaishankar had met senior Pakistani leaders under the SCO format.

Privacy law can shut newsrooms

speech and expression protected under Article 19(1) (a) of the Constitution of India".

Appearing for the Association, Senior Advocate Madhavi Divan told the bench that the impugned provisions "will shut down the newsroom".

"This is perhaps the first comprehensive petition by institutional, what we call 'legacy media'... We are the traditional, conventional legacy media... It's changing the whole concept of what is news. If I am left at the mercy of the data principal on whether he or she will give consent, the concept of news... News has to be new. It will shut down the newsroom. What's the point if I have to ask for permission and consent?" she said.

The CJI said, "You are the domain experts because you are in this field. You are the best persons to suggest (to) the Union as well as (to) us how you will ensure there's no misuse." the CJI said.

Divan said, "We went and made a representation even after the filing of the petition."

The CJI said a balance must be struck between the rights of citizens and those of the media.

"It's between the rights of innocent citizens and your rights. So, a balance has to be struck... You are the best persons to guide and suggest how you are going to ensure that... Rights are not misused," he said.

Divan said, "Certainly. But this Act, when Your Lordships will see it in detail, was not meant for journalism at all. The earlier avatars excluded it. We don't know why this has happened. Clearly, it was not meant for us... Otherwise, newsrooms will shut down if we have to ask for permission."

"It's then a complete regime of pre-censorship. We have to ask your permission if we report on you. How can that ever be? What is news otherwise? We will face the consequences if something is wrong, if something is incorrect or inaccurate, but it can't be frozen before (it is published)... We are (already) regulated," she said.

The petition urged the court that Sections 7, 17(2), 18, 19, 27, 29, 36, 37, 44(3) of the DPDP Act and Rules 16, 17, and 23 of the DPDP Rules framed under Section 40 "be declared void to the extent they are in contravention of rights under Part III of the Constitution".

It said these sections "fail to provide any exemption in favour of journalistic activity as a distinct class of processing, entitled to constitutional protection under Article 14 and 19 (1) (a) of the Constitution of India and threaten the full spectrum of journalistic activity carried out by journalists, ground reporters, citizens, whistleblowers, RTI activists, and other stakeholders, and strike at the core of our democratic framework and run contrary to the basic tenets of the Constitution of India".

"Publishers, editors, reporters and correspondents are, as a consequence, brought within a regime of notice and prior consent, compelled erasure, and verifiable consent, obligations that cannot be reconciled with the ordinary functioning of the press," the petition stated.

Karnataka final roll sees 18% dip

to EC data. The SIR is ongoing in eight other states, with the final rolls yet to be published.

Prior to the SIR, Karnataka had 5,54,32,314 voters. On Tuesday, the number of voters declined by over 99.32 lakh, to 4,55,00,011. Bengaluru Urban saw over 40 per cent decrease, from 1.03 crore electors earlier to 59.6 lakh on Tuesday.

Asked about this, State Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) V Anbukkumar said the SIR was carried out in a transparent manner and as per the law. Responding to a question, he also ruled out the possibility of mass generation of Form 7 for deletion of names.

Responding to another query, Anbukkumar said that while foreigners had been detected, "their number is definitely less than 1,000". According to sources, most of the foreigners identified during the SIR were from Nepal, with a handful from the United States, Canada and Norway among others -- mostly those who had relinquished their Indian citizenship.

According to EC data, enumeration forms were generated for a total of 5,54,32,314 electors whose names were present in the rolls as on June 16 this year. The draft roll published on August 24 had a total of 4,46,80,151 electors. The rest were listed as 'ASDD' -- absent (19,00,926), shifted (65,45,679), deceased (16,39,864), and duplicate entries (7,09,870).

Among those in the draft roll, notices were generated to 43,82,824 electors. While 43,20,957 electors were included in the final roll, 61,867 were found "ineligible". Moreover, a total of 10.08 lakh new electors were included during the "claims and objections" period.

An age-wise breakup of the electors in the final roll showed that those in the 30-39 years comprised the largest group at 1.02 cr, followed by the 40-49 years group at 94.17. The number of voters aged 18-19 is 6.83 lakh.

Bold escape, brief freedom

Monday, when one prisoner appeared to suffer an epileptic fit inside a cell. When a guard entered to respond to the apparent medical emergency, the inmates allegedly attacked him. The guard suffered a head injury, and 17 prisoners in the cell — one of them a murder accused and the others petty criminals — fled through the main entrance.

The scale of the escape prompted a statewide alert. Seventeen special teams were formed. A single-line brief went out to over 3,000 policemen before the search operation: Pick up all suspects without a cellphone and ID.

Two dozen drones were used, and police personnel from Dindigul, Theni and Madurai districts remained on duty overnight. They checked vehicles, searched surrounding areas and alerted districts across the border in Kerala.

The first recapture came in the early hours.

Praveen was found among bushes behind the prison. He had crossed the institution's boundary but had not travelled far beyond it. Silambarasan, from Thevaram in Theni, was caught walking along a road near Andipatti, about six kilometres from the jail.

Rajkumar from Sudararajapuram in Madurai and Raja Sikhanthar from Melamadai in Madurai were apprehended on a village road at Ukkaraipatti, approximately 10 kilometres away. They, too, were walking.

Lingaprasad, from Alavanthan near Madurai, was caught while boarding an autorickshaw in a town about six kilometres from the prison. He reported health problems and was taken to a hospital.

The accounts of those five recaptures supplied an unglamorous sequel to the overnight escape. Bushes, village roads and an autorickshaw. Getting outside had been one problem. Finding somewhere to go was another.

By afternoon, police had obtained significant leads from a forest area near Theni. More than 300 personnel were deployed in a combing operation, supported by drones. Eight escapees were subsequently apprehended there.

All in their mid-20s, they had briefly exchanged a prison ceiling for the open sky, which turned out to have a police drone in it. An overhead image from the operation, accessed by *The Indian Express*, shows figures negotiating a narrow, uneven passage between large rocks and thick vegetation. From above, the ground appears broken into small pockets of visibility. A stretch of reddish earth, a rock surface, a person partly obscured by foliage. The scrub that offered cover also made movement difficult to follow from ground level.

A photograph taken after the forest arrests shows the captured group sitting close together beneath low branches, against an earthen and rocky bank. Several are bare-chested; some hold clothing against their bodies. Bare feet rest on the rough ground.

Police continued combing the Tamil Nadu-Kerala border areas on Tuesday evening, with Kerala's border districts alerted. At the prison, officials were examining how an apparent medical emergency had developed into a mass escape.

The incident recalled the 1995 breakout in which 43 suspected LTTE militants escaped from a special detention camp inside Vellore Fort through a 153-foot tunnel. At Thekkampatti, the route out was the main gate.

The jailbreak also produced a political exchange. Former chief minister M K Stalin declared that, after Breaking Bad, Tamil Nadu had begun Prison Break – a reference to hit TV shows. TVK's IT wing replied with a watchlist of crime and corruption series — Narcos, Money Heist — alleging that DMK rule had supplied their inspiration.

Drama as police 'seize' body headed for site of protest against anti-drug activist's killing

Kamaldeep Singh Brar
Mansa, October 27

TENSIONS ESCALATED in Punjab's Mansa on Tuesday as police forcibly took away the body of a 35-year-old man when his family and others were taking it to the site where a protest is on against the killing of anti-drug activist Parvinder Singh Jhota. While the family claimed that the man, identified as Daljit Singh and a resident of Bhamme Kalan village, died allegedly of drug overdose, police termed it "misinformation" and said the cause of death is under investigation.

It all began soon after Daljit Singh's family and villagers blocked the Sarsa-Mansa road, alleging he had died of a drug overdose and demanded action against local drug peddlers.

Mansa SSP Vaibhav Chaudhary, however, disputed the claim saying investigators had found that someone had allegedly brought the body in a vehicle and dumped it by the roadside. A murder case was being registered, he said, adding, "three main accused have been rounded up".

The family, meanwhile, wanted to take Daljit's body to the Mansa protest site to highlight the continuing drug menace and seek justice. His wife, Paramjit Kaur, and mother, Chand Kaur, demanded the immediate arrest of those responsible. "The government makes tall claims about ending the drug menace, yet the sale of drugs continues unabated. Young lives are being lost to addiction, and families are left to suffer the unbearable consequences," the family said, asserting that their agitation would continue until those responsible were apprehended.

As the protesters prepared to march towards Mansa with the body, police barricaded the route using vehicles and trucks. A standoff followed, with the police saying some people accompanying the family were attempting to disturb law and order.

Police personnel eventually took the body away. Videos showing personnel carrying it across a road divider and placing it in a vehicle were shared by Opposition leaders on social media, drawing criticism of the police action.

"We made mild use of force to maintain law and order. If anyone tries to disturb law and order, action will be taken," SSP Chaudhary said.

He said the body had been taken outside Mansa and that the family would be allowed to perform the last rites. "The police will not perform the last rites without the family's consent," he said, adding that the police had met the family.

The confrontation was followed by a police raid at the main Morcha site in Mansa, where several protesters including activists Lakha Sidhana and Bhana Sidhu were detained.

Bhana Sidhu later released a video statement claiming he had escaped police custody. He subsequently returned to the protest site.

The Morcha, which entered 15th day, is being held by Jhota's family and supporters, who have refused to allow a post-mortem examination in his case until their demands are met. These include a probe into his killing and resignations of Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann and .DGP Gaurav Yadav.

Son of AAP sarpanch killed outside gurdwara in Punjab

Kamaldeep Singh Brar
Amritsar, October 27

THE SON of an AAP sarpanch was shot dead by unidentified assailants outside a gurdwara in Chite Kalan village in Punjab's Amritsar, police said Tuesday. While police, citing preliminary investigation, said the murder stemmed from an old enmity, the victim's brother alleged the attack took place because their family had repeatedly challenged drug peddlers, asking them to stop selling narcotics.

The incident took place Monday evening when Teerath Singh and his friend Ranjeet Singh were coming out of the gurdwara after offering prayers, Amritsar SSP Kanwalpreet Singh Chahal said. Ranjeet, who sustained a gunshot wound to his thigh, is currently undergoing treatment, police said.

Teerath's mother Paramjit Kaur is sarpanch of the village. Speaking to reporters, his brother Karaj Singh, a block committee member, alleged that his family often spoke out strongly against drug peddlers and the attack possibly took because of that.

Based on Karaj's statement, police registered a First Information Report (FIR) against four accused, identified as Gurditt Singh, Gurjant Singh, Harkirat Singh alias Hockey, and Gora, all from the same village.

SSP Chahal denied any confrontation over drugs issue. "No NDPS case is registered against the accused. Both sides had old enmity. It resulted into the murder," the SSP said, adding that all four accused are absconding. He said their mobile locations are being traced and they will be nabbed soon.

Imran

petitioner by FRRO will be kept in abeyance, until the adjourned date of hearing," noted a bench of Chief Justice Mahesh Chandra Tripathi and Justice Advait M Sethna.

When the hearing began on Tuesday, senior advocate Venkatesh Dhond, representing the actor, opposed an intervention application which claimed that Khan's civil writ plea fell under criminal jurisdiction and could not be heard by the present bench in its existing assignment. Dhond raised the preliminary objection that the applicant was a "third-party bystander" and did not have locus standi (legal standing) to file the application.

The court sought to know if Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, representing the Centre, had a similar objection, adding that it would send the matter to the HC registry to verify and "submit a report". It said the matter arose out of a "civil consequence" and it "did not see a criminality attached to it". The court then adjourned the hearing for 10 minutes, after being told that Mehta was occupied with another matter.

When the court resumed the hearing, the Centre, through ASG Singh, sought a "short adjournment" until November 2, with the oral assurance that "nothing will happen" until the next hearing. Dhond did not oppose this.

In its notice on October 14, the FRRO had invoked provisions of the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025, including Section 7(2)(c), which empowers authorities to direct a foreign national not to remain in India, and Section 29, which provides for the removal of a foreigner for violation of the Act, rules or orders made under it, or on the basis of an adverse security report.

On October 17, the FRRO issued a show-cause notice, indicating that Khan's OCI cardholder registration could face cancellation under Section 7D(e) of the Citizenship Act, 1955.

Khan, represented by advocates Zulfiquar Memon, Parvez Memon and Chirag Naik of MZM Legal, moved the High Court on October 17, challenging the move as "unconstitutional, manifestly arbitrary and disproportionate". Pending final disposal of his writ petition, he sought the court's directions to quash and set aside the 'Leave India Notice', along with an "immediate stay" on its operation and implementation.

The HC had agreed to hear the matter on Monday to enable the FRRO lawyer to respond to Khan's plea. On Monday, the matter was adjourned to Tuesday, after Khan's lawyer sought time.

Dhond had earlier argued that the actor has been living in India for nearly four decades and has no criminal antecedents. He sought interim protection against any coercive measures, such as deportation, issuance of a Look Out Circular (LOC), blacklisting, or any adverse steps impacting his OCI status.

After Khan was detained at the October 10 protest, BJP leader Kirit Somaiya had filed a police complaint alleging that the actor had violated OCI rules and visa conditions. The Mumbai Police then forwarded an "unproven" FIR to the FRRO, which issued the 'Leave India Notice'.

Kuno

to comment on how the cheetah had managed to stray far from Kuno National Park and why the monitoring teams were unable to intervene earlier. "This incident did not take place in my jurisdiction. It would have been our responsibility had the incident taken place at Kuno National Park," Sharma told *The Indian Express*.

With KNG22's death, India's cheetah population stands at 58, according to the forest department. Of these, 52 are in Kuno National Park, four in Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary, and two in Veerangana Durgavati Tiger Reserve — all in MP.

KNG22 was found injured by a monitoring team on Sunday evening in the Pahargarh range of the Morena Territorial Forest Division. It was subsequently shifted to Jabalpur for advanced veterinary care, where doctors repeatedly found evidence of a gunshot injury and removed pellets during surgery.

The State Tiger Strike Force (STSF), a specialised wildlife crime investigation unit, has been deployed in the area and is identifying those responsible for the act. The unit is now focused on looking at a suspected poaching angle along with human-animal conflict.

The investigation has acquired particular significance because the cub was found in a forest landscape that has recently been the focus of a major investigation into leopard poaching.

An alleged interstate network was uncovered earlier this year after investigators linked the killing of at least 10 leopards to forest divisions in the wider Kuno, Morena and Sheopur landscape. More than 10 people were arrested in connection with the alleged racket, according to previous reports.

The possibility of human involvement had been among the explanations examined when the cub was first found. Other possibilities, including an encounter with another wild animal, were also considered before medical findings pointed to a gunshot injury.

The biggest challenge for wildlife officials is protecting cheetahs as they venture beyond the national park into surrounding territorial forests, where the responsibility for their safety is shared across multiple forest divisions.

The cub was radio-collared and was being monitored by a dedicated team. The Kuno authorities took responsibility for its rescue and treatment, while territorial forest officials became central to the investigation because the incident occurred within their jurisdiction.

Morena's rugged ravines and the reported availability of locally made firearms add to the challenges faced by forest personnel.

Officials at Kuno said they have been developing intelligence on suspected poaching networks in the region since the project's inception in 2022. The death also brings the effectiveness of surveillance and protection measures for free-ranging cheetahs into focus, particularly when the animals move through territorial forest divisions where they may encounter human activity.

Monitoring cheetahs under Project Cheetah involves round-the-clock tracking by teams from the MP Forest Department, supported by researchers from the Wildlife Institute of India. The animals are fitted with satellite-GPS radio collars equipped with Very High Frequency and Ultra High Frequency transmitters.

Ministry of Home Affairs
Government of India

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TALKS ENDED IN DEADLOCK: STUDENTS

Jamia protest Day 16: Union Minister says talks underway



Security personnel outside Jamia Millia Islamia on Tuesday. ABHINAV SAHA

Tabshir Shams & Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, October 27

AS A protest by students in demand of the restoration of the Jamia Millia Islamia Students' Union (JMISU), along with a fixed election date and schedule, entered Day 16 on Tuesday, Union Education Minister Pralhad Joshi said negotiations were underway.

The Minister also appealed to the protesting students not to create a law-and-order situation on the campus. "Many efforts have been made ... there have been no elections since 2006... Negotiations are underway. Nobody should try to create a law-and-order problem. That is my appeal. The authorities , including the Vice-Chancellor, are looking into the remaining issues," Joshi said. Despite the university's decision to hold elections within 15 days of the approval of the union's constitution, students have refused to call off the protest.

Outside the university on Tuesday more than 15 police buses and riot-control vehicles were stationed. Security personnel carried tear gas shells. Announcements were being made with officers asking people not to come out in groups and stay away from the protest as prohibitory orders under BNSS Section 163 were imposed in the area.

At Ghulistan-e-Ghalib compound inside the main university campus, more than 200 students remained.

"The campus is completely cordoned off," said Haneena, one of the organisers of the protest. "They have closed the canteen and sealed the gates. They have imposed (BNSS) Section 163 outside. There are riot-control vehicles, tear gas vehicles....."

Food and water, meanwhile, reached them over the boundary walls with spikes and barbed wires. At the Political Science block, there were mattresses and a few pillows. The protesters took turns: a few rested as the rest kept a watch.

Outside the building, a whiteboard was erected on a wooden chair. It displayed names and beside each were mentioned the weight they lost. Protesters said Ebin and Rehan have grown very weak — now struggling to even speak.

A university official told *The Indian Express*, "We have tried to talk. Two delegations of professors and the provost went in on Tuesday. The first, comprising only women faculty staff, went at 8 am. The second went around 7 pm." "Efforts have been made to listen to the students. In acute lawlessness, it is difficult to run a university. We have seen people from outside roaming inside. They have broken the gates. We are also concerned about the safety of the women students," the official said.

"A constitution cannot be made in haste. It is a deliberate process, and it takes time. The students should understand this. They should end the hunger strike and meet us in the middle," the offiicial added.

Haneena said both rounds ended in deadlock.

"They told us the process is long and cannot be hastened," she said. "We still say there must be a timeline. Framing this constitution is a legal duty the university has under the Jamia Act, and the Supreme Court has directed it. So why has it not been done till now?"

Haneena also pointed out that for over 100 women currently living inside the institute, there are only two washrooms.

EXPRESS special

As winter curbs kick in, Cong Nov 1 rally-goers may have to park vehicles at Delhi borders

Alok Singh
New Delhi, October 27

CONGRESS AND INDIA bloc workers travelling to Delhi for the November 1 rally at Ramlila Maidan may have to leave their buses and other vehicles outside the Capital's borders and arrange alternative transport to the venue, or walk long distances. Authorities are considering setting up designated parking points along Delhi's borders to ensure this, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

The reason: Many of the buses and other vehicles expected to ferry participants from neighbouring states are likely to meet BS III or BS IV emission standards but not the BS VI norms, which are going to come into force in the Capital on the same day.

The Delhi government is set to enforce curbs from midnight on November 1 under its Winter Action Plan, with the Transport department and Delhi Traffic Police deploying teams at entry points to stop vehicles that do not meet the prescribed emission standards. Curbs on non-BS VI vehicles entering the Capital will remain in force until February 28, 2027.

The Congress and other Opposition parties expect more than one lakh people to attend the rally, titled *Vote Bachao, Desh Bachao* and *Dilli Chalo*, against the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral roll and demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Participants are expected to arrive from Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Rajasthan, Punjab and Madhya Pradesh, many in buses and four-wheelers — many of which are likely to be arranged by local party leaders — that may not meet BS VI emission standards.

With the restrictions coinciding with the rally, officials are unlikely to grant any relaxation to non-compliant vehicles, sources said.

The All India Motors and Goods Transport Association (AIMGTA) warned that the simultaneous implementation of the restrictions and the rally could cause confusion and inconvenience unless the organisers and authorities work out arrangements in advance.

AIMGTA president Rajendra Kapoor said many participants travelling from cities within 250-300 km of Delhi were likely to use buses, tempos and private vehicles. "How will these people reach Delhi in their vehicles once the restrictions come into effect? Will they have to leave their vehicles at designated entry points and walk nearly 20 km?" he asked.

"This is not merely a matter of convenience for rally participants; it also concerns traffic management, law and order, and the potential inconvenience to the general public. The organisers should work out a practical solution well before the rally to ensure that thousands of people do not face unnecessary hardship and that the event does not cause further traffic congestion and disorder on Delhi's roads," he added.

With Delhi's air quality deteriorating to the poor category, the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) has invoked Stage I of the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP). Diesel vehicles older than 10 years and petrol vehicles older than 15 years remain banned in Delhi-NCR under existing restrictions.

According to officials, several rounds of meetings have been held between Delhi government and police personnel to work out arrangements for the smooth implementation of the restrictions. When contacted, a senior police officer said meetings were being held regularly with counterparts in neighbouring cities ahead of the rally. "We will definitely stop vehicles that do not comply with the rules under the Winter Action Plan," the officer added.

The Congress has obtained a no-objection certificate from the Delhi Police for the rally, subject to certain terms and conditions.

The Transport department said on Tuesday that it has deployed around 250 enforcement personnel at key entry points, toll plazas and identified pollution hotspots across the Capital as it prepares to enforce restrictions from November 1.

Transport Minister Pankaj Singh said, "Our enforcement teams are deployed round the clock at major entry points, toll plazas and pollution hotspots."

• Delhi Police conditions for organisers



Preparations underway at Ramlila Maidan on Tuesday. ANI

- Conclude rally by 5 pm; no overnight stay or march to other locations permitted.
- Install CCTV cameras at strategic locations.
- Inflammatory speeches prohibited.
- Arrange water tankers and separate toilets for women.
- Violations may invite legal action or revocation of permission.
- Submit lists of invitees and volunteers, programme schedule and vehicle details.
- Deploy identifiable volunteers and ensure adequate parking.

• Skywatch

Forecast: Oct 28, 2026
Mainly clear sky becoming partly cloudy sky

MAX: 29-31
0.8°C below normal

MIN: 15-17
0.2°C below normal

• AQI Tracker

Narela
Poor
AQI: 261

Najafgarh
Poor
AQI: 204

Vivek Vihar
Poor
AQI: 240

Badarpur
Moderate
AQI: 137

- Good (0-50)
- Satisfactory (51-100)
- Moderate (101-200)
- Poor (201-300)
- Very Poor (301-400)
- Severe (401-500)

Over 1,400 ghats to be readied for Chhath, foreign ambassadors may be invited

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 27

AUTHORITIES IN Delhi are expected to make over 1,400 ghats ready for the upcoming Chhath festival — up from 1,326 last year. The four-day festival begins on November 13. Chief Minister Rekha Gupta Tuesday directed officials to complete all basic preparations at the ghats by November 6 and make arrangements for the safety of devotees.

The Delhi government has also planned to invite foreign ambassadors to be part of the festival. Officials were directed to coordinate with the Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR) to identify a suitable venue to host the dignitaries.

At a review meeting on Tuesday, CM Gupta instructed officials from various departments, district administrations and civic agencies to inspect the ghats in person and address any shortcomings. She said all key arrangements should be completed at least two days before the festival, leaving only tasks such as filling the ghats with water, installing tents and final cleaning for later.

Cabinet Minister Kapil Mishra, MLAs Abhay Verma, Chandan Kumar Chaudhary and Sandeep Sehawat, officials from the Revenue department, Delhi Police, Traffic Police, Delhi Jal Board, MCD, New Delhi Municipal Council, PWD, Irrigation and Flood Control Department and Delhi Fire Services were among officials who attended the meeting.

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Registrar, HNBUMU

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This is to inform all the trade stockists, wholesalers, retailers, consumers of **Beta Drugs Limited, Adley Formulations Pvt. Ltd.** and the general public that as per the notification issued by the Government authorities, prices of anti-cancer drugs marketed by the Company have been revised. The revised rates will come into effect as per DPCO circular, S.O. 5690(E) dated **17th October 2026**. Price list of products can be obtained from your trade channel partners or company's depot C&F and company website.

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Sd/-
Director



THREE DAYS REMAIN TO FILE CLAIMS AND OBJECTIONS REGARDING REMOVAL OF NAME FROM DRAFT ROLL

Over 1 lakh spl camps held in Delhi, only 27,510 apply for enrolment as new voters

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, October 27

ONLY 27,510 applications seeking inclusion in Delhi's electoral roll were received at over one lakh special camps organised across the Capital during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR), according to data released by the office of the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO), Delhi, on Tuesday.

This comes after 47.57 lakh names were excluded from the draft roll released on August 31.

Until October 26, the poll body received 2.67 lakh Form 6 applications — by which citizens can apply to get their names included in the final electoral roll — including 27,510 at the special camps. BLOs usually sit at these camps to help people fill Form 6.

Only three days remain for one to file claims and objections, including Form 6 applications. The final roll is scheduled to be published on December 4.

Under fire over the scale of deletions from voter lists in the nationwide SIR exercise, the Election Commission of India (ECI), on September 29, had directed 20 states and Union territories where the SIR exercise had been completed to conduct a special drive to enrol eligible voters left out of the electoral roll.

The CEO's office said more than one lakh special camps had been organised across Delhi's 14,947 polling stations over seven Sundays since September 20. Camps were also held at educational institutions and universities, night shelters and areas affected by demolitions.

Of the 27,510 Form 6 applications received at the special camps, 25,255 came from polling station locations, 1,706 from colleges and universities, and 549 from camps for homeless people, transgender persons and sex workers.

The special camps received 38,849 applications in all, including 10,729 Form 8 applications for changes in existing electoral entries and 610 Form 7 applications seeking deletion of names. The figures indicate that around 73,000 camps did not receive any Form 6 application.

The Indian Express had reported on Monday that few people were turning up at the camps, with booth level officers (BLOs) in several areas saying they had received few or no applications. At an MCD school in East Delhi's Chilla village, a BLO had said he had not received a single Form 6 application through the day. In New Moti Bagh, another BLO said he had visited 42 houses over five hours and received four applications.

The low turnout at the camps is reflected in the overall enrolment figures during the claims and objections period. From August 31, when the draft roll was published, until October 26, Delhi received 2.67 lakh Form 6 applications. These include 27,510 applications received in the special camps. Additionally, 2.12 lakh Form 6 applications were received before the draft roll was published.

As per the CEO's data, Delhi received 20,074 Form 7 and over one lakh Form 8 applications during the claims and objections period until October 26.

• SIR: Key numbers

47.57 lakh Names excluded from the draft electoral roll published on August 31

2.12 lakh Form 6 applications received before publication of draft roll

2.67 LAKH: Form 6 applications received between August 31 and October 26

OVER 1 LAKH: Special camps organised in Delhi.

27,510: Form 6 applications received at special camps

NEARLY 73,000: Camps that received no Form 6 application.

38,849: Total applications received at special camps, including Forms 6, 7 and 8.

OCTOBER 30: Last date to file claims and objections.

GROUND report

At Jan Sunwai in Trilokpuri, families scramble to get back on electoral roll

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, October 27

FOR 29-YEAR-OLD Suresh Kumar Patel, the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls was something he had paid little attention to. He would scroll past the occasional reel about it on his phone, while conversations about the exercise carried on among his neighbours.

A JCB driver, Patel had little reason to worry: his family had lived in Indira Camp for decades, and he had carefully filled out his enumeration form, that too in front of the booth level officer (BLO).

That confidence was shaken this Sunday, when a group of activists knocked on his door to tell him that his name had been deleted from the draft electoral roll. "I couldn't believe it. I had filled my details and my father's details from the 2002 SIR in front of the BLO," he said, showing a photograph of his completed enumeration form.

His father's name had made it to the roll. His had not.

On Tuesday, Suresh was among hundreds of people who gathered at a 'Jan Sunwai' in East Delhi's Trilokpuri, seeking answers over names they said had been wrongly deleted from the draft electoral roll published on August 31.

The hearing was organised by Jan Sarokar, Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan (MKSS), National Federation of Independent Women (NFIW) and Voter Adhikar Manch. It followed a four-day public audit in which volunteers went door to door to verify electoral records and identify cases of alleged wrongful deletion.



Rahul Gandhi with a child during the Jan Sunwai on Tuesday. PTI

The audit covered 1,236 voters across 700 households in four polling booths in Trilokpuri — booths 42, 43, 79 and 80. According to the organisers, they identified 416 people, or 33.7% of those verified, who had been wrongly placed on the list of absent, shifted, dead or duplicate entry.

At the camp, Suresh was helped by volunteers to fill out Form 6, used to register as a new elector.

Delhi had around 1.45 crore electors before the SIR began. When the draft electoral roll was published, around 97.5 lakh names were retained, while around 47.5 lakh electors were classified as "uncollectible" after BLOs marked them as absent, shifted, deceased or having duplicate entries.

The hearing brought together Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi, CPI(ML) General Secretary Dipankar Bhattacharya, civil society activist Yogendra Yadav, Nikhil Dey of MKSS, JNUSU joint secretary and AISA leader Danish Ali, Supreme Court lawyer Prashant Bhushan, and former AISA president and CPI(ML) activist N Sai Balaji, among others.

"Every Indian citizen has the right to vote, but crores of people are being deprived of this right. We have been raising this issue for a long time, but the entire country is now realising that 'vote chori' is being carried out at the highest level, with the poor being removed from electoral rolls," Gandhi said at the camp.

He added that the Opposition would remain united in its fight against the injustice until Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar resigned.

For 52-year-old Sunita, the problem was not simply about getting her name restored. She and five members of her family had been marked as "shifted" and removed the draft roll after they sold their house and moved to a rented house two streets away.

"A couple of years ago, we had to sell our house due to a financial crisis. When I got to know a month ago that our names have been removed, we went to our BLO. He told us that our landlord is not allowing us to get voter ID cards made on the basis of the address of the rented accommodation," Sunita said.

Sunita acknowledged that her name could have been deleted from the previous address because she had moved. "But I have visited at least three camps set up by our BLO at the local school to get enrolled again. But every time he makes an excuse – says the deadline is over or asks for new document."

For Urmila Devi, the importance of a valid a Voter ID extends beyond the ballot box. Her family fears that being removed from the electoral roll will make them to miss out on the benefits of government schemes.

She and her elder son, Rohit, received notices over discrepancies in the spelling of their names. Her husband, Ram Murat, and younger son, Prince, had their names struck off the roll altogether.

"If our vote is removed, they will destroy our slum and take away our ration card. How will we survive then?" she asked.

SIT on Gurugram woman biker case: 'Deliberate crash' by accused

Express News Service
Gurugram, October 27



The impact threw Shivani Chauhan from the bike, sending her skidding across road. FILE

THE SPECIAL Investigation Team (SIT) probing the road rage incident involving woman biker Shivani Chauhan has concluded that the accused driver deliberately rammed his car into her motorcycle in Gurugram on September 13, police said on Tuesday.

According to the police, the chargesheet, which will likely be filed by next week, will retain all offences invoked in the FIR, including the charge of attempt to murder.

The five-member SIT, headed by Assistant Commissioner of Police (Crimes Against Women) Sushila, recently submitted its findings to Gurugram Police Commissioner Sibash Kaviraj. The report concluded that the collision was intentional and methodical, rather than an accidental crash, officers said.

"The SIT has also readied the chargesheet. It will be filed in court within a week, in accordance with the sections of law applied in the FIR," a senior officer said.

The findings came in opposition to the defense offered by the accused driver identified as Kalyan Baisla, officers said.

According to police, Baisla had allegedly admitted to the collision after his arrest but claimed he had lost control of his vehicle near a U-turn and denied hitting her intentionally. Investigators, however, stated that the driver intentionally steered into the motorcycle following an act of misbehaviour.

The incident took place on September 13 on Golf Course Road. Chauhan, a 27-year-old resident of Delhi's Kalkaji who posts motoring content under the moniker Sia, was riding her sports bike alongside a group of friends. Footage captured on helmet-mounted cameras by Chauhan and a fellow rider showed a white car pursuing the group, officers said.

Occupants in the vehicle rolled down their windows, made alleged lewd gestures, and ordered her to pull over, police said.

When Chauhan refused to stop, the car accelerated, swerved sharply across lanes, and struck her motorcycle from the side before fleeing the scene, police added.

The impact threw Chauhan from the bike, sending her skidding across the road.

Gurugram Police initially registered a case at the Sector 56 police station and later added Section 109 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), which pertains to attempt to murder. The case also invokes BNS sections 78 (stalking), 79 (words, gestures, or acts intended to insult the modesty of a woman), and 3(5) (joint liability with common intention).

Police Commissioner Kaviraj had ordered the constitution of the SIT after receiving a notice on the matter from the Haryana State Commission for Women.

Four people were inside the vehicle at the time of the incident. Gurugram Police arrested Baisla and his cousin Lavnish from Rajgarh in Dausa, Rajasthan, on September 15. Both men remain lodged in Bhondsi Jail after the local court recently dismissed their bail petitions, police said.

Cop 'displayed revolver': Lawyers abstain from work indefinitely

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, October 27

LAWYERS ACROSS Delhi's district courts are "indefinitely" staying away from work, starting Tuesday, protesting against an assistant commissioner of police who allegedly displayed his revolver to advocates seeking action on the assault on a colleague.

The strike was called by the Coordination Committee of All District Courts Bar Associations of Delhi through a circular issued on Monday. The Committee, which held a meeting on Tuesday, said it resolved that the "abstention from judicial work shall continue indefinitely" until its demands are met.

"The matter originated from an FIR at Shahdara police station, concerning an incident in which Advocate Lalit Bansal sustained a serious head injury following an assault. Advocate Amulya Ratan is the complainant in the said matter... The seriousness of the injury called for a prompt, effective and impartial response from the police authorities, in accordance with law," the circular stated.

"On the evening of October 23, several advocates visited the Shahdara police station... to seek appropriate legal action against the persons concerned... The ACP and the SHO of Police Station Shahdara are stated to have assured the advocates that the persons named in the case would be arrested... On October 24, the advocates came to know that the persons concerned had not been arrested and had reportedly been released," it added.

The lawyers demanded suspension of the ACP, who allegedly showed them a gun, and other "erring" officers. "When advocates approached the police station to express their concern regarding the handling of the matter... an incident involving ACP Manasvi Vashishta occurred. According to the account placed before the Committee, the ACP displayed his revolver and threatened and intimidated the advocates... The Committee considers the circumstances surrounding this incident to be of utmost seriousness," Monday's circular read.

"After due deliberations, the Committee resolved that the abstention from judicial work in all District Courts of Delhi shall continue indefinitely until the demands of the Committee are fulfilled," another circular issued on Tuesday stated.

"The Committee reiterates its demand for the immediate suspension of ACP Manasvi Vashishta, the concerned SHO and other erring police officials of Police Station Shahdara, pending legal action," it added.

No demolition of Race Course Masjid until Oct 29: Centre

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, October 27

THE CENTRE on Tuesday gave an oral assurance to the Delhi High Court that it will not take any coercive action against the Race Course Masjid until Thursday.

The oral assurance came on a petition by a worshipper, Syed Ahmed Saud — represented by advocate M Sufian Siddiqui — who sought unrestricted access to the mosque as well as protection against its demolition.

Arguing that "worshippers (are) being prevented from entering the mosque", Siddiqui said "there is complete abdication of duty by the Delhi Waqf Board, by not taking due measures" to protect the 1977 Waqf-notified property.Saud, in his plea, has flagged that the Waqf Board's failure so far to "secure effective protection or disclose adequate legal steps despite knowledge of the threatened demolition" and "continuing restrictions constitutes a serious prima facie deficiency in the discharge of its statutory responsibilities".



A notice hangs outside the gate leading to the mosque. FILE

The mosque, located on the Race Course ground premises and opposite the Prime Minister's residence at 7, Lok Kalyan Marg, apprehended demolition after officials from the Land and Development Office (L&DO) reportedly orally instructed the Masjid's imam to vacate the premises for impending demolition in the absence of any written order. Water and electricity connections to the masjid premises were also disconnected on October 7.

The court Tuesday issued notice to the respondents — Delhi Waqf Board, L&DO and Delhi Police. It also court posed a specific query: if the Centre plans to demolish the mosque as well as a temple on the premises. The Centre, through the L&DO — represented by Union government standing counsel Ashish Dixit — sought time until Thursday to seek instructions.

Dixit argued that the masjid is part of the same land where jhuggi dwellers too resided and had approached court challenging the eviction and demolition notice served to them. He added orally, "As of now, we are not demolishing (the mosque)."

Justice Anish Dayal, however, asked if Dixit's submission can be recorded in the order.

Dixit answered in the negative, adding that he has only been instructed to the limited extent to inform the court that representations made by Saud as well as Delhi Waqf Board on disconnection of utilities will be decided.

Addressing Dixit, Justice Dayal remarked, "We will have to determine it (the reliefs and protection being sought in the petition), because under the cover of your submission that you will decide the representation, it cannot be that you demolish. Today the mosque is before us. Assuming that someone is raising the issue of the temple, then what? We assume you are not going to do anything in the next couple of days?"

Dixit sought time until Thursday to return with instructions, adding, "As an officer of court, I will brief the officers on this (to not take any action towards demolition of the mosque until Thursday)."

The court will hear the matter next on October 29.

Earlier this month, the imam moved the HC seeking restoration of the disconnected utilities in the absence of an eviction order. The plea was dismissed. The New Delhi Municipal Council had refused to restore the utilities, saying "demolition work is still going on" in the area.

• THE CHAIMAR GANG HAS BEEN LINKED TO A SERIES OF ROBBERIES AND MURDERS

'Kill six' gang: Inside Kachha Baniyan offshoot with crime trail in UP and Haryana

Pragynesh
New Delhi, October 27

THEY MOVE from one city to another with their families. They live on the fringes in makeshift jhuggis and pose as labourers or beggars to scout potential targets before carrying out robberies — and allegedly committing murder.

This is the modus operandi of the Chaimar gang, an offshoot of the Kachha Baniyan gang. Police said the gang's name comes from the Hindi words: '*chai* (six)' and '*maar* (kill)'. Police claimed that to become its leader, a person has to commit at least six murders.

On October 25, the alleged gang leader, Savan, 53, landed in the Delhi Police net following a shootout while he was scouting farmhouses in South Delhi, officers said. His arrest has brought renewed attention to a gang linked to a series of robberies and killings in Uttar Pradesh and Punjab.

Around 1 am on August 28, 2016, a family was asleep inside its grocery shop-cum-home in Mathura's Pathak Nagar area. Gopal Sharma and his father, Randev, were sleeping in a room just behind the shutters. Gopal's mother and sister, Kusumlata, were in the verandah.

Police said Savan and three other men — Akbar, Salim and Harun — were allegedly moving through the neighbourhood with sticks, looking for a house to rob. They were dressed in boxers and vests, with oil smeared on their arms.

The four reached Railway Road, where the Sharmas lived, and targeted their home.

According to Uttar Pradesh Police records, they entered the premises from the back. Kusumlata, 17, woke up and saw them. When she and her mother screamed, the men allegedly began beating them up. Gopal and his father rushed in after hearing the screams, but were beaten too.

"The robbers fled; Kusumlata died from the injuries. This was allegedly the seventh murder by the group," said a senior police officer.

"They had committed two similar robberies in 2014: One in Jaunpur, where they killed a man while robbing his house, and another in Punjab's Mansa, where they entered with four other people and killed five members of the same family," said the officer.

After the Mathura incident, police prepared sketches of the four men and circulated them across several North Indian states. Savan's sketch was recognised in Mansa and Jaunpur.

The four were arrested in 2016. They were convicted and sentenced to life imprisonment in 2023. In 2025, Allahabad HC granted bail to them after they challenged their sentences. The court said the sentence shall remain suspended during the pendency of the appeal.

After their release on bail, police said Savan and the other three allegedly moved their families from Uttar Pradesh to Ambedkar Nagar in Alwar. They subsequently began making frequent visits to Delhi.

In July this year, police said the group allegedly identified a farmhouse in Mehrauli as a potential target. They entered the premises but could not reach the house and left, an officer said.

On October 25, the Delhi Police alleged, Savan was scouting South Delhi farmhouses in the Maidan Garhi area of Saket when police received a tip-off about his presence.

"At 6.25 am, the suspect arrived on a motorcycle from Bass Gaon Road and was identified by a secret informer. When the police team attempted to intercept him, he allegedly opened fire using a country-made pistol. Sub-Inspector (SI) Narendra Kumar fired three warning rounds. The suspect subsequently took out another country-made pistol and allegedly fired again, with a bullet striking the bulletproof jacket of SI Kumar," said DCP (South) Anant Mittal.

Another police officer on the team then fired at Savan, hitting him in the right calf. He was taken to AIIMS and will soon be questioned in detail, said police. According to police, the Chaimar gang originated in Kannauj in Uttar Pradesh before spreading to other parts of the state and to Haryana.

An officer investigating Savan's case told *The Indian Express* that his family was among the more notorious groups. "His brother, Fati, was arrested after an encounter last year in Mathura. He had 17 cases lodged against him," the officer said.

• How the case unravelled

SAVAN AND three aides allegedly raided a Mathura home in 2016, leading to the murder of 17-year-old Kusumlata.

SKETCHES CIRCULATED across states led to four arrests in 2016.

POLICE LINK the gang to earlier killings in Jaunpur, Mansa in 2014.

THE FOUR got life sentence in 2023; released on bail in 2025 after court suspended their sentence during pendency of appeal.

OUT ON bail, the four moved their families from UP to Alwar; members eyed a Mehrauli farmhouse in July as potential target.



Savan of Chaimar gang.

SAVAN WAS arrested on October 25 after a shootout with police.

BRICS JOINT DECLARATION



Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla and Rajya Sabha Deputy Chairman Harivansh with the Joint Declaration during the 12th BRICS Parliamentary Forum 2026 at the Parliament House, on Tuesday. ANI

Forum condemns Pahalgam terror attack and seeks UNSC reforms

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 27

THE 12TH BRICS Parliamentary Forum, which concluded on Tuesday, adopted a joint declaration, condemning the Pahalgam terror attack, expressing concerns over continued escalation of tensions in West Asia and seeking reforms in the United Nations, including its Security Council.

The two-day forum opened by Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla on Monday drew participation from BRICS member countries — Brazil, China, Egypt, Ethiopia, India, Indonesia, Iran, Russia, South Africa and the United Arab Emirates.

Condemning the Pahalgam terror attack, the joint declaration said: "We express strong condemnation of any acts of terrorism as criminal and unjustifiable, regardless of their motivation, whenever, wherever and by whomsoever committed. We condemn in the strongest terms the terrorist attack in Jammu and Kashmir on 22 April 2025, during which 26 people were killed and many more injured."

"We reaffirm our commitment to combating terrorism in all its forms and manifestations, including the cross-border movement of terrorists, terrorism financing and safe havens. We reiterate that terrorism should not be associated with any religion, nationality, civilization or ethnic group and that all those involved in terrorist activities and their support must be held accountable and brought to justice in accordance with relevant national and international law. We urge to ensure zero tolerance for terrorism and reject double standards in countering terrorism," it said.

The joint declaration also called for an expeditious finalisation and adoption of the Comprehensive Convention on International Terrorism in the UN framework.

The joint declaration also expressed concerns over the tensions in West Asia in the wake of the US-Israel war with Iran.

"We express deep concern over the continued escalation of tensions in the Middle East/West Asia and, recalling our respective national positions, call for exercising maximum restraint, as well as avoiding actions that could further aggravate the situation...," it said.

Seeking reforms in the UN, the Forum said, "We stress the urgency of reforming the current international peace and security architecture, which necessarily requires the strengthening of multilateralism, and support a comprehensive reform of the United Nations, including its Security Council."

Man with 21 lakh online followers gets 33 votes in panchayat polls

Press Trust of India
Jodhpur, October 27

HAVING A huge following on social media does not guarantee a win in an election. This bitter truth was highlighted by the results of a sarpanch election in Osian tehsil of Jodhpur district, where popular influencer and YouTuber Omprakash Bishnoi, an astrologer and face reader, suffered a crushing defeat despite having over 21 lakh followers across digital platforms.

Bishnoi, who contested the election in Indon Ki Dhani-II gram panchayat, secured just 33 votes in a village with around 1,600 voters. His defeat came as a surprise, given his substantial online popularity.

He has over 14 lakh followers on Instagram, over 2 lakh on Facebook and approximately 5.5 lakh subscribers on YouTube. An astrologer and face reader, Bishnoi, is also the president of a cow shelter.

Following the announcement of the results, Bishnoi took to his official social media accounts to thank the voters of his native village and accept their verdict gracefully.

"Heartfelt thanks to all the voters of Indon Ki Dhani Second Gram Panchayat, my birthplace, for giving me so much support...Out of the nearly 1,600 people in my village, only 33 members of my own family voted in my favour. I contested the election for the post of sarpanch from my village, and the fact that my election office remained completely free of intoxicants is itself a matter of great satisfaction for me. Everyone claims to stand by you, but it is in times like these that you discover who truly supports you from the heart. May Lord Dwarkadhish fulfil all your wishes," he wrote.

His dignified response to the defeat and emphasis on a drug-free campaign have drawn appreciation on social media.

INDIAN FARMERS FERTILISERS COOPERATIVE LIMITED

NOTIFICATION FOR THE ELECTION OF 03 CASUAL VACANCIES IN THE BOARD OF DIRECTORS – CONSTITUENCY NO. XIV

The election of **03 Casual Vacancies** in the Board of Directors-**Constituency No. XIV** of Indian Farmers Fertilisers Cooperative Limited will be conducted at **IFFCO Sadan, C-1, District Centre, Saket, Delhi** in accordance with following schedule :

1.	Last Date of receiving of resolution of delegates from member organization Societies by RO	02nd November, 2026 (Monday)
2.	Publication of Provisional List of Delegates eligible to vote on website and notice board	06th November, 2026 (Friday) By Evening
3.	Time window for Raising Objection to the Provisional List	09th to 11th November, 2026 (Monday to Wednesday) 11:00 AM to 03:00 PM
4.	Scrutiny of objection received to the Provisional List (if any)	12th to 13th November, 2026 (Thursday-Friday) 11:00 AM to 03:00 PM
5.	Publication of final list of Members/ Delegates, eligible to vote on website & notice	13th November, 2026 (Friday) By Evening
6.	Issue and Filing of Nomination Form	16th to 19th November, 2026 (Monday to Thursday) 11:00 AM to 03:00 PM
7.	Display of nominations on website and notice board received by Returning Officer.	19th November, 2026 (Thursday) By Evening
8.	Scrutiny of Received Nomination Forms	20th November, 2026 (Friday) Till Completion of Scrutiny
9.	Publication of List of Valid Nominations	20th November, 2026 (Friday) After Completion of Scrutiny
10.	Withdrawal of Nominations	23rd November, 2026 (Monday) 11:00 AM to 03:00 PM
11.	Publication of Final List of Contesting Candidates	23rd November, (Monday) 2026 By Evening
12.	Date of Polling, if any	30th November, 2026 (Monday) 08:00 AM to 04:00 PM and all those who have entered polling station at 04 PM or before should be allowed to cast vote
13.	Counting of votes	30th November, (Monday) 2026 Immediately after polling
14.	Submission of Form 19M with recommendation for seeking approval of CEA before declaration of result of BOD	01st December, 2026 (Tuesday)
15.	Declaration of Result of Board of Directors	On or before 08th December, 2026 (Tuesday).

For more details **www.iffco.in**

LAKSHAY SINGHAL,IAS
RETURNING OFFICER, IFFCO



Police 'assault' on Brittas: Home Secy reply sought

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 27

MORE THAN two weeks after CPI(M) MP John Brittas was allegedly assaulted by security personnel on October 11, during a protest in central Delhi against CEC Gyanesh Kumar, the Rajya Sabha Secretariat has sought a response from the Home Secretary, it is learnt.

Brittas had written to President Droupadi Murmu, Vice-President and Rajya Sabha Chairman C P Radhakrishnan and CJI Surya Kant, alleging breach of Parliamentary privilege. "This is not merely an assault on an MP. It is an assault on democratic freedoms and the rule of law... it happened within hours of the Supreme Court issuing directions to safeguard peaceful protest and constitutional rights," he said in a post on X.

FORM NO. NCLT. 3A
BEFORE THE NATIONAL COMPANY LAW TRIBUNAL, NEW DELHI BENCH (COURT- VI)
CP (CAA)- 64/ND/2026
in
CA No. CA(CAA)- 41/ND/2026
In the matter of the Companies Act, 2013
AND
In the matter of section 230 to 232
and other applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013
AND
In the matter of Scheme of Amalgamation
Between
Avinya Batteries Limited
(Transferor Company/Petitioner Company 1)
and
PPAP Automotive Limited
(Transferee Company/Petitioner Company 2)
and
their respective shareholders

1. AVINYA BATTERIES LIMITED, a company, incorporated under the Companies Act, 2013 **CIN: U31109DL2015PLC274891,** Regd. Off: 54, Okhla Industrial Estate, Phase III, South Delhi, New Delhi- 110020, PAN: - AAHCP9448F **... Petitioner Company No. 1/Transferor Company**
2. PPAP AUTOMOTIVE LIMITED, a company, incorporated under the Companies Act, 1956 **CIN: L74899DL1995PLC073281,** Regd. Off: 54, Okhla Industrial Estate, Phase III, South Delhi, New Delhi- 110020, PAN: - AAACP5144P. **... Petitioner Company No. 2/ Transferee Company**

NOTICE OF PETITION

A petition under section 230-232 of the Companies Act, 2013, for sanctioning of the Scheme of Amalgamation between Avinya Batteries Limited (Transferor Company/Petitioner Company 1) and PPAP Automotive Limited (Transferee Company/Petitioner Company 2) and their respective shareholders was presented by Petitioner Companies before the New Delhi Bench (Court No. VI) of the National Company Law Tribunal on 16.10.2026 and the said petition is fixed for hearing before National Company Law Tribunal, New Delhi (Court No. VI) on **21.01.2027.** Any person desirous of supporting or opposing the instant petition should send to the Petitioner's advocate, notice of his intention, signed by him or his advocate, with his name and address, so as to reach the Petitioner's advocate not later than two days before the date fixed for the hearing of the petition.

Where he seeks to oppose the petition, the grounds of opposition or a copy of his affidavit shall be furnished with such notice. A copy of the petition will be furnished by the undersigned to any person requiring the same on payment of the prescribed charges for the same.

Sd/-
Dhritiman Bhattacharyya / Deeti Ojha
Advocates, Unity Legal, S 369, GK 2, New Delhi 110048
Ph : 9818499377 / 9650806620 / 011-41435356
dhritiman.bhattacharyya@unitylegal.com

Date : 27-10-2026

HBSU

Dr Homi Bhabha State University, Munbai

The Search-cum-Selection Committee invites Applications/Nominations for

THE POST OF VICE-CHANCELLOR

APPLICATIONS/ Nominations are invited for the post of Vice-Chancellor. Dr Homi Bhabha State University, Mumbai. Candidates who fulfil the prescribed qualifications and experience may submit applications in the prescribed format to the Nodal Otficer on Email ID: **nodal_scsc@hbsu.ac.in** on or before **Monday, 28th November 2026.**

The application format and other details are available on the web site : **www.hbsu.ac.in**. The candidates are also required to submit two (02) hard copies of the application. along with supporting documents (to a maximum of 50 pages) by post. so as to reach on or before **15th December 2026** at the following address :

The Nodal Officer (Search-cum-Selection Committee - VC).
Dr. Homi Bhabha State University.
Dr. Shyama Prasad Mukherjee Chowk. Mahatma Gandhi Road, Fort, Mumbai-400 032.

Eminent Persons/Peers may also nominate suitable candidates in the prescribed format (A soft copy by email and two hard copies of the same on the above address as well). The timeline and other conditions for the nominations will remain the same as for other applicants. Applications received after the due date shall not be considered.

Date : 28.10.2026

Chairman
Scarch-cum-Selection Committee

DGIPR-2026-27/3416

टीएचडीसी इंडिया लिमिटेड
THDC INDIA LIMITED
(अनुसूची 'ए' मिनी रत्न श्रेणी-I, पीएसयू, एनटीपीसी लिमिटेड की सहायक कंपनी)
(Schedule 'A' Mini Ratna Category-I PSU, a subsidiary of NTPC Limited)
CIN : U45203UR1988GOI009822



[Regulation 52 (8), read with Regulation 52 (4) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (LODR Regulations)]
Extract of the Unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter & Six Months ended 30 September 2026
(₹ in Crore)

S. No.	Particulars	Standalone					Consolidated				
		Quarter Ended		Six Months Ended		Year Ended	Quarter Ended		Six Months Ended		Year Ended
		30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)	30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
1	Total Income from Operations	2,214.27	1,641.82	3,839.74	2,721.41	7,087.50	2,214.29	1,642.07	3,839.76	2,721.74	7,087.66
2	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items#)	771.37	451.44	1,121.68	632.04	1,028.58	771.06	451.03	1,121.09	631.14	1,018.84
3	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items#)	771.37	451.44	1,121.68	632.04	1,028.58	771.06	451.03	1,121.09	631.14	1,018.84
4	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items#)	675.71	454.36	969.54	598.60	1,036.15	675.44	454.08	969.01	597.96	1,028.97
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/(Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	673.06	454.61	964.24	599.08	1,028.94	672.79	454.33	963.71	598.44	1,021.76
6	Paid up Equity Share Capital	4,358.53	3,665.88	4,358.53	3,665.88	4,358.53	4,358.53	3,665.88	4,358.53	3,665.88	4,358.53
7	Other equity (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	8,436.65	7,549.30	8,436.65	7,549.30	7,965.38	8,426.80	7,544.69	8,426.80	7,544.69	7,955.92
8	Securities Premium Account	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
9	Net worth*	12,795.18	11,201.39	12,795.18	11,201.39	12,323.91	12,785.33	11,196.78	12,785.33	11,196.78	12,314.45
10	Paid up Debt Capital	23,631.44	23,393.28	23,631.44	23,393.28	23,249.92	23,663.66	23,545.68	23,663.66	23,545.68	23,320.28
11	Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
12	Debt Equity Ratio	1.85	2.09	1.85	2.09	1.89	1.85	2.10	1.85	2.10	1.89
13	Earnings Per equity share (of ₹10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations) -										
	1. Basic: (in ₹)	1.55	1.24	2.22	1.63	2.79	1.55	1.24	2.22	1.63	2.78
	2. Diluted: (in ₹)	1.55	1.24	2.22	1.63	2.78	1.55	1.24	2.22	1.63	2.76
14	Capital Redemption Reserve	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
15	Debenture Redemption Reserve	516.47	415.05	516.47	415.05	467.26	516.47	415.05	516.47	415.05	467.26
16	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	1.91	2.06	1.65	1.79	1.68	1.90	2.05	1.65	1.78	1.67
17	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	3.43	2.94	3.06	2.75	2.37	3.43	2.94	3.06	2.75	2.37

- Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items adjusted in the Statement of Profit and Loss in accordance with Ind AS Rules / AS Rules, whichever is applicable.
*Excluding fly ash utilization reserve.

Notes:
1. The above results have been approved by the Board of Directors at their meeting held on 26.10.2026.
2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of financial Results filed with the Stock Exchange(s) under Regulation 52 of the Listing Regulations. The full format of the Financial Results is available on the websites of the stock exchange(s) and THDCIL **(https://beta.bseindia.com/xml-data/corpfiling/AttachLive/07b1a928-34bb-426b-8319-2fa39d1452a7.pdf** and **https://nsearchives.nseindia.com/content/debt/WDM/TIL671_26102026141402_Outcome.pdf)**
3. For the other line items referred in regulation 52(4) of the Listing Regulations, pertinent disclosures have been made to the stock exchange(s) (NSE and BSE) and can be accessed on the URL **(https://beta.bseindia.com/xml-data/corpfiling/AttachLive/07b1a928-34bb-426b-8319-2fa39d1452a7.pdf** and **https://nsearchives.nseindia.com/content/debt/WDM/TIL671_26102026141402_Outcome.pdf)**

Dated: **26.10.2026**
Place: **New Delhi**

THDC INDIA LIMITED
Registered Office: Ganga Bhawan, Pragatipuram, Bypass Road, Rishikesh, Dehradun- 249201
Website: **www.thdc.co.in**; Email: **csrksh@thdc.co.in**

For and on Behalf of Board of Directors
(Sipan Kumar Garg)
Managing Director and Director (Finance)
DIN: 10746205

@THDCIL24x7 @thdc_india_limited @THDC India Limited-Official @THDC India Limited-Official @THDCIL_MOP

DELHI CONFIDENTIAL



Art Fest

WITH INDIA'S return to the Venice Biennale after a seven-year gap being hailed as a success, Union Culture Minister Gajendra Shekhawat is keen to replicate the concept in India. He has planned an art biennale in the Capital which would go on for 108 days. The event will start on December 4 and continue till March 21. Monuments, including Purana Qila, Qutub Minar and the National Gallery of Modern Art, will be the venues for the exhibition. Artists from across the country and 20-odd countries will take part in it. Around 15,000 artistes will perform in the biennale and make it a wholesome cultural event. Shekhawat wants to make the event one of the major art celebrations in the world and India a major art destination.

Past Tense

AMID THE Opposition's allegations of violence and intimidation ahead of rural body polls in Andhra Pradesh, Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu has claimed to have provided special police security to YSRCP candidates filing their nomination. Naidu's statement follows the Supreme Court's direction to the State Election Commission to prevent poll-related violence in the state. To prove that things are better under the Naidu government, TDP leaders have circulated a letter by N Ramesh Kumar, the SEC in 2020 — when the state last had local body polls — in which he complained to the Union Home Secretary and sought central force protection for him under the then Jagan Mohan Reddy government. In the letter, Kumar had pointed out that at least 24% of the Mandal Parishad candidates and 19% of Zilla Parishad ones were unanimously elected whereas those were only 2% and 0.09% respectively, in 2014. In Kadapa, Jagan's constituency, the share of the elected unopposed was 79% and 76%, the letter states.

Ladies Special

THE SUPREME Court has acceded to a request to relax the dress code for women employees of its Registry on the occasion of Karwa Chauth on Thursday. An official communication said the Competent Authority has agreed to the request received on behalf of the women employees to permit them to attend office in sober attire on October 29, 2026, in place of the prescribed official uniform.

ENVIRONMENTAL CONCERNS: PANEL SEEKS SCRUTINY OF HIGHWAY EXPANSIONS

SC panel: Need capacity study for tourism hubs in Himachal

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, October 27

THE SUPREME Court's Central Empowered Committee (CEC) has recommended a slew of measures — short-term and long-term — to protect the environment and ecology of Himachal Pradesh. The measures include assessing the carrying capacity of major tourist destinations, completing pending compensatory afforestation works, considering mandatory environmental clearance for construction or expansion of hill roads with two or more lanes, and railway lines.

The recommendations were made in a report following examination of the thematic areas of hydroelectric projects, compensatory afforestation, roads and tourism and multi-storey buildings, on the directions of the Supreme Court. The CEC advises the court on writ petitions related to environment and forest matters, and assists in monitoring of its orders.

The committee said in its opinion, the rapid expansion of tourism-related construction in Himachal Pradesh requires a shift from a "permission-based approach to a coordinated system of scientific, carrying capacity assessment, risk-sensitive planning, inter-departmental regulation and continuing compliance monitoring".

It said the state government should implement the measures recommended in a time-bound manner. The CEC report submitted a range of observations and findings on these four thematic areas, such as a 10% shortfall in the compensatory afforestation for forest land diverted since 1980-81, landslides due to engineering failures, and near-vertical excavation on slopes.

CEC'S KEY OBSERVATIONS

Compensatory Afforestation

- Against the target of 34,169 hectares during 1981-82 to 2025-26, plantation reported over 30,462 hectares, leaving a shortfall of 3,707 hectares (10.85%). Hydropower, roads and transmission lines accounted for highest forest diversion.
- During 2020-21 to 2025-26, against an approved Annual Plan of Operations of ₹1,110.81 crore, ₹865.10 crore was allocated and ₹592.69 crore spent. The gap between planned and actual expenditure has affected the timely implementation of plantation and conservation activities.

Roads

- CEC has recommended that the Transport Ministry and NHAI establish a mechanism for appointing an Ombudsman in each state to examine grievances arising from NHAI project implementation.
- NHAI reported Rs 198 crore in damage — Rs 27 crore on Parwanoo–Solan and Rs 171 crore on Mandi-Palampur-Kiratpur alignment — between 2021 and 2026.

Hydropower

- Inspections revealed rehabilitation of muck-dumping sites of Larji, Parvati–III and Parvati–II hydroelectric projects remains incomplete, although afforestation is reported as complete.
- Projects below 10 MW account for 866 of the 1,007 projects. Only 136 of these projects have been commissioned, while 470 remain under clearance and investigation and 217 are yet to be allotted.

Tourism

- Registered hotels in Himachal increased by 90.8%, from 2,784 in 2016 to 5,311 in 2026. Registered homestays grew much faster, by 669.7%, from 876 to 6,743, and now outnumber hotels.
- Hotel growth was highest in Kullu (136%), Hamirpur (115%) and Kangra (108%), while homestay growth was higher in Lahaul and Spiti (5,315%), Kinnaur (1,556%) and Hamirpur (1,500%)

SOURCE: CEC REPORT TO SUPREME COURT

The SC had taken suo motu cognizance of environmental concerns prevailing in Himachal in July 2025 in the context of developmental pressures, landslides and the fragile ecosystem. Later in July 2026, it directed the CEC to "undertake a comprehensive examination of nine identified thematic issues" and submit reports. On Tuesday, a bench of Justices Vikram Nath, Sandeep Mehta and Aparesh Kumar Singh took up the matter and granted the Himachal government time to file its response to the CEC's recommendations.

The CEC was directed to examine nine thematic areas. In the first phase, it examined four areas. The SC panel's examination involved independent assessment of the information furnished by the state government, including site visits and evaluation of existing regulatory measures, as per the report.

Some of the crucial findings in CEC report pertained to road expansions and tourism in the hill state. During site visits, the panel found repeated damage to national highways. It noted that the NHAI approved Rs 825 crore for restoration and stabilisation on the Kiratpur-Manali corridor, after geological investigations identified 44 critical landslide and erosion-prone locations.

Among its recommendations, it said the ministry shall review the exemptions from environmental clearance in place for certain NH expansion projects.



State Visit

Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Liechtenstein's Prince Alois and Princess Sophie at Hyderabad House in New Delhi on Tuesday. Prince Alois is on a four-day visit to India. Secretary (West) in the MEA, Sibi George, said at a media briefing that Modi and Alois explored ways to enhance bilateral ties in areas of trade and investment, advanced manufacturing, tech, innovation, financial services, agriculture, space, education, and skill development. PTI

'We know everything': SC on pleas alleging unilateral ECI decisions

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 27

THE SUPREME Court said Tuesday it would examine all aspects of the controversy surrounding the functioning of the Election Commission of India (ECI), including allegations that its decisions to conduct the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls were not unanimous.

"We know everything. We will examine," Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said while presiding over a three-judge bench hearing petitions challenging the poll body's functioning.

The CJI fixed the matter for hearing on November 17 to enable the petitioners to file their counter to ECI's affidavit, which asserted that the decisions were "unanimous".

The CJI made the remark as Senior Advocate A M Singhvi, appearing for Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi and INDIA Bloc leaders, urged the bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, to direct preservation of the file notings and ECI's internal communications, which he contended are crucial to decide if the decisions were taken unanimously.

"This whole issue depends on the decision-making process, consultation, and whether the decision was unanimous or not unanimous," Singhvi submitted.

Appearing for TMC MP Dola Sen, Senior Advocate Menaka Guruswamy said the ECI affidavit had in fact proved the petitioners' right. She alleged that the poll body had tampered with Form 6, used for enrolling new voters, and had also released a press release claiming the SC had approved it.

Opposing this, Senior Advocate Maninder Singh, who represented ECI, called her submission "rhetoric".

In the joint affidavit filed Monday, Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi said they acted "unanimously" in issuing orders to schedule SIR in states and Union Territories.

The joint affidavit was filed before the Supreme Court, which heard petitions regarding ECI's functioning after *The Indian Express*'s September 23 report.

UP CEO's office apologises for jibe on Council voter roll error

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, October 27

THE UTTAR Pradesh Chief Electoral Officer's (CEO) office Tuesday apologised for the tone of its social media post responding to criticism over errors in the Legislative Council electoral roll.

In a post on X, it said, "The language, tone and sharp nature of the comments in the earlier post are not in keeping with the communication expected from an official handle... We sincerely apologise to those who were surprised and upset by this. From now on, our communication will be dignified and formal."

The controversy began after opposition leaders raised questions over bizarre voter names, such as "Ram ne Yadav ko maara (Ram beat Yadav)", appearing in the electoral roll for the MLC polls in UP. The entry was later clarified by the UP CEO office as a translation error involving the name "Ramhit Yadav".

In a post on X in Hindi, AAP Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Singh had asked, "Gyanesh Kumar ji, why did Ram hit only a Yadav? Why did Ram not hit any Singh, Pathak, Asthana, Sharma, Rai or Bisht? Is your computer casteist? Are you running the agenda of any political party?"

In response, the UP CEO's handle stated: "The recent Legislative Council election voter list also contains a strange name: 'Ram beat Sharma'. Computers/software are not casteist. We accept that a mistake was made, but fortunately, even while making the mistake, there was no caste discrimination. We should also thank God that Ram did not kill a member of a minority community..."

After the errors were found in 158 of the 14.81 lakh entries in the electoral rolls for the biennial elections to five graduate and six teachers' constituencies, CEO Navdeep Rinwa had demanded explanations from officials responsible.

Rinwa had attributed the discrepancies to a combination of software-related errors and human negligence.

EXPRESS special

Rice at Rs 61.66/kg, Tur Dal at Rs 134.23: TN seeks stock limits

Proposed limits for wholesalers, retailers, millers, drawing on earlier Central orders

Harikishan Sharma
New Delhi, October 27



Monthly average retail prices of several commodities in Tamil Nadu were higher than their respective all-India averages, per data. FILE

WITH RETAIL prices of several essential commodities in Tamil Nadu exceeding national averages, the state government has sought the Centre's approval to impose stockholding limits on rice, pulses, edible oils, and onions to curb hoarding and black marketing.

Stockholding limits restrict the quantity of a commodity that traders and other market participants can keep in stock. The Centre generally imposes such limits under Section 3 of the Essential Commodities Act, 1955.

The state government has sought the Centre's concurrence to introduce limits on the specified commodities, for which no such limits are currently in force, according to the information cited in its proposal.

In a letter to the Union Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution, the state government said the restrictions were necessary to ensure essential commodities remain available to the public at reasonable prices.

The Tamil Nadu government is learnt to have cited "global factors" and "crop failure due to El Niño", arguing that these conditions could encourage wholesalers and millers to hold large stocks and engage in hoarding and black marketing, adding to inflationary pressures and eroding consumers' purchasing power.

Data available on the Department of Consumer Affairs' portal shows that the monthly average retail prices of several of these commodities in Tamil Nadu were higher than their respective all-India averages during April-September of the current financial year.

In September, rice was priced at Rs 61.66 per kg in Tamil Nadu, against the national average of Rs 46.20 per kg. Tur dal cost Rs 134.23 per kg, compared with the all-India average of Rs 124.41 per kg. Onion prices stood at Rs 59.28 per kg in the state, against Rs 52.96 nationally, while palm oil was priced at Rs 160.28 per litre, compared with the national average of Rs 150.91 per litre.

According to sources, Tamil Nadu has proposed limits similar to those the Centre imposed through orders issued in previous years.

The state has cited these earlier orders as precedents for the restrictions it is seeking.

For paddy and rice, the state has proposed a stockholding limit of 2,000 metric tonnes for wholesalers and eight metric tonnes for retailers. Millers would be allowed to hold stocks equivalent to no more than one month's production capacity.

To justify the proposed rice limits, the state has cited the Centre's wheat stockholding order issued on January 16, 2026. That order applied across states but remained in force only until March 31, 2026.

For tur and urad dal, Tamil Nadu has proposed a stockholding limit of 200 metric tonnes for wholesalers and five metric tonnes for retailers.

The state has cited the Centre's July 11, 2024, order imposing stockholding limits on tur and chana, which remained in force until September 30, 2024.

For edible oils, including mustard, palm, sunflower, and groundnut oils, as well as vanaspati, the proposed limits are 500 quintals for wholesalers and 30 quintals for retailers.

The state has referred to the Centre's order dated March 30, 2022, which imposed stockholding limits on edible oils for the period from April 1 to December 31, 2022.

For onions, the state has proposed limits of 25 metric tonnes for wholesalers and two metric tonnes for retailers.

It has cited the Centre's October 23, 2020, order imposing onion stockholding limits across states and Union Territories until December 31, 2020.

Cong: Will hold 'public impeachment' of CEC at Kharge's house on Friday

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 27

AFTER DELHI Police "denied" INDIA bloc permission to hold the "public impeachment" of CEC Gyanesh Kumar at Ramlila Maidan, Congress leaders on Tuesday said it will be held at party chief Mallikarjun Kharge's residence — 10, Rajaji Marg — on October 30.

Speaking to reporters at Ramlila Maidan on Tuesday afternoon, Congress general secretary (organisation) K C Venugopal said: "We don't know how scared PM Modi and Amit Shah are, even for a minimal gathering. We announced the public impeachment of Gyanesh Kumar. We planned a march on November 1... We have permission from October 25 to November 3... We decided to conduct the public impeachment here. The day before yesterday, our people came to construct the infrastructure. The police stopped them. We don't know what the reason is."

Venugopal alleged that the decision to deny permission was that of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah, not Delhi Police.

REGIONAL LEADERS AND WORKERS RAISE ISSUES OF 'NEGLECT BY SECTIONS OF LEADERSHIP AND STATE GOVT', PARTY ASKS THEM TO DO MORE TO DEFEND AGAINST OPPOSITION'S ATTACKS

Ahead of UP polls, Nitin Nabin, senior leaders hear out unhappy BJP workers

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, October 27

FOUR MONTHS before the Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections, the BJP has launched a feedback exercise to iron out internal differences.

While several regional BJP leaders have flagged the "disappointment" that party workers feel due to their alleged neglect by sections of the party leadership and state administration, senior leaders have told the district functionaries they were not doing enough to counter the Samajwadi Party's (SP) attacks on Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath and his government.

The feedback was shared at recent organisational meetings chaired by senior leaders of the BJP and the RSS. The meetings were held separately by BJP national president Nitin Nabin, the party's UP co-in-charges Jagdish Patel and Pradip Kumar Varma, and RSS sah-sarkaryawah (joint general secretary) Arun Kumar. The meetings were organised in Varanasi and Sultanpur earlier this month as part of the statewide exercise to galvanise the BJP's regional leaders and workers ahead of the 2027 polls.

"The meetings were held to let party workers vent...The BJP and Sangh will take note of the concerns raised," a senior UP BJP functionary said on the condition of anonymity.

Nabin chaired a meeting in Varanasi city on October 8 with the BJP's former office-bearers in the Kashi region. At the meeting, a leader questioned the party's "criteria" for rewarding workers, it is learnt. The leader alleged that "those who meet top party leaders in Delhi and Lucknow with flower bouquets get positions in the organisational teams, whereas those who work on the ground are neglected," sources said. BJP national general secretary Smriti Irani, UP state president Pankaj Chaudhary, and Jagdish Patel were also present.

A BJP leader is learnt to have said that allotting Assembly election tickets and ministerial berths to "outsiders" might be "acceptable", but accommodating them in senior organisational posts "makes it difficult for dedicated workers to work with them". Another leader suggested replacing sitting MLAs in the Varanasi region with fresh faces, sources said.



The meetings were held separately by BJP National President Nitin Nabin, party's co-in-charges and others. PTI

On October 14-15, Patel and Varma chaired a two-day workshop of BJP *vistaraks* (full-time workers tasked with outreach and expansion) and in-charges of the Kashi region's 71 Assembly seats and the Gorakhpur region's 62 constituencies. At the workshop, held in Varanasi city, the central leaders expressed concern that district functionaries, including MLAs, were "not showing enthusiasm" in defending the CM and the state government against the SP's allegations and attacks using AI-generated videos. "It was discussed that while SP workers were enthusiastic and aggressive in circulating social media posts of Akhilesh Yadav, BJP leaders were comparatively less enthusiastic in defending CM Adityanath and the BJP," said a BJP insider who attended the workshop.

"It was pointed out by our leaders from the dais that party MLAs were posting messages to wish birthdays to their near-and-dear ones but not bothering to counter the SP's allegations against the CM and the BJP on various political issues," said the source.

RSS's Arun Kumar had chaired a meeting of the Sangh Parivar in Sultanpur on October 5. At the meeting, BJP leader Govind Singh Chauhan from Amethi, who is also the Kashi region head of RSS affiliate Vidya Bharti, asked how workers could trust local leaders if they could not "ensure justice at police stations and government offices".

Chauhan also asked why "party hoppers" wield more influence in the belt and alleged that Opposition workers were "getting more respect at government offices". "Some other participants in the meeting also suggested reforms in the functioning of the organisation. I said BJP workers should not be disregarded and that bureaucracy's working style should be improved," he told *The Indian Express*.

BJP national general secretary (organisation) B L Santhosh, Pankaj Chaudhary, state BJP general secretary (organisation) Dharampal Singh, and leaders from different Sangh affiliates from the Kashi and Gorakhpur regions were present at the meeting.

UP BJP spokesperson Rakesh Tripathi said he had no information as he was not present at the meetings, while the BJP central leadership did not respond to queries.

After the BJP faced a setback in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections in UP, several party leaders listed "disappointment among party workers because of neglect" by the administration among the major factors for its poor performance. The BJP's tally had plunged from 62 to 33 of the state's 80 seats, while the SP won 37 seats, its best-ever performance in the parliamentary polls.

MCOCA invoked against 11 in Tiger Shroff firing case

Express News Service
Mumbai, October 27

THE MUMBAI police crime branch has invoked the Maharashtra Control of Organised Crime Act (MCOCA) against the 11 people arrested so far in the October 18 firing on actor Tiger Shroff's car in Juhu.

The move makes it much harder for the accused to get bail. Police have used the same law in other cases allegedly carried out at the behest of the Lawrence Bishnoi gang: the 2024 firing outside Salman Khan's house, the killing of NCP leader Baba Siddique the same year, and the firing outside filmmaker Rohit Shetty's home earlier this year.

Two shooters fired at Shroff's car as he was leaving a football ground in Juhu. Shroff escaped unhurt, while his driver and an autorickshaw driver were injured in the incident for which the Lawrence Bishnoi gang has claimed responsibility.

Under the MCOCA Act, a court can grant bail only if it is satisfied that there are reasonable grounds to believe the accused is not guilty. Police get 180 days instead of 90 to file a chargesheet. Confessions before an officer of DCP rank are admissible as evidence.

DCP (Crime) Raj Tilak Roushan said the police had invoked Sections 3(1)(ii), which covers punishment for organised crime where no death has resulted, 3(2), facilitating organised crime, and 3(4), membership of an organised crime syndicate.

The arrested accused will be produced before the special MCOCA court on Wednesday.

Cyclone Arnab hurtles towards Andhra coast, landfall advances

Express News Service
Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Bhubaneswar, October 27



Cyclone Arnab is expected to make landfall between Kakinada and Visakhapatnam in Andhra Pradesh in the early hours of Wednesday. PTI

CYCLONE ARNAB moved rapidly towards Andhra coast and was expected to make landfall in the early hours of Wednesday, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said, advancing its earlier forecast by several hours.

It said the landfall was expected between 2am to 4am on Wednesday as against forenoon predicted earlier.

"Due to the fast movement of the cyclone, cyclone Arnab will cross the north Andhra Pradesh coast between Bapatla and Visakhapatnam during the early hours of Wednesday," said IMD.

As of 5.30pm on Tuesday, the 'very severe' cyclone Arnab was located at about 90km southeast of Kakinada and 170 km east-northeast of Machilipatnam. The landfall is expected between Bapatla and Visakhapatnam.

"It is likely to make landfall... as a 'severe' cyclone, with a maximum wind speed of 115-125 kmph, gusting to 140km/hr Wednesday," the IMD said.

Squally weather, rough sea conditions, and strong winds, along with a storm surge with wave heights going 1-2 metres above the astronomical tide, are expected to affect coastal Andhra Pradesh. This is likely to cause inundation along the low-lying areas during the cyclone's landfall. The maximum peak surge is expected near the Kakinada and Yanam coasts.

Coastal regions of Odisha have already been lashed with heavy to very heavy spells.

The Met department has issued an orange alert for Anakapalli, Srikakulam, Visakhapatnam, and Vizianagaram districts in Andhra Pradesh, along with Odisha's Angul, Boudh, Bhadrak, Cuttack, Dhenkanal, Gajapati, Ganjam, Jagatsinghpur, Jajpur, Kandhamal, Kendrapara, Khorda, Koraput, Nayagarh, Puri, and Rayagada districts.

Thousands evacuated in Odisha

The Odisha government has relocated over 48,000 people from vulnerable areas to shelters in eight districts as heavy rainfall under the influence of cyclone Arnab lashed several districts on Tuesday.

As many as 135 cyclone shelters and 1,600 temporary shelters have been set up to accommodate the people evacuated from low-lying areas and vulnerable places in the state.

Several Odisha districts, including Gajapati, Ganjam, Rayagada, Koraput, Nabarangpur and Malkangiri, are under red warning with the Met department predicting heavy to very heavy rainfall accompanied with lightning and gusty surface wind reaching 60-80 kmph to up to 90 kmph in these districts.

Officials said Malkangiri district will receive maximum rainfall and wind speed in Odisha as it falls in the path of cyclone.

Odisha's special relief commissioner Rajesh Patil said based on the assessment made by the district collectors, a decision has been taken to relocate nearly 48,000 people in the first phase from districts like Nabarangpur, Gajapati, Malkangiri, Ganjam, Koraput, Rayagada, Kalahandi and Nuapada.

As many as 244 fire services teams, 60 Odisha Disaster Rapid Action Force teams and nine NDRF teams have been deployed in various districts.

"The state government is fully prepared to tackle every possible situation...We urge the people not to panic and to cooperate with the administration in dealing with the situation," said the special relief commissioner.

Amid concerns of possible landslides in certain districts due to incessant rainfall, officials said teams have been deployed there with equipment to clear roads and debris, if needed. Maximum vulnerable points for landslides have been identified in Gajapati district where the district administration has been keeping a close watch.

Nearly 3,000 pregnant women approaching the date of delivery have been identified and shifted to nearby hospitals from across the state.

16 districts likely to be hit in Andhra

According to preliminary assessments, the cyclone is expected to have a significant impact across 16 districts, covering 2,460 revenue villages and 92 urban areas. To facilitate coordinated relief operations, authorities have identified 1,763 cyclone shelters and established 2,907 control rooms at district and mandal levels.

As a precautionary measure, beaches have been closed to the public. All fishermen who had ventured into the sea have reportedly returned home, and all 30,043 fishing boats have been secured at harbours to minimise the risk of damage from adverse weather conditions, authorities said.



Union Minister for Road Transport and Highways Nitin Gadkari addresses the CII conference on Highways of India's Future: Smart, Safe and Sustainable in New Delhi on Tuesday. PTI

Protest over E20 fuel a paid propaganda, says Nitin Gadkari

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, October 27

A DAY after the government notified E100 or nearly pure ethanol as auto fuel, the Minister for Road Transport and Highways Nitin Gadkari Tuesday said that the protest over the blending of 20% ethanol in petrol was a "paid propaganda".

"Since 2022, 4 crore cars and 20 crore two-wheelers have been running on E20 fuel. Three months back, there was a lot of uproar (halla) over ethanol. Now everything has gone quiet. E20 is being used since 2022, has anyone's vehicle broken down yet? This was entirely paid propaganda," said Gadkari at an event by the industry body CII over Highway of India's future.

He further said that due to such initiatives, the domestic production of ethanol, methanol, biodiesel, LNG, CBG (Compressed Bio-Gas), hydrogen, and aviation biofuel will increase and import of it will reduce significantly.

Gadkari also said that he has directed the authorities not to issue a challan for a speed of 120 kmph for vehicles.

"Some people are receiving notices on the road due to speed. I have instructed that no notices should be sent for speeds up to 120 kmph. And even above 120, if someone exceeds it by 20%, let them go. If someone goes beyond this, issue a challan," said the Minister.

He also sought industry support for the implementation of an AI-based Advanced Traffic Management System for enforcement and detection of lane discipline issues.

The Ministry Monday notified the amendment to the Central Motor Vehicle Rules, 1989, allowing flex-fuel vehicles to run on up to E100. This does not mean that every petrol car can use E100 now.

The new regulation expands the range of fuels that can be used in vehicles and paves the way for the manufacturing and supply of more flex-fuel vehicle components, ethanol production infrastructure, and the deployment of such vehicles on the road.

The ministry said that vehicles designed as flex-fuel vehicles will not have material compatibility issues with E100. It also said that E85 or E100 shall be used in vehicles designed by the original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) as flex-fuel vehicles. This means that vehicles that use normal fuel or E20 cannot use E100.

India mandated E20 fuel compatibility for all new petrol-powered vehicles starting in 2023, and that is the most commonly available fuel blend available across petrol pumps in the country.

HC quashes FIR against Pune engg student over Operation Sindoor post

Omkar Gokhale
Mumbai, October 27

THE BOMBAY High Court on Tuesday quashed an FIR registered against a 20-year-old Pune engineering student over a social media post on Operation Sindoor last year, observing that a "youthful error of judgment cannot automatically be equated with a deliberate criminal act".

Justice Milind N Jadhav also observed that the prosecution lacked a "sufficient factual foundation" to establish its case.

A single-judge bench was hearing the student's criminal application seeking to quash the FIR. She contended that she had reposted an Instagram post without any ill intent and deleted it within two hours.

Following the controversy, the Sinhgad Academy of Engineering in Pune rusticated the student.

In the FIR registered on May 9 last year, the Pune Police said the student had "shared a post on her Instagram account on May 7 regarding the war between Bharat and Pakistan..."

The HC also accepted advocate Farhana Shah's arguments that the FIR did not disclose substantial material establishing the student's criminal intent and that no actual incident of communal disturbance or unlawful activity was attributable to her repost.

Emphasising her prompt deletion of the post and her apology, Justice Jadhav observed, "This is a chance required to be taken by the Court because trial and punishment have to be believed to be inflicted for a reformative result rather than being punitive in nature, especially when the applicant is a young student. It is widely believed that education can transform lives and generations."

"In my opinion, the circumstances indicate that the applicant did not persist in her said conduct and rather corrected herself. A youthful error of judgment cannot automatically be equated with a deliberate criminal act in the absence of material establishing the ingredients of the alleged offences," the judge added.

The bench also observed that the "mere possibility that a publication may cause displeasure or resentment cannot, by itself, constitute a sufficient ground for criminal prosecution".

Lucknow parking killings: Five family members of accused held

Express News Service
Lucknow, October 27



Parts of the accused's home being demolished in Lucknow on Tuesday. EXPRESS

LUCKNOW POLICE on Tuesday night arrested five members of the family of Rishabh Shukla, a day after he allegedly shot dead three members of his neighbour's family in the Old City area over a parking dispute.

Rishabh, 29, was arrested from the crime scene soon after the incident on Monday.

Hours before the arrests, the Lucknow Development Authority (LDA) began demolition of the "unauthorised portion" of Shukla's house.

Among those arrested are Rishabh's father Dinesh Shukla (62), sister Aditi (24), uncles – Satish (69) and Girish (78) – and latter's 38-year-old daughter Priya. "They were named in the murder FIR by the family of Shivendra Tiwari, who was shot dead along with his brother Shivaji and his son Suyash. As per the complaint... they were allegedly instigating Rishabh to kill the members of the Tiwari family," said a police officer.

The police are searching for another accused, Rajesh Shukla, the third uncle of Rishabh.

The police and administration's actions came soon after Uttar Pradesh Deputy Chief Minister Brajesh Pathak met the Tiwari family and assured stringent action. "The government stands with the victim's family... The case will be taken to a fast-track court, and action will be initiated under the National Security Act. No one will be spared," he said.

Earlier in the day, the Tiwari family sat on dharna on the road after the bodies were brought home. The victims' family refused to cremate the bodies, accusing the police of failing to act on repeated complaints against Rishabh Shukla.

Following the protest, Lucknow Police Commissioner Tarun Gauba suspended the Station House Officer of Saadatganj police station, and Sub-Inspector, in-charge of the Kashmiri Mohalla police outpost. Gauba confirmed the suspensions to *The Indian Express* and said a departmental inquiry had been ordered.

On Monday, Shukla, who reportedly works with the Merchant Navy, allegedly opened fire at his neighbours in Lucknow's Old City area. He was arrested from the crime scene. Police said he allegedly used an illegal pistol.

Gauba had told *The Indian Express* that the incident began after a member of the Tiwari family parked a car in front of their house, which Shukla objected to. An officer said local police had intervened twice in disputes between the families and issued warnings.

Kerala Congress tenders apology over post on CJI

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, October 27

THE KERALA Pradesh Congress Committee (KPCC) has tendered an unconditional apology to Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant over a controversial post shared recently on the X handle of the party's state unit.

In the post shared on October 12, Kerala Congress's X handle had demanded the resignation of the CJI and suggested that the organisation would find a replacement for him. The post was withdrawn later.

Days later, Supreme Court Bar Association joint secretary Meenesh Dubey served a legal notice to KPCC president Sunny Joseph.

In his reply to the notice, Joseph, who is also the State Electricity Minister, said the post was published on the X handle of the party without authorisation.

"Neither the KPCC president nor the party leadership had authorised him (the person concerned) to demand the CJI's resignation or suggest that a replacement be found," the reply stated.

Joseph said the person responsible has been removed.

Bengaluru DRDO scientist dies by suicide; family alleges work-related stress

Atiya Firdos
Bengaluru, October 27

A 47-YEAR-OLD scientist with the DRDO allegedly died by suicide in Bengaluru on October 21. His family told the police that he was under considerable mental strain because of work-related stress.

Sharad Katiyar, a scientist at the DRDO's Aeronautical Development Agency, lived with his family on the fourth floor of a residential complex in Seegehalli. He was associated with the programme office of the light combat aircraft Mk2.

According to the police, Katiyar had been receiving treatment for psychological and behavioural issues. On October 21, he visited Bengaluru's National Institute of Mental Health and Neurosciences (Nimhans) for a psychiatric consultation in the morning and returned home with his family later that day, the police said.

Katiyar allegedly attempted suicide between 7.30 pm and 8 pm. He sustained critical injuries. Family members and other residents rushed him to a hospital in K S Halli, where he was declared dead on arrival.

A police officer said, "His father, who was with him, became concerned when Katiyar took the lift to the fifth floor and followed him..."

Based on a complaint filed by his family, the police registered an unnatural death report. They are verifying his family's allegations.

In Maharashtra textbook, Newton shares gravity chapter with Bhaskaracharya

Pallavi Smart
Mumbai, October 27

ISAAC NEWTON now shares the chapter on gravity with Bhaskaracharya II. Meteorologist Anna Mani, the "Weather Woman of India", makes her first appearance. And foreign invasion no longer figures among the reasons the Harappan civilisation declined.

These are among the changes in Maharashtra's new Class 6 history, geography and science textbooks, introduced by Balbharati, the state's textbook bureau, this academic year under the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020.

Over 1.4 crore students in Classes 1 to 8 — about 65 per cent of Maharashtra's total school enrolment — study from Balbharati textbooks in State Board schools that follow the SCERT curriculum.

A comparison of the old and new textbooks by *The Indian Express* shows the changes run along three lines. Ancient Indian science, scripture and scholars have been written into all three subjects, often placed alongside, or ahead of, modern science or standardised concepts. Contemporary Indian achievements and role models have been added. And in history alone, content on caste, priestly privilege and foreign invasion has been cut.

The direction closely tracks NCERT's own NEP-aligned textbooks, which have drawn criticism since 2024. Sample these:

Ancient India influence

Indian geography in scripture (geography): A new section on the history of Indian geography cites the Vedas, Puranas, Upanishads and the Suryasiddhant. It describes the Earth as "Saptadweep", with seven dweeps, or islands, mapped on to modern regions from Europe to Japan, and equates the ancient Kshir Sagar with the Indian Ocean and the Kshar Samudra with the Arctic. It sets the Vedic account of the creation of the universe alongside the Big Bang theory.

Ujjain meridian (geography): The old book defined the prime meridian only as the Greenwich meridian. The new one says, "Ancient Indian astronomers considered Ujjayani (Ujjain) as the central point of the Earth and proposed the concept of base longitude for the first time." It also introduces ancient units of time such as the ghatika and muhurt.

Bhaskaracharya and gravity (science): When explaining gravitational force, the science textbook's chapter on "Force and Pressure" gravitation states: "When we say gravitation, many people remember scientist Newton." It then says Bhaskaracharya II wrote, around 950 years ago, that "the earth pulls objects towards itself" in his book, Siddhant Shiromani.

Aryabhata (science): A "Do you know?" box in the chapter titled Beyond the Sky says Aryabhata was the first to explain that the Earth goes around the Sun. It states that "the time measured with modern instruments and the time calculated by Aryabhatta long ago are exactly the same".



Anna Mani, the 'Weather Woman of India', makes her first appearance in Science textbook

Chanakya (history): Mentioned in one line in the old textbook, he now gets a full passage on his Arthashastra and his role in Chandragupta Maurya's rise. The new textbook says the Arthashastra "deals with subject like governance, tax system, defence, Intelligence and politics".

What's been taken out

All the cuts are in history.

Caste: The old book said varnas were first based on occupation and later on birth. "This gave rise to castes. The caste system led to inequality in the society," it said. The new book replaces the passage with: "Vedic society was structured into four Varnas : Brahmana, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra."

Priestly monopoly: A paragraph on the priestly class controlling knowledge of yajna rites has gone from the new textbook. The paragraph in the old textbook stated, "Towards the end of the Vedic period, the minute details of yajna rites acquired undue importance. Only the priestly class had knowledge of those details. Others no longer had the freedom to gain that knowledge. The Varna system restrictions became very hard in the course of time. A person's social position was decided by the varna into which he was born rather than by his achievements."

The new chapter instead speaks of Vedic values, moral duties and nature worship.

Harappan decline: The old book listed "invasions by foreign tribes" among the causes. The new book cites a shift in river course, natural calamities and falling trade with Sumerian, but not invasion.

What's been added

Not every change looks back, particularly in science.

Space missions (science): Where the old science book only asked students to visit the ISRO and NASA websites, the new one describes Chandrayaan-1, Mangalyaan, Chandrayaan-3, Aditya-L1 and the NASA-ISRO NISAR satellite, launched in July 2025.

Anna Mani (science): The Indian meteorologist Anna Mani (1918-2001) is introduced as the "Weather Woman of India". "Because of Anna Mani's contributions, India's dependence on other countries for weather forecasting was reduced," states the new text.

Women in the Vedic period (history): The book expands on women in the early Vedic period, naming famous female scholars from the era such as Lopamudra, Ghosha, Gargi, Maitreyi and Apala. The old book named three.

It states that women in the early Vedic period had the freedom to study the Vedas, before society became "increasingly patriarchal" and women "were reduced to a secondary position".

Several of these changes echo NCERT's new Class 6 social science textbook, Exploring Society: India and Beyond, released in 2024.

Anuradha Oak, Director of Balbharati, said that the changes made to the textbooks are in line with the NEP 2020 recommendations, which was also the reason for revision of textbooks. "The learning outcomes mentioned at the beginning of every textbook will provide the intentions behind why certain topics are part of the said curriculum... Comparison with old textbook will show that the concepts... remain similar; but there are changes... The NEP 2020 recommendations have great emphasis on Indian Knowledge System..."

Oak also said that this should not be misunderstood as way of establishing superiority between the two — ancient and modern — streams of knowledge. "The new textbooks only bring out the ancient Indian knowledge to create awareness among students..." he said.

'Bound to be tamasha...': Sonia Gandhi ahead of memoir release

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 27

CONGRESS PARLIAMENTARY Party chairperson Sonia Gandhi Tuesday said that there is bound to be some "tamasha" when her memoir comes out next month.

"There's bound to be some tamasha when this book comes out. After all, others have spent decades telling my 'story', now it's my turn," Sonia said on X, after sharing a video on *Belonging: A Journey of Love* that is set to hit the stands on November 10.

In the 1.28-minute video, Sonia is seen sifting through the pages of her memoir and says, "I don't know if I should tell the whole story."

Sonia said that she was written about extensively, but added that a lot of it was not quite correct, as it was either "invented or exaggerated".

"People have different views, some people may change their view about me. Some people's view may become worse, but that is what it is; that is what happens when you write a book, or when you are in public life. There is bound to be a 'tamasha' as you say it here," the former Congress chief was seen saying in the video.

In September, Sonia's memoir came in the eye of a storm after Penguin Random House India decided against publishing the book, following disagreements over proposed editorial changes and deletions. *The Indian Express* reported that the disputed passages allegedly included references to Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), the Galwan standoff with China, communal tensions, and the condition of minorities.

'WAS PAID MONEY, TUTORED ON WHAT TO SAY'

'Victim' in sting op tells police she never met Siddaramaiah

Kiran Prashar
Bengaluru, October 27

THE 'VICTIM' in the alleged 'sting operation' video targeting former Karnataka Chief Minister Siddaramaiah learnt to have told the police that she had never met the Congress leader and that whatever she said in the video was done at the instructions of certain people.

The Central Crime Branch (CCB) of Bengaluru City police is investigating the case following a complaint by Siddaramaiah on October 6 over the circulation of the video.

The former Chief Minister alleged that the video was fabricated and circulated with the intention of blackmailing him and damaging his reputation.

According to an officer who is part of the investigation, the 'victim' woman in the video told the police that a group had approached her in 2023, paid her money and tutored her on what to say.

"She said that she had given the statement accordingly. She also said that she had never met Siddaramaiah, but was aware that he was the chief minister. The woman has admitted that she met Rakesh Shetty and Kripa Alva (a Congress leader and former Karnataka Child Rights Commission chief)," the officer said.

Deputy Commissioner of Police (Crime 2) of Bengaluru City police, Raja Imam Kasim P, who is heading the probe, refused to comment, saying the investigation is still underway.



Karnataka ex-CM Siddaramaiah

In his complaint, Siddaramaiah alleged that the unidentified creators of YouTube channel — Karnataka Honey Trap — were involved in spreading a fake sting video shot in 2023 allegedly by Power TV MD Rakesh Shetty and others.

"On 27-09-2026, some unknown persons made false, malicious and false allegations against the complainant on a YouTube channel, secretly filmed a (clandestine) video on the social media platform, published the video on YouTube and circulated it publicly, causing damage to the public honour and life of the complainant, and an investigation should be conducted against the persons who created it with malicious intent and disseminated it on YouTube," states the FIR registered based on Siddaramaiah's complaint.

Power TV MD Rakesh Shetty approached the court and was granted anticipatory bail on October 23. He has since appeared before the police multiple times to record statements.

On the other hand, Congress spokesperson Kripa Alva, who is allegedly said to be in the video with Rakesh Shetty, has also appeared before the police. "She has given her statement that she was unaware that it was being recorded and was unaware of the woman. But she said that she had joined Rakesh Shetty when he told her that he wanted to expose some people," a police officer said.

"We will be calling them to record their statements in future too. There are a lot of unanswered questions given that many people are involved and the purported video is said to be of 2023, before Karnataka Assembly elections," a police officer added.

On October 23, Siddaramaiah accused Alva and Shetty of orchestrating the sting operation.

"There is no truth in the allegation and it has been done to blackmail me. The truth has to come out and people should know that the allegation is not true. Let the investigation reveal the conspiracy," he had said.

Union Minister and Janata Dal (Secular) leader H D Kumaraswamy has already demanded a CBI investigation into the case.

SCIENCE CONCLAVE

PM: Our goal today is to develop new technologies for India, world

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 27

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi, while inaugurating the government's Emerging Science, Technology and Innovation Conclave (ESTIC) 2026 at Bharat Mandapam, urged all the researchers, industry leaders, start-up founders, and the youth in attendance to set measurable goals for themselves towards 'Viksit Bharat'.

He said: "Over the next three years, they should decide which technology, which prototype, which pilot project, or which product they would develop? Let us pursue innovations that help transform India into a developed nation." He added that he hoped the event will not just remain a forum for discussion of ideas but become a platform for such measurable outcomes.

The inauguration session took place on the evening of the first day of the programme, with the PM taking the dais along with Union Minister of State for the Ministry of Science and Technology Jitendra Singh, principal scientific advisor Ajay K Sood, and three Nobel laureates who are participating in the event — Prof. Joachim Frank, Sir Richard J Roberts and Prof. Kostya Novoselov.



Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the inauguration of the ESTIC 2026 in New Delhi on Tuesday. PTI

Speaking at the session, Singh said: "India today is no longer a follower. India today beckons others to follow her. India today is no longer only a collaborator. India today is a global co-creator. And India today is no longer the trailing India of the 20th century. India today is the future-ready, Modi's India of the 21st century."

Echoing the sentiment, PM Modi said: "Decades ago, there was a time when science and technology for India meant catching up with the world. Whenever there was any innovation in the world, the technology would come to us in a few years. We used to adopt it or make minor improvements to it and take it forward..., for the present and the future — to shape their direction, and to build the capacity to provide solutions to global challenges."

Stating that the country would soon celebrate the birth anniversary of Homi J Bhabha – widely credited as the father of the Indian nuclear programme — on October 30, PM highlighted India's move towards self-sufficiency in nuclear power.

He said, without depending on imports of nuclear fuel, India developed its own fast breeder reactor technology, with the 500 MW prototype reaching first criticality — an important landmark, where a nuclear reactor becomes self-sufficient.

The PM went on to say that India also organised its first AI Impact Summit this year and launched its own model. He said that India-made chips were also being shipped to the world.

Modi said that the real success of science is not in how advanced it is but whether it makes the lives of people better. "For us, emerging science and technology means solutions that strengthen the health sector, transform agriculture, create new opportunities for education and employment, and assist in disaster mitigation. I am pleased that such issues are being given priority within India's startup revolution," he said.

JSP member goes missing from train, body found near Ranchi a day later

Shubham Tigga & Himanshu Harsh
Ranchi, Patna, October 27

THE BODY of the digital communications manager of the Jan Suraaj Party (JSP) was found in a bush along the railway tracks between Jonha and Kita in Jharkhand on Tuesday afternoon — almost a full day after he went missing while travelling from Ranchi to Patna on the Jan Shatabdi Express on Monday.

RPF Ranchi Post Inspector Shishupal Kumar told *The Indian Express* that Devpalik Gupta was suspected to have fallen off the moving train.

Gupta, 31, a resident of Uttar Pradesh's Kushinagar district, was travelling on the Jan Shatabdi Express (12366) with two JSP associates, Gautam Kumar and Nishant Kumar, both aged around 24.

Nishant, talking to *The Indian Express*, questioned the time taken in locating the body, which was found on the tracks between the first and second station on the train route.

He also alleged that he, along with Gautam, was detained by the GRP in Ranchi. Nishant said no FIR has been registered a day after the incident. "First, it took them a long time to locate the body which was right next to a railway track and then, we (Gautam and him) were held in separate rooms and not allowed to talk to each other," he said.



Devpalik Gupta

IG, Railways, Michael Raj denied the allegation, saying they had not been detained and were only being questioned. "The body has just been found. The complaint has been received. Whatever further action is required will be taken according to the law," he told *The Indian Express*.

Kumar Saurabh Singh, National Spokesperson of JSP, wrote on X: "Devpalik and his team had been continuously working behind the official pages and other social media campaigns associated with Jan Suraaj for the past 4 years... We request Hon'ble Chief Minister Shri @HemantSorenJMM Ji to direct senior officials for a prompt and impartial investigation into this matter."

He said party chief Prashant Kishor has been in continuous contact with Jharkhand CM Hemant Soren and officers of the Jharkhand Police since Monday night, adding, "This is an extremely painful and heartbreaking (development) for all of us."

According to the details shared by Gupta's batchmate and former JSP colleague Gunjan Goswami, the three (Gupta, Nishant and Gautam) boarded the train around 2.30 pm.

Goswami said around 25 minutes after boarding, Gupta went to the pantry car to order food, telling his associates that he would return shortly. "When he did not come back after 15-20 minutes, Nishant and Gautam called him but his phone was switched off," Goswami said.

The associates then searched the pantry car and approached the travelling ticket examiner (TTE), who called RPF personnel to help search the train, including the washrooms. However, they could not find Gupta anywhere. The train had also not stopped anywhere between Ranchi and Muri — the first station after the Jharkhand capital — negating the possibility of Gupta deboarding the train.

Once there is roster, CJI has no right to interfere in it: Former SC judge Oka

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 27

FORMER SUPREME Court judge Abhay S Oka on Tuesday questioned the transparency of the SC roster system, asking how cases are allocated to benches and whether the process leaves room for manual intervention.

"Once there is a roster, the CJI has no right to interfere in it," Oka said, questioning the absence of clarity on how matters are assigned when multiple benches hear cases involving the same subject. "You don't know which matter will be assigned to which bench," he said, asking whether the CJI or the Registry decides the allocation.

Delivering the keynote lecture at an event on the "Accountability of Judges of the Supreme Court and High Courts" organised by the Campaign for Judicial Accountability and Reforms (CJAR) in New Delhi, Oka said judicial accountability must extend to the administrative functioning of courts.

"Every dimension of accountability must be strengthened without compromising on judicial independence," he said. "Judges are first and foremost accountable to litigants who come before them with the great hope of getting speedy and quality justice."

Oka said getting freshly filed cases listed for their first hearing remained a major challenge, particularly in High Courts with substantial filings and pendency. "The only solution is auto-date all freshly filed cases," he said, suggesting bail applications be listed within a day or two and other cases within about a week.

On higher courts directing trial courts to dispose of cases within fixed timelines, he said such orders could burden judges already dealing with older and more complex matters. He called for a rational transfer policy for trial court and district court judges.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of President of India Dy. Cheif Mechanical Engineer, office at: Rail Coach Naveenikaran Karkhana, Sonipat invites e-tender for below mentioned work:-

NIT No.	383961
Name of Work and its location	Refurbishment of 22 LHB (LWACCW) coaches during MLR schedule at RCNK/SNP (As per Scope of Work).
Approx. Cost of Work	Tender Cost: Rs 106300391.30/- including GST@18% (Rupees Ten Crore Sixty-Three Lakh Three Hundred Ninety-One and Thirty Paisa Only).
Earnest Money	Rs. 21,26,000/-
Completion Period of Work	06 months from date of issue of Letter of acceptance.
Cost of Tender document (In Rs.)	NIL
Date and Time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Upto 15:00 hrs. on 16.11.2026, Opening of Tender at 15:15 hrs on same day.
Website particulars, notice board location, complete details of tender can be seen	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

Tender No.: 383961 Dated: 27.10.2026 3747/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE

Tender Notice No. TKDD-RSP-E70-2-331792 Dated 24.10.2026

The Sr.DME/Diesel, Northern Railway, Diesel Loco Shed, Tughlakabad for and on behalf of President of India invites e-tenders for the following work. The tender will be accepted online only in the prescribed tender document.

Subject	Description
Name of work	Overhauling/IOH schedule of E-70 Brake panel (FTRTIPL make) for three phase locomotives
Place of work	Diesel Shed, Tughlakabad, New Delhi-110044.
Completion Period	01 Years
Approximate cost of work	Rs. 30,95,512.40/- Including GST (Rs. Thirty Lakh Ninety Five Thousand Five Hundred Twelve And Forty Paisa Only)
Amount of Bid Security	Rs. 61,900/- (Rs. Sixty One Thousand Nine Hundred only)
Technical Eligibility Criteria	As per clause 10 of tender form (second sheet) of Tender Document.
Financial Eligibility Criteria	As per clause 10 of tender form (second sheet) of Tender Document.
Website to download and upload e-tender document	www.ireps.gov.in
Due date & time of uploading of Tender by tenderer	17.11.2026 upto 12:00 Hrs
Date & Time of Tender opening.	17.11.2026 after 12:00 Hrs
Validity of offer	60 days from opening of tender.
Allocation	PH-21 (CAP)

Tender Document can be downloaded from Indian Railway website www.ireps.gov.in. For details of work experience, scope of work and terms & conditions please see Tender document 3751/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE

Tender No. 383960 Dated: - 27.10.2026

On behalf of President of India Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer, office at - Rail Coach Naveenikaran Karkhana Sonipat invites e-tender for below mentioned work: -

NIT No.	383960
Name of Work and its location	Refurbishment of 30 LHB (LWACCN) coaches during MLR schedule at RCNK/SNP (As per Scope of Work)
Approx. Cost of work	Tender Cost: Rs 134980715.33/- including GST@18% (Rupees Thirteen Crore Forty-Nine Lakh Eighty Thousand Seven Hundred Fifteen and Thirty-Three Paisa Only)
Earnest Money	Rs. 2699600/-
Completion period of work	06 Months from date of issue of Letter of acceptance
Cost of Tender document (In Rs)	NIL
Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Up to 15:00 hrs on 18.11.2026. Opening of Tender at 15:15 hrs on the same day.
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3746/26

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
RURAL WATER SUPPLY & SANITATION DIVISION
Water Works Road, PURI-752002
25001/1390/2627
☎(06752) 251276 Fax: - (06752) 251276 E-mail: -eerwsspuri@gmail.com, Mab-9439045500
Quotation Call Notice No.: 08 / Date: 26.10.2026

Sealed quotations are invited from interested eligible and registered Manufacture/Authorized Distributer/ Authorized Dealer.

1	Name of work	:-	Supply, Installation, testing & Commissioning of 2 Nos of Silent DG Set (1.800 KVA for WTP & 2. 630 KVA Intake well) of adequate capacity including with AMP panel & Synchronized panel with precision AC & DG house with panel room for Mega PWS to 69 villages of Brahmagiri & 30 villages of Krushnaprasad Block.
2	Description of materials with quantity required	:-	As detailed given in Annex-A
3	Approximate estimated cost.	:-	Rs.2.20 Cores (excluding GST 18%)
4	Details Quotation Documents Available	:-	Up to 1.00 P.M. on -04.11.2026
5	Last date and time for receipt of quotation	:-	Up to 3.00 P.M. on -04.11.2026
6	Date & time for opening of quotation	:-	At 4.00 P.M. on -04.11.2026
7	Documents to be submitted along with quotation	:-	Attested copies of the GSTIN, Reg. No. & PAN Card No.
8	Place of delivery	:-	WTP & Intake Site of Mega PWS to 69 villages of Brahmagiri & 30 villages of Krushnaprasad Block.

Further details and documents can be available with O/O. Superintending Engineer, RWS&S Division, Puri

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer,
RWS&S Division, Puri

OIPR- 25001/25017/1/26-27/0005

कार्यालय : प्रधानाचार्य, जी० एस० वी० एम० मेडिकल कालेज : कानपुर।

संख्याः-256/एन०डी०/एम०आर०यू०/2026 दिनांकः 21/10/2026

-:: सेवायोजन हेतु विज्ञप्ति ::-

इस चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय में भारत सरकार के चिकित्सा स्वास्थ्य एवं परिवार कल्याण मंत्रालय के स्वास्थ्य एवं अनुसंधान विभाग नई दिल्ली द्वारा पोषित एम० आर०यू० लैब हेतु संविदा के आधार पर लैब टेक्नीशियन-2 एवं लैब असिस्टेन्ट-01 रिक्त पद को भरे जाने हेतु दिनांक 19-11-2026 को प्रातः 10:00 बजे से 4:00 बजे तक वाक-इन-इन्टरव्यू परीक्षा हाल-3. मेडिकल कालेज, कानपुर में आयोजित किया जा रहा है। अर्ह इच्छुक अभ्यर्थी अपने समस्त मूल शैक्षिक प्रमाण पत्रों के साथ उक्त निर्धारित वाक-इन-इन्टरव्यू में समयानुसार उपस्थित होना सुनिश्चित करे। उक्त निर्धारित वाक-इन-इन्टरव्यू में उपस्थित अभ्यर्थियो को यात्रा भत्ता अनुमन्य नही होगा। समस्त जानकारी मेडिकल कालेज, कानपुर की वेवसाइटः www.gsvmmedicalcollege.com पर उपलब्ध है।

UPID-259440 Date 26/10/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

प्रधानाचार्य,
मेडिकल कालेज, कानपुर।

OFFICE OF THE PRINCIPAL GOVERNMENT COLLEGE FOR WOMEN, BAHADURGARH
TENDER NOTICE

Sealed tenders are hereby invited from interested and eligible **Cooperative Labour & Construction Societies (approved by the Government of Haryana)** and having at least three years of experience in similar services, for housekeeping, cleaning of premises, security services, and gardening/horticultural services at Government College for Women. Bahadurgarh, in the prescribed format.

Cooperative Societies may obtain the tender forms from the Office of the Principal, Government College for Women, Bahadurgarh, on any working day between 09:00 AM and 04:00 PM upon payment of ₹500/- (Rupees Five Hundred only). The payment shall be made through a Demand Draft/Banker's Cheque drawn on any nationalized bank in favour of the Principal, Government College for Women, Bahadurgarh.

All terms and conditions shall be as per the norms of the Government of Haryana (Letter No. C-7-2025/4728 dated 27.06.2025). The tender may be withdrawn without prior notice at any stage of the process.

Availability of Tender Documents: **02.11.2026 to 12.11.2026.**

Last Date for Submission of Sealed Tenders at the College: **14.11.2026.**

Date of Opening of Tenders: **16.11.2026.**

Sd/-
PRINCIPAL
GOVT. COLLEGE FOR WOMEN,
BAHADURGARH

No. 50522/HRY

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
47वाँ (वि० / यॉ०) वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, मुरादाबाद
प्रहरी- https://wms.uppwd.gov.in
ई-प्रोक्योरमेन्ट (अल्पकालीन) निविदा सूचना

पत्रांक 1437/3WE(BLY)-47/26 दिनांकः 22.10.2026

महामहिम राज्यपाल महोदय उ०प्र० की ओर से निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु ऑनलाइन निविदायें वेबसाइट https://etender.up.nic.in एवं प्रहरी https://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari के माध्यम से दिनांक 30.10.2026 से दिनांक 06.11.2026 दोपहर 12:00 बजे से आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा की तकनीकी बिड दिनांक 06.11.2026 अपराह्न 02:00 बजे गठित समिति के सदस्यों द्वारा ऑनलाइन खोली जायेगी। कार्यालय बन्द होने अथवा छुट्टी होने की दशा में बिड उसी क्रम में समयानुसार अगले कार्यदिवस में खोली जायेगी। इच्छुक एवं सम्बन्धित ठेकेदार विस्तृत जानकारी हेतु उपरोक्त वेबसाइट पर लॉगिन करें, कार्य का विवरण निम्नवत है:-

क्र० सं०	जनपद का नाम	कार्य का नाम	कार्य की अनुमानित लागत (लाख)	धरोहर धनराशि (लाख)	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	कार्य सम्पादित कराने वाले अधि० अभि० का मता	सम्बन्धित अधीक्षण अभि० का पता	सम्बन्धित मु० अभि० का पला	निविदा हेतु पात्रता
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	12
1	बरेली	जनपद बरेली में लोक निर्माण विभाग के अन्तर्गत शासकीय भवनों पर सोलर रुफटॉप की स्थापना का कार्य।	23.78 + जी०एस०टी० अतिरिक्त	2.38	854.00	03 माह	अधि० अभि० वि० / यॉ० खण्ड लो०नि०वि० बरेली	अधीक्षण अभि० 47 वॉ० (वि० यॉ०) वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, मुरादाबाद	मु०अभियन्ता ५० अ० वि० / यॉ० लो०नि०वि० मुरादाबाद	लो०नि०वि० में विद्युत कार्यों हेतु 'ए' श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदार जिनके पास समान कार्य का अनुभव हो।
2	बदायूँ	जनपद बदायूँ में लोक निर्माण विभाग के अन्तर्गत शासकीय भवनों पर सोलर रुफटॉप की स्थापना का कार्य।	19.74 + जी०एस०टी० अतिरिक्त	1.97	854.00	03 माह				
3.	शाहजहाँपुर	जनपद शाहजहाँपुर में लोक निर्माण विभाग के अन्तर्गत शासकीय भवनों पर सोलर रुफटॉप की स्थापना का कार्य।	5.38 + जी०एस०टी० अतिरिक्त	0.54	766.00	03 माह				
4.	पीलीभीत	जनपद पीलीभीत में लोक निर्माण विभाग के अन्तर्गत शासकीय भवनों पर सोलर रुफटॉप की स्थापना का कार्य।	10.77 + जी०एस०टी० अतिरिक्त	1.08	766.00	03 माह				

शासनादेश संख्या 1/2016/3070/78-2-2018/2071 (22) दिनाँक 03.01.2018 में निहित व्यवस्थानुसार निविदा की तकनीकी बिड खोलने के उपरान्त निविदादाता द्वारा मूल अभिलेख व्यक्तिगत रूप से विभाग / कार्यालय में प्रस्तुत किये जाने हैं। निविदादाता द्वारा मूल अभिलेख प्रस्तुत न किये जाने की दशा में निहित प्राविधानों के अनुरूप कार्यवाही की जायेगी।

(अनिल कुमार)
अधिशासी अभियन्ता
वि०/यॉ० खण्ड लो०नि०वि०
बरेली

(संदीप कुमार सक्सेना)
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
47 वॉ (वि/यॉ) वृत लो०नि०वि०.
मुरादाबाद

UPID-259536 Date 26/10/2026
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Tender Enquiry No.	Tender Description	EMD (in Lakhs)	Due Date & Time of Bid Submission
CPDL/FY26-27/DTR Repairing/040	RATE CONTRACT FOR REPAIRING AND OVERHAULING OF DISTRIBUTION TRANSFORMERS	1.75	18.11.2026

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03	07261972	KIT OF BRAKE GEAR BUSHES	2663 SET	25.11.26
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07	07261133A	WEARING PIECE FOR SIDE BEARER	5773 NOS	09.12.26
08	07261096	HELICAL SPRING	1157 NOS	14.12.26
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EXPRESS special

Project GIB shrugs off one lost bird, next batch to be released soon

One of four birds released this month in Rajasthan was found dead near a desert fox den

Jay Mazoomdaar
New Delhi, October 27



Three captive-bred Great Indian Bustards released in Rajasthan's Desert National Park. COURTESY: PROJECT GIB

TOP OFFICIALS running Project Great Indian Bustard (GIB) for conservation of the species have said that the process of releasing captive-bred ones in Rajasthan's Desert National Park will continue as scheduled in the coming weeks, dismissing reports that the authorities would destroy desert fox dens in the area before it.

In a milestone for the conservation of the critically endangered GIB, Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav released two six-month-old male GIBs into the wild at Sam in Jaisalmer on October 4. Another two birds were released subsequently. On October 17, one of the four was found dead near a desert fox den. Officials said losses to predation are factored into any rewilding process, and there was no question of mass removal of the desert fox species to secure the GIB.

Rajasthan Chief Wildlife Warden Arun Prasad told *The Indian Express*: "There is no such decision. Destroying desert fox dens is out of the question."

Sutirtha Dutta, lead scientist on the Project GIB, said: "We will release up to 10 six-month-old birds in the first phase. The actual number will depend on the condition of individual birds. The six-month cut-off is ideal because the birds reach 70-75% of their adult size and gain flight capability by then, and are yet young enough to adapt in the wild."

Lessons from Saudi

Long before India launched its captive breeding programme for the GIB in 2018, Saudi Arabia had held a similar project for the bird's evolutionary cousin, the Houbara bustard, in 1986.

Between 1991 and 2016, the Saudi project released 1,117 birds across a royal reserve spanning 2,553 sq km. In the first year, the Houbara releases suffered major setbacks: all five birds in the first batch were lost to predation; only three of 12 survived in the second batch; and only five of 14 in the third.

Houbara project researchers then relocated red foxes and feral cats from the vicinity of the release enclosure. But this did not reduce the overall predation rate significantly, as avian raptors – such as the Steppe eagle and eagle-owl – remained major threats.

Finally, releasing 4-month-old flying sub-adults turned the tide, and by 1994, the survival rate was up to 50%. By 2016, the locally extinct Houbara had reached a self-sustaining population of 300-400 birds.

Predation is natural

Project GIB is releasing six-month-old sub-adults with flight capability which, even at that stage, are typically too large for a desert fox to run down or ambush during twilight hours. However, the birds which roost on the ground are vulnerable to foxes, which are nocturnal predators, at night. Other predators, such as raptors, desert cats and dogs, also pose a threat to GIB in the Desert National Park.

Dutta noted that the captive-bred GIBs they released were seen in the company of wild GIB flocks within days. "Beyond their natural instincts, they are expected to pick up certain survival skills through social interaction over time," he said.

Even wild-born birds are not immune to predation, pointed out G S Bhardwaj, Director, Wildlife Institute of India, which means wild reintroduction programmes are bound to face initial hurdles. "Across species and geographies, it has always been about learning from experience, calibrating the response, and filling up the gaps. Our scientists are doing a good job with the help of Rajasthan forest officials. Project GIB is on the right track," he said.

Ground realities

The Rajasthan Forest Department claims to have established approximately 200 sq km of fenced grassland enclosures inside the Desert National Park for the GIB. However, the quality of the GIB habitat restoration work has often been questioned.

"One cannot train a bird how to avoid predators it has never encountered in captivity. But the species would have a better chance of survival if habitat restoration was given as much importance as captive breeding," said Dau Lal Bohra, a Bikaner-based member of the IUCN Wildlife Health Specialist Group.

A senior forest official said along with the birds, their eggs at wild nesting sites are vulnerable to predation. "Our focus is on the prime nesting areas – around 20 sq km in all – where we do limited predator management through selective translocation. But other predators occupy the empty space. So far, we have succeeded in keeping only dogs out permanently."

Project GIB facilities at Sam and Ramdevra now house 97 birds – 40 from wild-laid eggs and 57 bred in captivity. Of these, 86 birds are being maintained for captive reproduction.

Dutta outlined the project's realistic ambitions: "Captive breeding resulted in 24 live chicks in 2025 and 29 in 2026. Our plan is to release up to 30 birds annually in the coming years. Even at a 30-35% survival rate, that will provide a major boost to India's wild GIB population, currently estimated at around 130."

2 encounters, 2 dead: Bengal police account identical in both cases

Snatched police weapons during reconstruction of crime scene: Cops

Sweety Kumari
Kolkata, October 27



The encounter site in North 24 Parganas district. EXPRESS

TWO MEN, one accused of a BJP worker's murder and another of a minor girl's rape and murder, have been killed in separate encounters with police in West Bengal in the past 24 hours.

Prahlad Das, accused of raping and killing a 13-year-old girl in North 24 Parganas district, was shot dead in an encounter late on Monday, police said. Hours later, the police said Samaul Sheikh, who was accused of killing BJP worker Sujit Mondal, was shot dead in a "gunfight" with police in Murshidabad on Tuesday evening.

According to the police, in both incidents, the accused were taken for crime scene reconstruction when they snatched firearms from the police teams accompanying them and were killed in retaliatory firing.

Police sources said the teenage girl went missing from her home in North 24 Parganas on Saturday. Her body was found near her neighbour's house on Sunday. Police later arrested Das (23) for allegedly raping and murdering the 13-year-old.

Late on Monday, a police team took Das for crime scene reconstruction. According to police, while returning from the crime scene, Das snatched a service revolver from a police officer and opened fire at the police team. One policeman had to jump into a pond to save himself, the police said. The police personnel retaliated and shot Das. He was rushed to the Bongaon superspeciality hospital, where he was declared dead.

This is the second incident in which a rape-murder accused has been killed in an encounter with police in Bengal since July.

The second encounter took place at Samsherganj, Murshidabad. Samaul Sheikh, in his 40s, was an accused in the murder of BJP worker Sujit Mondal, whose dismembered body was found on August 28 this year.

According to police, CID officials were taking Sheikh for crime scene reconstruction when he tried to snatch a service weapon and escape. He was shot in retaliatory firing and declared dead at a local hospital.

Surinder Singh, Superintendent of Police at Jangipur, said, "CID is investigating the case. The accused was taken to the place of occurrence for crime reconstruction. The incident took place there."

Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari said, "The police have been given complete freedom in such cases. In cases involving drug abuse and violence against women, the police will take immediate action."

Cabinet minister and former state BJP chief Dilip Ghosh said it will instil fear among criminals. "It happened in South 24 Parganas and now here. Police have to give justice to the victims. Sometimes, police have to do unpleasant tasks," he said. "Criminals don't fear easily. This is because of years of no law and order in Bengal. But this will instil fear in the hearts of criminals."

State BJP president Samik Bhattacharya also justified the encounters, saying, "What is going on in Bengal is the rule of law. Until now, there was the rule of the rulers in West Bengal. Now, that has transformed into the rule of law. The word 'syndicate' no longer exists. There is no extortion, and people are now able to step out fearlessly."

Trinamool Congress MP Sougata Ray, on the other hand, demanded an explanation from the government. "This is entirely the fault of the police; the government must provide a clear explanation, and an inquiry should be conducted," he said earlier.

13-yr-old girl from Kolkata 'drugged and gang-raped'

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, October 27

A 13-YEAR-old girl from Kolkata was allegedly drugged and gang-raped, with the accused allegedly having filmed the act, police said, adding a case has been filed under relevant sections of BNS and POCSO Act.

The girl's mother, in her complaint, has named the teen's friend as one of the accused, police said, adding the girl has been sent for medical examination.

According to police, the complainant has alleged that her daughter had left home around 3:30 pm on Saturday to meet a friend in Birati. When she did not return home by evening, the woman called her around 8:30 pm. The minor then said that she had gone to Barrackpore with a friend and would return home by 10:30 pm. When the girl failed to return, her mother called her again but could not reach her, police said.

At 12.06 am, the girl messaged her mother, saying she was in danger and added that her friend had taken her to the house of another man, police said.

"The family further alleged that a man later called and assured them that the girl was safe and would return home by car. According to the complaint, a man had contacted the girl's mother from an unknown number and claimed that he had found the minor crying on the road and had allowed her to use his phone," a senior police officer said, adding, the girl returned the next day around 10.30 am.

"My daughter had been taken to a hotel in Hooghly district. There she was forced to have a cold drink laced with sedatives before being gang-raped. She was also forced to take a contraceptive pill," the woman stated in her complaint, police said. The accused allegedly filmed the act and later blackmailed the family with the videos, police said.

Two held from Bihar for Pune techie's suicide; had blackmailed him, say police

Chandan Haygunde
Pune, October 27

PUNE CITY police have arrested two alleged cyber criminals from Bihar in connection with the suicide of Shikhar Saxena, a 22-year-old IT professional working with Accenture.

Shikhar had jumped to his death from the 27th floor of a building at Riverdale Suites in Kharadi on October 1, allegedly after receiving phone calls from a man posing as a police officer, demanding money and threatening to implicate him in a drug smuggling case.

Police have arrested Akashkumar Sanjay Singh (18), of Baikunthpur in Gopalganj district of Bihar, who posed as 'Haryana police officer Ajaykumar Bhatiya' while speaking to the victim over phone. Police also arrested his accomplice Rajkumar Sampurnanand Singh (20), from Barahat in Banka district.

Police produced both the accused before judicial magistrate (first class) B S Bankar on Tuesday. The court, which remanded them in police custody on Monday, extended their custody till October 31. Police said a search was on for four more alleged cyber criminals, including key accused Aniketkumar Gupta.

According to police, the accused allegedly contacted the victim through a fake Instagram account with a girl's name around September 29. Further, they allegedly made an obscene video call to him over a Telegram link. The accused allegedly recorded the victim during the call and started blackmailing him. Police said the accused forced the victim to transfer Rs 1.77 lakh to different bank accounts. Police suspect the accused used a bank account in the name of a dead man for the fraudulent transactions. Police told the court the accused blackmailed the victim on social media repeatedly, leading to his suicide.

When contacted, Shikhar's father Kumargaurav Saxena said all the accused cyber criminals and their accomplices should be arrested and punished severely. "They have committed a crime which is not less than a murder. My son deserves justice. Also, what happened to my son should not happen to anyone else," he said.

Day after Guwahati firing, SIT formed

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 27



Security personnel keep vigil near the hotel in Guwahati where five people were shot dead, Tuesday. ANI

"IN VIEW of the gravity of the [firing] incident" in Guwahati – which left five dead and one injured, Assam Police on Tuesday constituted a Special Investigation Team (SIT) to "ensure a thorough, scientific and expeditious investigation".

Around 9pm on Monday, reports of multiple gunshots being fired at Hotel Bilas Inn were received by the Paltan Bazar Police Station in the city.

According to senior police officials, preliminary investigation revealed that the incident stemmed from a property-related dispute between the hotel owners and the leaseholder.

The accused Ghanakanta Gogoi, 34, was nabbed within an hour of the incident. A native of Dibrugarh, he had been residing at Sawkuchi, Guwahati, officials said. "He is being interrogated," they added.

"The hotel owners had entered into a 5-year lease agreement with Gogoi on September 10, 2025 on a monthly rent of approximately Rs 1.8 lakh. Following renovation of the property by the accused, disagreements reportedly arose regarding the use of the premises and provision of certain facilities," senior police officials said.

In a statement issued, Assam Police further said, "A meeting was scheduled at the hotel on October 26 (Monday) to resolve these issues. However, even before the meeting could formally commence, an argument escalated into a physical altercation, following which the accused opened fire on six persons."

While four of the victims were found dead when police reached the spot, two people were found injured on the approach road. Officials said that one of the injured succumbed to his injuries while another is currently undergoing treatment at the Gauhati Medical College and Hospital.

Out of the five who died, four belonged to the same family – that of the owners' family, officials said.

The deceased have been identified as Bhudev Bharali, his sister Helena, her son Debarshi Kashyap and daughter-in-law Rinika Kashyap, and family staffer Narayan Das. A driver of the Bharali family, Satyendra Pathak, was also injured in the shooting.

Bhudev Bharali, Narayan Das and Pathak had arrived from Barpeta earlier on Monday, while the other victims were residents of Guwahati.

Kolkata stripping: Day after, police parade accused in undergarments

Sweety Kumari
Kolkata, October 27

A DAY after a boy, his father and a friend were paraded naked in south Kolkata because the teenager reportedly kissed a 13-year-old girl, police made the arrested accused walk on the streets in their underwear.

Police have not issued an official statement about the parade yet. However, a senior police officer said, "They were being taken to reconstruct the crime." Videos on social media purportedly show three accused walking barefoot with ropes tied around their waist as police officers flank them.

On Monday, police had arrested the girl's relatives, including her parents, a day after they allegedly assaulted and paraded naked the boy, his father and his friend.The boy's mother was also assaulted.

Police officers said the boy met the girl with his friend on Sunday. The girl's uncle, they said, saw the boy kissing the girl and alerted her father and uncle.

The girl's father and uncle then reached the spot and forcibly took the teenager and his friends to their place. They allegedly assaulted them and forced the boy to call his parents there.

According to sources, the boy and his parents told the investigators that the girl's relatives gave them three 'choices': first, they could be framed in a police case; second, they could be shot dead; and third, if they wanted to save their lives, they must roam the streets naked while the incident was recorded on video.

These visuals later circulated online, sparking tension in the area. In response, a group of agitated residents attacked the accused's house on Monday.

The boy's father then filed a complaint against the girl's family and police registered a case under multiple sections of the BNS, including charges of attempt to murder, voluntarily causing hurt, wrongful confinement, criminal intimidation and kidnapping.

Veteran TMC leader and MP Saugata Roy described the incident as "absolutely appalling". "There is a complete breakdown of law and order," he said.

Bengal minister and BJP leader Indranil Khan claimed the accused are associated with the Trinamool Congress, which was voted out of power in May this year. "During elections, these TMC cadres engaged in electoral rigging and carried weapons to spread terror in the area. Though their influence has waned, they continue to cling to that same terror-inducing mentality. They need a harsh dose of reality, and they are getting it now," he said.

"As for law and order in West Bengal, any criminal considering such acts should now know precisely what consequences await them," the minister added.

Ankita Bhandari case: Sanawar who raised 'VIP' allegation faces 8 FIRs

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
Dehradun, October 27

ARRESTED ON Sunday, a day before she was to appear before the CBI for questioning in the Ankita Bhandari murder case, Urmila Sanawar is facing at least eight FIRs — six of these filed after she released audio and video recordings indicating the involvement of a "VIP" in the case, in December 2025.

The September 2022 murder is back in the news after the appointment as Sikkim Governor of BJP leader Dushyant Kumar Gautam, whom Sanawar has identified as the "VIP" being talked about in the recordings released by her. Earlier, giving into Opposition pressure in an election year, the BJP government agreed to a CBI probe, though three people have been convicted for Bhandari's murder, including the owner of a resort where she had joined as a receptionist days earlier.

The allegations against Sanawar, who has acted in a few films, include extortion, death threats, circulation of "objectionable" photographs, remarks hurting religious sentiments, and defamation over the circulation of the recordings. The first of these FIRs was filed soon after she put out the recordings in December 2025. She was arrested on Sunday on a complaint by Deepika Rathore, the daughter of former BJP MLA Suresh Rathore. Sanawar has claimed that Rathore was the man she was discussing the "VIP" in the recordings with. She also claims to be married to Rathore, accuses him of sexual harassment and says he threatened to release "objectionable" videos of her.

Rathore has denied being married to Sanawar and refuted allegations of sexual harassment. He has also accused Sanawar of trying to blackmail him.

THE EIGHT FIRs:

■ *October 25, 2026*

An FIR was registered at Kotwali Nagar Police Station in Dehradun, based on a complaint by Sagar, a resident of Moti Bazaar in Dehradun, over alleged defamatory remarks made by Sanawar, outside the CBI court in Dehradun, against Gautam, BJP national general secretary B L Santhosh, former district panchayat member Aarti Gaur and others.

Sagar said the remarks were objectionable, indecent and defamatory, and that their circulation on social media had damaged the reputations of those named and potentially disturbed public peace.

The FIR was filed under BNS Sections relating to acts insulting a woman's modesty, intentional insult, certain false or misleading statements, and criminal defamation.

■ *October 24, 2026*

On the night of October 24, Deepika Rathore lodged a complaint at Ranipur Police Station, Haridwar, against Sanawar, accusing her of posting obscene, objectionable and defamatory remarks about her and her family on social media. She also accused Sanawar of making WhatsApp calls demanding Rs 5 crore and seeking the transfer of Ravidas Dham property in her name, threatening that she would kill Rathore family members and circulate more photographs online otherwise.

An FIR was registered under BNS Sections relating to extortion through threats of death or grievous hurt, acts intended to insult a woman's modesty or intrude upon her privacy, and criminal defamation, as well as under Sections of the Indecent Representation of Women (Prohibition) Act.

On October 25, the Haridwar Police arrested Sanawar from her residence in Govindnagar, Saharanpur, in connection with the FIR. She was remanded in judicial custody.



Urmila Sanawar was arrested a day before she was to appear before CBI for questioning. FILE

Congress leaders questioned the timing of the police action, a day before Sanawar was to appear before the CBI, having consented to narco-analysis and polygraph tests as part of the Ankita case investigation.

■ *January 5, 2026*

Gautam filed a complaint at Dalanwala Police Station, Dehradun, accusing Rathore, Sanawar and unidentified individuals associated with political parties of circulating fabricated audio and video clips to damage his reputation and link him to Ankita's murder.

The FIR invoked Sections of the Information Technology Act, along with provisions of the BNS relating to false or misleading statements, criminal defamation and conspiracy.

In an order on June 3, 2026, on petitions seeking to quash the FIRs against Sanawar, the Uttarakhand High Court did not quash Gautam's FIR. While it did not hold that the recordings were fabricated, it said their authenticity and evidentiary value remained matters for investigation. The court proceedings also referred to voice samples and mobile phones being sent for forensic examination.

■ *December 26, 2025*

Haridwar resident Sanchit Kumar filed a complaint at Jhabrera Police Station, accusing Sanawar and Rathore of circulating false or misleading statements about Gautam through audio clips on social media, damaging the BJP leader's reputation and hurting the sentiments of the Ravidas community.

On June 3, 2026, the High Court quashed this FIR, observing that the allegations overlapped with Gautam's complaint that had been filed on January 5, 2026, and that the complainant was neither the direct victim nor an affected party.

■ *December 24, 2025*

Dr Dharmendra Kumar, identified as an office-bearer of the Sant Shiromani Guru Ravidas Akhara, filed a complaint at Bahadrabad Police Station, Haridwar, over the audio clips released by Sanawar and allegedly featuring Gautam. Kumar said these claims were false and misleading and were intended to damage Gautam's reputation and hurt the sentiments of followers of the Ravidas community. Gautam is associated with the organisation.

The High Court quashed this FIR too on June 3, 2026, on grounds similar to those in Sanchit Kumar's case.

■ *December 24, 2025*

Aarti Gaur, a district panchayat member from the Amroli area of Yamkeshwar constituency, filed an FIR at Nehru Colony Police Station alleging harassment and claiming she was being falsely implicated in the Ankita Bhandari case due to the release of the recordings by Sanawar.

The FIR was challenged before the Uttarakhand High Court. In its June 3, 2026, order, the court declined to quash it.

■ *March 2025*

Deepika Rathore filed a complaint against Sanawar and another man, whose identity could not be independently verified, alleging that objectionable photographs of her had been circulated online and that an attempt had been made to extort money from her.

■ *May 2025*

An FIR was filed against Sanawar for allegedly posting objectionable comments about Lord Valmiki, hurting the sentiments of members of the Valmiki community. (The name of the complainant was not mentioned.)

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The limits of my language mean the limits of my world.
— Ludwig Wittgenstein

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BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

ECI affidavit to Court has unbroken silences

THE AFFIDAVIT that the Election Commission of India has filed before the Supreme Court is underwhelming, raises more questions than it answers. It comes in response to a petition in the wake of this newspaper's investigation into the ECI's functioning during the ongoing Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls. The investigation highlighted the erosion of internal checks and balances in the three-member constitutional body that underwrites democracy's fundamental compact. It pointed to its shrinking, on the watch of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, into a one-man show. Now, the affidavit projects an impression of unanimity, and justifies the Commission's decision-making processes. But it does so while blurring important distinctions and is riddled with persisting silences. The objections recorded by the two ECs, Vivek Joshi and Sukhbir Singh Sandhu, 14 in 10 months, were part of the consultative process, it says — this papers over the fact that most of them were about orders already issued and decisions taken without keeping the two ECs informed. Even where the ECI makes corrections, it does not do so fully. It rolls back controversial changes made to Form 6 for first-time voters online, and sets up a committee that includes experts to review ECINet's compliance with the law. It does so, however, without acknowledging the mistake, or holding anyone accountable.

Going ahead, the persistence of unresolved questions could return to haunt an institution whose credibility is pivotal for safeguarding the right to vote and nourishing people's trust in free and fair elections. In Goa, for instance, 88 of the 97 voters who were left out of the final rolls have subsequently applied through Form 6. But why did the software block, in February, the Electoral Registration Officers' decisions to reverse the deletions? The affidavit has no answer. It addresses a question in West Bengal, but leaves others hanging — the appeals against orders restoring voters to the electoral roll were filed by the office of the state's Chief Electoral Officer, it says. But why were Commissioners Sandhu and Joshi kept in the dark when they asked about this matter earlier, and how did an exercise of this scale proceed, in the name of the Commission, with this level of opacity — again, there are no answers in the affidavit.

The SIR process continues to stumble. In West Bengal, a report in this newspaper has also revealed, judges of tribunals appointed by the Court to decide appeals of those affected by the SIR have pointed out that the ECI requirement for Aadhaar authentication in its portal is coming in their way. Their problem, among others, needs to be addressed by an ECI that listens, one that gives primacy to due process in its conduct vis-à-vis other players and institutions, and internally. The affidavit is an imperfect start. The Court, which has a distinguished record of upholding Article 324 that secures the ECI's powers, must now nudge it towards a course correction. That requires, first, fuller transparency.

Workforce shake-up is here to stay. Brace for it

MICROSOFT (MS), the technology company synonymous with computers and software, has made a "voluntary exit offer" to as many as 60,000 of its staff. Its Chief People Officer said that it "gives eligible employees who may be considering a future outside the company a new choice to make that transition now with support". "With support" suggests that those who do not take up the offer may face a future scenario where they may be let go of, but without the monetary compensation that is available now. The move affects 27 per cent of MS's total workforce spread across the US, Canada, the UK and India. This comes on the back of a "voluntary retirement programme" in July that was offered to more than 8,700 employees. More than 30 per cent of them accepted it even as MS followed it up by firing another 4,800 a few weeks later.

While it was not stated openly, a reason for these layoffs is the advent of artificial intelligence. Companies like MS are finding, one, that with the power of AI by their side, they can do more with fewer employees. And two, that there is a need to free up money so that hundreds of billions of dollars more can be invested into building AI infrastructure. MS is neither the first company nor the only one that is cutting employees in the wake of AI. Reportedly, some of the biggest players across technology and banking — Barclays, HSBC, Oracle, Meta, Amazon, to name a few — have shed significant bits of their workforce in 2026. What's more, companies are doing it even as their profits continue to grow.

The immediate impact of AI-related restructuring at the global scale will also be felt by Indian IT companies. It is possible that, in the short term, the transition to AI will create some job opportunities, but over the medium term, this industry, which is the largest provider of white-collar jobs in India, will likely face headwinds. The bigger challenge, however, is for Indian policymakers. AI's much-touted ability to replace humans threatens India at a time when the country is experiencing a bulge in its youth population, while struggling to create good quality jobs, amid growing unrest among the young. These trends should make policymakers rethink their human resource strategies.

Language, the original maxxer

WORDS CAN travel far enough from their roots that they lose any obvious connection to their origins. Take "camouflage". The root word, *camouflet*, described a practical joke that involved blowing air up someone's nose while they slept. "Berserk", which now means "out of control with anger", comes from the Old Norse noun *berserkr*, which described frenzied warriors who wore bearskin coverings. "Weird" derives from the Old English noun, *wyrd*, which largely translates to "fate" (the transformation began with Shakespeare's *Macbeth*). Now, there's "maxxing", Dictionary.com's word of the year for 2026.

Born from Game Theory, the word was absorbed into video and board gaming slang, before 4chan message boards and incel circles turned it into the portmanteau "looksmaxxing": The practice of going to extreme lengths — like breaking and reforming one's jaw — to "improve" one's looks because that, according to the strange logic of misogyny, was the only way to gain confidence and attract women. But as with *wyrd*, so with maxxing — people have made the term their own.

Having been absorbed, and diluted, by the mainstream, maxxing appears now to embody self-improvement. "Proteinmaxxing" to be healthier, "hustlemaxxing" to realise one's potential, "vocabularymaxxing", to have new thoughts with new words. Language, it turns out, is as good as ever at meaningmaxxing.

A visit to Baku, a gateway to a changing Eurasia



RAJA MANDALA
BY C RAJA MOHAN

EXTERNAL AFFAIRS Minister S Jaishankar's visit to Baku last week pointed to a reset in relations with Azerbaijan that had soured in the last few years. Like the dramatic turnaround in ties with Canada over the past year and a half, the opening in Baku reminds us that productive diplomacy is possible even with countries dismissed as hostile by public opinion.

Even more interesting, the positive results from the engagement with Azerbaijan underline the enduring power of nationalism and self-interest over political affiliations based on religion and ethnicity. Indian perceptions of Turkey, Azerbaijan and Pakistan as a strategic bloc hardened during Op Sindoor in May 2025. Going back a little further, Delhi flagged the 2021 Islamabad Declaration by the three countries, which backed Pakistan's position on Kashmir. Their "Three Brothers" military exercise in Azerbaijan that year gave the partnership a memorable label. During Op Sindoor, calls to boycott Turkey and Azerbaijan spread through television and social media into travel and trade.

Obscured by the media outrage was the reality that Baku's ties with Islamabad were thinner than the language of brotherhood suggested. Baku's engagement with Islamabad was a consequence of Azerbaijan's close ties to Turkey. But Baku's apparent solidarity with Ankara is now showing strains. As Azerbaijan prepares to hand the chair of the Organisation of Turkic States (OTS) to Turkey this week, their emerging differences offer a reminder of the gap between rhetoric on trans-national solidarity and national interests.

Pan-Arabism and pan-Islamism have struggled to overcome divisions in the Middle East. Pan-Turkism, promoted by Turkey's leader Recep Tayyip Erdoğan, also faces limits in Eurasia. Shared religious and ethnic identities can facilitate practical cooperation, but they do not automatically produce a unified strategic bloc.

The idea of Turkic unity gained ground in the late Ottoman era amid imperial decline and European expansion. The Soviet collapse in 1991 opened an opportunity for Ankara to reconnect with the former Soviet republics of the Caucasus and Central Asia. But the new republics valued their sovereignty. They were not interested in trading one hegemon for another. The Turkic Council, established in 2009, became the Organisation of Turkic States in 2021. Its agenda spans trade, transport, technology and culture. Common security commitments are more difficult to develop. The OTS brings together Turkey, Azerbaijan, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan and Uzbekistan. Turkmenistan, although Turkic-speaking, remains an observer.

Recent political friction between Ankara and Baku illuminates the problem. Azerbaijan's restrictions on Islamic headscarves in schools drew sharp criticism from conservative Turkish voices. Baku defended its secular order and rejected outside interference. Azerbaijani authorities also issued arrest warrants for Turkish nationals accused of incitement. Behind the dispute lie different political orientations. External solidarity does not translate into a common position on the relationship between state and religion.

> Azerbaijan's energy resources and transport links give it influence across the Caucasus, inner Asia and the Greater Middle East. Closer engagement can help Delhi expand its access to these regions

Foreign policy adds another divide. Azerbaijan values its strategic relationship with Israel, including defence cooperation. Turkey, the first Muslim-majority country to recognise Israel in 1949, is now sharply at odds with it. Baku sees no reason to abandon a partnership important to its security. To be sure, the Turkish-Azerbaijani partnership has strong roots. That does not mean they will take unified positions on all issues.

The Central Asian republics present a parallel challenge to ambitious visions of Turkic unity. They welcome Turkish investment, transport links and military technology. But they also pursue "multi-vector" partnerships , much like India's "multi-alignment". Their security circumstances differ from Turkey's. Ankara is a prominent member of NATO; and Central Asian states must carefully manage their relations with the big neighbours allergic to NATO — Russia and China.

Kazakh President Kassym-Jomart Tokayev made the Central Asian approach clear by rejecting the proposals to turn the OTS into a military alliance or geopolitical bloc. Kazakhstan and Kyrgyzstan also belong to the Russia-led Collective Security Treaty Organisation. Growing economic ties with China present additional constraints. Central Asian states seek partners to strengthen sovereignty and widen their choices while retaining freedom to engage other powers.

There is, nevertheless, much that Turkic cooperation can achieve. Better ports, railways and customs arrangements can bring material benefits to inner Eurasia. Such initiatives are reshaping its economic geography without requiring agreement on every security question. India must engage this changing Eurasian landscape. Russian power, China's growing presence and Turkish and Iranian ambitions are real. But the Caucasus and Central Asian states have agency of their own.

Jaishankar's visit recognises Azerbaijan's place in that strategy. It borders Russia and Iran, connects westwards through Georgia and Turkey, and looks across the Caspian towards Central Asia. Azerbaijan's energy resources and transport links give it influence across the Caucasus, inner Asia and the Greater Middle East. Closer engagement can help Delhi expand its access to these regions and strengthen its wider continental diplomatic presence. The Caucasus, nestling between the Caspian and Black Seas, has long drawn Russian, Ottoman and Persian ambitions. Its changing balance deserves sustained Indian attention.

India has energy interests in Azerbaijan and a stake in the International North-South Transport Corridor. Baku's ties with Israel and the United Arab Emirates offer further convergence. Delhi can explore these while preserving its partnership with Armenia, as Baku and Yerevan pursue normalisation.

India does not object to other countries having relations with Pakistan. But it does seek their neutrality in India-Pakistan disputes. Our intense social media debates can easily miss the fact that Pakistan's friends have interests of their own. Some of them overlap India's. Exploring that common ground is better than giving Islamabad a veto over Delhi's diplomatic choices. The opening in Baku should encourage Delhi's exploration of a reset with Ankara at an opportune moment.

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Not just welfare for elderly, Keralam needs silver economy



MUHAMMED RIYAS

KERALAM IS ageing faster than most Indian states. People aged 60 and above accounted for around 15 per cent of the population in 2021; this is projected to reach 30 per cent by 2051, according to the International Institute of Migration and Development. Longer life expectancy is an achievement, but it raises questions about pensions, care and public finances. The challenge is not simply to support more older people, but to enable them to age with dignity, financial security and meaningful participation.

The Keralam Senior Citizens' (Care and Protection of Rights) Bill, 2026, unanimously passed by the state Assembly on Monday, marks an important step towards strengthening the rights, care and protection of senior citizens. It proposes regulation of care centres and caregivers, protection against abuse and neglect, and measures concerning home-based care, accessible public spaces, digital inclusion, legal assistance and assistive products. Provisions concerning living wills and ageing at home seek to protect autonomy. Importantly, the Bill recognises income-generating opportunities and the sharing of older people's knowledge with younger generations. Its proposed State Reserve Fund could help finance care and welfare.

Keralam's approach to senior citizens must build on, rather than be confined to, the established framework of welfare and social protection. Pensions, healthcare, protection from abuse and affordable care remain non-negotiable. Nor should productive ageing become an obligation for people who have contributed throughout their working lives. It should be a choice, supported by opportunities for those who wish and are able to participate.

Kerala has many retired teachers, nurses, engineers, administrators, entrepreneurs, artisans and skilled workers. Their experience could support mentoring, vocational training, entrepreneurship and community development. Universities and local governments could connect this expertise to local needs.

The broader opportunity is to develop a silver economy, goods and services responding to an ageing population. Home healthcare, physiotherapy, assisted living, accessible housing, age-friendly transport, assistive technologies and lifelong learning can improve older people's lives while creating dignified jobs for younger workers. The Bill's caregiver certification framework should be accompanied by fair wages, social security, safe working conditions and career progression. Public provision and financial assistance are necessary to make care affordable for low-income households.

> Home healthcare, physiotherapy, assisted living, accessible housing, age-friendly transport, assistive technologies and lifelong learning can improve older people's lives while creating dignified jobs for younger workers

Local governments should anchor this transition. The state should consider a senior citizens' sub-plan, with predictable funding and clear responsibilities for panchayats and municipalities. It should identify needs, set spending priorities and assess outcomes. Local governments could assess care needs, mobility barriers, financial vulnerability and older people's skills and interests. They could coordinate home-based care, day-care services, public spaces and mentoring opportunities. The Department of Senior Citizens could set service standards, provide technical support and monitor implementation.

The state should provide earmarked transfers or a dedicated funding window while allowing local bodies flexibility. The proposed State Reserve Fund could complement predictable budgetary support, not replace it. Funding for essential care should be protected alongside investment in participation and livelihood opportunities.

Financial security remains the foundation. Employment cannot substitute for social protection, nor should the silver economy shift responsibility from the state to older people and their families. The Bill's success should be measured by more than registered care centres or resolved complaints. Keralam must also ask whether older people are secure, receive dignified care and can contribute on their own terms. Welfare and protection are indispensable; the next step is an economy of care, experience and intergenerational solidarity.

The writer is a faculty member at SIBM Bengaluru

Sudhakar Nadkarni was key in the making of Indian design



ANIL ZANKAR

I HEARD of Professor Sudhakar Nadkarni in 2017, when he received a lifetime award from IISc. What little information came my way triggered my curiosity, leading me to his book *The Design Journey*. This professional autobiography of a designer made me marvel at his achievements, the longevity of his career and the energy with which he worked. Also striking was his tendency to acknowledge his colleagues' contributions. Most of his endeavours were collective efforts, with credits shared fairly. Subsequently, I decided to film him and obtained some marvellous footage from his interviews. It revealed to me the many finer and humane aspects of his work and personality.

Nadkarni breathed his last on October 20 in Mumbai at the age of 90. His seven-decade-long career began in 1958 when he joined an advertising agency in Mumbai as a commercial artist. There, a colleague, Yeshwant Chaudhury, advised him to join Ulm Design School in Germany, which was at the time reputed to be the best design school in the world. Nadkarni landed in Ulm in December 1962, dressed in summer clothes, with no knowledge of what design meant, nor of the German language.

This middle-class Marathi boy's journey would develop into a glorious chapter of design practice and education in India. In 1966, on returning to India, Nadkarni joined the small group of pioneering design teachers at NID. In 1969 at IIT Bombay, he set up the Industrial Design Centre (IDC) and raised it to global stature through a rigorous curriculum and international collaborations. He arranged for young teachers to get global exposure. After he stepped down in 1997, IIT Guwahati invited him to set up a design department. In 2004, when he returned to Mumbai, Welingkar Management Institute invited him to set up a customised design department. He was associated with the institute till 2020.

It was Nadkarni's belief that a designer must be informed by his own socio-cultural tradition on the one hand and emerging modernity on the other. Although trained in the best and the latest European tradition, he strongly believed in developing an Indian perspective. Nadkarni's final-year thesis at Ulm (in 1966) was called "Design as one of the factors in developmental planning, India as an example". His design for the final project was the iconic Aarey Milk Booth. He despised elitism in design practice.

Ever a disciplinarian, there was also something of the maverick about him. Students held him in awe, but they could also draw caricatures of their favourite "Nadu sir". In June, when his book *by design* was released, the function was attended by a few hundred people, mostly his students and colleagues. They put up skits that presented him as the absent-minded professor, but their reverence and warmth for him was unmistakable.

Besides IISc, Nadkarni was honoured with the Lifetime Achievement Award by the India Design Association (2015) for building institutions and his contribution to the field. The Bauhaus Manifesto defined an artist as "an exalted artisan". Professor Nadkarni was the perfect example of this. When the Ulm school closed down, its tradition found a new life in India thanks to him.

> The Bauhaus Manifesto defined an artist as 'an exalted artisan'. Professor Nadkarni was the perfect example of this. When the Ulm school closed down, its tradition found a new life in India thanks to him

Zankar is a writer and filmmaker

40 YEARS AGO
October 28, 1986


SAREES
INDIAN EXPRESS
LUXMI
Sukhjinder held at Ramgarh
Hoshiarpur under curfew after clash
Bandh in Punjab partial

Curfew in Hoshiarpur

ONE PERSON was killed and another injured by suspected terrorists in Punjab, while the statewide bandh in protest against terrorist killings at Khumban village passed off peacefully barring Hoshiarpur town, where indefinite curfew was imposed following clashes and police firing. Suspected terrorists shot dead a shopkeeper in Khwajpur village in Verowal, Amritsar district.

Badal Dal leader arrested

SUKHJINDER SINGH, a prominent leader of Akali Dal (Badal group) and former education minister, was arrested from his native village, Ramgarh, in Kapurthala district. The Punjab Police and CRPF personnel went to his residence and took him into custody. Singh was taken to Adampur aerodrome, from where he was flown to Delhi in a special plane.

Panel finds rape cover-up

A SUPREME Court commission has blown the cover off a conspiracy by top police officers to erase evidence of the rape of a Gujarati tribal by several policemen. The rape of 22-year-old Gunta Behn of Sagbara taluka in Bharuch district was sought to be covered up by the collector, two doctors of the local public hospital, the deputy superintendent of police, the SP and a sub-inspector among others. The commission has indicted all of them in a report submitted to the SC.

Two killed in Tripura firing

TWO PERSONS were killed when police fired to quell a violent mob in Jatrapur area of West Tripura district. Sources said the firing took place after a stone-throwing mob attacked a police station to snatch away two persons, arrested on the charge of drunkenness.

WHAT THE OTHERS SAY

Lula's comeback is a victory for Brazil and the world, as well as a Trump rebuff.
— The Guardian

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On theatre commands, let's finish arguing, reach a settlement, before next crisis comes



ARUN PRAKASH



ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

SEVEN YEARS after the government directed the newly minted Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) to restructure military commands and bring about jointness through the establishment of theatre commands, the debate seems to have become a quarrel over turf garbed in the language of high principles. The Army worries about not getting air support when needed. The Air Force worries that its scarce squadrons will be divided and controlled by theatre commanders. The Navy worries that a continental mindset will starve it of resources.

These worries are legitimate. But their persistence shows that we have failed to learn what others have learned the hard way: That air power has been a bone of contention between the services ever since World War I, and that inter-service disputes are best settled by negotiations under the watchful eye of committed politicians who comprehend the gravity of the issues.

The status quo, however, is not an option. India's archaic structure of 17 geographically dispersed single-service military commands would be caught flat-footed in modern conflict. Each command answers to its own service headquarters and maintains an area of responsibility that does not align with those of the other services. A conflict on the western or northern fronts, or at sea, would span the boundaries of several commands simultaneously. Coordinating across these arbitrary lines would consume precious time that modern, fast-moving, AI-guided algorithmic warfare simply will not permit. Theatre commands would replace this cumbersome patchwork with a single commander equipped with the operational authority as well as necessary forces.

The most frequently heard objection concerning air power stems from the Air Force doctrine of "centralised control and decentralised execution". Critics argue that dividing scarce air assets among theatre commanders would disrupt this doctrine. Not true, because theatreisation does not violate this core principle. IAF squadrons and wings would remain in their current locations and need not be parcelled out. Air power would still be controlled centrally and tasked, as required, in a decentralised manner — as at present. The sole change is that control would shift from an IAF commander to the theatre commander. Objecting to theatreisation under the guise of this doctrine confuses the principle itself with the person wielding it. Furthermore, critics disregard the fact that theatre commanders would receive advice and guidance on air power employment from a three-star IAF Component Commander.

America's National Security Act of 1947 had carved an independent air force out of the US Army Air Forces, and created a unified defence establishment, but failed to address the question of "who does what". Open conflict broke out between the services. The US Navy wanted a role in nuclear deterrence and suspected the USAF of coveting naval aviation; the USAF believed that strategic bombing had rendered the navy fleet redundant; and the army did not want the Marine Corps trespassing on its ground role.

> The status quo is not an option. India's archaic structure of 17 geographically dispersed single-service military commands would be caught flat-footed in modern conflict

Defence Secretary (Minister) James Forrestal assembled the joint chiefs at Key West and insisted that they would not disperse till they came to an agreement on their respective roles and missions. The air force took primary responsibility for strategic air warfare. The navy kept carrier aviation and the Marine Corps. The army kept land combat. While the deal did not end inter-service acrimony, the Key West Agreement had established a principle: Service roles and missions would be allocated or re-allocated by mutual agreement, under civilian political authority.

Two decades later, the same principle resolved a different dispute. In Vietnam, the US Army, in addition to owning a fixed-wing tactical transport fleet, had built a large helicopter force and was arming it. The USAF held that fixed-wing aircraft supporting ground troops were its business. In 1966, the two services negotiated and agreed on a swap. The US Army agreed to give up its fixed-wing aircraft in exchange for combat helicopters, while the USAF relinquished its claim to most forms of rotary-wing aircraft.

It is obvious that Indian problems call for India-specific solutions, and it would be foolish to "cut and paste" foreign paradigms on ourselves. But does that mean that we should refuse to learn from others? Or close our eyes to ongoing conflicts, which demonstrate the dizzying transformation in the nature and grammar of war? Ukraine, despite lacking a traditional navy, has crippled Russia's Black Sea Fleet and sunk its flagship, the cruiser Moskva. Iran, with its air force decimated, has leveraged missiles and drones to attack 14 US military bases in West Asia and to contest control of the Persian Gulf. India, on the verge of major weapon acquisition commitments, must not shut its eyes to these momentous developments in warfare.

Britain offers lessons of a different kind. In 2023, Air Chief Marshal Sir Richard Knighton took charge of the Royal Air Force (RAF). An aeronautical engineer by training, he became the first non-pilot ever to head the service. In 2025, he went further still, becoming CDS and professional head of all three services. Earlier, the UK had broken another long-standing tradition by appointing General Sir Gwyn Jenkins, a Royal Marine, as First Sea Lord and head of the Royal Navy. The wisdom of such unconventional choices can be debated, but they reflect open-mindedness, a spirit of innovation and decisiveness on the part of the decision-makers. Contrast this with our own seven-year stasis on theatre commands.

It took the US nearly four decades, and several operational disasters, following the Key West Agreement to achieve true jointness through the Goldwater-Nichols Act of 1986. Given its fraught security environment, India cannot afford the luxury of further procrastination. The path forward requires bold service chiefs willing to break old shibboleths, a resolute CDS who can act as an honest broker-cum-persuader, and a government with a clear-eyed vision, anchored in a formal national security strategy.

The next security crisis will not wait for the services to finish arguing, and a settlement should be reached before it comes.

The writer is a former Indian Navy chief

Beyond midterms, Indian Americans need a new dream



VAMSEE JULURI

HOW MANY Indians make for "too many Indians" in the United States? One more than all the others in the room? Or even just one more than the only other Indian in the room? Many years ago, a housemate selection interview in a campus town in America snowballed into a legal squabble and even a distress sale of the house over a question like this. A graduate student who had rented there for a long time insisted that his Indian housemate could not get any more Indian tenants lest the Whites be overrun, as he rather explicitly insisted, not realising it was against the law to do so.

Now, questions like this are discussed by otherwise seemingly nice American people in places like Texas, where years of online campaigns and complaints about Indians "stealing jobs", shopping in shops, winning spelling bees, and cheering in football games, have become the face of what was once optimistically called "Making America Great Again".

The 2026 US midterm elections may be unfolding around several major issues not unfamiliar to American voters in the past, such as wars and fuel and food prices. But never has the numerically minuscule Indian American population found itself the subject of existential doubt in relation to its future as it has now.

It would be an exaggeration to say that anti-Indian racism will be a key issue on which votes are cast in most of the national or local polls. Nor will the relatively small numbers of Indian-descent voters make a significant impact, perhaps except in certain pockets. Outside the Indian-American diaspora and the Indian media, there is little urgency or awareness about the recent rise in anti-Indian racism. Notwithstanding the fact that there has been some coverage in mainstream media of incidents like the narrowly averted mass shooting at a major Hindu temple in Illinois, the fact remains that anti-Indian racism is not seen as a "thing" for everyone to profess concern about, unlike the protests against the "Muslim Ban" in 2017 or the Black Lives Matter revolutionary zeal of 2020.



In the competitive world of attention for identity-based claims for not just pain and struggle, but just about almost anything, Indians, India, Hindus, are not even in the running. Yet, Indian Americans try so hard to argue on social media that everyone, even Italian and Irish Americans, faced their share of problems in the past. It is comforting to think it's just every immigrant community's rite of passage, before the right to arrival, or acceptance, presents itself.

Meanwhile, one has to live through it, or out-vote it. That seems to be the approach, and no one can fault besieged immigrants for feeling this way.

But what would a MAGA defeat in the midterms, even if it does happen, mean for Indians, for America? Will the genie, as they say, go back in the bottle? Or will another group of motivated actors find in the tropes that have been manufactured around the "Indian American" a useful arsenal to demonise, dehumanise, and disenfranchise once again? A scapegoat that wears the coat that fits without so much as a fight is the most convenient scapegoat of all.

The core issue is that Indians in America haven't confronted the reality of their lot here: That they have no collective control over anything, starting with their image. For a highly visible, and some might say audible, community, we have neither strategy nor ideology, nor story, nor voice. We are status-conscious (with each other), but image-oblivious (beyond each other). We put our best feet forward into schools and careers, but we have never understood that chanting "we can be more American than you Americans" is not exactly endearing, once it stops being amusing.

This is not to say that it is all a failure to self-represent. The resistance to change in the representation establishment is monumental, be it media or academia. But without the effort and the investment in creativity and self-representation, the Indian American will continue to remain, in politics, as in culture, mostly inconsequential. To put it another way, it is time to stop being just the machinery (or worse, a performative mercenary), and start thinking of what it means to be missionary. America can use an altogether new American Dream, and not just a claustrophobic Indian parenthesis in one of its declining old ones.

The writer is professor of Media Studies, University of San Francisco

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

ECI impartiality

IN STARK contrast to the tenure of T N Seshan and several of his successors, who exercised the powers vested in the Election Commission with firmness and impartiality, the present Election Commission has faced allegations of partisanship and of appearing overly accommodating towards the ruling dispensation ('On institutions, a stark hypocrisy from Congress', *IE*, October 27). The large-scale deletion of names from electoral rolls, particularly when voters are unable to effectively defend their right to remain enrolled, has raised serious concerns about transparency, due process and the right to vote.

Tharcius S Fernando, Chennai

Brazil nailbiter

WINNING AN election by a whisker is the easy part; healing a nation split down the middle is the real mountain to climb ('Lula's return is dramatic, his challenges formidable', *IE*, October 27). While the world celebrates a victory for the left, the narrow margin reveals a deeply fractured society. For the ordinary citizen, political slogans mean little when grocery bills are soaring and household debt is crushing. President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva must now build bridges with those who voted against him, focusing on practical economic relief.

K Chidanand Kumar, Bengaluru

THE EDITORIAL rightly points out the monumental task awaiting President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva following his historic fourth-term victory ('Lula's return is dramatic, his challenges formidable', *IE*, October 27). Navigating a deeply divided nation, an uncooperative conservative Congress, and severe fiscal constraints will undoubtedly test his political acumen. However, seeing his narrow victory solely as a potential harbinger of gridlock underestimates Lula's abilities as a pragmatic coalition-builder. As public debt and humble growth projections strictly restrict ambitious social spending, fiscal discipline and progressive reform need not be mutually exclusive.

Sanjay Chopra, Mohali

Clean air needs targets, timelines, accountability



ZERIN OSHO

AFTER SERIOUS heatwaves and deadly deluges, it's time for toxic air to afflict lives and livelihoods in India. Again, till the cycle is forgotten. This seasonal amnesia consistently collides with a revealing policy paradox. In September, the Union government's latest Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan rankings were released. Lucknow was crowned India's best-performing million-plus city. The city deserves credit: Its annual average PM10 levels have fallen from 253 micrograms per cubic metre in 2017-18 to around 135 today. Even then, this is more than double the national safety standard of 60. The country's capital highlights an equally serious malaise: A recent analysis by the Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air reveals that Delhi has had no appreciable improvement in its winter air quality over the last four years, despite pollution-control measures and activities under the Graded Response Action Plan. Are we missing the wood for the trees?

Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan assesses administrative activity — sweeping roads, managing waste, paving sidewalks and preparing action plans. Actual reductions in particulate matter account for just 2.5 per cent of a city's total score. A municipality can follow procedures, earn national accolades and still have dangerously polluted air.

This is the blind spot in India's clean-air strategy. Under the National Clean Air Programme (NCAP), India has improved its ability to design programmes, allocate budgets and track municipal action. But its policy framework has failed to account for the economic cost of delays in delivering clean air. An assessment by the UN Environment Programme (UNEP) and the Climate and Clean Air Coalition, Hidden Assets, offers a way to understand this cost. South Asia bears the world's heaviest economic burden from air pollution, losing the equivalent of 10 per cent of regional GDP annually through reduced productivity and healthcare costs. Every rupee invested in a package of 25 climate and clean-air measures could yield an estimated Rs 21 in economic and health benefits. The returns include lower hospital bills, fewer missed workdays and improved productivity, alongside the economic value of lives saved and years of healthy life preserved. Even when non-market benefits are excluded, the report estimates a global return of Rs 4 for every rupee invested.

> If Delhi and the NCR meet national air quality standards on schedule from 2026, their cumulative PM2.5 exposure burden could fall by 20 per cent by 2040

If Delhi and the NCR meet national air quality standards on schedule from 2026, their cumulative PM2.5 exposure burden could fall by 20 per cent by 2040. An eight-year delay, reflecting the study's global average, would halve that reduction. Delayed implementation does not merely postpone benefits; it destroys them. A filter installed in 2034 cannot clean the air a child breathed in 2026, nor can a delayed electric bus fleet recover lost workdays or school attendance.

Why do we lose this time? The study identifies institutional fragmentation as a major obstacle across developing nations. Air pollution results from transport, electricity generation, industry, waste management, agriculture and household cooking. These fall under different ministries, departments and urban agencies. When clean air is treated as the responsibility of environment departments alone, coordination suffers, deadlines slip and accountability diffuses.

India has shown that it can manage complex transitions when responsibilities are clear. The expansion of rural LPG connections under the Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana and the growth of solar power demonstrate its capacity to deliver at scale. Clean-air policy, however, cannot depend on emergency measures and disconnected schemes. As the government considers NCAP 2.0, it must change how success is measured. Clean-air spending should be judged by how much human exposure it reduces, how quickly relief reaches people and which agency faces consequences when deadlines are missed. Central grants and Finance Commission transfers should reward sustained reductions in pollution exposure.

Air pollution's costs are well understood, as are many of the solutions. India's clean-air policy needs not another list of measures, but a stopwatch.

The writer is director, India Programme at the Institute for Governance & Sustainable Development

The many political lives of Benjamin Netanyahu



KHINVRAJ JANGID

ISRAEL VOTED to elect a new government on October 27. Benjamin Netanyahu was, once again, at the centre of the polls. The October 7, 2023 terror attacks by Hamas, the inconclusive wars that followed, the growing criticism of Israel across the world, and the corruption charges against Netanyahu — these were the key electoral issues. That Netanyahu is still in the conversation as a major contender baffles many.

Netanyahu became prime minister for the first time in 1996 and has dominated Israel's domestic politics and foreign policy for the past three decades. So far, he has contested 11 national elections and won six. He has served as PM for over 19 years. That is the longest period in that office. The country's founding prime minister, David Ben-Gurion, served for 13 years. In his long political life, Netanyahu and his party, Likud, have not won a clear majority (61 out of 120 seats in the legislature). He has, however, brought together groups comprising several smaller parties.

The story of Netanyahu's rise and dominance is also the complex story of Israel in the last three decades. He became PM in 1996 following a domestic backlash against the Oslo Peace Process. He advocated no compromise, as he does now, on the part of Israel towards the two-state solution. To him, Palestinian leaders — Yasser Arafat in the past and now Hamas — would use violence against Israelis if they could. He was vindicated when the Oslo process failed due to Arafat's last-hour hesitation in 2000-2001 and the suicide bombing of the Al-Aqsa Intifada led by Hamas in the early 2000s. More than 1,000 Israelis were killed between 2000 and 2005. Since then, Netanyahu has advocated an "Iron Wall" approach and a policy of retaliation rather than compromise with the Palestinian nationalists. According to him, it is only the "strong who survive" in the Middle East.

> He became PM in 1996 following a domestic backlash against the Oslo Peace Process. He advocated no compromise, as he does now, on the part of Israel for the two-state solution

There is much more to Netanyahu's appeal to his base than war and terrorism. Israel was founded on a strong socialist ethos and till about the 1990s, its economy was heavily centralised, state-controlled and dominated by labour unions (Histadrut). Netanyahu was born in Tel Aviv but spent a significant portion of his adult life in the US, where he studied architecture and business at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology and worked in corporate consulting in Boston. He returned to Israel as a quintessential American who believed in the free-market economy, tax cuts, foreign direct investment, entrepreneurship, and innovation.

In the past three decades, Israel has been recognised as a "start-up nation" — a global innovation powerhouse driven by private equity, venture capital, and fintech. After Americanising Israel's kibbutz (socialist) economy, he turned his politics to Israeli society's fault lines. Israel has been deeply divided between Ashkenazi (European-origin Jews) and Mizrahi (Middle East-Asian-origin Jews) and religious conservatives and liberals, doves and hawks, etc. The Likud party before him advocated for the Mizrahi Jews, who were marginalised in Israeli politics, society and cultural-intellectual spaces. Netanyahu caters to ultra-religious elements who do not serve in the army and receive plump subsidies from the state exchequer, as well as those religious Zionists who remain unapologetic about the settlements in the West Bank.

Israel's domestic crisis and external threats do demand more from its leaders than just coalition skills or the Hebrew expression *combina* (*jugaad* in our terms).

The writer is professor and executive director, Jindal Centre for Israel Studies, OP Jindal Global University and founding chair, India-Israel Centre, Delhi

The many wars of Matthew VanDyke

AMERICAN ARRESTED WITH 6 UKRAINIANS

In March 2026, US national Matthew Aaron VanDyke and six Ukrainians were arrested on terror charges. Six months later, with the UAPA charges dropped, VanDyke and the others flew out of the country, raising questions about the man and his affiliations. NIRBHAY THAKUR traces his arc — from motorcycle journeys across the Arab world to his detention in Tihar jail



ILLUSTRATION: SUVAJIT DEY



ON MARCH 13, 2011, a 30-year-old American from Baltimore city was "struck on the head" in an ambush near the Libyan oil town of Brega and woke up a prisoner of Muammar Gaddafi. He would spend the next 166 days in solitary confinement.

Exactly 15 years later, on March 13, 2026, the man, Matthew Aaron VanDyke, was arrested by India's National Investigation Agency (NIA) at Kolkata airport. The same day, six Ukrainians — Hurba Petro, Taras Slyviak, Ivan Sukmanovskyi, Marian Stefankiv, Maksim Honcharuk and Viktor Kaminskyi — were arrested in a coordinated swoop from Lucknow and Delhi airports.

The NIA alleged the seven were part of a group that had entered India on tourist visas, travelled through Assam, and moved into the protected border state of Mizoram. From Mizoram, they allegedly entered Myanmar, where, the agency alleged, they trained banned Indian insurgent groups and supplied them with weapons, including drones, and terrorist hardware from Europe. The charges against them — of conspiring to carry out terrorist activities against India — were grave enough for the NIA to slap the stringent Section 18 of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act against them.

But then, after a little over six months in custody, most of it in Delhi's Tihar Jail, late September, VanDyke and his six Ukrainian co-accused walked out of prison on default bail and took the first flight out to their respective countries.

Then, in an unexpected twist to an already unusual case, VanDyke appeared in a Delhi court on October 23. With the NIA saying it needed three months to probe the terror charges against him, the court, citing VanDyke's compliance, allowed him to leave for the US and return to India in February 2027.

Questions followed, all of which surrounded the man and his affiliations.

Who is Matthew VanDyke? A "mercenary" with a knack for finding himself in dramatic situations in some of the most conflict-ridden regions of the world? A CIA agent, a charge that has followed him everywhere in the last few decades? A "motorcycling, freedom-fighting, filmmaking activist (and prisoner)" — "an accidental warrior", as a 2013 report in the *City Paper*, a Baltimore publication, called him? A "committed pro-democracy activist", as friends and associates describe him?

On his website, the American calls himself a "freedom fighter and prisoner of war in the Libyan civil war", an "award-winning filmmaker", a "war correspondent in Iraq and Afghanistan", founder of Sons of Liberty International (SOLI, "the first military contracting firm run on non-profit principles"), and an "international security analyst".

From all accounts, including *Point & Shoot*, a 2014 award-winning documentary based on VanDyke's journeys, these are labels he has walked in and out of as he turned up in the most unlikeliest of places, from Mauritania to Afghanistan, Iraq, Libya, Syria and now, India and Myanmar. Which is what makes him notoriously hard to tag, and pin down.

Requests by *The Indian Express* for an interview with VanDyke went unanswered.

The boy from Baltimore

VanDyke was born in Baltimore, Maryland, on June 11, 1979, as the only child of Sharon VanDyke, a retired elementary school principal, and Edgar VanDyke, a seafood broker. After his parents divorced when he was three, he was raised by his mother and grandparents in a South Baltimore house that had been in the family for generations, the *City Paper* reported in 2013.

He attended two private schools and took a high school equivalency diploma, before graduating in political science from the University of Maryland, Baltimore County (UMBC), in 2002. It was at UMBC, the report says, in classes taught by the late Middle East specialist Louis Cantori, that he developed a fascination for the Arab world.

Thomas Schaller, one of his professors at UMBC, refused to comment on his former student for this story. In a 2011 interview to the Associated Press, Schaller had described VanDyke as one of his smartest students, someone with a "thirst for life".

The Indian Express reached out to Professor Brian Grodsky, Department Chair of the Political Science Department at UMBC, who said VanDyke left the university "well before my time".

Two years later, VanDyke earned a Master's in Security Studies, with a West Asia concentration, from Georgetown University's Walsh School of Foreign Service.

It was here, he told the *City Paper*, that his fascination for a career in the CIA clashed with his opposition to the Iraq war. "...I had wanted to work for the CIA, to start out as an analyst and then transition into the operations side. But my worldview changed with the Iraq War," he is quoted as telling journalist Van Smith.

In *Point & Shoot,* he talks about how, after failed attempts at finding an alternative career path, in 2007, inspired by Alby Mangels, an Australian adventurer who filmed his 'world safari' journeys, he decided to do something similar — film his motorcycle journeys across West Asia, a region he had specialised in while in university, but never visited.

Between 2007 and 2010, he is said to have travelled across North Africa and West Asia with a camera, from Morocco and Mauritania to Libya, Syria, and later through Iraq and Iran to Afghanistan.

The more he travelled and the more people and friends he made, the farther he went from his goal of making his motorcycle adventure film. It was around this time, his associates say, that he started believing he needed to "be part of revolutions".

By the time he landed in Tripoli, the capital of war-torn Libya, in 2011, he had made friends with Libyans who were fighting against Gaddafi's regime, and plunged straight into the war.

He was captured within weeks and held in a cell in Tripoli's Maktab al-Nasser prison for 85 days, and then in Abu Salim prison for another 81, say reports. For months, the Gaddafi government denied it had him.

With VanDyke missing, his then "girlfriend" Lauren Fischer and mother Sharon VanDyke ran a public campaign to find him, enlisting a Maryland Congressman, Dutch Ruppersberger, to press his case. On May 23, 2011, Ruppersberger held a news conference to draw attention to VanDyke's disappearance.

As rights groups lobbied for his release, the Committee to Protect Journalists (CPJ) counted him among 17 journalists detained or believed to be held by the Gaddafi government, according to a report in the Associated Press.

Then, on August 24, 2011, amid the chaos that had gripped Tripoli, the guards at the Abu Salim facility, where he was kept, fled and he and other prisoners were freed, according to an account on VanDyke's personal website. He refused to go home and enlisted in the rebel National Liberation Army with his Libyan friends and fought in the battle for Sirte, his website says, before returning to Baltimore in November 2011.

After it emerged that VanDyke had been involved with rebel forces, rather than acting strictly as an independent journalist, the CPJ distanced itself from him.

"Matthew VanDyke was identified as a journalist in CPJ's 2011 census based on information provided by his family and news reports regarding his previous work as a journalist. Following the emergence of information about his involvement in combat in Libya, CPJ subsequently revised its assessment," Kunal Majumder, Asia-Pacific Program Coordinator at CPJ told *The Indian Express*. "CPJ does not include individuals who engage in combat in its killed, missing, and imprisoned datasets."

The next war VanDyke went to, he went with a camera. In October 2012, he went to the Syrian city of Aleppo, where he spent about a month filming *Not Anymore: A Story of Revolution*, a short documentary built around two Syrians, the journalist Nour Kelze and a rebel commander fighting the Bashar al-Assad regime.

The Indian Express reached out to Kelze, who is yet to respond.

With Syrian state television branding him a terrorist, VanDyke told the *City Paper*, "it became quite dangerous for me."

In 2014, American director and producer Marshall Curry's *Point and Shoot,* shot from VanDyke's footage in Syria, won Best Documentary at the Tribeca Film Festival in New York.

The same year, VanDyke founded SOLI, a US-registered non-profit that says it provides free military training, advice and supplies to forces fighting authoritarian regimes and terrorists.

Gia Santos, VanDyke's former girlfriend who works with SOLI and recently led the campaign for his release from Tihar, told *The Indian Express,* "Ultimately, SOLI stands for freedom." On the "free military training" that SOLI provides, she said, "Self-defence is important, whether you are defending your home, or defending yourself from an attack by a stranger... But for Matthew, it's about democracy. It's not just about the defence of freedom."

While SOLI claims its first mission was training the Nineveh Plain Protection Units, an Assyrian Christian force fighting in Iraq, in 2018, it worked with a counterterrorism force in the Philippines. Since March 2022, it has trained and supplied Ukrainian forces.

VanDyke has said he also enlisted in the Armed Forces of Ukraine as a combatant. "When he decides to do something, he's going to do it, one way or another... He's usually very involved with a lot of the missions," Santos said.

In January 2025, VanDyke claimed on X that he had been running covert operations with Venezuelan rebels since 2019.

It was this work, training armed groups in other people's wars, that the NIA would place at the centre of its case.

Jailed in India

On March 27, after 11 days of police custody, a special NIA court remanded VanDyke and the Ukrainians in judicial custody, following which they were transferred to Tihar jail on April 6.

According to the NIA's initial remand papers, the accused had entered Mizoram, a protected area, and then crossed the international border into Myanmar.

The NIA alleged that the accused were involved in illegally "importing huge consignments of drones from Europe to Myanmar via India" for the use of "ethnic armed groups" that were targeting the Myanmarese military junta.

The allegations grew stronger in the months that followed. In an application dated August 19, the NIA sought permission to interrogate VanDyke and his Ukrainian associate, Kaminskyi, in Tihar.

"...The Central Government has received credible information indicating the involvement of certain Ukrainian and US Nationals in a drone attack on a civilian aircraft in Myanmar," the NIA said in the application.

While the agency built its case, VanDyke was fighting another battle inside Tihar.

Sources in Tihar's high-security Jail 8/9, where he was lodged in a single cell, say he "wasn't friendly" with other inmates and barely interacted with anyone else.

In an application moved in July before Special NIA Judge Prashant Sharma, VanDyke claimed that "oily" and "greasy" food served in Tihar jail had forced him to go hungry and prompted him to go on strike.

"...the Applicant/Accused is a citizen of America who is not accustomed to the diet ordinarily served in Indian prison, which is predominantly spicy, oily, deep-fried and greasy in nature," the application said, claiming VanDyke lost nearly 30 pounds (14 kg) and developed vision problems.

He also requested a kitchen-like set-up with a list of 19 items so that he could cook for himself. On the list of items he demanded were lentils, protein-rich foods such as red meat, chicken, and fish (shrimp), uncooked noodles, pasta, uncooked rice, potatoes, onions, beans, spices, bread, butter, olive oil, toned milk, soya milk, and bottled water. VanDyke had also asked for an induction cooker/stove, pots, bowls, and a plastic chopper.

Sources said he was granted most of these, including a cook to meet his special diet needs.

Outside, a familiar campaign was under way. Fifteen years after Libya, his mother Sharon fought the same campaign. During his months in Tihar, the family issued statements through his X account and through his organisation, wrote to the US Embassy and pressed American lawmakers.

"The family of @Matt_VanDyke seeks urgent U.S. diplomatic intervention as he is presently still denied basic detainee rights, and is being kept in solitary confinement at Tihar Jail 8/9 in Delhi, India. Matthew is innocent of all charges against him. Throughout his career, he has documented human suffering and provided humanitarian assistance to people affected by conflict and crisis. It is time to bring #MatthewVanDyke back home," a September 2 tweet on his X account read.

"You have to know Matthew to understand why he does what he does," Sharon VanDyke said in an interview in May, according to a post on X by VanDyke's former girlfriend Santos, who handles social media for SOLI and has issued statements on the family's behalf.

Santos told *The Indian Express*, "Matthew has not talked about the conditions inside the cell. I think that's a conversation that he has had with his mom, rather than with me. He got a five-minute emergency call (while in jail) per month, which he used to call his mom. She did mention a few things to me. I think he told her that he made a friendship there, a friend or two."

VanDyke flies out

Then came September 8, the 180th day of the custody of VanDyke and the six Ukrainians, by which time the NIA had to file a chargesheet in the special court.

When it did so, the agency invoked only Sections 21 and 23 of the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025, offences that can be compounded before the Foreigners Regional Registration Office (FRRO). There was no mention of the terror charge, though the FIR was registered under Section 18 of the UAPA (punishment for being part of a terrorist conspiracy). The NIA told the court it needed more time to finish the investigation into the terror charges.

An official of the NIA told *The Indian Express,* "The investigation is still ongoing. The chargesheet that has been filed is not a final chargesheet."

With no UAPA in the chargesheet filed within the statutory 180 days, on September 18, VanDyke and the Ukrainians were granted default bail.

The court called the chargesheet "piecemeal" because it covered only the immigration offences while the UAPA probe was on.

The seven accused were subsequently discharged in the Foreigners Act case after the FRRO compounded the offences and imposed a penalty of Rs 5.5 lakh on each of them.

Next came the plea to go abroad. The seven asked for six weeks to return to their countries and meet their families, a plea the court allowed on September 24 on the condition that they return in a month.

"The right to travel abroad is an extension of fundamental rights under Article 21 of the Constitution... which cannot be taken lightly... and a balance has to be struck," the court said.

Though the case has not formally ended — the NIA can still file a supplementary chargesheet if it establishes UAPA offences — the agency told the court that the physical presence in India of VanDyke and the others would not be needed in the near future to complete the investigation.

On September 25, VanDyke and the others flew out of India.

Less than a month later, on October 23, VanDyke was back in India, stunning those who said he wouldn't show up.

Santos said, "Even the court agreed that you can show up virtually... But he felt it was important that he showed up. He has nothing against India. Everything that was done was done, not against India, and I would say, and I would even dare to say, was in support of India."

That day, dressed in a formal white shirt and black trousers, he walked into Judge Sharma's courtroom at Delhi's Rouse Avenue Court, with a beige envelope in his hand. He told the court that he wanted legal aid counsel as he didn't have money to pay a private lawyer. He also filed an application in court seeking the release of his seized personal items.

The same day, the court extended till February 24 the permission granted to VanDyke and six Ukrainians to remain abroad. The six Ukrainians did not return to India. The court had granted their appeal for an extension of their stay abroad.

A day later, on October 24, VanDyke flew out of India.

With inputs from Alok Singh, New Delhi

> **"Matthew has not talked about the conditions inside his cell in Tihar. He got a five-minute emergency call (while in jail), which he used to call his mom."**
> **GIA SANTOS,** VANDYKE'S FORMER GIRLFRIEND

(Below, left) VanDyke at Delhi's Rouse Avenue Court; with his former girlfriend Gia Santos
ANI VIDEO GRAB





VANDYKE'S JOURNEYS

- **2006: Spain** Stayed for eight months before launching his motorcycle journeys
- **2007: Morocco** Kicked off his motorcycle journey across the Arab world from here, before travelling through Mauritania, Tunisia, Libya, Jordan, Syria, Turkey and Egypt between 2007 and 2009
- **2009: Iraq** Embedded with US forces as a correspondent for *The Baltimore Examiner*
- **2010: Afghanistan** Reached Bagram in November and was embedded with US forces
- **2011: Libya** Arrived in Benghazi on March 6, was captured on March 13, escaped on August 24, rejoined rebels
- **2012-13: Syria** Filmed *Not Anymore: A Story of Revolution* in Aleppo and released it
- **2014: Iraq** Returned to Iraq in 2014 when SOLI started working there
- **2018: Philippines** Reached the Philippines where SOLI was working with a counterterrorism force
- **2019: Venezuela** Conducted covert operations with rebels
- **March 2022: Ukraine** Enlisted in the Armed Forces of Ukraine as a combatant
- **2025-26: Myanmar** NIA alleges VanDyke and six Ukrainians entered Myanmar from Mizoram and trained armed groups

AS DOHA STEPS UP DARK TRANSITS THROUGH HORMUZ

LNG imports from Qatar rise to eight-month high in Oct

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, October 27

QATAR BECAME the second largest supplier of liquefied natural gas (LNG) to India in October, a comeback the Gulf nation scripted by aggressively using tactics like switching off the LNG tankers' transponders, or "going dark", to avoid detection and capitalising on windows of opportunity based on maritime security assessments in the Strait of Hormuz.

Doha's increased risk tolerance follows similar tactics being used by the UAE for a few months now to ship its LNG through the fraught waters of the strait. Additionally, industry sources indicated that ship-to-ship (STS) transfers are also being used by Qatar to move LNG beyond the strait.

Qatar was only second to the US in terms of LNG supplies to India in the October 1-25 period, when overall import volumes grew sequentially as well as on a year-on-year basis. The gulf nation has traditionally been India's top source of LNG, but the disruption in vessel movements through the Strait of Hormuz led to a crash in supply volumes starting March.

India got 0.44 million tonnes of Qatari LNG till October 25, up nearly 370% from volumes imported in all of September, according to provisional data from commodity market analytics firm Kpler.

In March-September, LNG imports from Qatar averaged just 0.07 million tonnes, just a fraction of the 2025 monthly average of 0.95 million tonnes.

STS transfers have already emerged as a key ploy for Gulf producers to move oil out of the Persian Gulf. Unlike regular operations, in which crude is loaded onto tankers that sail directly to the destination port, STS transfers involve a shuttle tanker that carries the oil for some distance, after which the cargo is transferred to another tanker.

In STS operations in the Strait of Hormuz, the supplier usually takes on the responsibility — and the risk — of sending the oil through the strait, after which a tanker waiting in safer waters takes the oil to its destination. STS is not that common in LNG flows as the process is a lot more complex than transferring crude from one tanker to another. Super-chilled gas requires cryogenic hoses to be transferred, and requires much more careful handling. However, in the absence of any alternative route to evacuate export volumes, Qatar is evidently resorting to STS transfers ahead of the northern hemisphere winter, when demand jumps globally. "Qatari LNG deliveries to India are at their highest monthly level since the conflict began...For India, a sustained recovery in Qatari supply could ease the pressure to source replacement cargoes from other suppliers, particularly as underlying import requirements remain firm despite elevated prices," said Sonal Ranjan, LNG and natural gas analyst at Kpler.

Robust LNG demand in India has led to Indian importers competing hard to pick up cargoes from the spot market at super-normal prices, even as some of the other major Asian LNG buyers have curtailed imports.

The West Asia crisis has pushed India to secure cargoes from non-hormuz dependent supply sources, as New Delhi has been prioritising supplies over price considerations.

The US was the top LNG supplier to India in the October 1-25 period, reclaiming the pole position after losing it to Oman in September. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• India's LNG imports from Qatar in 2026

Month	Volumes (million tonnes)	Share in India's LNG imports
January	1.05	40.9%
February	0.74	39%
March	0.06	3.6%
April	0	0%
May	0	0%
June	0.13	5.3%
July	0.09	4%
August	0.09	3.4%
September	0.09	4.2%
October (till Oct 25)	**0.44**	**17.6%**

SOURCE: KPLER

SUCCESSION BATTLE: MALLIKA, DAUGHTER LAKSHMI VENU SEEK AMICABLE SOLUTION

TVS family files caveats in courts

While Venu and his son Sudarshan are in one camp, his wife Mallika and daughter Lakshmi are on the other side

George Mathew
Mumbai, October 27



Four caveats each have been filed in the City Civil Court and the Commercial Court in Chennai. X

TRACTOR FARM Equipment Ltd (TAFE) Chairman and MD Mallika Srinivasan and her daughter Lakshmi Venu on Tuesday expressed their desire for an amicable family settlement through transparent discussions and dialogue, even as members of the TVS family filed caveats against one another in two Chennai courts amid an ongoing dispute over the division of the family's wealth.

Venu Srinivasan, chairman emeritus of TVS Motor Company, his wife Mallika Srinivasan, and their children Lakshmi Venu and Sudarshan Venu have filed several caveats on October 12 and 13.

Four caveats each were filed in the City Civil Court and the Commercial Court in Chennai, indicating that the family members are preparing for possible legal proceedings as the dispute continues.

While Venu Srinivasan and son Sudarshan Venu are on one side, Srinivasan's daughter Lakshmi Venu and wife Mallika Srinivasan are on the other side.

The filings place members of the family on opposing sides as they seek to safeguard their interests in the event of further court proceedings.

In a statement, a spokesperson reiterated the position taken by Mallika Srinivasan and Lakshmi Venu on resolving the differences amicably.

"As stated earlier in the joint statement, Lakshmi Venu and Mallika Srinivasan reiterate their desire for an amicable resolution through transparent discussions and dialogue," the spokesperson said on Tuesday.

The statement signals that Mallika Srinivasan and Lakshmi Venu continue to favour discussions as a way to settle the dispute. However, the caveat filings suggest that the parties are also taking legal precautions in anticipation of potential proceedings. The filings in both the City Civil Court and the Commercial Court indicate that the parties are preparing to protect their respective positions should the matter come before the courts.

A caveat is a legal notice filed by a person who wants to be heard before a court passes an order on an application that may affect their interests. Such a filing generally seeks to ensure that the court gives the caveator an opportunity to present their position before passing an order without hearing them.

The larger TVS family partition, agreed upon in 2020 and implemented subsequently, was carried out through a process involving the relevant stakeholders, Lakshmi and Mallika said in a joint statement earlier this month.

They, however, maintained that the same process has not taken place for the economic interests within the Venu Srinivasan family.

"The fundamental issue is not about management positions which have been compensated appropriately and commensurately. It is about the fair recognition of rightful economic ownership, which remains unresolved," they said.

Lakshmi is the Vice Chairman of TAFE.

She is also ED-MD of Sundaram-Clayton. Sudarshan Venu is Chairman and MD of TVS Motor. TAFE forms part of the Amalgamations Group, a separate family business group in which Mallika Srinivasan is a shareholder. TAFE has no bearing on the economic settlement within the Venu Srinivasan family and should not be conflated with it, Mallika Srinivasan said.

Maruti Suzuki India Q2 profit falls 26% amid rising input costs

New Delhi: Car market leader Maruti Suzuki India Ltd on Tuesday reported a 26.36% decline in its consolidated net profit for the second quarter ended September at Rs 2,466.1 crore, due to higher input costs resulting from the West-Asia conflict even as the revenue rose sharply, driven by record quarterly vehicle sales volumes.

The auto major had posted a net profit of Rs 3,349 crore in the same quarter of the previous fiscal, a regulatory filing to the exchanges showed.

During July-September, total revenue from operations increased to Rs 53,355.5 crore as against Rs 42,344.2 crore in the same period of 2025-26 fiscal, Maruti Suzuki India said in the filing.

Total expenses in July-September also shot up to Rs 50,619 crore against Rs 39,018.4 crore in the year-ago period, the company said. Cost of materials consumed in the second quarter rose to Rs 37,488.5 crore from Rs 25,324.2 crore in the corresponding period last fiscal, it added.

Maruti Suzuki India said the Operating Profit (EBIT) in the quarter stood at Rs 2,803.7 crore as compared to Rs 3,382 crore in Q2 FY25-26 owing to West Asia-conflict-linked commodity price rises. **PTI**

• Indian businesses face compliance gaps

Physical audits across 52 sites in 17 states and Union Territories found 4,694 non-compliances, averaging 90 per site, said a report by TeamLease RegTech.



70% carried the risk of penalty or prosecution — 3,306 of 4,694

46% carried the risk of imprisonment — 2,166 of 4,694

29% named directors or senior officers — 1,378 of 4,694

31% involved fines that could escalate — 1,457 of 4,694

60% were classified as Critical or High risk — 2,592 of 4,332 rated

92% came from environment and labour laws — 3,086 + 1,219

- Compliance scores ranged from **61%** at warehouses to **79%** at manufacturing plants, with registered offices at **75%** and branch offices at **70%**.
- Indian laws can hold directors, senior officers, factory occupiers, and managers personally responsible for compliance.

SOURCE: TEAMLEASE REGTECH REPORT - HIDING IN PLAIN SIGHT: COMPLIANCE AUDIT INSIGHTS 2026

Funds with limited China link may get easier access

Mukesh Jagota
New Delhi, October 27

THE GOVERNMENT is considering easing paperwork requirements for investment funds with less than 10% ownership by investors from countries sharing a land border with India (LBCs), a senior official said Tuesday. The proposed changes would involve modifying forms to remove disclosure requirements for information that is not necessary, the official said.

In March, the government amended Press Note 3 of 2020 through Press Note 2 of 2026, allowing investments from entities and funds with beneficial ownership of 10% or less by investors from LBCs to come through the automatic route, provided there is no management control or ultimate effective control by such investors. The countries covered by the restrictions are China, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Myanmar, Nepal, Bhutan, and Afghanistan. Between March and August 29, investment proposals worth Rs 4,895.65 crore came into India under the relaxed provisions. **FE**

• BRIEFLY

India, Mexico finalise trade pact terms

New Delhi: India and Mexico will formally launch negotiations for a preferential trade agreement (PTA) with the signing of the Terms of Reference (ToR) during Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal's two-day visit to Mexico City beginning October 26. Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said Mexico is keen on an early-harvest arrangement to liberalise trade in selected goods faster. "Mexico is very keen to have an early harvest," Goyal said in The Hague. **FE**

ACC Q2 profit slumps 92% amid sales volume dip

New Delhi: ACC Ltd, an Adani Group cement firm, on Tuesday reported 91.7% fall in consolidated net profit to Rs 93 crore for September quarter FY27, on account of decline in sales volume due to a Master Supply Agreement with the parent entity. The company had posted a profit of Rs 1,119 crore in the July-September period, according to a regulatory filing from ACC, a subsidiary of Ambuja Cements. **PTI**

Cipla Q2 net profit falls 35% to Rs 877.5 cr

New Delhi: Cipla on Tuesday reported a 35% decline in consolidated net profit for Q2 ended September at 877.54 crore, as revenue fell marginally while expenses grew. It had posted a net profit of Rs 1,351.17 crore in same period a year ago, showed a regulatory filing. **PTI**

JLR India begins local production of Defender 110

Mumbai: Jaguar Land Rover India on Tuesday said it has started production of the Defender 110 at its Pune facility to cater to its local customers, thereby reducing prices by up to Rs 34 lakh for the fully loaded top-end version. The company said it expects up to a 20% uptick in sales volumes. **PTI**

Japan pitches Rs 8-10 lakh cr investments in India

Prasanta Sahu
New Delhi, October 27

A 32-MEMBER Japanese industry delegation led by the Japan Chamber of Commerce and Industry (JCCI) and Mitsubishi corporate adviser Ken Kobayashi met top policymakers here, pitching investments to the tune of Rs 8-10 lakh crore in India's infrastructure and manufacturing sectors over the next few years.

The commitment comes as India scouts for durable capital and seeks to stem capital outflows. The group's visit also coincides with the Asian country emerging as India's top source of foreign direct investment in Q1FY27, pipping conventional source countries like Singapore, Mauritius and the US. During the interactions, the delegates sought faster clearances for projects, tax predictability and a larger pool of skilled manpower, official sources said. The proposed investments span several sectors, including automobiles, manufacturing and new high-speed rail networks. **FE**

CBIC issues circulars to simplify GST reforms

Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, October 27

FOLLOWING THE latest decisions of the Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council, the Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC) issued eight circulars focusing on simpler registration with a list of required documents, export payments and clear guidelines for raising tax demands with focus on pre-show cause notices and proving the intent of fraud before invocation of charges.

Citing an analysis of GST registration applications, including the reasons for rejection and the nature of queries raised during processing, the CBIC said that delays or rejections were often attributable to certain deficiencies in the applications including non-furnishing of requisite information or documents; submission of incorrect, incomplete, or inconsistent details, or uploading of documents that are not clearly legible. Stating that such issues are commonly observed in respect of identity details of the applicant, proof of principal place of business, the CBIC directed tax officers to refrain from seeking unwarranted documents or raising presumptive queries not relevant to GST registration applications. "While there is a need to exercise due diligence in processing registration application to prevent GST registration of being obtained by unscrupulous and fraudulent elements for passing on input tax credit (ITC) without any underlying supply, at the same time, it is also important to ensure that genuine applicants seeking registration are able to complete the process without undue inconvenience," the CBIC said in the circular dated October 26.

For premises taken on rent or lease, the applicant is required to upload a clear and legible copy of the valid registered rent or lease agreement and no other document is required. If the rent or lease agreement is not registered, then an applicant has to upload the latest copy of any one of the documents in the name of the landlord such as the property tax receipt, municipal khata, property identification document, electricity or water bill along with the rent agreement. Under GST, suppliers exclusively dealing in goods, with annual aggregate turnover of Rs 40 lakh are required to register, while for suppliers in the supply of goods and services both or supply of services only, the threshold is Rs 20 lakh.

"It is, therefore, in the interest of the applicant that he opts for and undergoes authentication of Aadhaar number...to get his application for registration processed at the earliest," it said.

For issues related to demand, adjudication and appeal proceedings under the Central GST (CGST) Act, the CBIC said there has to be a uniform reference framework for officers engaged in quasi-judicial proceedings and consistency, transparency and uniformity in the implementation of provisions of law across field offices. The circular stated that pre-show cause notice has to be issued to taxpayers, wherever feasible, as it offers them a "vital opportunity to clarify their position prior to formal proceedings". FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

IRDAI to implement distribution reforms only after consensus: Seth

New Delhi: Amid concerns over the impact of the proposed changes in insurance distribution, IRDAI Chairman Ajay Seth on Tuesday assured the industry that the regulator will implement the reforms only after reaching a consensus.

Speaking at the annual Business Standard BFSI Insights Summit here, Seth said the regulator will work to expedite claims in case of health policies. Seth said he has been meeting people extensively since the release of the discussion paper on distribution reforms to hear out the industry's concerns. **PTI**

• MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▼	US Dollar ▼
73,598.67	22,749.75	₹1,41,431	₹95.12
-8.08	-3.45	Silver ▼	Oil ▲
-0.01%	-0.02%	₹1,92,499	$123.72

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF OCTOBER 26, 2026

Adopt prudent borrowing strategies: RBI chief to states

Mumbai: Central bank Governor Sanjay Malhotra on Tuesday advised state governments to adopt prudent borrowing strategies and ensure quality spending, highlighting the importance of long-term fiscal health.

Addressing the 36th Conference of State Finance Secretaries, the governor also advised states to make effective use of the State Level Bankers' Committee forum. The Conference was attended by the finance secretaries of 27 States and three Union Territories as well as senior officials from the Union Ministry of Finance, Controller General of Accounts. **PTI**

JAIPUR DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Indira Circle, Jawahar Lal Nehru Marg, Jaipur-302004
No. JDA/EE/DR/2026-27/D-607 Date : 26-10-2026
NOTICE INVITING BID
NIB No.: **EE (DR) /10/2026-27**
Online Bids are invited up-to 06:00 PM of 16.11.2026 for **"Development, Operation and Maintenance of Dravyavati Sports Complex, Jaipur on Design, Build, Operate and Maintain (DBOM) Basis"**. on License basis for Five years. The last date for applying Bid and making online payment on JDA portal is up-to 6.00 PM of 16.11.2026. The estimated cost of NIB is Rs. 759.06 Lacs. Details may be seen in the Bidding Document at our office or the State Public Procurement Portal website www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in, www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in and www.jda.rajasthan.gov.in/jda
(UBN No. : JDA2627WLOB00394)
To participate in the bid, bidder must:
A. Participate in Tender & Deposit Payment on 'Online Tender Participation' Portal of JDA at https://jda.rajasthan.gov.in/jda or by Single-Sign-On at http://service.jaipurjda.org.
B. Submit e-Bid on e-Procurement portal of GOR at www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in
Raj.Samwad/C/26/12511 Executive Engineer- DR

SBI Premises & Estate Department - Local Head Office, 16, College Lane, Chennai-600006, Tel: 044 28308401/12/16
SBI invites application/tender for the following works:
1. Application for the selection of Project Management Consultant for Construction of Office & Residential buildings at Stephenson Road, Perambur, Chennai on EPC basis at an estimated cost of ₹148 Crores.
2. Tender from contractors for the Heritage restoration works of Chennai Main Branch Building (Grade A) at Rajaji Salai, Chennai at an estimated cost of ₹13.18 Crores.
For further details, log on **https://sbi.bank.in/web/sbi-in-the-news/procurement-news**
Corrigendum, if any, will be published only in website. Last date for submission: **02.12.2026**
Chennai
Date: 28.10.2026 AGM (P&E)

Rajasthan State Road Development And Construction Corporation Ltd., JAIPUR.
No. NIT/2026-27/8772-83 Date: 26.10.2026
अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 439/2026-27
निम्नलिखित परियोजनाओं पर पथकर वसूली हेतु ई-टेन्डरिंग प्रक्रिया से ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है:-

कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की कुल अनुमानित लागत (रु.)
Selection of Bidder for Collection of User Fee on the basis of competitive bidding through e-procurement basis for the following:-	
On Bharatpur-Deeg-Alwar Road for a period of 01 year. **UBN: RRC2627SLOB00722**	**4510.38 Lakh**
On Nasirabad-Kekri-Deoli BOT Road'' for a period of 01 year. **UBN: RRC2627SLOB00721**	**3884.11 Lakh**

निविदा से सम्बन्धित प्रपत्र में निविदा शुल्क, धरोहर राशि, डाउनलोड करने व खोलने की तारीख सहित सम्पूर्ण विवरण एवं संशोधन वेबसाईट: **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in**, **http://sppp.rajasthan.nic.in** तथा **http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in/rsrdc** पर देखा जा सकता है। इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेबसाईट **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** पर रजिस्टर्ड करवाना आवश्यक है। महाप्रबंधक

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA – DEPARTMENT OF SPACE
CONSTRUCTION & MAINTENANCE GROUP, SDSC – SHAR
SRIHARIKOTA – 524124
Brief E-TENDER NOTICE
e-Tender Notice No.CMG/C/CON/268722 Date: 22/10/2026
On behalf of President of India, EPC tenders are invited through e-tendering for the following works:

Brief Name of work	Est. Value (Rs.)
Planning, Design, Construction, Commissioning of SHAR Recreation Facility (Indoor Sports complex, Club building with Swimming pool, Play area) at SDSC SHAR Sriharikota, Tirupati District of Andhra Pradesh (Architectural, Civil, Structural, PH, Road, Site Development works, Electrical, AC, and allied works in EPC MODE- 1)	971.33 Lakhs

Last date for sale (Tender documents can be downloaded) upto **18/11/2026 14:30 hrs**. For eligibility criteria and other details, interested tenderers may please refer to the detailed bilingual (Hindi-English) Notice Inviting Tenders (NIT) on the website **https://www.isro.gov.in/Tenders.html** and tender free view at **https://www.tenderwizard.com/isro**
Sd/- GROUP HEAD, CMG/ SDSC SHAR

OFFICE OF THE ENGINEER-IN-CHIEF (CIVIL), ODISHA
NIRMAN SOUDHA, KESHARI NAGAR, UNIT- V, BHUBANESWAR - 751 001
1st corrigendum to Bid Identification No.- CE-BRIDGES-18/2026-27
34001/1059/2627
The following changes are made to the Invitation for the work "Improvement such as widening and strengthening of Dhenkanal Tarava road from 0.0 to 7.751km in the District of Dhenkanal for the year 2026-27" vide **Bid Identification No. CE-BRIDGES-18/2026-27.**
- The bid documents will be available in the website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in from 10.00 A.M of Dt. 03.11.2026 to 05.00 P.M of Dt. 18.11.2026** for online bidding.
- The Last date of submission of tender is extended **upto 5.00 PM of Dt. 18.11.2026.**
- The Bids received on line shall be opened at **11.30 AM on Dt. 19.11.2026.**
All other terms and conditions remain unchanged
Sd/-
Chief Engineer, Bridges-I
Odisha, Bhubaneswar
OIPR-34001/34174/1/26-27/0037

Egypt: Court orders closure of independent media outlet, convicts editor

Associated Press
Cairo, October 27

AN EGYPTIAN court ordered the closure of one of Egypt's last independent news outlets Tuesday after convicting its editor-in-chief of operating a website without a license in a major blow to the country's shrinking press freedom.

The publication, *Mada Masr*, said its editor-in-chief and founder, Lina Attalah, was ordered to pay a fine equivalent to about $53,400. After the verdict, the judge ordered Attalah detained until the fine is paid. *Mada Masr* was one of the few remaining news outlets in Egypt known for investigating corruption, the expanding role of the country's powerful military, and human rights violations in a country where newspapers and television stations are closely controlled by authorities.

Gunmen kill 62 in northeastern Nigeria: Officials

Associated Press
Abuja, October 27

AT LEAST 62 people have been killed after gunmen attacked a community in northeastern Nigeria, the country's emergency agency said Tuesday.

The attack, reportedly carried out by criminals known as bandits, happened on Friday in Binnari community located in the Karim-Lamido local government area of Taraba state, and also wounded 52 other people and displaced thousands, according to Ladan Ayuba, the state head of National Emergency Management Agency. Attacks by bandits are common across northern Nigeria where armed groups carry out attacks against civilian populations.Fifty-two bodies have been recovered so far, including 15 from the Benue River, NEMA officials said.

55.7% OF ELIGIBLE VOTERS CAST THEIR BALLOTS WITHIN THE FIRST NINE HOURS: POLL PANEL

Israelis shatter turnout records as they decide Netanyahu's future

Heavy voting by Israeli Arab voters could hold the key to future govt

Steven Scheer & Pesha Magid
Jerusalem, October 27





(Left) Israeli PM Benjamin Netanyahu casts his ballot alongside his wife Sara in Jerusalem, while Gadi Eisenkot, leader of the Yashar party, and his wife Hanna Eisenkot, vote in Herzliya during the national elections on Tuesday. AP

ISRAELIS SURGED to the polls on Tuesday at a pace that shattered records, to pass wartime judgment on Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu in what voters described as the most consequential election in the nation's history.

Long lines formed outside polling stations for the first election since the October 7, 2023, Hamas-led attacks, with voters passionately engaged over the trauma of the country's deadliest day and the ensuing wars in Gaza, Lebanon and Iran.

The Central Elections Committee reported that 55.7% of eligible voters had already cast their ballots within the first nine hours of voting, a record by that point in the day with six more hours to go.

"I think these elections are the most important of all the ones I've known," said Ruth Epstein, an 81-year-old longtime left-wing voter in Ramat Gan near Tel Aviv, who voted for the opposition Democrats.

Netanyahu has campaigned on an endorsement from US President Donald Trump, his ally in war against Iran, who has said they should "finish the job".

If neither Netanyahu nor Eisenkot can form a governing coalition in the 120-seat parliament, Netanyahu could stay on as caretaker until another election is held. His opponents have managed to wrest him from the premiership only once since 2009, and that took four inconclusive elections in two years. He was back 18 months later.

Ahmed Tibi, a candidate from an Arab party, said record turnout from Israel's Arab minority would "pave the way for an alternative government and change the grave reality".

Eisenkot has ruled out partnering with Arab parties, although some possible scenarios envision him relying on them to propup a minority government to topple Netanyahu. Netanyahu has repeatedly described Arab Israelis, a fifth of the population, as a threat, in language his opponents say crosses into racism.

He posted an image on X on Tuesday showing a queue of Arab women, in niqabs or with angry expressions, purportedly at a polling station. According to OpenAI's verification website the image was prepared using its AI tools.

Meanwhile, Netanyahu and his far-right coalition partners made a last-ditch push to get their supporters to the polls, warning of surging Arab voter turnout, a tactic Arab politicians denounced as racist and inflammatory. He highlighted long queues at polling stations in Arab communities and published an image that he said showed Arabs, including women in niqabs, waiting to vote.

"If we don't wake up now, we'll find ourselves with a government of Mansour Abbas and Ahmed Tibi," he said in a post, referring to two leading Palestinian Arab politicians in Israel. REUTERS

War, conscription and ethnic tensions key issues for voters

Harinder Mishra
Jerusalem, October 27



Israeli settlers line up to vote during the general election in the settlement of Kiryat Arba, in the occupied West Bank on Tuesday. AP

AS ISRAEL goes to the polls on Tuesday, the first since the tumultuous events of October 7, 2023, it is being seen as a referendum on PM Benjamin Netanyahu's leadership.

Issues such as security, judicial overhaul, the secular-religious divide over national burden sharing, ethnicity, and the economy are at the forefront but talks of a two-state solution to the vexed Israel-Palestinian conflict have been pushed out of public discussions.

Netanyahu is seeking to retain power after three years of war and mounting demands for accountability over the October 7, 2023, attack.

Eisenkot, a former chief of staff of the Israel Defence Forces, has emerged as a principal challenger, while former prime minister Naftali Bennett is leading a separate opposition alliance with Yair Lapid.

Major military failures have historically reshaped Israeli politics. Following the 1973 Yom Kippur War, the ruling Labour-led Alignment and its allies lost power in 1977 for the first time in 29 years, paving the way for Likud's rise under Menachem Begin and greater political representation for Mizrahi Jews.

In the election following October 7, 2023, some longstanding political loyalties appear open to challenge.

Netanyahu's carefully cultivated image as "Mr Security" has been damaged by the failures preceding the Hamas assault, while the question of who should be held accountable remains central to the campaign.

Likud has traditionally drawn considerable support from Mizrahi and traditional Jewish voters, even though many of its prominent leaders, including Netanyahu, have Ashkenazi backgrounds.

Eisenkot, whose family has Moroccan Jewish roots, has emerged as a significant challenger to the prime minister. The former military chief's background has also brought questions of ethnicity to the forefront of the campaign. PTI

• BRIEFLY

FRANCE

Kylian Mbappe apologises for his 'Chinese dictator' remark



Kylian Mbappe

SOCCER STAR Kylian Mbappe apologised for comments in which he apparently referred to Mao Zedong, the founding leader of Communist China, as a dictator, after facing backlash and losing brand deals with three different Chinese companies."My comment was ill-judged, and I now understand that it hurt many people in China and in Chinese communities around the world," Mbappé said in a statement Tuesday. "I apologise to everyone my words have upset," he said. "This was absolutely not my intention. I have deep respect for the Chinese people and their history, and I am sincerely sorry." AP

GERMANY

Court rejects bid to end Ukrainian ex-officer's trial

A GERMAN court on Tuesday rejected a defense request to end the trial of a former Ukrainian army officer who is accused of damaging the Nord Stream gas pipelines built to carry Russian gas to western Europe in blasts four years ago. Serhii Kuznietsov, 50, went on trial at the Hamburg state court on Oct. 14, charged with causing an explosion, damaging property, disrupting public service and being an "accomplice to war crimes" by attacking civilian infrastructure. AP

SPAIN

Asylum-seekers in Ceuta sent back to Morocco

SPAIN HAS returned to Morocco more than a dozen sub-Saharan African and Asian migrants who reached the Spanish enclave of Ceuta and were turned down for asylum, the first deportation of its kind from the enclave since a mass border crossing in July. The Interior Ministry spokesperson said the group had been sent back to Morocco after it agreed to receive them and they remained on Moroccan territory at present. It declined to give numbers or nationalities. REUTERS

Burnham reignites Britain's divisive Brexit debate with his push for closer EU ties

Jill Lawless
London, October 27



British PM Andy Burnham

FOR A decade, British governments have observed a cardinal rule: Don't mention Brexit. In particular, don't suggest that voters' 2016 decision to leave the European Union should be reversed.

Prime Minister Andy Burnham, who marked his 100th day in office on Tuesday, has broken that code of silence and reignited a debate that bitterly divided the country. He says Brexit has been a failure and the U.K. should seek a much closer relationship with the EU, with options up to and including rejoining the 27-nation bloc.

"I am positive about closer ties with Europe and I'm not hiding that," Burnham told the Sunday Times. "I think it will add to British GDP. I think it will give us stronger control of migration. I want to make those arguments."

In recent interviews, Burnham has said the country should have an "evidence-based debate" about the consequences of Brexit. He gave the example of immigration. Supporters of Brexit argued that it would give the country control over its borders by ending the right of EU citizens to live and work in the U.K., and of British nationals to settle across the bloc.

While Britain now sets its own immigration policy, Burnham said leaving the bloc had made it harder to control unauthorized migration because Britain has lost access to EU databases and agreements.

"The truth of the matter is we've lost immigration control in the way that we once had," Burnham told broadcaster ITV on Monday.

Most economists agree that Brexit has hurt the British economy, but few politicians have wanted to reopen the painful debate.

The decision of British voters, by 52% to 48%, to leave the bloc after four decades of membership was followed by years of U.K.-EU wrangling over divorce terms. Britain finally left the EU in 2020 with a bare-bones trade deal that erected new barriers to doing business with the bloc of 450 million people on the U.K.'s doorstep.

Protesters enter Serbian pro-Vucic TV station, call for arrest of editor

Reuters
Belgrade, October 27



Riot police officers stand guard in front of the TV Pink building in Belgrade. REUTERS

PROTESTERS ENTERED a Serbian television station supportive of former President Aleksandar Vucic late on Monday, interrupting broadcasting to call for the arrest of its editor, as tens of thousands took to the streets for a second night of post-election celebrations.

Serbia's Student List, born out of a student-led anti-corruption protest movement, unseated Vucic in a historic election on Sunday, bringing to an end 14 years in power for a man who served as information minister under Slobodan Milosevic and who maintained tight control over the media.

Live footage broadcast by Informer TV showed around 30 people walk into its newsroom on Monday evening and surround editor-in-chief and owner Dragan Vucicevic. Some protesters shouted: "This is how it is in free Serbia" and "Where is Vucic now?" Some also called for Vucicevic's arrest.

On his personal Instagram account, Vucic, dressed in a jumper displaying the crossed-out word "sorry", called the event an attack on free speech and the freedom of journalism.

Ceasefire brokered by Melania starts as Nordic leaders speak to Putin, Zelenskyy

Hanna Arhirova
Mykolaiv, October 27



People walk past a car dealership damaged in a Russian overnight missile attack on Kyiv, on Tuesday. AP

RUSSIA AND Ukraine began observing a localized ceasefire in a devastated southern Ukrainian city on Tuesday, ahead of a planned humanitarian mission brokered by U.S. first lady Melania Trump. But Moscow kept up its deadly missile attacks on other cities in the meantime.

Meanwhile, Finland's president and Norway's prime minister spoke on the phone with Russian President Vladimir Putin, officials said, in their first known direct contact since shortly after Russia's all-out invasion of Ukraine began on Feb. 24, 2022.

The war launched by Russia set most of Europe against Moscow, with Western officials accusing Putin of masterminding a campaign of disruption across the continent.

After their conversation with Putin, Norwegian Prime Minister Jonas Gahr Støre and Finnish President Alexander Stubb spoke with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, according to Zelenskyy's office.

A local pause in fighting started at 3 a.m. to allow an aid mission into the Russian-occupied city of Oleshky later this week.

The situation in Oleshky is desperate, with food and medical supplies running perilously low for the up to 2,000 people still there, as drones and land mines restrict movement.

Russia committed war crimes, finds UN-backed probe

United Nations: Russia committed war crimes and crimes against humanity in Ukraine by intentionally attacking energy infrastructure, leaving millions of people without electricity and heat in freezing temperatures, a UN-backed inquiry reported Monday.

The inquiry also found evidence that Russia recruited men from 29 countries into its armed forces "through deception or coercion" to fight in Ukraine in violation of international law.

The men, age 18 to 60, "came mostly from vulnerable and marginalized communities, with a poor economic background and a low education level," it said. AP

• IN THE LONG-AWAITED MEMOIR OF HIS 55 YEARS IN JOURNALISM, *THE WASHINGTON POST* ASSOCIATE EDITOR 'DEEP THROATS' ON HIMSELF

'Secrets': Where Bob Woodward 'reveals his sources' & says he's disillusioned with Bezos

Peter Baker
October 27

WHEN BOB Woodward, the veteran star Washington Post reporter of Watergate fame, was about to publish a hard-hitting book about President Donald Trump in 2018, he called the owner of his newspaper, Jeff Bezos, to warn him.

"Don't worry, I have your back, Bob," Bezos told him. "I'll always have your back."

"Always" turned out not to be as long as it used to be, Woodward now says he discovered. After more than a half-century breaking stories about Washington, one of the scoops in Woodward's new memoir is his own breakup in all but name with Bezos, who in his view turned out to not have the backs of the journalists working for him, after all.

Instead, Woodward writes, Bezos has been "compromising public trust in The Washington Post's aggressive and independent journalism" in deference to Trump. While he says Bezos has not interfered in news stories, Woodward writes that the billionaire owner's sweeping staff cuts, reorientation of the editorial page and personal ingratiation to the president have betrayed the legacy of a newspaper known for courageous coverage.

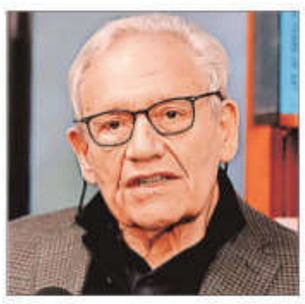
The condemnation of Bezos by his most famous employee is one of the headlines from "Secrets," the long-awaited memoir of his 55 years in journalism to be published November 24 by Woodward, who still holds the title of associate editor at the paper.

Naming Sources

For decades, Woodward guarded the identity of the sources of his blockbuster stories and bestselling books. But now, he finally names names. Many of his early sources have died, and he received permission from others still alive to identify them.

While W Mark Felt, the former deputy FBI director, unmasked himself in 2005 as the famous Watergate source called Deep Throat, much of Washington will pore through this new book to learn who else talked. It turns out that lots of people did, including presidents, Cabinet secretaries, generals, spymasters, Supreme Court justices and FBI agents.

Woodward discloses for the first time his sources for one of the most iconic scenes he ever reported, a moment shortly before Richard Nixon resigned because of Watergate, when the sobbing president asked Secretary of State Henry Kissinger to fall to his knees and pray with him.



Bob Woodward has reported on Washington politics for more than half a century. NYT

The sources, the book now reveals, were two of Kissinger's lieutenants, Brent Scowcroft and Lawrence Eagleburger. While neither was present for the scene, Kissinger described it to them shortly afterward and the two then listened in on the phone when Nixon called Kissinger to ask him not to tell anyone he had cried.

One of Woodward's earliest books was "The Brethren," a penetrating look inside the normally secretive chambers of the Supreme Court. In "Secrets," Woodward discloses the names of five justices who spoke with the authors, all of whom have since died: Potter Stewart, Lewis F Powell Jr, Byron R White, Harry A. Blackmun and William H Rehnquist. he describes how he obtained one of the documents that informed the book: a secret history of the Nixon Watergate tapes case, which revealed the internal debate among the justices over how to rule.

He went to the home of Steven P Goldberg, who was a clerk to Justice William J Brennan Jr and had authored the case history, but refused to give it to Woodward. The reporter convinced him to instead read it to him, which Goldberg proceeded to do. But it was long and Woodward took his time scribbling down notes. Finally, an exhausted Goldberg nodded off.

Woodward waited 20 minutes so that Goldberg would reach a deep sleep. He decided not to simply take the document — "that seemed a little too far, even for me" — so he nudged Goldberg and simply told him that he would borrow it and bring it back the next morning. The groggy clerk stirred and mumbled his assent.

Woodward addresses some of the controversies of his career. He insists that, despite denials and doubts, he did get into a hospital room to see a dying William J Casey, the CIA director in the 1980s — he was let in, he writes, by a security agent he had befriended. He publishes images of the notes that he took quoting Casey acknowledging a role in the Iran-Contra affair by saying, "I believed."

By contrast, he accepts blame for "my spectacular failure" as an editor in publishing a fabricated story by Post reporter Janet Cooke about what turned out to be a fictional eight-year-old heroin addict. That incident convinced him "that I was not cut out to be an editor."

One of the other mistakes in judgment Woodward acknowledges was his faith in Bezos. "I remember feeling relief when Jeff decided to buy The Post in 2013," he writes. "I believed at the time that Bezos would provide the finances for The Post to continue to operate courageously."

But his views began to change in 2024, when Bezos decided just before the election to pull an endorsement of Kamala Harris and declare that the Post would no longer endorse presidential candidates. "At the time, I thought, is he not reading his own newspaper or my books about Trump?" Woodward writes. The timing made it look "like Bezos and the newspaper were capitulating to Trump." NYT

GLOBAL

Israel polls: How its electoral system works and government is formed

Moinuddin Ahmad
New Delhi, October 27

ABOUT 7.3 million Israelis were eligible to vote on Tuesday to elect the 26th Israeli Knesset (parliament). As many as 38 registered parties are competing for seats in the 120-member legislature, though only around 11 are projected to clear the strict 3.25% electoral threshold required for parliamentary representation.

This is the first Israeli parliament since 1988 to complete a full four-year mandate. The vote follows years of intense societal turmoil, including contentious judicial reform debates, the security crisis following October 7 and protracted wartime conditions. Beyond choosing a prime minister, this election is expected to be a referendum on Israel's governance, domestic civil cohesion, security architecture and long-term democratic character.

The electoral system

Being a democracy with a proportional representation system of elections, Israel has several lists and parties. The difference between parties and lists is that a party is an institution that seeks power within the established rules of elections, whereas a list is precisely what it says it is: a list of candidates prepared for the elections sponsored by a party or by a group of parties.

Any registered party or list may contest elections. Under Section 7A of Basic Law: The Knesset, the Central Elections Committee (CEC), or the Supreme Court may disqualify a political party list or an individual candidate if their platform or actions express denial of the existence of the State of Israel as a Jewish and democratic state, indulge in racism, or support armed struggle by an enemy state or terrorist organisation against Israel.

Parliamentary regime

Israel is a parliamentary democracy with three main branches of power: the legislative, executive, and judiciary.

The country has a unicameral (single-house) parliament, composed of 120 members. Members of the Knesset are elected nationally for four-year terms.

The PM holds the executive power. The government depends directly on the confidence of the Knesset and must maintain a working majority (at least 61 seats) to govern. Headed by the Supreme Court, the judiciary acts independently to interpret basic laws and review legislation. National elections are administered and overseen by the CEC.

Electoral threshold

In Israel's party-list proportional representation system, the electoral threshold is the minimum percentage of the total nationwide vote a political party must receive to enter parliament. The threshold is currently set at 3.25% — a standard established by Knesset legislation in 2014. Crossing this hurdle grants a party a baseline of at least four out of the 120 total Knesset seats. If a party fails to reach the 3.25% mark, all votes cast for its slate are discarded, producing "wasted votes" that are reallocated among the parties that succeeded.

The main purpose of the threshold is to balance representation with political stability by preventing extreme parliamentary fragmentation. Historically, the threshold started at just 1% in 1951 before being gradually raised to 1.5% (1992), 2% (2003), and finally 3.25% (2014), notes Prof Ofer Kenig, a researcher at the Israeli Democracy Institute.

This high barrier incentivises smaller ideological factions to merge into joint slates before election day. This plays a decisive role in shaping coalition arithmetic, he adds.

Government formation

Since no single political party in Israel's history has ever won a 61-seat majority on its own, every Israeli government has been a coalition. In such a situation, the process of forming a government, with both old and new allies, takes time.

Following election day, the CEC certifies the final count and seat distribution. The President holds discussions with representatives of party lists that cleared the electoral threshold regarding the possible PM candidates. After discussions with party lists, the President grants the mandate to form a government to the party candidate who is most likely to ensure a 61-seat majority.

The President grants 28 days to the chosen candidate to form a coalition. A single 14-day extension, if required, can be given to the candidate. If one candidate fails to get the required support, the President can either transfer the mandate to a second candidate for a 28-day attempt.

But what if there is a gridlock between the top two lists? Though this situation comes with its own complexities, simply speaking, a caretaker government, under the current PM, steps in until the dates for the next elections are announced.

THE KEY 'LISTS' IN ISRAEL ELECTIONS

Government coalition & right-wing blocs

Likud: Led by PM Benjamin Netanyahu, running on a consolidated national-conservative list that merged with Gideon Sa'ar's New Hope.

Otzma Yehudit: A far-right party list headed by Itamar Ben-Gvir.

Religious Zionist Party – Zehut: A joint list led by Bezalel Smotrich (Religious Zionism) and Moshe Feiglin (Zehut).

Shas: Ultra-Orthodox Sephardic party list led by Aryeh Deri.

United Torah Judaism: Ultra-Orthodox Ashkenazi joint list between Degel HaTorah and Agudat Yisrael, led by Ya'akov Asher.

Amcha Yisrael: A new right-wing list formed by former Israel Defense Forces (IDF) general Ofer Winter and activist Yoseph Haddad.

Noam: A far-right, religiously conservative list headed by Avi Maoz.

Opposition and centre-left blocs

Together (Beyachad): A centre-right and centre joint list combining Naftali Bennett's new movement with Yair Lapid's Yesh Atid party.

Yashar!: A broad centrist list led by former IDF Chief of Staff Gadi Eisenkot and former Shin Bet chief Yoram Cohen.

The Democrats (HaDemokratim): A merger between the Labor Party and Meretz, headed by Yair Golan.

Yisrael Beitenu ("Israel [is] Our Home"): A secular right-wing party list led by Avigdor Liberman.

Blue and White (Kahol Lavan): A centrist list headed by Benny Gantz.

The Reservists & The Economic Party: A list formed by Yoaz Hendel (The Reservists) and economist Yaron Zelekha (New Economic Party).

Arab sector parties

The Joint List: A united electoral list bringing together the Hadash, Ta'al, and Balad factions, headed by Yousef Jabareen and Ahmad Tibi.

United Arab List (Ra'am): An Islamist Arab-Israeli party list headed by Mansour Abbas.

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to
explained@indianexpress.com

HEALTH

The risks of food colouring, as UP steps up scrutiny

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, October 27

BRIGHT RED chutney served with samosas, pink cotton candy sold outside schools, vivid red tandoori chicken — food colourings have come under scrutiny in Uttar Pradesh after authorities found non-food grade industrial dyes in chutney. Amid the festive season, with Diwali approaching, the state's Food Safety and Drug Administration has issued detailed guidelines about where and how food colours can be used, which ones cannot be used, and how vendors must measure and account for the colours they buy.

What's under the scanner?

For street-food lovers, one of the most direct changes concerns the green and red chutneys served with *samosas*, *chaat*, *momos* and rolls. The guidelines prohibit adding colours to chutney and advise vendors to use ingredients such as tomatoes, beetroot, coriander and mint to achieve the desired colour and flavour.

Cotton candy and ice lollies have also been included. The use of non-food colours, particularly Rhodamine-B, is prohibited. This industrial dye is used in textile and paper colouring and cannot be used as a substitute for food-grade colour. The same restriction applies to the use of other industrial dyes to give a bright red appearance to chicken *tikka*, *kebabs*, *chaap* and fried fish. Vendors have been advised to use suitable food ingredients, including Kashmiri red chilli and degi mirch, for colour and flavour.

How widespread is use of Rhodamine-B?

A food safety officer had earlier told *The Indian Express* that Rhodamine B is usually reported from roadside vendors in small cities. "Small vendors are not aware that this dye can be harmful as effects might not always be felt immediately," the officer had said. "Although no colouring is allowed in cooked food, in the bigger cities usually edible food colours are used to give the red colour in butter chicken and tandoori chicken."

What risks do prohibited dyes in food pose?

The guidelines list several prohibited industrial dyes, including Rhodamine-B, Metanil Yellow, Butter Yellow, Malachite Green, Auramine, Orange II and Sudan dyes. Their suspected illegal uses range from giving a bright pink or red appearance to cotton candy, chutney and sweets to making turmeric, pulses, chilli powder and other spices appear more vibrant. Sudan dyes have also been associated with adulteration of edible oils and packaged sauces. Their consumption can pose several health risks, varying by substance and level of exposure.

The use of Rhodamine B in food for a long time, for instance, could lead to liver dysfunction or cancer. When exposed to large amounts over a short period, it results in acute poisoning. Tartrazine is a synthetic yellow food dye and has been indirectly linked to hives, food allergies like swelling of the lips, tongue, throat and neck. Carmoisine, a red dye, can trigger hypersensitivity reactions, including skin swelling, breathing difficulties and hives.

Can artificial colours be used in sweets and cakes?

Yes, under the Food Safety and Standards (Food Products Standards and Food Additives) Regulations, 2011, but only when the colour is permitted for the particular food category and the prescribed limit is followed.

Colour permitted in a cake cannot automatically be used in bread, chutney or another product. This is because colours serve different purposes in different foods. Their safety also depends on how much quantity is consumed and how the colour behaves during processing. For instance, the FSSAI says that assessing a colour's use in deep-fried snacks may require information on its heat stability and the formation of by-products.

Natural colours, too, are subject to category-specific conditions.

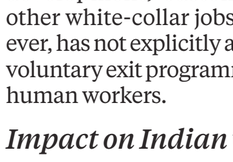
WHAT THE LAW SAYS

- The Food Safety and Standards Act of 2006 provides for punishment for sub-standard, misbranded and unsafe food.
- Depending on the violation, the penalty may range from a fine of Rs 3 lakh to imprisonment up to six months.

TECHNOLOGY

The message in Microsoft exit offer for 60,000 staff

Microsoft has not linked the job cuts to AI, but they come amid growing concerns over AI-driven job losses, particularly in the technology sector



SOUMYARENDRA BARIK

MICROSOFT, WHICH employs around 23,000 people in India, has extended to the country a global voluntary exit programme covering approximately 60,000 employees.

People in India working in roles across Copilot, AI experiences, Windows and Devices, Xbox, finance and human resources could be affected by the move.

The development comes amid increasing concerns over AI-led disruptions to employment, particularly in the technology sector, where companies are deploying AI tools to automate tasks traditionally performed by human workers.

Several major technology firms have announced workforce reductions, hiring slowdowns and organisational restructuring in recent months, with some explicitly citing productivity gains from AI. While the technology is creating demand for new skills and specialised roles, its growing adoption has also raised questions about the future of conventional software development, customer support and other white-collar jobs. Microsoft, however, has not explicitly attributed its latest voluntary exit programme to AI replacing human workers.

Impact on Indian workers

Announcing the Voluntary Exit Offer (VEO) on Monday, Microsoft said the scheme would be available to eligible employees at level 70 and below across participating teams in India, the US, the UK and Canada. Level 70 is an internal hierarchical structuring within Microsoft, and could cover employees with vice-president titles. While the company has not disclosed how many of its India-based employees would be eligible for the scheme, it hires Indians across software engineering, research and development, artificial intelligence, cloud infrastructure, sales, customer support and corporate functions. The technology giant employs around 23,000 people in India.

It is understood that employees in divisions such as Copilot, AI experiences, Windows and Devices, Xbox, finance and human resources are among those eligible. This means that not all Microsoft employees in India will receive the offer, with eligibility depending on the business division to which they belong.

For Indian employees, the voluntary exit package is understood to be broadly similar to Microsoft's standard severance arrangements, including one month's base salary for every completed year of service, along with health insurance and career transition assistance. Eligible employees in India will have until December 1 to decide whether to accept the offer, with departures expected by the end of December.

The move comes as Microsoft seeks to reorganise its workforce while significantly increasing investments in artificial intelligence infrastructure, with the company stating that its India plans remain unchanged.

The programme could also have implications for Indians employed by Microsoft in the US, particularly those working on H-1B visas. While the company has not clarified how the scheme would apply to foreign workers on temporary visas, employees choosing to exit without securing alternative employment could face immigration-related challenges. Unlike US citizens, H-1B visa holders are generally required to find another sponsoring employer, change their immigration status or leave the country within an applicable grace period, typically up to 60 days following termination of employment. These concerns come amid greater US scrutiny of employment-based visa and permanent residency programmes.

AI-led job disruptions

Microsoft's move comes amid a broader restructuring of workforces across the global technology industry, with several companies either reducing their headcount or slowing hiring as AI tools take over tasks previously performed by employees. While some companies have explicitly linked job cuts to AI-driven productivity gains, others have cited the need to redirect resources towards AI investments and reorganise their operations.

One of the most prominent examples came in February 2026, when Block, the financial technology company founded by Twitter co-founder Jack Dorsey, announced plans to cut more than 4,000 jobs, nearly half its workforce. Dorsey directly attributed the decision to improvements in AI tools. In September 2025, enterprise software company Salesforce said it had reduced its customer support workforce from around 9,000 to 5,000 employees as AI agents increasingly handled customer queries. CEO Marc Benioff said the company needed fewer people for these functions.

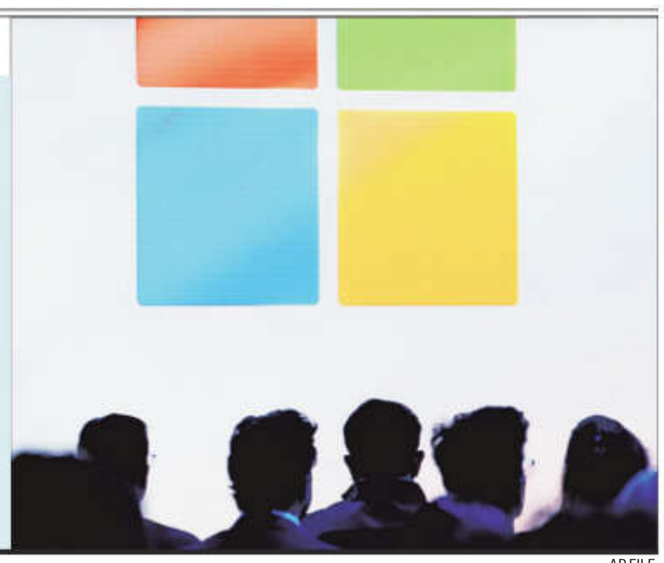
In India, home interiors platform Livspace laid off around 1,000 employees, 12% of its workforce, in February 2026 as it shifted towards an AI-led operating model.

India's larger IT services industry has also faced pressure to reorganise its traditional labour-intensive business model. In July 2025, Tata Consultancy Services announced plans to reduce its workforce by around 12,000 employees, primarily in middle and senior management positions. While the company cited skill mismatches and changes in business requirements, the announcement came amid increasing adoption of generative AI in software development, testing and maintenance. TCS did not directly attribute the job cuts to AI.

There have also been instances of companies reversing or moderating their reliance on AI. Swedish fintech company Klarna, which had earlier said its AI assistant could handle work equivalent to 700 customer service agents, moved to recruit human support staff again after acknowledging that customers continued to require human assistance, particularly for complex problems.

Microsoft's India footprint

- A significant part of Microsoft's India operations is its India Development Center, one of the company's largest research and development facilities outside its headquarters in Redmond, Washington.
- With operations in Hyderabad, Bengaluru and the National Capital Region, the centre develops technologies for Microsoft's global businesses, including Windows, Azure, Microsoft 365 and AI products.
- Its Indian teams also contribute to Copilot Studio, Azure AI Search, AI agents, speech and translation technologies and machine learning platforms.



AP FILE

Indian jobs that may be hit

Microsoft employs around 23,000 people in India.

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Employees in divisions such as Copilot, AI, Windows and Devices, Xbox, finance and HR are among those eligible for the voluntary exit package.

LEGAL

Punishment and pendency : Need for, role of a sentencing council



EXPERTS EXPLAIN

SIDHARTH LUTHRA & RAGHAV SENGUPTA

LUTHRA IS A SENIOR ADVOCATE, SENGUPTA IS AN ADVOCATE

TWO PEOPLE convicted of the same crime in India can walk away with very different sentences, and the difference often has less to do with the law than with which judge or Bench heard the case.

Sentencing is the process where the State translates prescriptive ranges — for instance, 'up to ten years' imprisonment — into a specific prison term, fines, probation or community sanctions for the convict(s). In India, this decision is left almost entirely to an individual judge's or Bench's discretion.

Statutes set out the maximum, and sometimes the minimum sentences. There is no checklist of what should count as a serious aggravating factor, what counts as genuine mitigation, or how prior conduct and remorse should be weighed. Empirical research, such as Dr. Mrinal Satish's work on rape sentencing, shows that courts have reduced sentences based on legally irrelevant factors and retrograde concepts such as the complainant's supposed "chastity" or her subsequent marriage, while ignoring psychological harm or breach of trust.

Unequal justice

Articles 14 and 21 of the Indian Constitution prohibit arbitrary State action and require fair, just and reasonable procedures whenever liberty is restricted. If two similarly placed offenders receive very different sentences because one judge treats poverty or social standing as a mitigating factor while another does not, the resulting disparity is hard to reconcile when dealing with equality before the law.

The Supreme Court acknowledged this in *Sunita Devi vs State of Bihar* (2024), while observing that "sentencing shall not be a mere lottery" and directed the Centre to examine the feasibility of a comprehensive national sentencing policy, potentially via a Sentencing Commission. The Centre has tasked the Law Commission of India with examining the issue, and its recommendations are expected soon. Interestingly, the Law Commission of India raised the same concern more than 50 years ago in its 47th Report. Yet, Parliament has never taken up the task of designing a coherent framework.

Unguided discretion

Framing such a policy requires detailed empirical research into existing practices, impact on prison capacity, and the relationship between sentencing purposes (deterrence, rehabilitation and protection of the public) measured against actual outcomes.

The present mechanism often ignores salutary provisions of probation and other permissible factors.

Indian statutory provisions already provide alternatives to custody, in accordance with Sections 401 and 402 of the BNSS, along with Sections 3, 4 and 6 of the Probation of Offenders Act 1958 that require courts to consider probation for the offender in eligible cases.

However, there is no general framework explaining how courts may use these alternatives against competing aims of deterrence, reformation, and rehabilitation.

In the case of *Soman vs State Of Kerala* (2012), the Supreme Court recognised these competing principles, while also observing that sentencing remains one of the weakest parts of criminal justice administration.

So it is at the appellate stage that courts often get tasked with correcting harsh or unduly lenient sentences, on a case-by-case basis without a common yardstick to apply. As a result, valuable judicial time is spent by appellate courts undertaking this exercise. The primary responsibility for this lies with the convicting court empowered under Section 258(2) of the BNSS, which requires a Sessions Judge to hear the accused individual separately on sentence, once they have been convicted.

That particular hearing should allow the parties to gather relevant material to determine mitigating and aggravating circumstances for sentencing.

What such a council would do

A Council created by an Act of Parliament could be tasked with three core functions. First, develop offence-specific guidelines that require courts to pass through a three-stage framework: (1) determine seriousness by assessing culpability and harm using tailored factors (planning, violence, weapon use, victim vulnerability, demonstrable physical or psychological harm); (2) mark an indicative starting point and range within the statutory envelope for an ordinary case; and (3) individualise and justify the sentence by considering only those offender-related circumstances that are based on recognised purposes such as rehabilitation or the impact of punishment.

Secondly, the proposed Council should build a national sentencing database drawing on the National Judicial Data Grid's infrastructure, with anonymised information on offence type, harm and culpability factors, starting points, adjustments, and final sentences. This would allow Parliament, courts and the public to see where disparity lies and whether guidelines are working.

Thirdly, guidelines should be issued as delegated legislation, placed before Parliament for approval, and treated as advisory but strongly presumptive. Sentencing courts must consider them in every case and provide reasons when they depart. This preserves judicial independence while making discretion accountable.

Lessons from the English model

- In England and Wales, Parliament created the Sentencing Council and backed it with a Sentencing Code.
- Guidelines follow a step-by-step method. Judges first classify the offence by culpability and harm caused. Each culpability-harm combination has a starting point and a category range.
- Judges then adjust this provisional sentence based on aggravating and mitigating factors, apply any reduction if the accused pleaded guilty, account for multiple offences, and make ancillary orders.

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CORPORATE BRIEFS

SCOPE: Pursuant to their recent MoU, SCOPE and IISD (Canada & Geneva) convened a workshop on 'Climate-Related Disclosures for PSEs,' addressed by Atul Sobti, Director General, SCOPE, and Christopher Beaton, Director, Energy Program, IISD. The convening under 'Practitioners' Learning and Action Network on Energy Transition (PLANET) for PSUs' focussed on "Climate-Related Disclosures for PSEs". A first of its kind initiative, this initiative aims to strengthen the energy transition of PSEs by focussing on pertinent subjects while bringing together PSEs, practitioners, experts, and other stakeholders, to form a unified voice through deliberations, discussions and solutions.





OIL has achieved a landmark milestone in its strategic energy diversification journey with the signing of the Revenue Sharing Contract for Special Coal Bed Methane Block SRONHP-(CBM)-2026/1 on 15-10-2026. The historic signing ceremony was graced by Hardeep Singh Puri, Minister of Petroleum and Natural Gas, Dr. Neeraj Mittal, Secretary, MoP&NG, and V. Ponnuraj, Director General, DGH. From OIL, Director (Operation), Trailukya Borgohain and his team represented the distinguished occasion. OIL celebrates this milestone as a landmark return to Coal Bed Methane (CBM) exploration, underscoring its commitment to unlocking India's unconventional hydrocarbon potential and strengthening the nation's energy security.



PNB hosted a two-day workshop recently at its Staff Training Centre in Panchkula. The workshop was organised by the Department of Financial Services (DFS), Ministry of Finance, Government of India and focused on the implementation of the Government of India's Reservation Policy across Public Sector Banks (PSBs), Public Sector Insurance Companies (PSICs), Sectoral Regulators, and Public Financial Institutions (PFIs). The workshop also aimed to strengthen institutional capacity to ensure uniform and effective implementation of reservation policies and welfare measures across the public financial ecosystem.

IREDA announced its Audited Standalone and Consolidated financial results for the Quarter and Half-Year ended 30th September 2026, showcasing significant growth across several financial metrics. The results were approved at the Board meeting held at IREDA's registered office in New Delhi. Dr. BK Mohanty, CMD, IREDA, said: "Our Q2 FY27 performance reflects the continued strength of IREDA's business fundamentals and focus on quality growth. 31% rise in loan disbursements, along with 15% growth in loan book, underscores the sustained demand for renewable energy financing across the country. Equally significant is the sharp improvement in our asset quality, with Net NPAs declining to 1.08% from 1.97%, reflecting the strength of our risk management framework and monitoring."

IRCTC has signed a strategic MoU with the Quality Council of India. This high-stakes partnership establishes a rigorous, technology-driven, independent third-party audit mechanism to ensure the highest standards of food safety and hygiene across all IRCTC- managed mobile (trains) and static (station) catering units. Under this strategic alliance, QCI will deploy certified professionals to conduct intense, unannounced quarterly and half-yearly inspection cycles. These audits will enforce strict compliance with statutory Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) regulations and international culinary standards. The MoU was signed by Sudhir Warrier, General Manager/Quality & Projects, IRCTC, and Subroto Ghosh, Principal Advisor/Head-PPID, Quality Council of India, in the presence of Ramanand Nagendra Shukla, CEO, NABL and Mohit Padhy, Asst. Secretary General from Quality Council of India and Rahul Himalian, Chairman & Managing Director and Manoj Kumar Sharma, Director/Catering Services from IRCTC.

BOB has announced the launch of its festive campaign "bob ke Sang Tyohaar Ki Umang – Shubh Bhi, Labh Bhi." The campaign brings together a comprehensive suite of offers across retail loans, MSME loans, savings products and spending on Debit Cards, designed to make festive financial aspirations more accessible and rewarding for customers across the country.



BUREAU OF INDIAN STANDARDS organises Nationwide Interactive Sessions to Promote AYUSH with Quality Standards. Over 600 experts, practitioners and industry leaders participate to advance standardization, safety, patient care, and international acceptance in the fields of AYURVEDA, YOGA, and SOWA-RIGPA. In a major push towards standardisation in India's traditional systems of medicine, the AYUSH Department of the Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) conducted two national events on standardization in Ayurveda, Yoga, and Sowa-Rigpa. By bridging traditional heritage with scientific quality control, BIS aims to boost consumer trust, and drive international recognition for the AYUSH sector. The nationwide campaign brought together over 600 key stakeholders including top researchers, industry pioneers, academic leaders, and practitioner.



RECPDCL handed over Nawada Durgapur Power Transmission Limited, the project-specific Special Purpose Vehicle, to the successful bidder, M/s Shivalaya Construction Limited, on 16th October, 2026. The SPV was handed over by Rajkumar Sonkar, HoD (CS), RECPDCL to Rajesh Kumar Singh, Head (Power and Transmission), Shivalaya Construction Limited, in the presence of senior officials from RECPDCL, Shivalaya Construction Limited and Central Transmission Utility of India Limited. The transmission project broadly envisages establishment of new 765/400/220 kV Substation at Nawada in Bihar and new 765 kV Switching station at Durgapur in West Bengal, 765 kV D/c Line from Nawada to Durgapur (~265 km) and Durgapur to Jeerut (~145 km) along with associated works. The project is scheduled for implementation by 31.03.2029.



BOI: Strengthening its presence in Uttarakhand, Bank of India has inaugurated three new branches: Jagjitpur (Haridwar), Chamba (Tehri), and Ukhimath (Rudraprayag). With the opening of these new locations, the total number of Bank of India branches in the state of Uttarakhand has risen to 51. The Jagjitpur branch (Haridwar) was inaugurated in the presence of Anil Verma, GM (FGMO, Chandigarh), and Chetan Chandra, ZM (Bank of India, Dehradun Zone).



PRATEEK GROUP has performed the Bhumi Pujan for its upcoming luxury residential project in Sector 150, Noida, marking a key milestone in its development. The project is among the first in Noida where construction has commenced before the formal opening of sales, highlighting the Group's focus on execution readiness and on-ground progress. The project is expected to generate over 2,000 jobs, supporting employment and local economic activity. Located along the Noida–Greater Noida Expressway, Sector 150 offers a planned urban environment with an emphasis on green spaces and connectivity.



PTCUL: In compliance with the instructions given by the government under the public awareness program to mark the successful completion of 25 years of the government under the leadership of PM Narendra Modi and to fulfill the resolution of Developed India-2047, the "Seva Sankalp Abhiyan" program was organized at Hindu National Inter College, Laxman Chowk, Dehradun by the employees of Upkali and Pitkul under the leadership of PC Dhyani, Managing Director of Upkali and Pitkul, under which tree plantation was done in the college campus by the members of the college management committee, senior officers of Upkali and Pitkul, teachers and students and after that a public awareness program was organized to appeal to everyone regarding ensuring the participation of the general public in social service activities like cleanliness, tree plantation, education etc.

DELHI TOURISM: With the arrival of Navratri, the spirit of Dandiya has taken over. As part of these festivities, a grand three-day Dandiya/Navratri celebration is being organized at Chhatrasal Stadium, in collaboration with Delhi Tourism and the Government of Delhi. The youth in India eagerly awaits the Dandiya festival. Today's event was dedicated to the youth, who participated in large numbers. The event was inaugurated by the Chief Minister Smt. Rekha Gupta. The objective of the Dandiya festival is to promote traditional Indian folk dance, music, and the rich cultural heritage of the festival, while providing an opportunity for entertainment and cultural engagement. The event features traditional Gujarati dance, where participants perform while holding *dandiyas*.





BHEL: M.Sridhar has assumed charge as Director (Human Resources) of BHEL, the Public Sector Engineering and Manufacturing Enterprise. Prior to this appointment, M.Sridhar was serving as ED (Human Resources) at BHEL Corporate Office, New Delhi, where he was heading the Corporate Human Resource function and driving key HR policies and strategic people initiatives across the organisation. M. Sridhar is a Mechanical Engineering graduate from CBIT, Osmania University, Hyderabad. He also holds an M. Tech in CAD/CAM from JNTU, Hyderabad and a Post Graduate Diploma in Business Administration (PGDM) from XLRI, Jamshedpur.



NBCC: Ashutosh Gautam has assumed charge as Director (Projects) of NBCC (India). He has been serving for more than 34 years in multi-disciplinary wings of infrastructure viz highways, ports, inland water transport, logistics and urban development etc. managing/administration of the projects of thousands of crores during various line of duties. Ashutosh Gautam holds Bachelor of Technology (Civil Engineering); Master of Technology (Soil Mechanics and Foundation Engineering) from IIT Delhi; Advance Management Programme (Infrastructure Development and Financing from ISB, Hyderabad); Postgraduate Diploma in Management (Industrial Relations & Personnel Management); and Bachelor of Law (LLB).



OXFORD SR.SEC.SCHOOL Oxford Sr. Sec. School shines in the 37th HANS RAJ PRABHAKAR MEMORIAL INVITATIONAL BASKETBALL TOURNAMENT held at Oxford School grounds, E Block, Vikas Puri, New Delhi with victory over Army Public School, Heritage School and Adarsh Public School in Junior boys, Brain International School, Lancer's Convent and KR Mangalam in Senior boys and Adarsh Pub. Sch., Lancer's Convent and APS(DK) in Sub Junior Boys & St. Mark's Janak Puri and St. Mark's Meera Bagh in Senior Girls League matches.



SARLA CHOPRA DAV PUBLIC SCHOOL, Noida, celebrated *Mental Health Week* through a series of meaningful and engaging activities aimed at promoting mental health awareness, emotional well-being and a culture of openness and support.The week commenced with a *Mental Health Awareness Rally* on the theme *"Think, Feel, Talk and Heal."* Students enthusiastically participated in the rally, carrying thought-provoking placards and spreading awareness about anxiety, depression, stress and other emotional challenges. As part of the initiative, interactive *counselling and well-being sessions* were conducted by the Counselling and Well-being Department, for students of Grades 7 and 8.



SIR GANGA RAM HOSPITAL New Delhi, organised a comprehensive Preventive Cardiac Health Camp on 27th September to mark World Heart Day, bringing advanced cardiac screening closer to residents of the neighbouring colonies. Around 120 people enrolled for the camp, which was organised jointly by the Departments of Cardiology and CT scan. Participants underwent Random Blood Sugar, HbA1c, Lipid Profile and ECG free of cost, along with free consultations by senior cardiologists. The patients were screened by senior cardiologists Dr Kavita Tyagi, Dr Manish Sharma, Dr Ashish Jain and Dr Sushant Wattal, along with Dr Sonia Rawat, Director, Preventive Health, and Dr Noor Fatima Warris, Senior Staff Physician.

Office of the Executive Engineer, Provincial Division, P.W.D Rampur

Letter No:-2353/E-Tender Notice /26-27 **Date:-15-10-2026**

E-Tender Notice

1. On behalf of the Governor of UP, tenders for following work on percentage rates are invited by the Executive Engineer, Provincial Division, PWD, Rampur online on website **http://etender.up.nic.in** from contractors registered in Bridge Category from date 10.11.2026 at 10.00 am to 16.11.2026 at 12.00 noon. Technical bid/Prequalification of tenders shall be opened on 16.11.2026 at 12.30 pm in office of undersigned by tender committee in presence of authorised representatives/bidders who wish to be present. Financial bid of the tenders' who qualify in technical bid shall be opened on date and time as specified by a notice in the office of undersigned. In case of Government holiday the required process shall be carried out on next working day.
2. **Details of the works are following:**

Sl. No	DISTRICT	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.in Lacs) (Ex.GST)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lacs)	Cost of tender documents including GST (RS.)	Address of Executive Engineer executing the work	Time of Completion including rainy season	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer	Category of contractor eligible
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
		In Anticipation :-								
1	Rampur	Construction of a minor bridge (1 x 6 m span) and its approach road at km 1 of the Milak Khanam- Saidabad road, for the financial year 2026-27.	34.00	3.40	2354.00	Executive Engineer, Pro. Div, PWD, Rampur	05 Months including rainy season	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer MBD, Zone PWD MBD.	'A, B, C,D Bridge Category
2	Rampur	Construction of a box culvert (1 x 6 m span) and its approach road at km 2 of the road from Dhawani-Chainpur to Anwariya (at chainage 5.80) towards Kotalkheda, for the financial year 2026-27.	61.00	5.05	2354.00	Executive Engineer, Pro. Div, PWD, Rampur	05 Months including rainy season	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer MBD, Zone PWD MBD.	'A, B, C, Bridge Category
3	Rampur	Construction of a box culvert (2 x 6 m span) and its approach road at km 1 of the road from Dhawani-Chainpur to Anwariya (at chainage 5.80) towards Kotalkheda, for the financial year 2026-27.	78.00	5.90	2354.00	Executive Engineer, Pro. Div, PWD, Rampur	05 Months including rainy season	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer MBD, Zone PWD MBD.	'A, B, Bridge Category
4	Rampur	Construction of a box culvert (2 x 6 m span) and its approach road at km 3 of the NH-87 to Pipliya Mahto road, for the financial year 2026-27.	79.00	5.95	2354.00	Executive Engineer, Pro. Div, PWD, Rampur	05 Months including rainy season	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer MBD, Zone PWD MBD.	'A, B, Bridge Category
5	Rampur	Construction of a box culvert (2 x 6 m span) and its approach road at km 2 of the NH-87 to Indpur Baradari road, for the financial year 2026-27.	82.00	6.10	2354.00	Executive Engineer, Pro. Div, PWD, Rampur	05 Months including rainy season	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer MBD, Zone PWD MBD.	'A, B, Bridge Category

- The Rate adopted in the BOQ are inclusive of all taxes but excluding GST.
- Bid security and tender cost should be deposited online by Net Banking as per Column 05 and 06 in the table.
  All terms & conditions can be seen on website **http://etender.up.nic.in** The bidder have to login on Prahari URL **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari** to upload required documents as per Government order no.14/2020/879/तेईस-7- 2020-176 (सा0)/06 लोक निर्माण अनुभाग-7 दिनांक 25.08.2020, Government order 879 (1)/तेईस-7-2020-176 (सा0)/06 लोक निर्माण अनुभाग-7 दिनांक 25.08.2020 & E.N.C./H.O.D.'s uppwd letter No. 417/13रो०ए० मै० खं०/20 दिनांक 28.08.2020
- Additional EMD will be payable as per rule at the time of Agreement and according to G.O. No 86/2026/649/2026/23-7099/106/2025 /लोक निर्माण अनुभाग-7 दिनांक 23.05.2026
- All Rules/conditions & details of the tender are available at website **http://etender.up.nic.in**

Assistant Engineer
Pro.Div., PWD, Rampur

UPID-259521 Dt. 26/10/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

(Krishan Vir)
Executive Engineer
Pro.Div., PWD, Rampur
Email_pdrampur@gmail.com
For and on behalf of Governor of UP

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD. | GOLD AUCTION NOTICE

Regd. Office: Muthoot Centre, TC No 27/3022, Punnen Road, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, India - 695001. CIN : U65929KL1997PLC011518, Ph: +91 471 4911400, 2331427.

Notice is hereby given for the information of all concerned that gold ornaments pledged with under mentioned branches of the company , which were overdue for redemption and which have not been redeemed so for in spite of repeated notices will be auctioned on 28.11.2026 from 10 am onwards.

KHANDWA DISTRICT - KHANDWA-SHIVAJI CHOWK: 2584001106, 2584001196, 2584001203, 2584001209, 2584001225, 2584001261, 2584001271, 2584001367, 2584001488, 2584001544, 2584002304, 2584002311.

Auction will be conducted at respective branches. please note if the auction does not get completed on the same day due to any reasons, the same will be conducted on 07.12.2026 at 10.00 am onwards at KHANDWA DISTRICT - KHANDWA-SHIVAJI CHOWK: BHAIRAV TALAB, PADAWA MAHATMA GANDHI MARG, SITA APARTMENT, KHANDWA , MADHYA PRADESH - 450001 .The bidders are requested to produce photo id card ,Pan card .The successful bidder should transfer the money through RTGS.

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD

INDIAN RAILWAYS

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS
(RAILWAY BOARD)
NEW DELHI - 110001

E-TENDER NO. 2026RSI9547TC

Principal Executive Director, Railway Stores (S), Ministry of Railways, Railway Board, Government of India invites e-tender for procurement of 5800 Bogie Open Rapid Discharge Hoper Wagon type 'BOBRN' wagons to RDSO Specification No. WD-13-BOBRN-2011 of March, 2011. Index Drawing & Design WD-91071-S-50 with Design-M.

2.0 The interested tenderers are advised to visit the website **http://ireps.gov.in** for details of the tender and submission of their e-bids.

3.0 **No manual offers will be accepted against e-tender.**

4.0 **Tender will be closed at 15:00 hours on 26.11.2026.**

5.0 Any corrigendum to this tender will be published on the website **http://ireps.gov.in** only and not in print media.

Director, Railway Stores (W),
Ministry of Railways, Railway Board, New Delhi,
For and on behalf of the President of India

3752/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

KIDWAI MEMORIAL INSTITUTE OF ONCOLOGY,

Cancer Research & Training Centre
GOVERNMENT OF KARNATAKA AUTONOMOUS INSTITUTION (Regional Centre of Cancer Research & Treatment Member of International Union Against Cancer)

Dr. M.H. Marigowda Road, Bangalore-560029
Ph: 080-66697999, E-mail: kidwai@nic.in / directorkidwai01@gmail.com

No: KMIO/SME(1)/TENDER/CISPLATIN/518/26-27 **Date:27-10-2026**

e-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTIFICATION

Online Tenders are invited in Two Bid System for the following through GOK KPP Portal tender for Kidwai Memorial Institute of Oncology.

Sl No.	Tender No. & Date	Name of the Items
1	KMIO/SME(1)/TENDER/ CISPLATIN/518/26-27, DT: 27.10.2026, Call-2	Purchase of Cisplatin Drugs To KMIO (Estimated Budget: 92.89 Lakh)
2	KMIO/SME(1)/TENDER/ BMT DRUGS/519/26-27, DT: 27.10.2026, Call-2	Purchase of Drugs To BMT Dept, At KMIO (Estimated Budget: 246 Lakh)
3	KMIO/SME(1)/TENDER/ MEDICAL BOOKS/ 26-27, DT: 27.10.2026 Call-2	Purchase of Medical Books to KMIO (Estimated Budget: 45 Lakh)
4	KMIO/SME(1)/TENDER/ OT/524/26-27, DT: 27.10.2026	Purchase of OT Requirement To KMIO (Estimated Budget: 192 Lakh)
5	KMIO/SME(1)/TENDER/ 128 SLICE/520/26-27, DT: 27.10.2026	Supply Commissioning and Installation of 128 Slice CT Scanner to the Dept. of Radiodiagnosis (Estimated Budget: 1200 Lakh)
6	KMIO/SME(1)/TENDER/ ULTRASOUND/ 521/26-27, DT: 27.10.2026	Supply Commissioning and Installation of Ultrasound to The Dept. of Radiodiagnosis (Estimated Budget: 140Lakh)
7	KMIO/SME(1)/TENDER/ CATHLAB/522/26-27, DT: 27.10.2026	Supply Commissioning and Installation of of Cathlab With CBCT to The Dept. of Radiodiagnosis (Estimated Budget: 1200 Lakh)
8	KMIO/SME(1)/TENDER/ ECHO/523/26-27, DT: 27.10.2026	Supply Commissioning and Installation of Echo to the Dept. of Radiodiagnosis (Estimated Budget: 60 Lakh).
9	KMIO/SME(1)/TENDER/ CONSUMABLES/DMB /525/26-27, DT: 27.10.2026	Purchase of Chemicals Glassware Media & Miscellaneous Items to Microbiology

The Bid Document will be available in online for **Sl. No. 01 to 04** from **28-10-2026 to 05-11-2026 Sl. No. 05 to 09** from **28-10-2026** to **04-12-2026**. Bidders can view and download the Bid Document from the Website **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** Bids have to be submitted through e-Procurement Portal and e-procurement Portal fees. The last date and time of Receipt of Bid through e-Procurement Portal is **05-11-2026 & 04-12-2026** till **4:00 P.M.** Tender Accepting Authority reserves the right to accept/reject/cancel the tender without assigning any reason thereof.

DIPR/SI/3354/2026-27

Sd/-
Financial Advisor

दानापुर छावनी परिषद्

कार्तिकी छठ पूजा -2026 व्यवस्था मद्देनजर अल्पाकालिन पुनः ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

दानापुर छावनी परिषद् कार्यालय "कार्तिकी छठ पूजा 2026 के आलोक में घाटों एवं निर्देशित स्थानों पर विभिन्न व्यवस्था हेतु ईच्छुक निविदाकार से **e-procurement portal site https://defproc.gov.in/nicgep/app** माध्यम से अलग-अलग अल्पकालिन निविदा आमंत्रित करती है। विवरण निम्न प्रकार है-

क्रम सं0	निविदा/ठेके का नाम	धरोहर राशि	विपत्र शुल्क
1.	छावनी क्षेत्र के गंगा घाटों पर बालू बिछाने, गिराने एवं आवश्यक घाट अथवा स्थान तक पहुँचाने हेतू।	5,000/-	1,000/-
2.	छावनी क्षेत्र के गंगा घाटों पर कन्ट्रोल रूम की व्यवस्था जिसमें लाईट (10 मेटल एवं 15 ट्यूब) जेनरेटर, माईक, एवं कर्सी इत्यादि की व्यवस्था सहित।	5,000/-	1,000/-
3.	छावनी क्षेत्र के गंगा घाटों पर नाव, चेजिंग रूम, बैनर, पुआल, चाली, विडियोग्राफी, गेट व्यवस्था एवं आवश्यकतानुसार पाईप की व्यवस्था करने हेतु।	5,000/-	1,000/-
4.	छावनी क्षेत्र के गंगा घाटों, मार्गों एवं अन्य बताये जगहों पर बैरिकेडिंग व्यवस्था हेतु।	5,000/-	1,000/-

महत्वपूर्ण तिथियों निम्न प्रकार है:-

1.	प्रकाशन की तिथि	27.10.2026	शाम 05:00 बजे
2.	ऑनलाईन दस्तावेज डाउनलोड के शुरूआत की तिथि	27.10.2026	शाम 05:00 बजे
3.	निविदा भरने की प्रारंभिक तिथि	27.10.2026	शाम 05:00 बजे से
4.	ऑनलाईन दस्तावेज डाउनलोड की अंतिम तिथि	03.11.2026	शाम 03:00 बजे तक
5.	पंजीकरण हेतु शुल्क जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि	03.11.2026	शाम 03:00 बजे तक
6.	तकनिकी दस्तावेज के खुलने की तिथि	05.11.2026	शाम 04:00 बजे

नोट-

(i) निविदा दस्तावेज ऑनलाईन उपलब्ध है और भारत सरकार के **e-procurement portal site https://defproc.gov.in/nicgep/app** पर ही ऑनलाईन आवेदन दे सकते हैं। निविदा के आवेदन के लिए निविदाकार के पास अधिकृत अधिकारी द्वारा प्रमाणित **Digital Signature Certificate (DSC)** होना आवश्यक है।

(ii) निविदाकार को सक्षम पदाधिकारी द्वारा प्रमाणित आचरण एवं चरित्र प्रमाण पत्र, आवासीय प्रमाण पत्र, अनुभव प्रमाण पत्र इत्यादि निविदा प्रपत्र के साथ अपलोड करना अनिवार्य है। क्रम सं० 1 से 4 तक का नियम एवं शर्तें अलग-अलग अपलोड करना होगा जो अलग-अलग दिया गया है।

(iii) पंजियन शुल्क **m-collect (https://echhawani.gov.in/citizen/language-selection)** द्वारा जमा ही मान्य होगा। जमा करने के उपरान्त छावनी परिषद् के मेल (**ceodana-stats@nic.in**) पर सूचना दिया जा सकता है या फिर कार्यालय में संचित रसीद जमा कर सकते हैं।

(iv) किसी तरह का संशोधन या सूचना **e-procurement portal site** पर दी जायेगी। केन्द्र अथवा राज्य सरकार द्वारा लिये गये निर्णयानुसार, समय-समय पर दिये जाने वाले छठ संबंधित दिशा-निर्देश भी अनुकरणीय होगा।

हस्ता/-
मुख्य कार्यकारी अधिकारी,
दानापुर छावनी

पत्रांक सी.बी.डी./ए.सी./छठ/2026-27/746
दिनांक: 28/10/2026

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER ELECTRICAL DIVISION, HP PWD UNA

Tel/Fax: +911975223484 | E-mail: ee-eleu-hp@nic.in

INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer, Electrical Division HPPWD, Una-174303 on behalf of the Governor of Himachal Pradesh invites the Percentage rate bids, in electronic tendering system from the eligible class of contractors registered with HPPWD for the works as detailed in table:-

Sr. No.	Name of work	Estimated Cost. (In Rs.) excluding GST	Starting date of Downloading bid	Earnest Money (In Rs.)	Cost of Form (In Rs.)	Deadline for submission of bid	Time limit	Eligibility of Contractor
1	Construction of Aqua park at Nadaun, Tehsil Nadaun Distt. Hamirpur (HP) (SH:- Providing E.I., Package Sub Station, Diesel Generator, Solar Power Generation therein)	1,03,90,623/-	28/10/2026 up to 09.00 A.M.	2,07,800/-	5,000/-	05/11/2026 up to 11.00 A.M.	One year	Class-A
2	A/R & M/O of various type different capacity Air Conditioner installed in various N.R. building under ESD Hamirpur Section Hamirpur Distt. Hamirpur (HP) (Chargeable to C/o Senior Secondary Boy School at Nadaun Distt. Hamirpur (HP)	2,92,482/-	28/10/2026 up to 09.00 A.M.	5,800/-	350/-	05/11/2026 up to 11.00 A.M.	One year	Specialized Job
3	A/R & M/O of various type different capacity Air Conditioner installed in various N.R. building under ESD Hamirpur (Barsar Section) for 2026-27 (Chargeable to C/o Mini Secretariate building at Barsar Distt. Hamirpur (HP)	1,03,486/-	28/10/2026 up to 09.00 A.M.	2,070/-	350/-	05/11/2026 up to 11.00 A.M.	One year	Specialized Job
4	Construction of Judicial Court Complex at Amb Distt. Una (HP) (SH:- Annual Video Comprehensive maintenance of CCTV Surveillance system and allied equipment therein)	7,87,830/-	28/10/2026 up to 09.00 A.M.	15,800/-	350/-	05/11/2026 up to 11.00 A.M.	Six months	Specialized Job
5	Repair of E.I. in PHC building Behal, Tehsil Sh. Naina Devi Ji at Bilaspur in Distt. Bilaspur (HP)	2,69,047/-	28/10/2026 up to 09.00 A.M.	5,380/-	350/-	05/11/2026 up to 11.00 A.M.	Six months	Class-D
6	Running and operation of Bolero Camper HP203-5483 in Electrical Division HPPWD, Una Distt. Una (HP) (SH:- Providing Skilled driving services for Six months from awarded date	1,28,880/-	28/10/2026 up to 09.00 A.M.	2,580/-	350/-	05/11/2026 up to 11.00 A.M.	Six months	Class-D
7	C/o Girls Hostel (For 42 Girls) For DIET Hamirpur at Gauna Kanour Distt. Hamirpur (HP) (SH: Providing E.I. therein)	24,02,814/-	28/10/2026 up to 09.00 A.M.	48,050/-	500/-	05/11/2026 up to 11.00 A.M.	One year	Class-B

The bidders are advised to note other details of tenders from the Department website www.hptenders.gov.in. The Technical bids to be opened on dated 05/11/2026 at 01.30 P.M.

No. 4367/HP

Executive Engineer,
Electrical Division, HPPWD Una

"IMPORTANT"

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MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD. | GOLD AUCTION NOTICE

Regd. Office: Muthoot Centre, TC No 27/3022, Punnen Road, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, India - 695001. CIN : U65929KL1997PLC011518, Ph: +91 471 4911400, 2331427.

Notice is hereby given for the information of all concerned that gold ornaments pledged with under mentioned branches of the company , which were overdue for redemption and which have not been redeemed so for in spite of repeated notices will be auctioned on 28.11.2026 from 10 am onwards.

Auction Date: 28.11.2026 - DAMOH DISTRICT - DAMOH-JABALPUR: 2767001025, 2767001253, 2767001254, 2767001255, 2767001290, 2767001291, 2767001311, 2767001429, 2767001455, 2767001482, 2767001491, 2767001564, 2767001601, 2767001742, 2767001758, 2767001821, 2767001835, 2767001849, 2767001867, 2767001915, 2767001934, 2767001981, 2767002006, 2767002025, 2767002076, 2767002102, 2767002105, 2767002108, 2767002111, 2767002117, 2767002123, 2767002124, 2767002125, 2767002126, 2767002128, 2767002136, 2767002137, 2767002154, 2767002320, 2767002326, 2767002338, 2767002342, 2767002346, 2767002358, 2767002392, 2767002400. **Auction Date: 28.11.2026 - JABALPUR DISTRICT - ADHARTAL-JABALPUR:** 4359001966, 4359002642, 4359002747, 4359002794, 4359002847, 4359002885, 4359002905, 4359002919, 4359002980, 4359002995, 4359003029, 4359003038, 4359003046, 4359003071, 4359003088, 4359003110, 4359003111, 4359003144, 4359003151, 4359003183, 4359003270, 4359003293, 4359003297, 4359003310, 4359003314, 4359003383, 4359003395, 4359003396, 4359003397, 4359003413, 4359003423, 4359003448, 4359003484, 4359003485, 4359003522, 4359003566, 4359003608, 4359003651, 4359003658, 4359003695, 4359003699, 4359003738, 4359003751, 4359003820, 4359003831, 4359003860, 4359003862, 4359003863, 4359003899, 4359003923, 4359003931, 4359003939, 4359003952, 4359003967, 4359003991, 4359004004, 4359004005, 4359004025, 4359004030, 4359004094, 4359004140, 4359004160, 4359004161, 4359004162, 4359004166, 4359004200, 4359004202, 4359004203, 4359004204, 4359004223, 4359004258, 4359004295, 4359004377, 4359004409, 4359004416, 4359004486, 4359004517, 4359004518, 4359004542, 4359004544, 4359004560, 4359004577, 4359004609, 4359004616, 4359004620, 4359004627, 4359004628, 4359004647, 4359004652, 4359004658, 4359004659, 4359004678, 4359004688, 4359004706, 4359004748, 4359004769, 4359004803, 4359004860, 4359004862, 4359004869, 4359005843, 4359007177, 8000214359. **BALDEOBAGH-JABALPUR:** 2238000130, 2238001456, 2238001497, 2238001580, 2238001585, 2238001613, 2238001633, 2238001637, 2238001723, 2238001732, 2238001772, 2238001789, 2238001831, 2238001862, 2238001925, 2238002012, 2238002013, 2238002021, 2238002024, 2238002048, 2238002050, 2238002056, 2238002062, 2238002068, 2238002089, 2238002100, 2238002104, 2238002137, 2238002138, 2238002153, 2238002162, 2238002165, 2238002167, 2238002170, 2238002209, 2238002342, 2238002347, 2238002348, 2238002371, 2238002373, 2238002382, 2238002388, 2238002407, 2238003271, 8000062238, 8000192238. **LABOUR CHOWK-JABALPUR:** 4354001295, 4354001299, 4354001342, 4354001380, 4354001383, 4354001390, 4354001566, 4354001582, 4354001586, 4354001608, 4354001623, 4354001651, 4354001690, 4354001699, 4354001715, 4354001735, 4354001750, 4354001760, 4354001850, 4354001869, 4354001870, 4354001883, 4354001928, 4354001930, 4354001959, 4354001969, 4354001994, 4354002010, 4354002019, 4354002020, 4354002022, 4354002029, 4354002055, 4354002074, 4354002087, 4354002088, 4354002097, 4354002113, 4354002835, 4354002984, 8000524354. **MADAN MAHAL:** 4373001706, 4373001714, 4373001793, 4373001808, 4373001812, 4373001817, 4373001821, 4373001826, 4373001849, 4373001916, 4373001924, 4373001945, 4373001954, 4373001970, 4373002000, 4373002011, 4373002043, 4373002049, 4373002057, 4373002062, 4373002082, 4373002089, 4373002123, 4373002135, 4373002192, 4373002209, 4373002245, 4373002249, 4373002326, 4373002332, 4373002455, 4373002514, 4373002518, 4373002564, 4373002578, 4373002581, 4373002590, 4373002607, 4373002625, 4373002632, 4373002633, 4373002642, 4373002696, 4373002730, 4373002732, 4373002752, 4373002765, 4373002769, 4373002771, 4373002775, 4373002789, 4373002798, 4373002799, 4373002820, 4373002877, 4373002880, 4373002885, 4373002896, 4373002945, 4373002967, 4373002977, 4373002979, 4373003004, 4373003013, 4373003065, 4373004085, 4373004216, 4373004221, 4373004287. **RANJHI-JABALPUR:** 3778000823, 3778000824, 3778000925, 3778000954, 3778000956, 3778000968, 3778000996, 3778001007, 3778001039, 3778001066, 3778001070, 3778001147, 3778001187, 3778001192, 3778001209, 3778001236, 3778001237, 3778001248, 3778001251, 3778001273, 3778001296, 3778001321, 3778001329, 3778001338, 3778001359, 3778001382, 3778001390, 3778001392, 3778001418, 3778001419. **Auction Date: 28.11.2026 - KATNI DISTRICT - KATNI-MADHYA PRADESH:** 2672001606, 2672001637, 2672001709, 2672001716, 2672001729, 2672001750, 2672001753, 2672001770, 2672001860, 2672001862, 2672001875, 2672001881, 2672001886, 2672001895, 2672001905, 2672001909, 2672001911, 2672001929, 2672001954, 2672001959, 2672001969, 2672001983, 2672001991, 2672002008, 2672002041, 2672002053, 2672002065, 2672002066, 2672002067, 2672002080, 2672002081, 2672002097, 2672002112, 2672002127, 2672002132, 2672002139, 2672002162, 2672002169, 2672002177, 2672002234, 2672002238, 2672002289, 2672002329, 2672002340, 2672002351, 2672002359, 2672003189, 2672003238, 2672003240, 2672003261. **Auction Date: 28.11.2026 - MANDLA DISTRICT - MANDLA-MADHYA PRADESH:** 2652001930, 2652001958, 2652001960, 2652001978, 2652002074, 2652002109, 2652002114, 2652002129, 2652002164, 2652002208, 2652002209, 2652002219, 2652002243, 2652002271, 2652002273, 2652002277, 2652002280, 2652002313, 2652002395, 2652002418, 2652002461, 2652002479, 2652002492, 2652002501, 2652002539, 2652002598, 2652002628, 2652002632, 2652002725, 2652002728, 2652002733, 2652002779, 2652002782, 2652002785, 2652002801, 2652002805, 2652002813, 2652002817, 2652002844, 2652002893, 2652002904, 2652002923, 2652002926, 2652002933, 2652003066, 2652003087, 2652003170, 2652003172, 2652003190, 2652003204, 2652004265, 2652004273, 2652004309, 2652004407, 2652004419, 2652004493. **Auction Date: 28.11.2026 - NARSINGPUR DISTRICT - NARSINGHPUR:** 2780001375, 2780001454, 2780001550, 2780001610, 2780001611, 2780001615, 2780001629, 2780001680, 2780001721, 2780001726, 2780001739, 2780001819, 2780001862, 2780001948, 2780001970, 2780002028, 2780002040, 2780002044, 2780002095, 2780002254, 2780002324, 2780002498, 2780003564, 2780003759, 8000322780.

Auction will be conducted at respective branches. please note if the auction does not get completed on the same day due to any reasons, the same will be conducted on 04.12.2026 at 10.00 am onwards at JABALPUR DISTRICT - BALDEOBAGH-JABALPUR: GROUND FLOOR, OLD BATA SHOWROOM , 4 KH, NH 7 , MAIN ROAD, NEARCITY HOSPITAL , BALDEOBAGH, MADHYA PRADESH , 482001 .The bidders are requested to produce photo id card ,Pan card .The successful bidder should transfer the money through RTGS.

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD

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Regd. Office: Muthoot Centre, TC No 27/3022, Punnen Road, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, India - 695001. CIN : U65929KL1997PLC011518, Ph: +91 471 4911400, 2331427.

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Auction Date: 28.11.2026 - DEWAS DISTRICT - DEWAS-AB ROAD: 2610001620, 2610001718, 2610001732, 2610001740, 2610001742, 2610001782, 2610001796, 2610001801, 2610001827, 2610001852, 2610001918, 2610001943, 2610001964, 2610001969, 2610001988, 2610001993, 2610001995, 2610002020, 2610002049, 2610002115, 2610002129, 2610002135, 2610002146, 2610002191, 2610002194, 2610002204, 2610002242, 2610002250, 2610002265, 2610002276, 2610002294, 2610002298, 2610002320, 2610002324, 2610002339, 2610002371, 2610002389, 2610002393, 2610002467, 2610002475, 2610002542, 2610002557, 2610002575, 2610002723, 2610002791, 2610002793, 2610002810, 2610002826, 2610002861, 2610002872, 2610002874, 2610002878, 2610002882, 2610002886, 2610002900, 2610002945, 2610002960, 2610002969, 2610003003, 2610003071, 2610003116, 2610003169, 2610003253, 2610003271, 2610003299, 2610003346, 2610004973, 2610005029. **Auction Date: 28.11.2026 - INDORE DISTRICT - ANNAPURNA ROAD-INDORE:** 2146003185, 2146006213, 2146006218, 2146006292, 2146006382, 2146006428, 2146006444, 2146006476, 2146006477, 2146006499, 2146006531, 2146006603, 2146006620, 2146006646, 2146006662, 2146006672, 2146006680, 2146006717, 2146006749, 2146006792, 2146006811, 2146006935, 2146006936, 2146007014, 2146007054, 2146007137, 2146007149, 2146007191, 2146007250, 2146007280, 2146007300, 2146007305, 2146007400, 2146007402, 2146007405, 2146007424, 2146007438, 2146007500, 2146007538, 2146007605, 2146007661, 2146007663, 2146007665, 2146007676, 2146007685, 2146007710, 2146007718, 2146007719, 2146007812, 2146007846, 2146007852, 2146007908, 2146007946, 2146008026, 2146008047, 2146008073, 2146008097, 2146008138, 2146008143, 2146008144, 2146008158, 2146008166, 2146008229, 2146008241, 2146008248, 2146008249, 2146008250, 2146008252, 2146008280, 2146008290, 2146008348, 2146008370, 2146008376, 2146008440, 2146008465, 2146008486, 2146008488, 2146008489, 2146008490, 2146008491, 2146008494, 2146008495, 2146008496, 2146008497, 2146008521, 2146008614, 2146008637, 2146008639, 2146008644, 2146008645, 2146008649, 2146008651, 2146008728, 2146008772, 2146008779, 2146008784, 2146008830, 2146008849, 2146008862, 2146008878, 2146008891, 2146008910, 2146008944, 2146008974, 2146009024, 2146009027, 2146009032, 2146009034, 2146009060, 2146009063, 2146009066, 2146009085, 2146011017, 2146011072, 2146011104, 2146011109, 2146011118, 8000322146, 8001122146, 8001252146, 8001272146, 8001302146, 8001362146. **JAWAHAR MARG-INDORE:** 2167003687, 2167003721, 2167003775, 2167003778, 2167003900, 2167004001, 2167004016, 2167004023, 2167004060, 2167004170, 2167004182, 2167004222, 2167004272, 2167004278, 2167004287, 2167004289, 2167004315, 2167004347, 2167004359, 2167004372, 2167004382, 2167004440, 2167004468, 2167004471, 2167004525, 2167004559, 2167004597, 2167004652, 2167004704, 2167004709, 2167004711, 2167004726, 2167004729, 2167004777, 2167004786, 2167004873, 2167004919, 2167004932, 2167004939, 2167004961, 2167004964, 2167004971, 2167004981, 2167005020, 2167005022, 2167005071, 2167005088, 2167005093, 2167005137, 2167005176, 2167005200, 2167005226, 2167005237, 2167005238, 2167005245, 2167005276, 2167005277, 2167005310, 2167005336, 2167005343, 2167005347, 2167005348, 2167005349, 2167005370, 2167005375, 2167006675, 2167006727, 2167006768. **MANGAL NAGAR-SUKHLIA:** 4326002978, 4326003022, 4326003030, 4326003100, 4326003117, 4326003137, 4326003139, 4326003155, 4326003209, 4326003224, 4326003247, 4326003260, 4326003299, 4326003314, 4326003315, 4326003385, 4326003402, 4326003485, 4326003587, 4326003588, 4326003609, 4326003647, 4326003693, 4326003806, 4326003811, 4326003812, 4326003833, 4326003847, 4326003852, 4326003858, 4326003864, 4326003938, 4326003976, 4326004006, 4326004020, 4326004022, 4326004036, 4326004054, 4326004082, 4326004084, 4326004093, 4326004106, 4326004136, 4326004137, 4326004151, 4326004166, 4326004178, 4326004205, 4326004238, 4326004250, 4326005315. **NANDA NAGAR-INDORE:** 2150007565, 2150007596, 2150007644, 2150007656, 2150007682, 2150007777, 2150007821, 2150007841, 2150007855, 2150007914, 2150007938, 2150007954, 2150007959, 2150007975, 2150008045, 2150008049, 2150008066, 2150008068, 2150008069, 2150008078, 2150008107, 2150008108, 2150008126, 2150008137, 2150008155, 2150008160, 2150008162, 2150008171, 2150008233, 2150008259, 2150008264, 2150008295, 2150008304, 2150008311, 2150008341, 2150008345, 2150008349, 2150008419, 2150008449, 2150008450, 2150008451, 2150008470, 2150008495, 2150008510, 2150008513, 2150008537, 2150008556, 2150008591, 2150008602, 2150008658, 2150008689, 2150008715, 2150008784, 2150008884, 2150008911, 2150008912, 2150008956, 2150008988, 2150009010, 2150009100, 2150009119, 2150009127, 2150009153, 2150009162, 2150009164, 2150009176, 2150009202, 2150009242, 2150009252, 2150009254, 2150009267, 2150009270, 2150009292, 2150009297, 2150009315, 2150009326, 2150009340, 2150009392, 2150009408, 2150009431, 2150009438, 2150009439, 2150009452, 2150009526, 2150009592, 2150009628, 2150009657, 2150009660, 2150009687, 2150009721, 2150009750, 2150009753, 2150009755, 2150009793, 2150009814, 2150009816, 2150009856, 2150009890, 2150009898, 2150009902, 2150009925, 2150009927, 2150009982, 2150010023, 2150010032, 2150010103, 2150010126, 2150010132, 2150010133, 2150010138, 2150010162, 2150010205, 2150010212, 2150010223, 2150010239, 2150010242, 2150010290, 2150010305, 2150010342, 2150010379, 2150010618, 2150012375, 2150012428, 2150012474, 2150012696, 2150012719, 8001002150, 8001142150, 8001172150, 8001442150, 8001502150, 8001562150, 8001692150. **Auction Date: 28.11.2026 - UJJAIN DISTRICT - UJJAIN-VED NAGAR:** 4016002349, 4016002371, 4016002372, 4016002400, 4016002424, 4016002425, 4016002449, 4016002463, 4016002464, 4016002477, 4016002533, 4016002542, 4016002642, 4016002650, 4016002656, 4016002703, 4016002706, 4016002720, 4016002731, 4016002747, 4016002757, 4016002758, 4016002768, 4016002863, 4016002906, 4016002917, 4016002927, 4016002929, 4016002934, 4016002947, 4016002986, 4016003091, 4016003127, 4016003151, 4016003170, 4016003193, 4016003197, 4016003223, 4016003224, 4016003253, 4016003270, 4016003298, 4016003302, 4016003325, 4016003327, 4016003328, 4016003332, 4016003334, 4016003386, 4016003399, 4016003405, 4016003406, 4016003436, 4016003438, 4016003462, 4016003477, 4016003481, 4016003506, 4016003521, 4016003549, 4016003594, 4016003603, 4016003604, 4016003605, 4016003615, 4016003642, 4016003648, 4016003674, 4016003695, 4016003703, 4016003726, 4016003742, 4016003757, 4016003768, 4016003793, 4016003803, 4016003935, 4016003943, 4016003957, 4016004001, 4016004003, 4016004024, 4016004034, 4016004049, 4016004051, 4016004092, 4016004135, 4016005550, 4016005667, 4016005776, 8000024016.

Auction will be conducted at respective branches. please note if the auction does not get completed on the same day due to any reasons, the same will be conducted on 08.12.2026 at 10.00 am onwards at INDORE DISTRICT - MANGAL NAGAR-SUKHLIA: GROUND FLOOR, SURVEY NO:585/3, MANGAL NAGAR - SUKHLIAMANGAL NAGAR MAIN ROAD, OPPOSITE ICICI BANK,SUKHLIYA, INDORE, MADHYA PRADESH – 452010 .The bidders are requested to produce photo id card ,Pan card .The successful bidder should transfer the money through RTGS.

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD

कार्यालय नगर पालिक निगम, रतलाम. (म.प्र.)

Municipal Corporation Office, Ratlam M.P. (RMC) 01, College Road, Ratlam (457001), Tel: 07412-270555
Fax: 07412-270556, E-mail: commratlam@mpurban.gov.in, Website: www.rmcratlam.in

क्रमांक/1446/लो.नि.वि./2026 — रतलाम, दिनांक : 23.10.2026

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

1	ई-निविदा क्रमांक 545162 कार्य- वार्ड क्रमांक 11 डोंगरे नगर में गीता भवन (बिल्डिंग) एवं लाईब्रेरी हॉल निर्माण कार्य एस्टीमेंट अनुसार (प्रथम आमंत्रण) समयावधि 16 माह, लागत 24860000/-, EMD 248600/- प्रपत्र शुल्क 15000/-, अंतिम तिथि 21.11.2026 समय 15:30 बजे।

नोटः- निविदा सें सबंधित किसी प्रकार के सशोधन का प्रकाशन ऑनलाईन https://mptenders.gov.in की वेब साईट पर ही किया जायेगा, पृथक से समाचार पत्र में प्रकाशित नहीं किया जावेगा।

कार्यपालन यंत्री.
नगर पालिक निगम, रतलाम

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD. | GOLD AUCTION NOTICE

Regd. Office: Muthoot Centre, TC No 27/3022, Punnen Road, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, India - 695001. CIN : U65929KL1997PLC011518, Ph: +91 471 4911400, 2331427.

Notice is hereby given for the information of all concerned that gold ornaments pledged with under mentioned branches of the company , which were overdue for redemption and which have not been redeemed so for in spite of repeated notices will be auctioned on 28.11.2026 from 10 am onwards.

Auction Date: 28.11.2026 - REWA DISTRICT - REWA: 4358001742, 4358001746, 4358001747, 4358001755, 4358001805, 4358001820, 4358001840, 4358001861, 4358001902, 4358001907, 4358001908, 4358001919, 4358001931, 4358001956, 4358001957, 4358001961, 4358001978, 4358001987, 4358002017, 4358002024, 4358002030, 4358002083, 4358002132, 4358002162, 4358002171, 4358002201, 4358002223, 4358002252, 4358002302, 4358002317, 4358002319, 4358002344, 4358002357, 4358002498, 4358002586, 4358002619, 4358002642, 4358002667, 4358002694, 4358002696, 4358002717, 4358002765, 4358002792, 4358002813, 4358002818, 4358002870, 4358002914, 4358002985, 4358002999, 4358003006, 4358003015, 4358003025, 4358003035, 4358003143, 4358003158, 4358003159, 4358003179, 4358003180, 4358003194, 4358003195, 4358003203, 4358003310, 4358003313, 4358003314, 4358003322, 4358003324, 4358003412, 4358003416, 4358003423, 4358003435, 4358003439, 4358003440, 4358003482, 4358003548, 4358003584, 4358003598, 4358003628, 4358003632, 4358003645, 4358003652, 4358003676, 4358003686, 4358003741, 4358003792, 4358003799, 4358003834, 4358003843, 4358003845, 4358003878, 4358003880, 4358003895, 4358003905, 4358003911, 4358003928, 4358003941, 4358003951, 4358003966, 4358005443, 4358005452, 4358005483, 4358005602. **Auction Date: 28.11.2026 - SATNA DISTRICT - SATNA:** 4357001532, 4357001549, 4357001581, 4357001589, 4357001609, 4357001628, 4357001660, 4357001673, 4357001732, 4357001767, 4357001789, 4357001800, 4357001830, 4357001844, 4357001854, 4357001857, 4357001877, 4357001878, 4357001911, 4357001926, 4357001929, 4357001958, 4357001968, 4357001970, 4357001981, 4357002026, 4357002039, 4357002041, 4357002063, 4357002103, 4357002120, 4357002149, 4357002178, 4357002179, 4357002235, 4357002236, 4357002278, 4357002300, 4357002307, 4357002339, 4357002395, 4357002398, 4357002400, 4357002434, 4357002475, 4357002481, 4357002482, 4357002501, 4357002502, 4357002510, 4357002513, 4357002535, 4357002536, 4357002557, 4357002568, 4357002584, 4357002618, 4357002646, 4357002668, 4357002714, 4357002716, 4357002751, 4357002756, 4357002773, 4357002779, 4357002807, 4357002812, 4357002827, 4357002843, 4357002849, 4357002850, 4357002851, 4357002859, 4357002901, 4357002937, 4357002992, 4357003009, 4357003010, 4357003026, 4357003029, 4357003030, 4357003041, 4357003051, 4357003073, 4357003084, 4357003113, 4357003120, 4357003124, 4357003143, 4357003145, 4357003149, 4357004361, 4357004541.

Auction will be conducted at respective branches. please note if the auction does not get completed on the same day due to any reasons, the same will be conducted on 05.12.2026 at 10.00 am onwards at SATNA DISTRICT - SATNA: GROUND FLOOR, 807 K, AHINSA TOWER, IFO PUSHKARNI PARK, BESIDE EQUITAS BANK, DISTRICT HOSPITAL ROAD, SATNA, MADHYA PRADESH-485001 .The bidders are requested to produce photo id card ,Pan card .The successful bidder should transfer the money through RTGS.

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD

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Auction Date: 28.11.2026 - CHHINDWARA DISTRICT - CHHINDWARA: 4089001553, 4089001565, 4089001595, 4089001619, 4089001937, 4089001969, 4089001973, 4089001980, 4089001994, 4089002023, 4089002035, 4089002041, 4089002042, 4089002111, 4089002118, 4089002131, 4089002133, 4089002135, 4089002197, 4089002248, 4089002262, 4089002278, 4089002279, 4089002334, 4089002398, 4089002424, 4089002440, 4089002443, 4089002446, 4089002463, 4089002464, 4089002481, 4089002493, 4089002494, 4089002498, 4089002507, 4089002607, 4089002662, 4089002760, 4089002770, 4089002781, 4089002792, 4089002873, 4089002901, 4089002904, 4089002915, 4089002945, 4089002951, 4089002962, 4089002963, 4089002978, 4089003016, 4089003017, 4089003058, 4089003103, 4089003151, 4089003174, 4089003191, 4089003213, 4089003250, 4089003264, 4089003272, 4089003325, 4089003345, 4089003398, 4089003416, 4089005046, 4089005072. **Auction Date: 28.11.2026 - HARDA DISTRICT - HARDA BUS STAND ROAD:** 4295001450, 4295001466, 4295001485, 4295001498, 4295001612, 4295001632, 4295001716, 4295001761, 4295001762, 4295001779, 4295001852, 4295001872, 4295001908, 4295001930, 4295001932, 4295001944, 4295001947, 4295001992, 4295001997, 4295002001, 4295002004, 4295002009, 4295002017, 4295002024, 4295002112, 4295002140, 4295002683, 4295002742. **Auction Date: 28.11.2026 - NARMADAPURAM DISTRICT - CHOTA SARAFA ITARSI:** 2118002699, 2118002700, 2118002732, 2118002751, 2118002754, 2118002832, 2118002900, 2118002921, 2118002937, 2118002941, 2118002943, 2118002969, 2118002980, 2118003017, 2118003018, 2118003025, 2118003061, 2118003065, 2118003104, 2118003117, 2118003134, 2118003151, 2118003156, 2118003159, 2118003179, 2118003183, 2118003185, 2118003186, 2118003194, 2118003202, 2118003221, 2118003232, 2118003241, 2118003252, 2118003264, 2118003273, 2118003310, 2118003316, 2118003360, 2118003362, 2118003366, 2118003402, 2118003415, 2118003430, 2118003464, 2118003472, 2118003475, 2118003508, 2118003513, 2118003541, 2118003582, 2118003601, 2118003629, 2118003636, 2118003663, 2118003668, 2118004610, 8000522118, 8000562118. **HOSHANGABAD CITY:** 2578002491, 2578002494, 2578002505, 2578002578, 2578002603, 2578002641, 2578002730, 2578002749, 2578002750, 2578002759, 2578002801, 2578002814, 2578002837, 2578002863, 2578002893, 2578002925, 2578002977, 2578003019, 2578003022, 2578003053, 2578003076, 2578003082, 2578003083, 2578003129, 2578003136, 2578003153, 2578003166, 2578003180, 2578003187, 2578003189, 2578003196, 2578003197, 2578003201, 2578003209, 2578003216, 2578003217, 2578003223, 2578003233, 2578003248, 2578003291, 2578003305, 2578003311, 2578003313, 2578003314, 2578003315, 2578003319, 2578003327, 2578003345, 2578003348, 2578003376, 2578003438, 2578003449, 2578003459, 2578003475, 2578003495, 2578003496, 2578003497, 2578003509, 2578003520, 2578003526, 2578003565, 2578003567, 2578003569, 2578003625, 2578003649, 2578003663, 2578003699, 2578003700, 2578004722, 2578004832.

Auction will be conducted at respective branches. please note if the auction does not get completed on the same day due to any reasons, the same will be conducted on 05.12.2026 at 10.00 am onwards at NARMADAPURAM DISTRICT - HOSHANGABAD CITY: PLOT NO 20,GROUND FLOOR,WARD NO 4,MAIN ROAD,INFRONT OF ANKUR CLUB,NEAR HALWAI CHOWK,HHOSHANGABAD,MADHYAPRADESH-461001 .The bidders are requested to produce photo id card ,Pan card .The successful bidder should transfer the money through RTGS.

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD

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Auction Date: 28.11.2026 - MANDSAUR DISTRICT - MANDSAUR: 4266000888, 4266001254, 4266001278, 4266001291, 4266001302, 4266001330, 4266001363, 4266001365, 4266001386, 4266001417, 4266001449, 4266001461, 4266001471, 4266001508, 4266001514, 4266001524, 4266001543, 4266001574, 4266001592, 4266001618, 4266001619, 4266001647, 4266001686, 4266001703, 4266001706, 4266001721, 4266001848, 4266001900, 4266001927, 4266001932, 4266001935, 4266001947, 4266001986, 4266002011, 4266002015, 4266002024, 4266002062, 4266002066, 4266002078, 4266002244, 4266002285, 4266002296, 4266002313, 4266002314, 4266002332, 4266002350, 4266002422, 4266002430, 4266002450, 4266002454. **Auction Date: 28.11.2026 - RATLAM DISTRICT - RATLAM:** 4068001131, 4068001138, 4068001148, 4068001151, 4068001186, 4068001187, 4068001269, 4068001322, 4068001378, 4068001425, 4068001541, 4068001558, 4068001597, 4068001633, 4068001645, 4068001678, 4068001745, 4068001756, 4068001775, 4068001798, 4068001927, 4068001964, 4068002862, 4068002921.

Auction will be conducted at respective branches. please note if the auction does not get completed on the same day due to any reasons, the same will be conducted on 07.12.2026 at 10.00 am onwards at RATLAM DISTRICT - RATLAM: GROUND FLOOR DO BATTI NEAR HDFC RATLAM RAILWAY STATION ROAD BESIDE YES BANK RATLAM RATLAM. PIN: 457001. .The bidders are requested to produce photo id card ,Pan card .The successful bidder should transfer the money through RTGS.

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD

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Notice is hereby given for the information of all concerned that gold ornaments pledged with under mentioned branches of the company , which were overdue for redemption and which have not been redeemed so for in spite of repeated notices will be auctioned on 28.11.2026 from 10 am onwards.

Auction Date: 28.11.2026 - BHOPAL DISTRICT - ASHOKA GARDEN: 4343002989, 4343003340, 4343003434, 4343003482, 4343003549, 4343003572, 4343003784, 4343004029, 4343004136, 4343004229, 4343004402, 4343004443, 4343004455, 4343004566, 4343004625, 4343004723, 4343004828, 4343004898, 4343004905, 4343004977, 4343005026, 4343005052, 4343005055, 4343005085, 4343005086, 4343005175, 4343005176, 4343005251, 4343005273, 4343005276, 4343005319, 4343005328, 4343005347, 4343005350, 4343005367, 4343005393, 4343005451, 4343005502, 4343005506, 4343005519, 4343005521, 4343005549, 4343005584, 4343005606, 4343005665, 4343005680, 4343005696, 4343005703, 4343005713, 4343005714, 4343005749, 4343005757, 4343005768, 4343005775, 4343005821, 4343005854, 4343005859, 4343005878, 4343005889, 4343005892, 4343005906, 4343005922, 4343005937, 4343005939, 4343005942, 4343005960, 4343005970, 4343005993, 4343006004, 4343006005, 4343006006, 4343006007, 4343006018, 4343006022, 4343006043, 4343006046, 4343006100, 4343006108, 4343006131, 4343006139, 4343006143, 4343006144, 4343006145, 4343006171, 4343006173, 4343006179, 4343006191, 4343006204, 4343006209, 4343006210, 4343006211, 4343006212, 4343006213, 4343006214, 4343006216, 4343006218, 4343006220, 4343006233, 4343006238, 4343006240, 4343006249, 4343006254, 4343006259, 4343006262, 4343006263, 4343006268, 4343006269, 4343006270, 4343006277, 4343006287, 4343006288, 4343006289, 4343006290, 4343006291, 4343006292, 4343006294, 4343006295, 4343006296, 4343006297, 4343006303, 4343006308, 4343006309, 4343006311, 4343006315, 4343006321, 4343006323, 4343006324, 4343006330, 4343006331, 4343006342, 4343006343, 4343006352, 4343006359, 4343006360, 4343006362, 4343006371, 4343006375, 4343006424, 4343006458, 4343006462, 4343006472, 4343006473, 4343006478, 4343006514, 4343006528, 4343006532, 4343006545, 4343006577, 4343006578, 4343006586, 4343006664, 4343006671, 4343006684, 4343006688, 4343006690, 4343006696, 4343006702, 4343008356, 4343008413, 4343008467, 4343008536, 8000134343. **BHOPAL-ARERA COLONY:** 27490024553, 2749002536, 2749002584, 2749002600, 2749002614, 2749002669, 2749002714, 2749002720, 2749002742, 2749002743, 2749002744, 2749002758, 2749002763, 2749002768, 2749002809, 2749002824, 2749002909, 2749003007, 2749003034, 2749003126, 2749003167, 2749003199, 2749003224, 2749003264, 2749003317, 2749003320, 2749003346, 2749003471, 2749003483, 2749003488, 2749003517, 2749003525, 2749003543, 2749003560, 2749003566, 2749003573, 2749003576, 8000242749. **BHOPAL-INDRAPURI:** 2127001885, 2127007139, 2127007148, 2127007196, 2127007214, 2127007218, 2127007286, 2127007292, 2127007304, 2127007484, 2127007533, 2127007572, 2127007605, 2127007608, 2127007638, 2127007689, 2127007691, 2127007709, 2127007767, 2127007892, 2127007897, 2127007945, 2127007974, 2127007995, 2127008019, 2127008113, 2127008115, 2127008116, 2127008121, 2127008122, 2127008133, 2127008262, 2127008275, 2127008284, 2127008287, 2127008291, 2127008308, 2127008315, 2127008348, 2127008405, 2127008421, 2127008456, 2127008477, 2127008510, 2127008558, 2127008579, 2127008603, 2127008611, 2127008793, 2127008794, 2127008827, 2127008841, 2127008857, 2127008869, 2127008870, 2127008872, 2127008903, 2127008911, 2127008941, 2127008962, 2127009000, 2127009004, 2127009055, 2127009058, 2127009060, 2127009128, 2127009141, 2127009195, 2127009197, 2127009199, 2127009202, 2127009241, 2127009256, 2127009266, 2127009267, 2127009285, 2127009366, 2127009369, 2127009418, 2127009432, 2127009439, 2127009442, 2127009449, 2127009464, 2127009465, 2127009470, 2127009491, 2127009504, 2127009525, 2127009547, 2127009644, 2127009678, 2127009709, 2127009727, 2127009751, 2127009837, 2127009901, 2127009928, 2127009948, 2127009955, 2127009965, 2127009986, 2127009987, 2127010039, 2127010044, 2127010085, 2127010165, 2127010175, 2127010223, 2127010228, 2127010306, 2127010320, 2127010350, 2127010351, 2127010370, 2127010384, 2127010429, 2127012876, 2127013079, 2127013097, 2127013159, 2127013215, 8000652127, 8000952127, 8001092127. **BHOPAL-MP NAGAR ZONE II:** 2065000607, 2065000621, 2065003538, 2065003550, 2065003582, 2065003610, 2065003613, 2065003686, 2065003688, 2065003778, 2065003789, 2065003792, 2065003843, 2065003851, 2065003870, 2065003872, 2065003894, 2065003897, 2065003913, 2065003917, 2065003922, 2065003971, 2065003983, 2065004008, 2065004039, 2065004052, 2065004058, 2065004059, 2065004071, 2065004084, 2065004093, 2065004123, 2065004131, 2065004224, 2065004225, 2065004247, 2065004308, 2065004346, 2065004373, 2065004378, 2065004403, 2065004406, 2065004411, 2065004427, 2065004704, 2065004709, 2065004739, 2065004861, 2065004921, 2065004954, 2065005125, 2065005147, 2065005177, 2065005199, 2065005202, 2065005306, 2065005335, 2065005341, 2065005357, 2065005373, 2065005432, 2065005475, 2065005495, 2065005521, 2065005589, 2065005609, 2065005663, 2065005667, 2065005669, 2065005702, 2065005706, 2065005707, 2065005775, 2065005788, 2065005804, 2065005843, 2065005846, 2065005852, 2065005863, 2065005891, 2065005928, 2065005934, 2065005961, 2065005964, 2065005998, 2065006672, 2065007575, 2065007599, 2065007601, 2065007649, 2065007803, 2065007818, 2065007819. **HOSHANGABAD ROAD-BHOPAL:** 2575003323, 2575003324, 2575003348, 2575003378, 2575003382, 2575003421, 2575003460, 2575003465, 2575003484, 2575003488, 2575003491, 2575003497, 2575003548, 2575003553, 2575003559, 2575003577, 2575003635, 2575003659, 2575003668, 2575003669, 2575003701, 2575003712, 2575003714, 2575003725, 2575003726, 2575003727, 2575003732, 2575003743, 2575003764, 2575003873, 2575003900, 2575003910, 2575003958, 2575003994, 2575004016, 2575004055, 2575004059, 2575004093, 2575004099, 2575004137, 2575004139, 2575004152, 2575004153, 2575004155, 2575004170, 2575004208, 2575004216, 2575004250, 2575004296, 2575004309, 2575004321, 2575004329, 2575004351, 2575004360, 2575004361, 2575004366, 2575004381, 2575004402, 2575004407, 2575004412, 2575004416, 2575004419, 2575004420, 2575004428, 2575004436, 2575004449, 2575004476, 2575004497, 2575004510, 2575004540, 2575004589, 2575004602, 2575004606, 2575004644, 2575004696, 2575004698, 2575004762, 2575004773, 2575004788, 2575004796, 2575004841, 2575004883, 2575004964, 2575006419, 2575006424, 2575006425, 2575006441, 2575006489, 2575006531, 8000162575. **KAROND-BHOPAL:** 2667005892,

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, Megha Madan, W/o- Rohit Pahwa, R/o-H.No. 10826, First Floor, Gali No.17, Partap Nagar, Malka Ganj, Delhi-110007. That in the school record and Birth Certificate of my minor son namely Garv aged-14-years my name has been wrongly written as Megha Pahwa instead-of Megha Madan, which may be amended accordingly. 0040885765-6

I, DIPIKA W/o ASHOK PANDEY R/o 34, KANCHANCHANGA APARTMENT, PLOT NO-90, PATPARGANJ, I.P. EXTENSION, EAST DELHI, DELHI - 110092 have changed my name to DEEPIKA PANDEY for all purposes 0071068120-1

I, Kalpana, W/O Pramod Kumar, R/O C-6-701, 7th Floor, Kendriya Vihar, Plot No.07, Sector-P4, Greater Noida, P.O. Alpha, Gautam Buddha Nagar, U.P.-201310 have changed my name & Henceforth, Be Known as Kalpana Kumari. 0071068158-1

I,Mo Amir,S/o-Liyakat Ali,R/o-E-60,Shaheen Bagh,Jamia Nagar,Okhla New-Delhi-110025,Have Changed My Name To,Mohd Aamir For All Future Purpuse 0040885755-6

I,Rida Fatima D/o-Syed Munawer,R/o-F-44, Muradi Road,Batla House,Jamia Nagar,Okhla, New Delhi-110025,have changed my name to Rida Naqvi,for all purposes. 0040885752-1

I, Neha Rastogi, W/o Shri Manish Rastogi, R/o H.No. 5/312, Mohalla Sarai, Shahdara Delhi-110032 do hereby solemnly affirm and declare that both the names i.e. "Neha Rastogi" (after marriage) and "KM Neha" (before marriage) belong to me and the same person, vide an affidavit before the Notary Public, Delhi on 26.10.2026. 0040885613-1

I, RAJ PRATAP SINGH, hereby declare that my mother's correct name is PREMWATI DEVI, whereas it is printed as PREMWATI in my CBSE Class X marksheet. Both names refer to the same person 0050300278-1

I,VIJAY GUPTA,S/O-RAM NARAYAN GUPTA,R/O-1134/E HARI OM GALI NO-1,BABARPUR,SHAHDARA NORTH-EAST DELHI-110032,HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO VIJAY KUMAR GUPTA FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040885738-7

I,Priti Jauhari,W/O-A N Jauhari,R/O-House No- 88 A,Sector 5,Rachna Vaishali, Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh have changed my name to Suchitra Verma,for all future purpose. 0040885781-2

I, Khushi Rai D/O Mr. Ramashray Rai R/O-D-352, Sector Delta-I, Greater Noida Distt G.B.Nagar,U.P-201308 have changed my name to AROHI RAI & Date of birth From 26-09-2003 to 26-09-2004 for all future purposes. 0040885722-2

I, Mohammad Parvez S/o Nawabuddin Khan R/o-1084 A/2, Ward-No.1, Gandhak-Ki Bawli, Mehrauli, South Delhi-110030,have changed my name to Mohd Parvez. 0040885752-3

I,hitherto known as S JOGINDER SINGH,S/O-KISHAN SINGH,R/O-V-58 A,Ground Floor,Rajouri Garden,PO:Tagore Garden,West Delhi-110027,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as JOGINDER SINGH. 0040885765-1

I, PRATHAM RATHAUR S/O JAI PRAKASH R/O 1344/91, GANESH PURA, TRI NAGAR, DELHI-110035 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO PRATHAM RATHORE FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0071068090-1

I, Vinod Ratan s/o Hukam Chand, R/o Flat No. 803, Tower 13, CWG Village, Near Akshardham Temple, Delhi-110092, hereby declare that Vinod Ratan, Vinod Ratan Gupta, Vinod R Gupta and V. R. GUPTA are one and the same person (myself), and my late father named Hukam Chand, Hukam Chand Gupta and H.C Gupta, are one and the same person. 0040885690-1

I,MANVASA @ MANBASHA W/o-Nanhe Prajapati R/o-RZ-233,Mandir Masjid Chowk Sayed Nangloi New Delhi, declare both names belong to same person 0040885738-9

I,APARNA KUMARI,D/O-Dhirendra Kumar,R/O-C-42,Fourth Floor, New-Krishna Park,Vikaspuri,Delhi-110018,have changed my name to,APARNA SINGH in future for all purposes. 0040885781-4

I Subhash Singh S/O, Jaypal Singh R/o H.no 523, Panchvati Colony, Dadri Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-203207 also known as Subhash Nagar and both are the same person. 0040885677-1

I,RAMESH CHAND,S/O-SUBEY SINGH,R/o-H.No.-183,Near Chopal, Sultan Pur Dabas , Delhi -110039, have changed my name to Ramesh Kumar for all Purposes. 0040885738-2

I, Lokesh Gupta, father of my minor son's Hiyaan Gupta, R/o B3/103, Sunny Valley, Sector-12, Delhi-78, do hereby solemnly declare that Hiyaan and Hiyaan Gupta are one and the same boy. Henceforth, I have changed my son's name from Hiyaan to Hiyaan Gupta for all future purposes. 0040885610-1

I,Neeru W/o Shanker R/o F-2/162, Second floor, Kh.no.447/2, Gali no-5, Mahavir Enclave,Palam Village,Delhi-110045, have changed my name to Mery Neeru. 0040885752-5

I,SUMAN PARASHAR,W/o-Shri ANIL PARASHAR,R/o.D-112-B,Gali No.-5,Laxmi Nagar,Delhi-110092,I hereafter Marriage is SONIA declare that SONIA &,SUMAN PARASHAR Both Name are Same person. 0040885765-3

I, Nidhi Garg W/o Vibhor Garg R/o O-601, Amrapali Silicon City, Sec-76, Noida have changed my name to Nidhi Mittal for All future purposes. 0071068118-1

I, ABHINAV KUMAR S/O BHOPAL SINGH House No-b-3/23, B-3 Block Yamuna Vihar, Near Police Station Bhajanpura Garhi Mendu North East Delhi, Delhi-110053, have changed the name of my minor son AYUSH aged 15 years and he shall hereafter be known as AYUSH CHAUDHARY. 0071068149-1

I,Ashutosh Mudgal, Resident of SF-5, 9/19A,Rajender Nagar,Sahibabad,Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh-201005,have changed my minor daughter's name from KSHITIKA to KSHITIKA MUDGAL.Henceforth she would be known by the name of KSHITIKA MUDGAL for all future purposes. 0040885755-2

I,SHYAM S BATRA Alias SHYAM SUNDER BATRA,S/O-KHUSHI RAM BATRA,R/O-53,B-6,SECTOR-5,ROHINI, DELHI-110085 Declare that SHYAM S BATRA AND SHYAM SUNDER BATRA are one and same persons for all future Purposes. 0040885752-7

I,Rukhsana Begum W/o Sikander Mansuri R/o A-42 Hari Enclave Part -I Kirari Suleman Nagar North West Delhi -110086 have changed my name and I shall be known as RUKHSANA MANSURI for all purpose in future. 0071068085-1

I, Ankit S/o Karnail, holder of Indian Passport no. W2143875 and valid until 07.08.2032, R/o 328 Vpo Yara, Kurukshetra, Pin 136135, Haynana, India have changed my name Ankit and surname Ankit. 0040885670-1

I,Shamem Ahmad,S/O-Shakil Ahmad R/o H NO-1002, B-Block, Gali No-11, Shri Ram Colony, Delhi-110094,Have Changed My Name To SHAMIM AHMED. Permanently. 0040885738-4

I,MD JAWED ZAFAR,S/O-MD JAINUL ABDIN,R/O-RZ-99C,Q EXTN,UTTAM VIHAR,UTTAM NAGAR,NEW-DELHI-110059.CHANGED MY NAME FROM,MOHAMMAD JAWAD ZAFAR,TO MD JAWED ZAFAR,FOR FUTURE PURPOSE,AND MOHAMMAD JAWAD ZAFAR ,AND MD JAWED ZAFAR,BOTH ARE THE NAME OF ONE AND SAME PERSON. 0040885765-5

I hitherto known as MD SAMSAD ALAM S/O MD JABBAR R/O D-290, JJ COLONY, KHANPUR, PUSHPA BHAWAN, SOUTH DELHI, DELHI - 110062, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as SHAMSHAD HASHMI 0040885624-1

I, Asha Masiwal, D/O- Leeladhar Masiwal, R/O-4s-203, Awho Gurjinder Vihar, Sector Chi-1, Greater Noida, G.B. Nagar, U.P. have changed my name after marriage to Asha Sharma W/o Vivek Sharma for all future purposes. 0071068155-1

I,Ved Prakash,S/o-Sh.Rakesh,R/O 5657/12,Gali Hanuman-Mandir , Nabi Karim,Swami Ram Tirth Nagar,Paharganj,Delhi-110055,do hereby declare that,Ved Prakash and Bharat,are one and the same person,for all future purposes. 0040885755-5

I,Amit Kumar Mishra,S/o-Devi Prasad Mishra,R/o-475/3,New Basti Kishan Ganj,Malka Ganj,New Delhi-110007,have changed my name to Amit Mishra,for all future purposes. 0040885752-9

I, Anil Verma, S/o Jai Pal Singh, R/o WZ-1598K/2, Nangal Raya,New Delhi- 110046, my name has been incorrectly mentioned as Anil Kumar in my son Mehul Verma's Passport No. N9376994. My correct name is Anil Verma. 0071068136-1

I,ASHWANI KUMAR SHARMA,S/O-ASHOK SHARMA,R/O-WZ 52,D,F/F,FRONT SIDE PREM NAGAR UTTAM-NAGAR,WEST METRO-PILLAR-NO-682,UTTAM NAGAR WEST DELHI-110059,HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO ASHWANI SHARMA,FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040885738-6

I,RAJ NARAYAN SINGH YADAV, S/O-SHRI DALCHAND YADAV,R/O-PLOT NO 66 G1,GATE-NO-5,RAMPRASTHA GREENS,SECTOR 7 VAISHALI,GHAZIABAD, UTTAR-PRADESH,have changed my name to RAJ NARAYAN SINGH, for all future purpose. 0040885781-1

I, Purnima Verma, W/o Anil Verma, R/o WZ-1598K/2, Nangal Raya, New Delhi110046, that my name has been incorrectly mentioned as "Purnima" in my son Mehul Verma's Passport No. N9376994. My correct and actual name is "Purnima Verma." 0071068121-1

I,ANJU BALA KATARIA,Wife of Mr.YOGENDER SINGH,Resident of H.No.09, Raghopur, Chhawla,Delhi,hereby declare that I,have changed my name from ANJU KATARIA to ANJU BALA KATARIA 0040885755-4

I, Pramod Kumar Mahabir Lal Das Alias Pamod Kumar, S/O Sh. Mahabir Lal Das, R/o-C-6, 701, 7th-Floor, Kendriya Vihar, Plot.No.07, Sector-P4, Greater Noida, P.O.-Alpha, Gautam Buddha Nagar,U.P.-201310 have changed my name & Henceforth, Be Known as Pramod Kumar 0040885722-1

I, SHARAD KUMAR, S/o- S. N. SINGH, R/o- A406, Angel Jupiter Apartment, Ahinsa Khand-2, Opp. DPS Indirapuram School, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201014, have changed the name of my minor son EHAN SINGH aged-17-years and he shall hearafter be known as JIVAANSH SEIINGH. 0040885755-7

I, BABITA D/O-MUNNA SINGH, R/O-231,FIRST FLOOR,SUNLIGHT COLONY-1,NEW DELHI-110014,have changed my name from BABITA to BABITA SINGH,for all purposes. 0040885752-2

I, Sandeep Shrivastav S/o Subhash Chand Shrivastav R/o C-52, Bhagat Singh Colony, New Usman Pur, Gari Mednu, Delhi - 110053, declare that I have changed my name from Sandeep Shrivastav to Ronit Shrivastav for all future purposes. 0040885608-1

I Balister Tyagi S/o Trilok Chand Tyagi R/o H.No. B-127, Shiv Mandir Road, Swaroop Nagar, Delhi-110042 have changed my name to Balister Singh Tyagi for all purposes. 0040885609-1

It is for general information,that I,MUSKAN VERMA,D/o-MAHA NANDAN R/o-E-49,Upper-Ground Floor,Near SD-Public School,Kirti Nagar,PO-Ramesh-Nagar,Dist-West,Delhi,Delhi-110015, declare that name of my mother has been wrongly written as VAISHALI in my Birth Certificate No.-44.The actual name of my mother is ANJU RANI,which may be amended accordingly. 0040885738-8

I,DHIRENDRA KUMAR,S/O-Krishna Mohan Singh,R/O-C-42,Fourth Floor,New Krishna Park,Vikaspuri, Delhi-110018,have changed my minor son's name to "KARTIK" to "KARTIK SINGH" in future for all purposes. 0040885781-3

I Shashi Devi W/O, Abhay Pratap Singh, resident of 1422, Ff, Pinewood Enclave, Sector-2, Wave City, Gaziabad, U.P. have changed my name from Shashi Devi to Shashi Singh. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Shashi Singh for all my future purposes. 0040885673-1

I hitherto known as SHAMA MANCHANDA,D/o-Umesh Manchanda R/o.B-66,Dayanand Colony,Lajpat Nagar,New Delhi-110024,have changed my name and shall hearafter be known as PARUL MANCHANDA. 0040885738-1

I,Priyanka Chaturvedi W/o Ruchir Chaturvedi R/o I-473,10th Avenue Gaur City-2,Greater Noida,Gautam Budh Nagar-201009,have changed my name to Priyanka Jaldi Chaturvedi. 0040885752-4

I,JYOTI RAKESH SAINI,W/o-Rakesh Tejaram Saini,R/o-Flat No.0202,T-08,Taksila Heights,Sector-37-C,Gurgaon, Haryana-122001,have changed my name to JYOTI SAINI for all future purpose. 0040885765-2

I, MALTI DEVI W/o SHRI GOVIND SINGH R/o B-2/188 BLOCK-B NEW KONDLI, MAYUR VIHAR PH-3 SHIV MANDIR VASUNDHRA ENCLAVE S.O, EAST DELHI, DELHI - 110096 have changed my name to MALTI GUPTA for all purposes. 0071068115-1

I,TASHI LATAR S/O KARDUN R/O HOUSE.NO.06, CAMP NO.04,PO : CHOGLAMSAR, LEH (UT) Ladakh,India,194101,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as TASHI LHADAR. 0040885755-1

I,Manoj Kumar S/o Surender Kumar Garg R/o H.No.- 9/328, Agarwal Colony,Jhajjar (Haryana)-124507,have changed my name to Manoj Kumar Garg for all Purposes. 0040885752-6

I,SUMANJEET SODHI,W/o-SHARANJEET SINGH SODHI R/o C-196,3RD FLOOR,LAJPAT NAGAR-1,NEW DELHI 110024, have changed my name to SUMANJIT SODHI. 0040885738-3

I MOHAN LAL S/O JYOTI RAM R/O B-176 LOK VIHAR PITAMPURA DELHI-110034 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MOHAN LAL GOEL. 0040885765-4

I, Manjit Kaur W/o No. 14501273N Rank Ex HONY/NB/SUB (Late) Sucha Singh Bansal R/o RZ-D2/27, Vinod Puri, Vijay Enclave, Delhi - 110045 have changed my name to Manjeet Kaur vide affidavit date 24-10-26 before Delhi. 0071068119-1

I, Vandana W/O Vikas Gautam R/O House No. E-1603, Apex Athena, Plot No. 12A, Sector 75, Noida, G.B Nagar - 201301, U.P, have changed my name to Vandana Gautam. For all future purposes 0071068154-1

It is for general information that I,NULA LAKSHMANA RAO,S/o-NULA CHINNAIAH, present address,Qtr Type-1/94,CISF Residential Complex, CISF 5th RB Ghaziabad,PO-Shipra Sun City,Indirapuram, Dist-Ghaziabad,State-Uttar Pradesh Pin-201014, permanent address 000,Thotala Cheruvu Palli, Varikuntapadu,Thotalacheruvupalle,PO:Thotlacheruvupalli,DIST: Nellore, Andhra Pradesh-524236,declare that name of my mine and my wife have been wrongly written as N LAKSHMANA RAO and N SUHASINIin my minor son namely, NULA JYOTHISH, aged 15 years in his CBSE class 10th marksheet. The actual name of mine and my wife are NULA LAKSHMANA RAO and NULA SUHASINI respectively, which may be amended accordingly. 0040885800-1

I,Km Priya Upadhayay D/o Kailash Chandra R/o SK-214, Sector-116, Noida(U.P) have changed my name to Kumari Priya for all purposes. 0040885684-1

I,PRIT PAL SINGH BAMRA,S/O-DEVINDER SINGH,R/O-J-81,GROUND FLOOR,RESERVE BANK ENCLAVE,PASCHIM VIHAR WEST-DELHI-110063,HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO PRITPAL SINGH FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040885738-5

I Ahmad Hasan s/o Mohammad Salim r/o 53 and 54, Block-R3A, Mohan Garden, Delhi-110059 have changed my name as AHAMAD HASAN. 0040885680-1

I,SHAMA PARVEEN W/O FIRASAT ALI KHAN R/O H.NO.82 GHALIB APARTMENT PITAMPURA DELHI-110034. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SHAMA KHAN. 0040885752-8

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PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public at large is hereby informed that my client **Des Raj Arora** S/o Late Sh. H.N. Arora & his wife Lata Arora both R/o **B-5/150, Paschim Vihar,Delhi-110063** have severed all their relations with their son **Jatin Arora** & his wife **Shreya Nitin Agnihotri** and disowned them from all their moveable & immoveable properties Owned by them, jointly & individually. Any person dealing with them shall be doing so at his/her/their own risks,costs& responsibilities

Ramesh Chander (Adv) Ch-68, Western Wing,Tis Hazari

PUBLIC NOTICE

To be known to all that I, Vinay Verma, S/o A S Verma R/o Flat No. BA-57 B, Ashok Vihar, Ph-1, Delhi-52 declare that I have lost my Original Property Documents, Possession Letter, Site Possession and NOC Electric & Water issued by DDA vide File No. M04 (563) 72/HBM in respect of Flat No. BA-57 B, F.F., MIG Flat, Ashok Vihar, Ph-1, Delhi–52. That the same are not traceable inspite of my best efforts. An NCR to this effect has been lodged vide LR No: 527751/2026 dated 10-08-2026. Finder Contact :9811868216.

PUBLIC NOTICE

General public is hereby informed that my client Rajeshwari W/o Sh. Jagdish R/o 224 -239 , 12.5 Sq Yds. Raghubir Nagar, New Delhi-110027. My client has disowned and debarred his son Rakesh and his wife from movable and immovable all properties due to their bad habits. Anybody dealing with debarred persons shall do at their own risk and responsibilities and my client will not be responsible for any act deed or dealing done by them.

Sd/- B.B.N.DEO, Advocate
S.R.IInd,B Compus,Janak Puri,ND-58

PUBLIC NOTICE

Mortgage of **House No. 1474/5, land area measuring 202 Sq. Yds., in Mustil No. 5, Killa No. 16, 25/1/15, in the residential colony known as Patel Nagar, in the revenue estate of village Jharsa, Tehsil Wazirabad, District Gurugram, Haryana** (Herein after referred as the "said property").

Notice is hereby given to the General Public that **Aakash Kumar Singh, and Sima Devi** is the current owner of the aforesaid property by virtue of **Sale Deed dated 25.01.2024 registered vide no. 20591, SRO- Wazirabad.**

That my client(s) intends to mortgage aforesaid property to Axis Bank Ltd. and the said property would be the security to the loan availed. If any person including banks, financial institutions or any other person, relative, organization, company, firm or government authority having any claim, right, title or any interest of any nature whatsoever into or upon the above-referred property, is hereby called upon to make the same known, in writing with documentary evidence by registered AD Post to the undersigned at the address mentioned herein below within **10 days** of publication of this notice to the undersigned failing which the same shall be deemed to have been waived and/or abandoned. In the event of no response being received to this notice, the purchase and further mortgage of this property shall be completed by our client and its client without any reference to and without in any manner being affected by any such right title, interest or claim whatsoever.

MANISHA CHAUDHARY, ADVOCATE
JUS LEGALIZ,
210, VARDHMAN STAR CITY MALL (NEAR RAMPHAL CHOWK),SECT-7,DWARKA NEW DELHI-75, 011-45606363, 9899006723

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SALUTE THE SOLDIER



NB SUB RAKESH KUMAR, KC

With profound grief and sorrow, we mourn the supreme sacrifice of JC-571195H Nb Sub Rakesh Kumar, KC who laid down his life in the line of duty on 28 Oct 2014.

A valiant soldier of exceptional courage and devotion to duty, he will always be remembered by entire family of 14 MAHAR for his supreme sacrifice.

Commanding Officer and entire 14 MAHAR Family

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant officers on their Balidan Diwas.


INSPECTOR RAM KANWAR YADAV 172 BN BSF 02.02.1948 – 28.10.2002


HEAD CONSTABLE M H LASKAR, PMG 162 BN BSF 31.10.1965 – 28.10.2002


HEAD CONSTABLE SACHINDRA DAS, PMG 162 BN BSF 14.11.1960 – 28.10.2002


CONSTABLE RAJU KUMAR BORO 172 BN BSF 08.10.1972 – 28.10.2002


CONSTABLE DINESH KUMAR P V 89 BN BSF 13.10.1969 – 28.10.2002


CONSTABLE GOPAL DASS 133 BN BSF 19.06.1969 – 28.10.2005


CONSTABLE KOLI NITIN SUBHASH 156 BN BSF 02.07.1988 – 28.10.2016


CONSTABLE GOWTHAM K 152 BN BSF 15.06.1992 – 28.10.2022

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE


Veer Balidani Head Constable Bijon Pal 140 Bn 5-5-1968 To 28-10-2003


Veer Balidani Constable/ Driver Dharmendra Kumar 136 Bn 10-9-1976 To 28-10-2003


Veer Balidani Constable/ Driver Jai Prakash 140 Bn 8-5-1970 To 28-10-2003

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to 3 bravehearts of 140 Bn and 138 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries while valiantly countering a Maoist ambush in dist. Narayanpur, Chhattisgarh, on 28 October 2003. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.


Veer Balidani Constable Pravin Bora 81 Bn 21-3-1966 To 28-10-1989

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Pravin Bora of 81 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining bullet injuries in a cowardly attack by militants during naka duty in Punjab, on 28 October 1989. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. Dy. CE/C/AGC/TN/2026/11 Dated: 26.10.2026

E-Tender Notice

Deputy Chief Engineer(Construction), North Central Railway, Agra Cantt for and on behalf of the President of India invites in **SINGLE PACKET SYSTEM** open tender on prescribed forms online **(E-Tendering).** Tender offer can be submitted on line up to **15.00 hours** of **20.11.2026,** on website **http://www.ireps.gov.in.** The details of the tenders are as under:-

Tender No.: E-Tender Notice No. CEN00AGC1126	**Approx Cost:** Rs. 1.17 Cr. (App.)
Description of work: Maintenance of GC line DHO-GIS section (Km 1290/0-1309/0) section of jurisdiction of SSE/PW/DHO.	
Earnest Money in Rs.: 2,34,100/-	**Completion Period:** 06 Months
Date of opening: 20.11.2026	**Validity:** 60 days

Note:- For complete details and submission of tender please see Indian Railway's website **htpp://www.ireps.gov.in.** **2445/26(K)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited

Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN: U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Procurement of Boiler Tubes which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1	**Tender Enquiry No. 207/GATP/MMD/BOILER/20018360 "Procurement of Boiler Tubes used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib"** at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 27/10/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

No. 16539/PB GATP-104/26

UJVN LIMITED

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
H. O. "UJJAWAL" MAHARANI BAGH, GMS ROAD, DEHRADUN - 248006. CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866
Tele.: 0135-2763508, 2763808, Fax: 0135-2763507, website: www.ujvnl.com

Tender No.999 Date : 27.10.2026

e-TENDER NOTICE

Office of the Executive Engineer (E&M-SHP), UJVN Ltd., Dharchula District Pithoragarh, invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

Tender No: 04/EE (E&M-SHP)/Dharchula/2026-27
Name of work: Repair & Maintenance work of Unit-1 of Suringad Stage–II SHP(2x2.5MW+10%COL) Located in Tehsil Munsiyari, District Pithoragarh, Uttrakhand.
Estimated cost: ₹ 28,10,500/- GST extra
Date of availability of bid document :27.10.2026, 16:00 hrs. **on website**
Last date for submission of bids : 21.11.2026 up to 11:00 hrs **on website**
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "http://uktenders.gov.in"

Executive Engineer (E&M-SHP), Dharchula

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

OFFICE OF MUNICIPAL CORPORATION KORBA

e-Procurement Tender Notice Main Portal: http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in

NIT No:GENS/86135/2026-COMM/NPN Korba Dated 23.10.2026

Sr No.	System Tender No.	Name of Work/Description of Work	Probable Amount of Contract (In Lacs)
1.	202561 (2nd Call)	Bitumen work from C.S.E.B. chowk to T.P.Nagar Chowk at Ward No. 15 T.P.Nagar Zone (DMF Fund)	152.53

The details can be viewed directly from the Government of Chhattisgarh **http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in** from 23.10.2026 at 15:00 Hours. (IST) onwards.

Sd/-
Superitending Engineer
Municipal Corporation
Korba (C.G.)

OFFICE of the Executive Engineer Mechanical Division bhep, Chanderkote

JKPDC

GIST OF e-TENDER NOTICE

For and on behalf of Managing Director JKPDC, e-tenders are invited from authorized dealers/ service providers of Cummins make DG-Sets for the below mentioned work:

S. No	Name of Work	e-NIT No. & Date	Due Date	Tenders receiving Authority
1.	**Maintenance of 380 KVA DG set at Dam.**	20-MECH of 2026-27 Dated 23-10-2026	13-11-2026 at 16:00 Hrs	Executive Engineer, Mechanical Division, BHEP, Chanderkote

For details of work, terms and conditions and any other clarifications, kindly visit www.jktenders.gov.in, you can also contact the Office of the undersigned on any working day up to 13.11.2026 till 14:00 Hrs.

Executive Engineer
Mechanical Division BHEP, Chanderkote
DIP NO. DIP/J-2660-P/26 DATE 27.10.2026

POOMPUHAR SHIPPING CORPORATION LIMITED

(A Government of Tamilnadu Enterprise)
692, Anna Salai, IV[th] Floor, Nandanam, Chennai - 600 035, India
Telephone No. : 044 - 24330505 / 807, Fax : 91-44-24344593 /24335706,
E-mail : pscship@gmail.com CIN : U63090TN1974PLC006596

GLOBAL E-TENDER INVITING NOTICE

Notice inviting E-tender for long term time chartering of two numbers of self trimming Kamsarmax/ Panamax gearless (or with gears considered as gearless) each with bulk carrying capacity of about 68,000 – 86,000 MT DWT on NTECL account.

E-tender bids are invited from the Ship owners / disponent owners for the following specification:

Tender Number	Lay Days	Period	Bid Submission start date	Bid Submission end date	Tender Opening date
(i)PSC/CHARTERING/ 002/2026-27, Dt 16.10.2026	08.12.2026 to 24.12.2026	12 Months + 3 Months +/- 10 days choption	27.10.2026 at 1600 hours	26.11.2026 at 1200 hours	26.11.2026 at 1400 hours
(ii) PSC/CHARTERING/ 003/2026-27, Dt 16.10.2026	08.12.2026 to 24.12.2026	12 Months + 3 Months +/- 10 days choption	27.10.2026 at 1600 hours	26.11.2026 at 1200 hours	26.11.2026 at 1400 hours

Prospective bidders shall submit separate bids for each vessel (Item (i) and (ii)), along with an Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) of **₹10,00,000/- (Rupees Ten Lakh only)** per vessel. All bidders are advised to refer **https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app** for specific important details, download and upload their bid, details also available on www.tamilship.com. The conditions / requirement mentioned in the website shall be met out by the bidders. This advertisement is an invitation for bid only. The details given in the website are comprehensive.
Tender Opening Venue :Poompuhar Shipping Corporation Limited., No. 692, Anna Salai, MHU Complex - 4th Floor, Nandanam, Chennai - 600 035
Further, all communications / corrigendum will be updated through https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app_only.

DIPR/3238/TENDER/2026 **CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING DIRECTOR**

PROVISION OF DIGITAL EARTH LEAKAGE DETECTOR LEVEL-II

E-Tender Notice No. KIR-N-2026-K-38 Dated: 23-10-2026. Works tenders through "E" Tendering system for and on behalf of the President of India are invited for the works as detailed below:- **Name of work:** Provision of Digital Earth Leakage Detector Level-II at stations and Auto Huts of Katihar Division. **Tender Value:** ₹1,73,06,945/-. **Earnest Money:** ₹3,46,100/-. **Date & Time of closing of tender:** At **15.00** hrs. **& opening at 15.30** hrs. on **17-11-2026.** The complete information on tender documents and corrigendum issued of above e-tender will be available upto **15.00** hrs. on **17-11-2026** in the website **www.ireps.gov.in**

DRM/(S&T)/Katihar
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Serving Customers With A Smile

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

e-Tender Notice No. 4654-GRC-CE-C-01-30-2026, dated 23.10.2026. e-Tender is invited by Chief Engineer(Con)I/Garden Reach-700043, S.E.Railway for and on behalf of the President of India for the following work. Following tender has been uploaded on website **www.ireps.gov.in** The tender will be closed at 12.00 hrs. on due date. **Brief Description of Works :** Request for Proposal (RFP) for Providing Project General Management Services (PGMS) for Major Upgradation of Ranchi Railway Station at Ranchi, South Eastern Railway. **Approx. Cost :** ₹ 6.63 Crore. **Bid Security :** ₹ 13,26,900/-. **Completion period:** 30 months. **Closing Date :** 20.11.2026. Interested tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details/ description/specification of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these items will be accepted. **N.B. :** "Prospective Bidders may regularly visit **www.ireps.gov.in** to participate in all other tenders". **(PR-945)**

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR

OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION SATWARI

SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Short e-NIT No. 89 of 2026-27 Dated 23-10-2026

For and on behalf of the **Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir** e-tenders are invited on **percentage basis** from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works: -

S. No	Name of Work	Advertised cost (In lacs.)	Cost of documents (In Rupees)	Earnest Money (in Rupees.)	Time Allowed for completion	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1.	Up-gradation of Revenue Training Institute Gole Gujral Jammu Phase-II By way of Construction of Indoor Badminton Court and Outdoor Basketball court	133.35	3000/-	(2% of the Advertised Cost)	09 Months	07/11/2026	A

Position of AAA :- Accorded
Position of TS :- Accorded
Major head of account :- capex

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website http://jktenders.gov.in as per below schedule:

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	23/10/2026 at 1800 Hrs.
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	23/10/2026 at 1800 Hrs.
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	27/10/2026 at 1300 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Satwari
4	Bid submission Start Date	23/10/2026 at 1800 Hrs.
5	Bid Submission End Date	06/11/2026 up to 1600 Hrs.
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	07/11/2026 on or after 13.00 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Satwari
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical bid evaluation iscompleted

No:- XEN/SAT/PWD/Tender/2026-27/
Dated:-

DIP NO. DIP/J-13146/26 DATE 27.10.2026

कार्यपालक अभियन्ता का कार्यालय
जलपथ प्रमण्डल, चाईबासा

शुद्धि–पत्र

ई० निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या– **01EE/WRD/WWD/CBSA/F2-01/26-27** पी•आर•संख्या–390606 (**West Singhbhum**)26–27 **.D** है, के माध्यम से प्रकाशित की गई को अपरिहार्य कारणों से अगले आदेश तक स्थगित की जाती है।

कार्यपालक अभियन्ता
जलपथ प्रमण्डल, चाईबासा

PR 392546 (West Singhbhum)26-27*D

Metro Railway, Kolkata

Dy. Chief Signal & Telecom Engineer/Signal, Metro Railway, Kolkata for & On behalf of The President of India invites e-Tenders against Open Tender due to open on 16.11.2026 at 15.00 hrs. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **Name of work:** Modification work in Signaling at KKVS & KSKD along with shifting of the existing MSDAC of KKVS to KSKD including allied works in view of the Rehabilitation of KKVS Station on the newly built UP PF/Old PF of both UP and DN lines. **Tender Value (Rs.) :** ₹ 25,25,688.03, **Earnest Money (Rs.):** ₹ 50,500, **Completion Period :** 2 Months. The Tender can be viewed at website: **https://www.ireps.gov.in** The tenderer/bidders must have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate & must be registered on IREPS Portal. Only registered tenderer/bidders can participate on e-tendering. All relevant paper must be uploaded at the time of participating in e-Tender.

Open Tender Notice No.: S&T/Works/32-2026

Follow us at: /metrorailwaykol /metrorailkolkata

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER Construction Circle,
U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN)

GWALIOR ROAD, JHANSI-284001
Email id - seurbanjhscircle@gmail.com
Lt. No. 1519/F-03/234
Dated: 27.10.2026

E-Tender Notice

U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) invites online percentage plus/minus (+/-) rate e-tenders on Turn-key basis in two bid system for execution of **Detailed Survey, Soil Investigation, Design, Supply of all materials, labour, T&P etc. required for construction, erection, completion, testing & commissioning of water supply works such as Clear water Gravity main, ZPSs/CWR cum Pumping Station, Rising main, Feeder main, SCADA Room, Chlorination room, Meter Room, Panel Room, Staff Quarter, Boundary Wall, Site Office & Site development works etc. and other appurtenant works including SCADA and Automation as per specifications in bid document "30 MLD Water Supply System In Activation Area Phase-1 BIDA For Master Plan-2045 Of Bundelkhand Industrial Development Authority (BIDA), District Jhansi Under Deposit Programme"** The scope of work also includes a trial run of 3 months, a defect liability period of 12 months for Civil works & 24 months for E&M works after completion of a successful trial run, and comprehensive Operation & Maintenance (O&M) for a period of 5 (five) years are hereby invited from eligible, reputed and experienced bidder. E-bid documents will be available for **download from 30.10.2026 by 17:00 Hrs.** Pre-bid meeting will be held on dated **05.11.2026 at 11:30 Hrs.** in office of the Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle, UP Jal Nigam (Urban), Jhansi. **E-bids can be submitted till 20.11.2026 upto 17:00 Hrs.** and technical bid shall he opened on **20.11.2026 at 17:30 Hrs.** in office of the Superintending Engineer. Construction Circle, UP Jal Nigam (Urban), Jhansi in presence of contractor or their authorized representative, E-tender Cost is Rs **20000+ GST @ 18%** for Each tender. Details are available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal http://etender.up.nic.in & UP Jal Nigam (Urban) website http://www.jn.upsdc.gov.in

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HSAMB YAMUNANAGAR	CONSTRUCTION OF VARIOUS LINK ROADS IN THE NOTIFIED AREA OF MARKET COMMITTEE RADAUR IN RADAUR CONSTITUENCY (GROUP-1) ROAD ID 12763, 12765, 12767, 12770 AND 12774 IN DISTT. YAMUNANAGAR + 1 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 05.11.2026	7,54,14,492/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9270010001 xenyw.hsamb2023@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 50515/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	UHBVN	FOR PROCUREMENT OF MALE & FEMALE CONTACTS FOR 11 KV 400 AMP. G.O. SWITCH (ONE SET COMPRISING OF ONE MALE & ONE FEMALE CONTACT)	LAST DATE OF SUBMISSION : 17/11/2026 UPTO 13:00 HRS.	2.95 CR./ EMD-2.0 LAKH	www.uhbvn.org.in 01/XEN/P-I/MM/ QH/2609 dated 16.10.2026	9466480421 comm@uhbvn.org.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50539/HR

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, रामगढ़
रामगढ़ थाना के सामने, थाना चौक / गांधी चौक, रामगढ़ कैन्ट,
जिला–रामगढ़, झारखण्ड – 829122, ई.मेल–eercdramgarh-jhr@nic.in

" सूचना "

एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि पथ प्रमण्डल, रामगढ़ अन्तर्गत एस०बी०डी० आधारित अल्पकालीन ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना का प्रसंग संख्या – RCD/RAMGARH/1525/2026-27 दिनांक – 10.10.2026 का P.R. No.- 391742 द्वारा आमंत्रित अल्पकालीन ई–निविदा में निम्न प्रकार से संशोधित किया जाता है:–

क्रमांक	विवरणी	पूर्व में आमंत्रित तिथि	संशोधन की तिथि
1.	वेबसाईट पर निविदा प्रकाशित होने की तिथि एवं समय	28102026 10:30 बजे पूर्वाह्न	02112026 10:30 बजे पूर्वाह्न
2.	वेबसाईट पर निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	10112026 12:00 बजे दिन तक	12112026 12:00 बजे दिन तक
3.	प्री–बिडमीटिंग की तिथि एवं समय	04112026 12:00 बजे दिन तक	06112026 12:00 बजे दिन तक

शेष यथावत रहेंगे।

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, रामगढ़

PR 392586 Road (26-27) D"

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता मेरठ वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, मेरठ।
ई–प्रोक्योरमेन्ट अल्पकालीन निविदा सूचना द्वितीय बार

पत्रांक 4582 / 11 कैशियर–मे0वृ0(नि0ख0मेरठ) दिनांक :–17.10.2026

1. महामहीम राज्यपाल महोदय, उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से उ0प्र0 लोक निर्माण विभाग में पंजीकृत निविदादाताओं से ई–टेण्डरिंग के माध्यम से दर्शाये गये कार्य हेतु निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

क्र० सं०	कार्य का नाम	अनुमानित लागत (रू० लाख में)	धरोहर धनराशि (रू० लाख में)	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि कार्य वर्जित	अधिशासी अभियन्ता का पता	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता का पता	मुख्य अभियन्ता का पता	पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों की श्रेणी
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
राज्य योजनान्तर्गत (ग्रामीण) लघु सेतु का निर्माण का कार्य।									
1	जनपद मेरठ में बागपत रोड डालूहेडा से बहरामपुर मार्ग के कि०मी०–05 में जानी स्कीप पर लघु सेतु का निर्माण कार्य।	410.00	22.50	2000+ 300+ GST 18%= 2714.00	10 माह	निर्माण खण्ड, लो0नि0वि0 मेरठ	मेरठ वृत्त लो0 नि0 वि0, मेरठ	मुख्य अभियन्ता, मेरठ क्षेत्र, लो0 नि0 वि0, मेरठ	एO सेतु कार्य

- बिल ऑफ क्वान्टिटी में लगाई गयी दरें सभी करो को जोड़ते हुये तथा जी0एस0टी0 करों को छोड़ते हुये लगाई गयी है।
- निविदा में निविदा शुल्क (कॉलम नं0 05 के अनुसार) ऑन लाइन केवल नेट बैंकिंग द्वारा भुगतान के पश्चात यू0टी0आर0 प्राप्ति रसीद के रूप में ही मान्य होगी।

2. निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण एवं शर्तें वेबसाइट http://etender.up.nic.in पर ऑनलाईन उपलब्ध है।
3. बिड डाक्यूमेन्ट वेबसाइट http://etender.up.nic.in पर दिनांक 31.10.2026 से 06.11.2026 तक उपलब्ध है, जो कि दिनांक 06.11.2026 को समय अपरान्ह 12:00 बजे तक अपलोड किये जा सकते है। निविदा की तकनीकी बिड दिनांक 06.11.2026 को समय अपरान्ह 12.30 बजे ऑनलाइन खोली जायेगी।
4. निविदा डालने हेतु निविदादाता के पास सर्टिफाईंग प्राधिकरण द्वारा जारी डिजिटल सिग्नेचर सर्टिफिकेट होना अनिवार्य है।
5. शासनादेश संख्या–879(1)/23–7–2020पी0डब्लू0अनु0–07 लखनऊ दिनांक 25.08.20 के आदेशानुसार फर्म/ठेकेदार का प्रहरी एप पर चाणक्य पोर्टल के माध्यम से निविदा डालने हेतु पंजीकरण कराना आवष्यक होगा।
6. शासनादेष संख्या–86/2026/649/23–7099/106/2025 लोक निर्माण अनुभाग–7 लखनऊ दिनांक 23 मई, 2026 के कम में लोक निर्माण विभाग में निर्माण कार्यो में अधिक पारदर्षिता, शुचिता एवं समयबद्वता हेतु बिडिंग डाक्यूमेन्टस के माध्यम से प्राप्त होने वाली निविदाओं में निम्नानुसार प्रकिया निर्धारित किये जाने का निर्णय लिया गया है।
7. प्रमुख अभियन्ता के पत्रांक सं–6410 एम0टी0/सामान्य वर्ग/60 एम0टी0–1/2025 दिनांक 17.12.2025 परिपत्र के कम में वेल/पाइल फाउंडेषन युक्त सेतु, सब–स्ट्रक्चर एवं सुपर–स्ट्रक्चर के निर्माण कार्य का अनुभव अवष्य हो, अन्यथा सम्बन्धित ठेकेदार को अपात्र माना जायेगा।

(संजय सिंह)
अधिशासी अभियन्ता
निर्माण खण्ड, लो0नि0वि0, मेरठ

(जगदीष प्रसाद)
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता,
मेरठ वृत्त, लो0नि0वि0, मेरठ

UPID-259558 Dt. 26/10/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA CORRIGENDUM

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD CORP./AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/NIT NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HVPNL	E.NIT NO.- 16 /XEN TS DIV HVPNL HISAR/2026-2027 DATED 08.10.2026 TENDER REF.NO / E-TENDER ID:2026_HBC_552885_1 20265118S3E6 7A4E 4890 80AB 5F7D52B6C846967HVP	"DATE OF BID OPENING - 08.10.2026 FROM 15:00 HR LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UPTO 04-11-2026 (15:00 HRS)."	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
2	HVPNL	NIT NO. 34/CWD-2/VOL-XXI/HVPN/2026-27 DATED: 09.10.2026 (ONLINE TENDER ID NO. 2026_HBC_553143_1)	"DATE OF OPENING BID 23.10.2026 (11:00 HRS) LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UPTO 04.11.2026 (13:00 HRS) (SOCIETIES & CONTRACTORS)"	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
3	HVPNL	NIT NO. 35/CWD-2/VOL-XXI/HVPN/2026-27 DATED: 09.10.2026 (ONLINE TENDER ID NO. 2026_HBC_553185_1)	"DATE OF OPENING BID 23.10.2026 (11:00 HRS) LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UPTO 04.11.2026 (13:00 HRS) (SOCIETIES & CONTRACTORS)"	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
4	HVPNL	QDP-1510(NIT NO.1390 DATED 08.09.2026)	THE LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UPTO 13.11.2026 UP TO 17:00 HRS	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
5	HVPNL	2026522EE893 OA1D 4CB8 B838 TENDER 58E58416E45B1056HVP/ TENDER ID: 2026_HBC_552153_1/ETENDER ENQUIRY NO.1005202613-29- 36/HARYANA VIDYUT PRASARAN NIGAM LIMITED DEPT/HRY. DATED.05.10.2026.	"CORRIGENDUM NO.02, THE LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UPTO 10.11.2026 (13.00 HRS)"	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50538/HR

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD

(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru-560009. Phone No. 080-22265383, Website: www.kiadb.in

No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-42/3791/2026-27 Date: 27.10.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

Item Rate Tenders under two cover bid system are invited as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Contractors who have got adequate financial resources, state of the art technology, suitable construction equipments, technical man power & sufficient past experience for the work of :

Name of the Work: Improvements to Industrial Layout including Reconstruction and strengthening of 18.0 m, 24.0 & 30.0m Wide Roads including Flexible pavement, Construction of RCC Side Drains, Storm Water Drainage, Chainlink Fencing and Balanced portion of Works in Gowribidanur 1st & 2nd Phase Industrial Area, Chikkaballapura District **(2nd call)**

The last date and time of receipt of tender is : **11.11.2026** upto **4.00 pm.**

Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.**

Sd/-
Engineer in Chief, KIADB, Bengaluru

DIPR/CP/3366/SMCL/2026-27

RFP for, SUPPLY, INSTALLATION, TESTING, COMMISSIONING, AND MAINTENANCE OF IT / ITES Items to be used for CAMPUS-WIDE WI-FI SOLUTION WITH COMPREHENSIVE AMC AT THE STATE SPORTS ACADEMY, RAJGIR FOR A PERIOD OF 03 YEARS

Govt. of Bihar

STATE SPORTS ACADEMY, RAJGIR

Islampur - Rajgir - Parwatipur Rd, Thera, Mahuwalla, Bihar 803117
Email: rajgirsportsacademy@gmail.com

RFP No.: **SSA/Tender/26-27/WIFI/448/26-27**

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

SSA invites Bids under two bid-basis, i.e. Technical Bid and Financial Bid from for 'SUPPLY, INSTALLATION, TESTING, COMMISSIONING, AND MAINTENANCE OF IT / ITES Items to be used for CAMPUS-WIDE WI-FI SOLUTION WITH COMPREHENSIVE AMC AT THE STATE SPORTS ACADEMY, RAJGIR FOR A PERIOD OF 03 YEARS.

Bidders have to download the Bid documents from the **https://ssarajgir.org/** Portal.

All Bidders are advised to see Amendments to RFP, if any, before submission of the bids. In case the Bidder does not submit the amended bids/amendments, it shall be presumed that Bidder has seen the amendments/Amended bids and bid shall be evaluated accordingly.

In case schedule date of submission / tender opening date are declared as holiday then tender shall be submitted/ opened on the very next working day on earlier schedule time.

SSA reserves the right to cancel the bid at any time or amend/withdraw any of the terms and conditions contained in the Bid Document without assigning any reason thereof.

All the communication to be made in hard copies at the office of
STATE SPORTS ACADEMY,RAJGIR
Islampur - Rajgir - Parwatipur Rd, Thera,
Mahuwalla, Bihar 803117
Website: **https://ssarajgir.org/**
Email: rajgirsportsacademy@gmail.com

• Tender Reference No.	• SSA/Tender/26-27/WIFI/448/26-27
• Period of Contract	• 03 Years
• Bid Security/ EMD (INR):	• Rs. 10,00,000/- (Rs. Ten Lakhs only)
• Date & time of Pre-Bid Meeting	• 04/11/2026, 13:00 hrs
• Last Date & Time for submission of Bids	• 25/11/2026, up to 13:00 hrs.
• Technical Bid Opening Date and Time	• 25/11/2026, up to 14:30 hrs.

Mithilesh Kumar
Assistant Director
State Sports Academy,Rajgir
Islampur - Rajgir - Parwatipur Rd, Thera
Mahuwalla, Bihar 803117

PR- 014409 (B & C) 2026-27

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
लोक स्वास्थ्य प्रमंडल, बिहारशरीफ

शुद्धि–पत्र–04

इस कार्यालय द्वारा आमंत्रित निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या–10/2026–27/O&M-PHED, जो P.R. No.-012149 (PHED) 2026-27, के माध्यम से दिनांक–24.09.2026 को दैनिक जागरण समाचार पत्र में प्रकाशित एवं जिसका प्रथम प्रथम शुद्धि पत्र, P.R. No.-013022 (PHED) 2026-27 के माध्यम से दिनांक–06.10.2026 को दैनिक सामाचार पत्र में प्रकाशित एवं द्वितीय शुद्धि पत्र P.R. No.-013497 (PHED) 2026-27, दिनांक–13.10.2026 को दैनिक सामाचार पत्र में प्रकाशित तथा तृतीय शुद्धि पत्र Adv. Id No. 209846 Dated 15.10.2026 है में निम्नांकित संशोधन किया जाता है:–

क्रम	विवरण	पूर्व निर्धारित तिथि	संशोधित (अवधि विस्तारित तिथि)
1	Period of sale (downloading) of tender Bid Document	30.09.2026 to 10.10.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs. through www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in	30.09.2026 to 31.10.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs. through www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
2	Date, time & place of pre-bid meeting	07.10.2026 at 12:00 hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer of concerned P. H. Division	28.10.2026 at 12:00 hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer of concerned P. H. Division
3	Last date and time of receipt (uploading) of tender	10.10.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in	31.10.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
4	Date and time of opening of technical bid	10.10.2026 at 15:30 Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.go v.in	31.10.2026 at 17:30 Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
5	Date and time of opening of financial bid	To be informed later after the approval of technical bid.	To be informed later after the approval of technical bid.

अन्य सभी प्रकाशित विवरणी एवं शर्त्तें पूर्ववत् है।
इस निविदा को उसी के अनुरूप संशोधित समझा जाय।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
लोक स्वास्थ्य प्रमंडल, बिहारशरीफ

PR- 014385 (PHED) 2026-27

विस्तृत जानकारी वेबसाइट//state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर देखा जा सकता है।

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

"IMPORTANT"

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ई–प्रोक्योरमेंट सेल, पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता विभाग,झारखण्ड, राँची

ई–प्रोक्योरमेंट अल्पकालीन निविदा (SBD)

Tender reference No-DWSD/Cluster/GIRIDIH-1/SBD/24/2026-27 (1st Call)
Dt. 26-10-2026

Sl No	Name of work	Cluster No.	Block	Estimate Cost (in Lakh)	Earnest money (in lakh)	Cost of BOQ (in Rs.)	Date of Completion
1	Implementation of Remaining Work under Cluster No. 25 for Single Village Water Supply Scheme under JJM in Block Jamua under DW&S Div. No.-1, Giridih for the year 2026-27	25	Jamua	370.33698	3.70337	10000.00	06 Months
2	वेबसाईट पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि	30-10-2026 at 02:00 P.M.					
3	निविदा प्राप्ति (ऑनलाईन बिडींग) की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	13-11-2026 at 02:00 P.M.					
4	सरकार के सचिव, सूचना प्रौद्योगिकी एवं ई–गवर्नेंस, झारखण्ड मंत्रालय के ज्ञापांक 120 दिनांक 03.10.2023 के आलोक में विपत्र का मूल्य एवं अग्रधन की राशि ऑनलाईन जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	13-11-2026 at 02:00 P.M.					
5	बिड खोलने की तिथि/समय	14-11-2026 at 2:00 P.M.					
6	निविदा प्रकाशित करने वाले कार्यालय का नाम एवं पता	कार्यपालक अभियंता, पेयजल एवं स्व0 प्रमंडल संख्या–1, गिरिडीह।					
7	प्रोक्योरमेंट पदाधिकारी का सम्पर्क संख्या	7782852739					
8	ई–प्रोक्योरमेंट सेल का हेल्पलाईन संख्या	0651-250731					

- किसी भी प्रकार का बदलाव http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।
- अन्य किसी भी प्रकार की सूचना http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।
- निविदा में प्राक्कलित राशि घट–बढ सकती है। तत्पश्चात अग्रधन की राशि मान्य होगी।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता प्र0 सं0–1,गिरिडीह

PR 392548 Drinking Water and Sanitation(26-27).D

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, KAITHAL	BEAUTIFICATION/RENOVATION OF MINI. SECRETARIAT BUILDING AT KAITHAL IN DISTRICT KAITHAL	CLOSING DATE 04.11.2026	931.17 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896320998 pwd-eepd-kaithal@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, KARNAL	STRENGTHENING WITH 50MM DBM PLUS 30MM BC ON RAIPUR TO LADWA ROAD (ROAD ID 7391) LENGTH 11.330 KM IN NILOKHERI CONSTITUENCY, IN KARNAL DISTRICT (UNDER WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27). + 1 WORKS	24.10.2026 13.11.2026	1252.81 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9876009311 pwd-eepd-karnal@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, JIND	SPECIAL REPAIR OF 3 NO. ROADS IN SAFIDON CONSTITUENCY IN JIND DISTT. (HON'BLE C.M. ANNOUNCEMENT CODE NO. 29887, 29888 AND 29891). 1. RETOLI TO AALANJOGI KHERA ROAD (ROAD ID 12500) 2. RODH TO LINK ROAD OF DERA BALBIR SINGH TO ASSANDH ROAD (ROAD ID 12502) 3. SARFABAD TO RANA KHERI ROAD (ROAD ID 12504)	CLOSING DATE 31.10.2026	170.95 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8398098075 pwdeepdjind@gmail.com
4	PWD B&R, FATEHABAD	SPECIAL REPAIR/STG. OF 02 NO. ROADS UNDER FATEHABAD CONSTITUENCY IN FATEHABAD DISTRICT (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) (GROUP-3) 1. PROVIDING BM PLUS PC ON FATEHABAD TO MAJRA ROAD KM. 0.65 TO 5.55 (ROAD ID 5587) 2. STRENGTHENING ON BISLA MAJRA ROAD TO DHANGER KM. 0.00 TO 4.17 (ROAD ID 9045)	23.10.2026 02.11.2026	470.88 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01667-220120 pwd-eepd-fatehabad@hry.nic.in
5	PWD B&R, FATEHABAD	IMPROVEMENT OF ROAD FROM TOHANA DHARSUL RATIA TO STATE BORDER ROAD (RATIA TO STATE BORDER) (MDR-101) KM 34.15 TO 57.98 (ID NO. 5468) IN FATEHABAD DISTT. UNDER NABARD SCHEME (WITHOUT GST)	23.10.2026 16.11.2026	1858.62 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01667-220120 pwd-eepd-fatehabad@hry.nic.in
6	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, SIRSA	RANIA TOWN:- REPLACEMENT / UPGRADATION OF EQUIPMENT`S AND ELECTRIC ITEMS I.E. AIR BLOWER, FLOW METER, ONLINE ANALYZER, PROVIDING AND INSTALLATION OF SCADA AND ALL OTHER WORKS CONTINGENTS THERETO AT 6 MLD STP RANIA TOWN, DISTT. SIRSA	22.10.2026 29.10.2026	55.52 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666221925 ee2sirsa@gmail.com
7	HORTICULTURE C.S.T.F. LADWA,KURUKSHETRA	TO PROVIDE MANPOWER FOR ROUTINE DAILY TASKS IN FRUIT PLANT NURSERY AND ORCHARDS	21.10.2026 12.11.2026	1 LACS	hortharyana.gov.in	7988103898 cstfladwa@gmail.com
7	CIVIL HOSPITAL, PANCHKULA	OUTSOURCING OF PEST AND RODENT SERVICES	27.10.2026 14.11.2026	EMD 50000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0172-2562199 establishmentpmo1@gmail.com
8	CIVIL HOSPITAL, PANCHKULA	PARKING SERVICES	27.10.2026 14.11.2026	EMD 50000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0172-2562199 establishmentpmo1@gmail.com
9	DIRECTOR GENERAL, HORTICULTURE,DEPARTMENT HARYANA, PANCHKULA	CONSTRUCTION OF HYDROPONIC DEMONSTRATION UNIT AT VARIOUS CENTRES GGNS OF HORTICULTURE DEPARTMENT HARYANA	28.10.2026 27.11.2026	EMD 2 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9465081197 HDOPN12@GMAIL.COM
11	HORTICULTURE, IHDC, HODAL(PALWAL)	REGARDING PUBLIC NOTICE FOR E-TENDER (GOODS & SERVICES) "RATE CONTRACT FOR MENIAL WORKS FOR VEGETABLES SEEDLING PRODUCTION AND OTHER CENTRE WORKS ON JOB ROLE BASIS" AT IHDC, HODAL (PALWAL) FOR THE YEAR 2026-27.	29.10.2026 09.11.2026	20,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	7015157607 ddhihdchodal@gmail.com
12	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, KARNAL	CONSTRUCTION OF BALANCE WORK OF ESCAPE REGULATOR-CUM-DRAINAGE CROSSING AT KM 21.200 OF AUGMENTATION CANAL. + 2 WORKS	24.10.2026 06.11.2026	1851.32 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0184-2258008 xeninddivn@yahoo.in
13	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, KARNAL	BALANCE WORK OF REMODELING OF AUGMENTATION CANAL FROM REACH RD KM 58.665 TO 70.000. + 2 WORKS	24.10.2026 06.11.2026	1034.92 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0184-2255291 knldivn335@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50544/HR

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
चतुर्थ वृत्त, लोक निर्माण विभाग, रुद्रपुर (ऊधम सिंह नगर)

Phone-9756930039 E-mail- sepwdusn@gmail.com

पत्रांक– 2526/23 एम–04/2026 दिनांक 27/10/2026

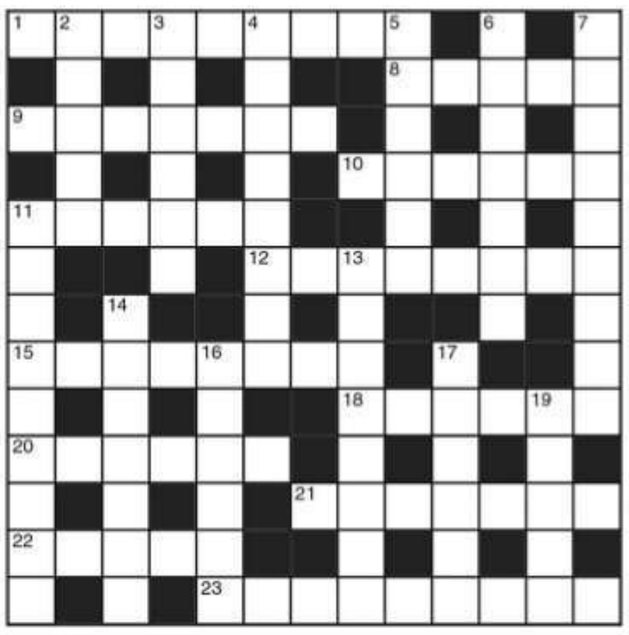
राष्ट्रीय प्रतिस्पर्धात्मक ई–निविदा (e-tendering)

महामहिम राज्यपाल उत्तराखण्ड की ओर से अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, चतुर्थ वृत्त, लो०नि०वि० रूद्रपुर (ऊधम सिंह नगर) द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्यों हेतु ई–टेण्डरिंग द्वारा टू–बिड बिड सिस्टम के अन्तर्गत निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा से सम्बन्धित सभी सूचनायें वेबसाईट **http://www.uktenders.gov.in** पर दिनांक 06.11.2026 से उपलब्ध होंगी।

क्र० सं०	कार्य का नाम	धरोहर धनराशि (लाख में)	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य (रू० में)	निविदा की वैधता (दिवस)	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	ठेकेदार की श्रेणी
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1.	राज्य योजना के अन्तर्गत जनपद ऊधमसिंह नगर के विधानसभा क्षेत्र खटीमा में मेलाघाट मेन रोड से बग्घा कालोनी होते हुए मयूर विहार सेक्टर 2, 3. वार्ड नं0 09 शीर्ष मार्ग का इण्टरलॉकिंग टाईल्स द्वारा मार्ग का पुर्ननिर्माण कार्य।	5.01	5000.00 + 18% GST	90 दिन	12 माह	राज्य सरकार के विभाग एंव उपक्रम में मार्ग कार्य हेतु श्रेणी C एवं उच्चतर में पंजीकृत ।
2.	मा० मुख्यमंत्री घोषणा संख्या 331/2021 के अन्तर्गत जनपद ऊधमसिंह नगर के विधान सभा क्षेत्र नानकमत्ता के अन्तर्गत नौगवाठग्गु चन्देली सम्पर्क मार्ग पर लोहिया नदी में पुल का निर्माण कार्य। (स्वीकृति की प्रत्याशा में)	9.13	5000.00 + 18% GST	90 दिन	18 माह	राज्य सरकार के विभाग एंव उपक्रम में सेतु कार्य हेतु श्रेणी A एवं उच्चतर में पंजीकृत ।
3.	मा० मुख्यमंत्री घोषणा संख्या 142/2025 के अन्तर्गत ग्राम प्रतापपुर में खाद गोदाम से तलवार फार्म होते हुए वकील फार्म तक 6.00 कि०मी० हॉट मिक्स रोड निर्माण। (स्वीकृति की प्रत्याशा में)	6.30	5000.00 + 18% GST	90 दिन	12 माह	राज्य सरकार के विभाग एंव उपक्रम में मार्ग कार्य हेतु श्रेणी B एव उच्चतर में पंजीकृत ।

हस्ता./–
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

• CROSSWORD 6131



ACROSS

1 One in the club takes Tom out for food (9)
8 Rascal with a strange love urge (5)
9 Music hall medley (7)
10 Time when the hands come together (6)
11 Magician produces a bird (6)
12 Late find wildly exaggerated (8)
15 An enclosed place might be costlier (8)
18 Move that shortens the game a little? (6)
20 Toiler disposed to belie his nature (6)
21 Left in a state of wretchedness or very near (7)
22 Point to weak track of an animal (5)
23 A theatrical entrance (5,4)

DOWN

2 Saw notice on time (5)
3 Be idle perhaps but ready to eat (6)
4 Specialist in the construction of tin boats (8)
5 A scoop for the gardening correspondent? (6)
6 Nimbleness of soldier in Italy on manoeuvres (7)
7 Protect a worker who is accused (9)
11 Lacking a game to play - or rivals (9)
13 Doing without because working (8)
14 Computer screen helps teachers (7)
16 Cattle drives (6)
17 Threaten a devil with something conclusive (6)
19 See! I go round a house in the north (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6130 ACROSS: 1 Getaway, 4 Floor, 7 Turn, 8 Assuages, 10 Shake hands, 12 Sherry, 13 Capone, 15 Schooldays, 18 Partaken, 19 Tail, 20 Dowse, 21 Trinket DOWN: 1 Gates, 2 Threaten, 3 Yes-man, 4 Found fault, 5 Orgy, 6 Respite, 9 Depreciate, 11 Tomahawk, 12 Slipped, 14 Honest, 16 Split, 17 Draw

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

God, give me courage to do what I can, humility to admit what I can't, and wisdom to know the ____. - B. J. Gupta (10)

IREEE

EETTCD

PTINR

DERUFF

SOLUTIONS: Eerie, Print, Detect, Duffer / Ruffed
ANSWER: God, give me courage to do what I can, humility to admit what I can't, and wisdom to know the **difference**. - B. J. Gupta

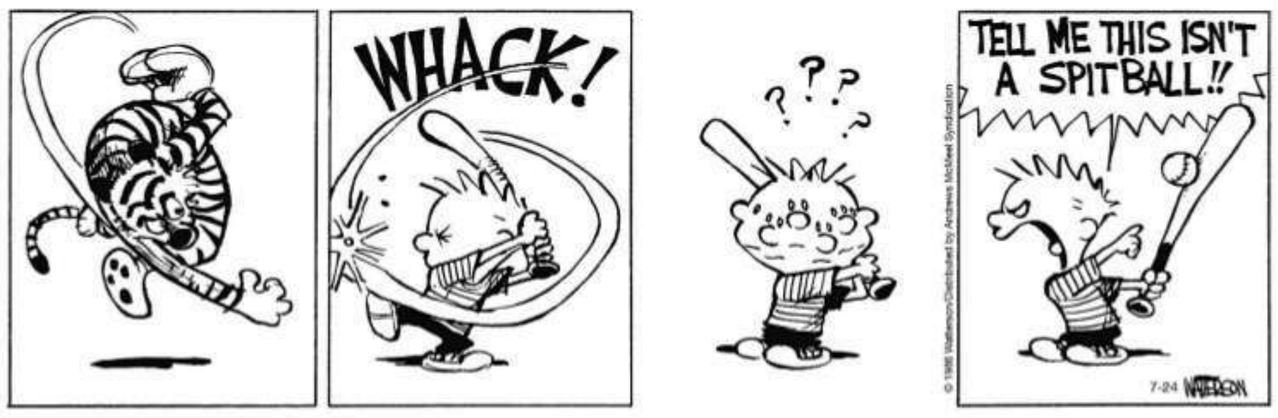
• OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS



• CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON



• MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG



SUDOKU 6485

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s
INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

7				6				8
	4					7		
3		9	2		5	6		4
		5	9		2	1		
1								9
		7	8		3	2		
5		8	7		1	4		3
	1						8	
6				2				1

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6484

2	4	3	6	1	7	8	5	9
6	7	5	2	8	9	3	4	1
9	1	8	3	4	5	6	2	7
5	9	4	8	2	6	7	1	3
3	2	6	5	7	1	9	8	4
1	8	7	9	3	4	5	6	2
7	5	1	4	6	3	2	9	8
8	3	9	1	5	2	4	7	6
4	6	2	7	9	8	1	3	5

• ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Your daily routine might change today. In fact, pay extra attention to everything you say and do to avoid accidents. Nevertheless, today you're mentally alert and charged with energy that might display itself in a practical way. Tonight: Learn something new.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Keep an eye on your money and possessions to avoid loss, theft or damage today. On the upside, you might have clever moneymaking ideas, and make home improvements. Tonight: Maintain your belongings.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Today the Moon is in your sign lined up with Uranus, which might cause sudden changes in your mood and impulsive actions. Someone older might have advice for you. Tonight: You're strong,

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): You might feel restless today. Don't worry, because discussions with an authority figure might directly or indirectly lead to your ability to boost your earnings either now or in the future. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): You might meet someone unusual today. Practical ideas related to publishing, higher education, medicine and the law look doable, especially because you have the diligence and perseverance to make something happen. Tonight: Friendships.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Stay on your toes today, because an authority figure might suddenly surprise you. Relax, they also might simply say or do something you least expect. Make solid plans about inheritances, taxes, debt and shared property. Tonight: Be modest.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): You might suddenly travel today or travel plans might change. You might learn something new or explore unexpected opportunities. A discussion with a partner, spouse or friend will yield practical results. Tonight: Explore and learn.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Double-check details related to banking, shared property, or inheritances. Something unexpected might happen. Count on the support you need to do things. Tonight: Check your finances.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): You might want more freedom in your closest relationships today. Or perhaps your partner wants more freedom. You might have practical discussions about kids, social occasions or sports. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Pet owners should be extra vigilant today. Meanwhile, your work routine might be interrupted by something unexpected. You might do something to solidify your home. Tonight: Work.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Parents should be extra vigilant today because this could be an accident-prone day for your kids. Meanwhile, social plans might suddenly change. Tonight: Socialise.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Your home routine might be interrupted today. Small appliances might break down or a minor breakage could occur. You've got lots of energy to work and be productive. When it comes to financial matters, you'll be practical. Tonight: Relax at home.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (i) Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Arjun S/o** Mukesh Kumar **R/o** H.No. 186, Gali No. 5, Nala Road Balbir Nagar Ext. Shahdara, Delhi, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 368/2025 U/s 281/125(B)345(3) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita & 3/181/39/192/146/196,66/192A MV Act**., has been registered at **PS: Jyoti Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Arjun** namely cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Arjun** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Arjun** of under **FIR No. 368/2025 U/s 281/125(B)345(3) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita & 3/181/39/192/146/196,66/192A MV Act**., Registred at: **PS: Jyoti Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.12.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Rahul Saini
Ld, JMFC-08, Room No. G-6
Karkardooma Courts, Shahdara Delhi

DP/15454/NE/2026
(Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Dharmender S/o:** Jag Ram **R/o**: H. No. 43 Rizak Ram Park, Behind RR Dharam Kanta Balmiki Mohalla V.P.O Rani Khera Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 288/2005 U/S: 506(2)34 IPC, PS: Kanjhawala, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Dharmender,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Dharmender,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Dharmender,** of **FIR No. 288/2005 U/S: 506(2)34 IPC, PS: Kanjhawala, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.11.2026**.

By Order
Apoorv Bhardwaj
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
Room No.113
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/15480/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

विश्वेश्वरय्या राष्ट्रीय प्रौद्योगिकी संस्थान, नागपुर-440 010 (भारत)
VISVESVARAYA NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, NAGPUR-440010.

EMPANELMENT OF BOOK VENDORS

Applications are invited from eligible publishers, booksellers and authorised distributors for empanelment for the supply of books to the VNIT Library, Nagpur. Details of the terms and conditions, application form and annexures are available on the Institute's website: **https://vnit.ac.in/library-and-information-center/** Interested firms are requested to submit their applications along with all requisite documents on or before **12.11.2026, by 5:00 PM.**

REGISTRAR

ARMY PUBLIC SCHOOL, DHAULA KUAN
RIDGE ROAD DHAULA KUAN-110010

TENDER NOTICE FOR SECURITY SERVICES

Sealed tenders are invited from leading firms with professional expertise for providing Security Services to Army Public School, Dhaula Kuan. Firms with past experience in providing required services and having Registration No, EPF Code, ESI Code, GST Code etc may contact school office between 9:00 a.m to 15:00 p.m. on any working day for collection of tender forms costing Rs 500/- between 28 Oct 2026 to 12 Nov 2026. Last date for submission of tender form is on 14 Nov 2026 by 1100 hrs. For any queries contact school on **011-25693131.**

Principal, APS, Dhaula Kuan

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited

Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN: U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Procurement of Boiler Tubes Protection Shiels which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1 **Tender Enquiry No. 212/GATP/MMD/BOILER/20018401**
"Procurement of Boiler Tubes Protection Shiels used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib" at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 27/10/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

No. 16549/PB GATP-109/26

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

No: - 128-W/Sr.DEN-C/NIT-19-2026-27/WC **Dated: 26.10.2026**

The Divisional Track, Northern Railway, Delhi Division for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender on prescribed form for the following work.

Invitation of tender through E- Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

1	Name of work with its location	Flash butt welding for conversion of loop lines of SWR/ LWR of 60 kg rails by using Rail cum road mobile flash butt welding plant in situ or on cess in Delhi Division. (NIT-19-2026-27-WC)
2	Approx cost of work	Rs. 6,73,33,736.26/-
3	Earnest money	Rs. 13,46,700.00/-
4	Date and Starting time for filling e-tender & Tender opening time	Starting time for filling e-tender is Date - 03.11.2026 at 15:00 hrs. & Tender opening time is Date - 18.11.2026 at 15:00 hrs instead of 06.11.2026
5	Website particulars, published e-tender, notice location etc. complete details of tender can be seen and web site where the tender form can be downloaded	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3729/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Namely: **Pappu @ Sonu, S/o. Sh. Dulla Ram, R/o. Lajpat Nagar Red Light and Permanent Adress: Village Ram Nagar, Distt Tonk, Rajasthan** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.853/2015 U/S 174A IPC** registered at **P.S Maurya Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Pappu @ Sonu** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Pappu @ Sonu** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Pappu @ Sonu**, accused of **FIR No.853/2015 U/S 174A IPC** registered at **P.S Maurya Enclave, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.12.2026.**

By Order, Ms. Anuradha Jindal,
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
North West Court No. 101,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/15405/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Shahnaj W/o** Rahman **R/o** H. No. E-1110, JJ Colony Bawana Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 249/2020, Date 17/05/2020, U/S: 33/58 DELHI EXCISE ACT, PS: Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Shahnaj,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Shahnaj,** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Shahnaj,** of **FIR No. 249/2020, Date 17/05/2020, U/S: 33/58 DELHI EXCISE ACT, PS: Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.12.2026**.

By Order
Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
North, Court No. 6, Ground Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/15353/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Rajpal** S/o Babulal, R/o Jhuggi No. B-215, H-4, N-30, Jahangir Puri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 197/2019 U/s 279/338 IPC, PS Jahangir Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Rajpal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rajpal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Rajpal** in **FIR No. 197/2019 U/s 279/338 IPC, PS Jahangir Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.12.2026**.

By order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class -07
North, Court No. 6, Ground Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/15223/NW/2026

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited

Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN:U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Procurement of Hot Air Control Dampers used in Mills of 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1 **Tender Enquiry No. 210/GATP/MMD/BOILER/20018313**
"Procurement of Hot Air Control Dampers used in Mills of 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib" at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 27/10/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

No. 16545/PB GATP-107/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Asif S/o Mohd. Rajit R/o AAM Baghichi, Jhuggi C-Block, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 255/2019 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Asif** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Asif** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Asif** of case **FIR No. 255/2019 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.12.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
North, Court No. 6, Ground Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/15450/ON/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Varinder Pal Singh, S/o**: Lt. Bhoopinder Singh, **R/o:** H.No. B-102, Uday Vihar, Gali No. 2, Chander Vihar, Delhi-41 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 478/2026 U/s 21(B) NDPS Act, P.S.: Nihal Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Varinder Pal Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Varinder Pal Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Varinder Pal Singh** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 478/2026 U/s 21(B) NDPS Act, P.S.: Nihal Vihar, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.11.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Shailender Malik
Addl. Sessions Judge/Special Judge
(NDPS) West District
Room No. 209, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/15465/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Aarif S/o Nawab R/o Village Tarapuri Madhavpuram Bass Wali Gali Brahampuri Merrut U.P.** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case FIR No. 014093/2019 U/s 379/411 IPC PS: IP Estate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Aarif** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Aarif** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Aarif** accused of **FIR No. 014093/2019 U/s 379/411 IPC PS: IP Estate, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.12.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Preeti
JMFC-03, Room No. 150
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/15384/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited

Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN: U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Procurement of ESP Spares of 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1 **Tender Enquiry No. 211/GATP/MMD/BOILER/20018305**
"Procurement of ESP Spares of 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib" at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt. Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 27/10/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

No. 16547/PB GATP-108/26



Auqib Nabi played a starring role in India A's near win. PTI

India A one wicket short as Heaphy's 90 saves NZ A

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 27

INDIA A needed one more wicket in Lincoln, but couldn't get it. New Zealand A finished the first unofficial Test on 187/9 after 65 overs, and the match was drawn when the umpires' light meter called a halt. Curtis Heaphy was unbeaten on 90 off 187 balls and with Jayden Lennox, he saw off the last nine and a half overs. Auqib Nabi had taken three for 28 early on, leaving the hosts 13/3.

Set a target of 313, New Zealand's Rhys Mariu survived a first-ball LBW appeal as the umpire perhaps thought it would have swung down the legside. In his next over, Auqib got the ball to move in sharply from outside off again, this time off the pitch, to breach the defences of Mariu.

Auqib struck again before the over was out, with another nipbacker to trap Tim Robinson in front of leg stump. In his next over, the fifth of the innings and his third, Auqib went round the stumps to slant a length delivery back into left-hander Matthew Boyle. It skidded on, a touch low, to disturb the stumps.

A partnership ensued between opener Heaphy and Dean Foxcroft, with both looking to be as positive as they could be.

India A then placed a short midwicket and a square-leg for Foxcroft for left-handed seamer Mukesh Choudhary, who bounced him. Foxcroft went for the pull and connected rather well, but it rocketed straight to square-leg where Yash Rathod took a sharp chance. India A continued to be sharp on the field as Devdutt Padikkal moved sprightly to his left at extra cover to take a good diving catch to dismiss Kristian Clarke off Washington Sundar.

Late drama

NZ A entered the final session needing 181 runs with four wickets intact. Mukesh tried the short-ball tactic to Heaphy, who dismissed it with a couple of lovely pulls to the boundary.

As things began to enter a sort of stalemate, India brought on Padikkal, who got two wickets in three overs. The batters played for non-existent spin and his slanted deliveries took the edge to slip, where KL Rahul held both catches. Akash Deep returned to take out the stumps of Simon Keene to leave NZ A 170/9.

BRIEF SCORES: India A 113 & 516 drew with New Zealand A 317 & 187/9 (Curtis Heaphy 90 not out; Auqub Nabi 3/28, Devdutt Padikkal 2/11)

NEW ZEALAND VS INDIA: THIRD T20I

Abhishek, Vaibhav showcase T20 batting from the future

Punjab batsman and wunderkind break records; India win with 40 balls to spare, take 3-0 series lead

Sandip G
New Delhi, October 27



Abhishek Sharma reached a half-century in just 15 deliveries and finished with 113 runs from 38 balls in India's runaway victory. CREIMAS

CRICKET'S FUTURE gleamed from the contents of the India-New Zealand match at Wellington's Hnry Stadium: Abhishek Sharma and Vaibhav Sooryavanshi plundered 133 runs in just 7.1 overs; India chased down 199 with 40 balls and six wickets to spare to seal the five-match T20I series at the first opportunity; a batsman reached 50 in 15 balls and 100 in 35; a 15-year-old tore apart men twice his age; a free-spirited phenom made bowlers curse and question their existence.

The match was a vision of how the sport would be over the next decade, or the one after, where T20 might have delinked fully from its parent sport and stood as a singular, autonomous sport.

A script from fiction unfolded. The contest was effectively over after three searing overs as 64 runs were ransacked in 18 deliveries. Runs arrived in a blur of limbs and hits.

Sooryavanshi set the tone, thumping the first ball of the chase from Jacob Duffy over the mid-on fielder to the fence. The teenager was playing his seventh international game; Duffy was until recently the highest-ranked T20I bowler. But adults sigh when they are lost for words to describe a youngster's bravado: "Well, kids these days!"

Bowlers would now stop looking at the fresh-faced batsman like a teenager. Rather, they wouldn't spare any tactic to get him out.

Third ball, Sooryavanshi slapped Duffy over point. The shot was a triumph of game awareness. After a slew of full and good length balls, he knew Duffy would go short or short of length. So he waited and flashed his hands at the ball.

Duffy let out a loud sigh of relief as Abhishek took guard for the final ball of the first over. He, or New Zealand's bowlers, had little premonition that they were stepping from hellfire to an inferno. Abhishek backed away and swung the ball over extra cover - a characteristic stroke, facilitated by quick hands, imperious bat-swing and glorious balance at the crease. He smiled at Sooryavanshi, the smile of a man who knew the night would be his.

Often with Abhishek, it's the first shot that indicates his mood and touch. He loves to charge or back away straight-away; he has hit several first-ball sixes. But this was arguably the sweetest of his first-ball sixes. Everything was in place, fleetness of feet, lightness of hands, clarity of thought, belief, and the agility of impulses.

The grisly Adam Milne laid a snare in his first bout with Abhishek. He placed a deep point and packed the ring on the off-side. He bowled the full ball that angled away. There was only a modicum of width to free his arms. Most batsmen would have looked to tap the ball to third man, or even leave it. An aerial shot carried risk. But Abhishek was unhindered, and let his arms through the ball and sent it flying over the fielder's left.

• Mayhem in 6 overs

118

• India's total in the Powerplay in their third match vs NZ — the highest in men's T20 internationals.

Milne went back of length next ball, and was creamed over cover. The next ball was smeared through cover point. New Zealand captain Mitchell Santner employed the match-up trick that has troubled him in the past, summoning off-spinner Michael Bracewell.

But Abhishek manufactured room by backing away and fleeced him through cover, his favourite piece of real estate on a cricket ground. He hit a six and four more, and left two balls for Sooryavanshi to flog the dead horse. The Bracewell ploy was sensible, but not the length. Abhishek murders anything short or on a good length. It's the off-spinner's full-length ball, which drifts and drops, that torments him.

No contest

A whiff of resignation floated among the Kiwis. The total of 198 seemed competitive, although they were 20 runs short, thanks to India's bowlers sneaking in a tidy over or two in the middle overs and at the death.

Prince Yadav produced a stingy last over, just nine runs without a boundary. Bhuvneshwar Kumar allowed only nine runs in the 18th; as did Arshdeep Singh, who bowled the previous over. Despite wickets in hand and set batsmen Daryl Mitchell (89*) and Bevon Jacobs (39*) , the hosts only managed 42 in the last four overs. Axar Patel fought back after being hit for 14 runs in his first over. He conceded only 22 in his next three.

Still, New Zealand would not have foreseen a carnage of this savage proportion. Abhishek and Sooryavanshi completed their century stand in the fifth over. When the Powerplay ended, the score read 118 for no loss, the highest by any side including Associate nations, in this format. Sooryavanshi perished five runs short of the 50-mark. Abhishek, though, converted his 15-ball half-century into a 35-ball ton, his fourth.

He departed for 113 (38 balls!), and soon after the ball began to misbehave a trifle. Shreyas Iyer and Sanju Samson found it a different wicket and staggered. "When Sanju and I went to bat, the ball was swinging and seaming, and I was like, 'how did they manage this!' the skipper wondered.

But when Sooryavanshi and Abhishek batted, there was only one distinct swing. The sweet swing of the bat, in a match from the future.

BRIEF SCORES: New Zealand 198/3 in 20 overs (Daryl Mitchell 89 not out, Finn Allen 40; Arshdeep Singh 1/33) lost to India 199/4 in 13.2 overs (Abhishek Sharma 113, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi 45; Kyle Jamieson 2/45) by six wickets

THREE CHASES, THREE WAYS: HOW INDIA WON THE NZ T20IS

Sanju's Powerplay, Tilak's late burst and Abhishek's 35-ball hundred each decided a different win. India's chasing is not built on one method.

THE greatness of a team lies not only in racking up victories, but in winning differently and involving different protagonists. All three wins share some themes: India's efficiency in chasing, the flying starts in the powerplay, Naman Dhir's cameos, and the belief that they could pull themselves out of any deep hole. But dig beneath, and the many shades of the team emerge. All three chases were completed in different ways, which shows their flexibility and their mastery of varied conditions. The destination was the same each time. The paths were not.



Sanju starts, Dhir finishes

The decks in New Zealand were supposed to shackle India's free-scoring openers. It was not to be. The hosts compiled 225, and the ball swung devilishly in the first two overs. But **Sanju Samson** and Abhishek Sharma counterpunched, striking 93 runs in 5.4 overs. Sanju breezed to his half-century from 23 balls, cutting out risk by sticking to his percentage shots. Seamers, unless they erred, were hit down the ground in the conventional arc between cover and midwicket. The spinners were slugged through midwicket. The powerplay launch proved its worth in hindsight, because the pitch became drier and the spinners began to strangle India's batters. When Sanju departed for 67, dragging Mitchell Santner's delivery onto the stumps, India stuttered momentarily. But Shreyas Iyer strung together his most important knock in recent times and Naman Dhir wielded the long handle to good effect. Dhir might never have walked in under more pressure, but cricketers arrive readymade, forged in the IPL fire. He showed his wares with a 15-ball 42.



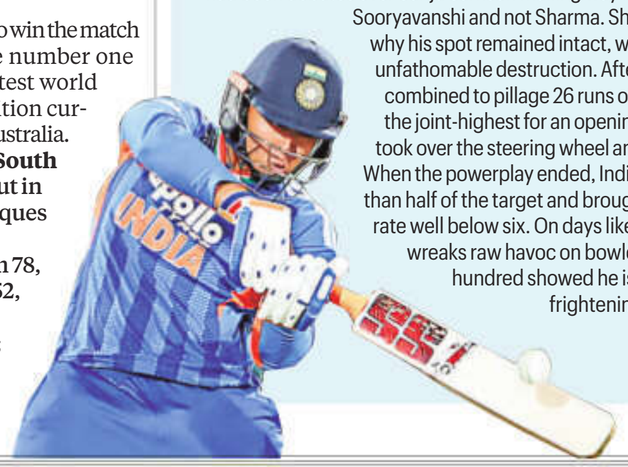
Middle-order muscle and magic

Like Australia in their years of dominance in the longer formats, India could never be written off. On a sluggish surface, against an innocuously guileful Mitchell Santner, India withered. The left-arm spinner's two-wicket over left them reeling: five men down, 110 runs needed from 54 balls. A difficult task, but **Tilak Varma** had willed himself to win. Batting down the order is an acquired craft rather than a natural calling for the batter from Hyderabad. But he has made a habit of winning games from the brink. He scraped and scratched at the start of the knock, but when the contest reached boiling point, he blew hot. With surgical authority, he whipped up 42 runs from 16 balls, after mustering only nine from the first 10. Naman Dhir and Nitish Kumar Reddy were able accomplices, contributing 57 runs off 30 balls combined on a pitch where the ball was not always the batter's best friend. The win, off the penultimate ball, showed that India are not top-heavy, nor always reliant on the top three. The lower middle order has both muscle and magic to win games.

Openers of destruction

The jostling to open the innings is intense. There are at least half a dozen competent openers waiting for a break. This time it was **Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's** turn. He crunched 45 off 19 balls. But the headline belonged to his senior partner, Abhishek Sharma. There had been debates over Sanju Samson making way for Sooryavanshi and not Sharma. Sharma proved why his spot remained intact, with a knock of unfathomable destruction. After they combined to pillage 26 runs off the first over, the joint-highest for an opening over, Sharma took over the steering wheel and zipped away. When the powerplay ended, India had cut more than half of the target and brought the required rate well below six. On days like these he wreaks raw havoc on bowlers. A 35-ball hundred showed he is the most frightening T20 opener.

SANDIP G



Starc 'problem solves', strikes late as Australia fight back

Reuters
Cape Town, October 27

MARQUES ACKERMAN scored a career-best 95 for South Africa and Australia fast bowler Mitchell Starc took 6-72 as the hosts were bowled out for 329 on a seesaw first day of the decisive third Test at Newlands on Tuesday.

Australia will bat on the second morning after Starc ran through the South African tail with the new ball and the home side let a commanding position slip. "We probably expected more out of the wicket, it was not our best start and South Africa took advantage," Starc told reporters.

"(The wicket) was quite slow, with a tennis ball type bounce. We had to reassess at lunch, problem solve and find a way to be effective. The last two sessions for us went well.

The home side were fast out the blocks as Ackerman and Aiden Markram put on 158 in 31.4 overs for the first wicket in a dosplay of attacking intent.

Approaching his maiden century in his second test, however, Ackerman had a rush of blood to the head as he charged down the wicket at spinner Nathan Lyon (2-71) and was stumped.



Mitchell Starc took 6 wickets. AP

It was not only a rash shot that denied him a century, but the catalyst for a collapse as South Africa lost six wickets for the addition of 74 runs, several to poor shots.

Markram (78) and David Bedingham (50) were caught on the boundary attempting pulls, and Wiaan Mulder was caught behind by wicketkeeper Alex Carey playing the same shot as Australia employed an effective short-ball plan.

Ryan Rickelton (42) and Marco Jansen (52) put on 95 for the seventh wicket to edge South Africa ahead again before both were removed in the same over by Starc.

He also took the wickets of Gerald Coetzee and Kagiso Rabada to end the innings just before the scheduled close of play.

The series is level at 1-1 after Australia won the first test by 214 runs in Durban and South Africa responded with a victory by an innings and 31 runs in Gqeberha.

The team who win the match will occupy the number one position in the test world rankings, a position currently held by Australia.

BRIEF SCORES: South Africa 329 all out in 82.3 overs (Marques Ackerman 95, Aiden Markram 78, Marco Jansen 52, David Bedingham 50; Starc 6/72) vs Australia

• CHESS SURVEY

Figures of gender bias, harassment are concerning: FIDE women's panel chair

Amit Kamath
Mumbai, October 27

EARLIER THIS month, the international chess federation (FIDE) released results of a first-ever survey conducted on women in the sport. The survey threw up concerning data about sexual harassment and gender bias that players, arbiters, coaches and federation officials said they had experienced. 672 female respondents linked to chess from 127 national federations took the survey this year. India was the largest contributing federation with 69 respondents, or over 10%.

The survey included responses from 133 FIDE-titled players, including 10 Women Grand Masters, 27 Women International Masters, 49 Women FIDE Masters and 43 Women Candidate Masters. According to the survey, 76% of respondents reported at least one form of discrimination or harassment, while 38% conveyed that they had experienced online abuse or harassment. It also showed that 63% of women and girls experienced gender bias in chess settings, and 38% reported sexual harassment or inappropriate behaviour. Tris-Ann Richards, chair of the FIDE Commission for Women's Chess, spoke to *The Indian Express* on Monday, about the survey — called "FIDE Women in Chess Representation, Participation and Development Survey".



PHOTO: FIDE

EXPRESS interview | TRIS-ANN RICHARDS, CHAIR OF FIDE COMMISSION FOR WOMEN'S CHESS

What led the FIDE Women in Chess Commission to undertake this survey?

Tris-Ann Richards: The decision to undertake this survey was driven by the need to better understand the experiences, challenges and barriers faced by women and girls in chess globally. To hear directly from women and girls themselves, rather than relying on assumptions or second-hand accounts.

I believe that meaningful and sustainable progress must be informed by evidence. By listening directly to women and girls across different countries, age groups and levels of participation, we can better identify the issues that need to be addressed and develop targeted, practical solutions. This survey represents an important step towards building a more inclusive, equitable and safer chess environment.

How alarming are these numbers?

Tris-Ann Richards: The figures are concerning; however, I believe it is important that we do not look at these findings solely as alarming statistics. They represent real experiences of women and girls who are part of our chess community. It is also important to recognise that the issues identified are not unique to chess, but reflect broader challenges that women face across other sports, in the workplace and in society as a whole.

At the same time, the findings present an opportunity for meaningful change. Bringing these experiences to light is an essential first step towards addressing them. The objective is not to portray chess negatively, but to acknowledge the reality of these challenges and work collectively to ensure that no woman or girl has to endure discrimination or harassment as the price of participating.

What mechanisms or safeguards currently exist for female players to report incidents of discrimination or harassment?

Tris-Ann Richards: There are existing mechanisms within the broader chess governance structure through which concerns can be raised, including the relevant national federations, tournament organisers and arbiters, as well as applicable FIDE disciplinary and ethics procedures. However, the availability, accessibility and effectiveness of these mechanisms can vary depending on the circumstances and the jurisdiction involved.

One of the important issues highlighted by the survey is the need to ensure that reporting mechanisms are clear, accessible, confidential and trusted by those who need to use them. And that is the value of the FIDE Commission for Women's Chess: we have the opportunity to work within FIDE to help create a better chess environment for all women and girls. We recognise that existing mechanisms need to be strengthened.

Could the percentages have been higher, considering that the report focuses on active women in chess and that responses from U18s required guardian consent?

Tris-Ann Richards: Yes, it is possible that the figures could have been higher if women who had already left chess were included. Some women may withdraw from the sport because of negative experiences, and their perspective is important to understanding the full extent of the problem. The survey provides valuable evidence about the experiences of its respondents, but it cannot establish the prevalence of these experiences among every woman or girl who has participated in chess.

Similarly, requiring guardian consent for respondents under 18 was an important ethical safeguard. Nevertheless, it is possible that some young people who had relevant experiences did not participate because of the additional consent requirements. Ultimately, this survey should be viewed as a starting point rather than the final word.

England's Kane pips Mbappe, Yamal to win Ballon d'Or



Harry Kane is the first England men's footballer to win the Ballon d'Or in 25 years. AP

Reuters
London, October 27

HARRY KANE completed his long quest for football's highest individual honour on Monday, the Bayern Munich and England striker winning the Ballon d'Or after a record-breaking season that cemented his status as one of the game's greatest goalscorers.

Kane was the first Englishman to win the prestigious award since Michael Owen in 2001. "Wow, wow, wow!" Kane said after taking the stage. "I am almost speechless. Being here in London has made it extra special. Made it a good omen for me tonight. Thank you to everyone who voted for me. I can imagine it was tough this year.

"Some world-class players in the room tonight. Congratulations to all the winners and nominees tonight and impressive showing determination and hard work can really achieve."

Spain midfielder Alexia Putellas won the Ballon d'Or Feminin for the third time.

Kane's move to Bayern in 2023 brought the team trophies that had long eluded him. The England captain was prolific last season, scoring 61 goals in 51 games for Bayern across all competitions as the German side completed a domestic league and cup double.

Kane was Europe's leading goalscorer but his influence stretched far beyond club football. He netted six goals at the World Cup and captained England to the semi-finals, combining his clinical finishing with the leadership and composure that have defined his career. The award represented the culmination of his journey. Few players have experienced a career arc quite like Kane's, and he thanked all of his coaches in an emotional speech, plus Tottenham Hotspur and his wife Kate.

Once struggling to establish himself at Spurs as a youngster, being sent out on numerous loans, he developed into one of the most complete centre forwards of his generation, capable of scoring every type of goal as well as operating as a playmaker.

"It's about the journey," Kane said. "Anything is possible, work hard when nobody is watching."

A FIRST FOR INDIA WOMEN AT WORLD C'SHIPS

2 Kajal (76kg) and Neelam (50kg) qualified for the final; first time two India wrestlers in line for gold.

1 Anshu Malik was the only woman from India to reach the finals of the Worlds. Until today.

3 Kajal's opponent Aiperi Medet Kyzy has won three medals at the Worlds (two silvers, one bronze)

2026 WRESTLING WORLD CHAMPIONSHIPS

Kajal, 18, on brink of world title

76kg wrestler from Sonipat, still a teen, came back from 1-7 down in the semis to win 10-7 vs three-time Worlds medallist

Pritish Raj
New Delhi, October 27

INDIAN WRESTLER Kajal Dhochak let out a scream and fell to the mat crying while three-time World Championships medallist Aiperi Medet Kyzy of Kyrgyzstan lay flat on her back in disbelief. The scene at the Wrestling World Championships in Astana panned out after the 18-year-old Indian debutant mounted a stunning comeback from 1-7 down to defeat world no 2 and one of the best heavyweight wrestlers in the world 10-7, in the semis of 76 kg category.

"Dimaag se bahut mazboot hai Kajal. (She is mentally very strong). She doesn't get overwhelmed by the occasion or the stature of her opponent," Kajal's early coach and paternal uncle Krishan Dhochak told *The Indian Express*.

With this win, Kajal became only the third Indian woman wrestler to enter the final at the World's.

Blockbuster bout

The bout between the inexperienced debutant and experienced pro was unlike any heavyweight bout. Both wrestlers had a go at each other before Aiperi took control. She scored four points for a headlock throw before getting two more for exposure and almost pinning Kajal. One would expect a debutant to get bogged down by pressure after surviving a pin attempt but Kajal had other plans. She counter-attacked twice in the first period to throw Aiperi on the side of the mat before executing another takedown to make it 5-7.

In the second, it was all about Kajal and she came all guns blazing in the final 3 minutes and tried to attack the legs of a tiring Aiperi. After getting one point for passivity, Kajal executed a double leg attack by moving to the side of her opponent and took the decisive lead of 8-7. As the bout inched towards the closing seconds, Aiperi tried to push Kajal out of bounds but the Indian wrestler used her agility to slip behind the Kyrgyzstani and take her down to seal the bout 10-7.

Before defeating Aiperi, Kajal had defeated reigning Asian Champion Davaanasan Enkh Amar of Mongolia 9-2 in the quarters after recording a win by fall over Kamile Gaucaite of Lithuania in the opening round.

• Women medallists at World Championships

SILVER **Anshu Malik** (2021)
BRONZE **Alka Tomar** (2006), **Babita Phogat** (2012), **Geeta Phogat** (2012), **Pooja Dhandha** (2018), **Vinesh Phogat** (2019, 2022), **Sarita Mor** (2021), **Mansi Ahlawat** (2024), **Antim Panghal** (2023, 2025)

One of the reasons behind Kajal's dominant show on her way to the final is her rapid transition from the junior to senior level. Kajal caught everyone's eye after she won the U17 World Championships in 2024. In 2025, she won the U20 World title in 72 kg and also claimed silver at U17 World championships in 73 kg.

In 2026, she played at every level including the U20 World Championships where she defended her title, a couple of Ranking Series, U23 and Senior Asian Championships before making her senior debut. "She played at senior level for the first time this year and I think all those tournaments have helped her in understanding how to tackle tough situations at the elite level," Krishan added.

Despite being just 18, Kajal has been wrestling for the past decade. A sport she picked, after looking at her uncle at their village in Sonipat. "I used to wrestle in heavyweight categories during the 2000s. After an injury in my right foot, the wrestling stopped. But I used to do the usual exercises and take the usual diet of a wrestler," said Krishan. "She started having the same food and following me while running and exercising. She started going to the akhada with me," he added further.

Following her uncle's footsteps, Kajal started climbing the ranks rapidly with that is when the family decided to move her to the academy of former National coach Kuldeep Malik. "When we saw that she is doing good and the potential is clear, we decided to go all in with her training and diet," said Krishan.

Kajal in turn didn't disappoint and the very year she turned eligible for the senior level, she has entered the Senior Worlds final on her debut. Tomorrow, Kajal will face European champion Anastasiya Alpyeyeva of Ukraine in the final.



Kajal Dhochak after winning her semifinal bout at the World Championships on Tuesday. UWW

Neelam's shot at history has one hurdle — the legendary Susaki

Pritish Raj
New Delhi, October 27



Neelam Sirohi in action on Tuesday. UWW

NEELAM SIROHI, 26, stamped her authority in the 50kg semifinal to beat Asian Games bronze medallist, Kazakhstan's Zeinep Bayanova, 7-3 at the World Championships on Tuesday.

Neelam blanked Belarus' Natallia Varakina 6-0 in her pre-quarterfinal bout and advanced to the last four after top seed Russian Elizaveta Smirnova withdrew from the quarterfinals due to an injury. Tomorrow, her only hurdle on the path to make history will be one of the most accomplished 50 kg wrestlers in the world — Japan's Yui Susaki.

The Japanese legend will be eyeing a fifth world title, while Neelam will look to pull off one of the biggest upsets. Before today, Indian women wrestlers reached the final at World Championships only once; in 2021 when Anshu Malik entered the 57kg final. However, on Tuesday in Astana, Kazakhstan, two Indian women wrestlers — Neelam and Kajal Dhochak (76 kg) — stormed into the final.

And all of it happened within a space of 15 minutes. "It is a historic day for us and before leaving India, I knew that the Indian girls are going to do well this time," national team coach Virender Dahiya told *The Indian Express* from Astana.

"Neelam is one of the experienced wrestlers. She has been a national champion, so we will expect her to not make mistakes early in the bout," Dahiya, who also trains Neelam at his *akhada* in Najafgarh, said.

Plan to beat Susaki

The coach and wrestler duo have come up with a plan to tackle Susaki, who has just lost once in her international career, at the 2024 Paris Olympics to Vinesh Phogat. "Because Susaki is a big name, Neelam's first task is to fight her for 6 minutes. If Neelam pushes her to the brink, there is a good chance that she can score points in the last few seconds," Dahiya said.

The plan looks similar to what Vinesh executed during her shock win at the Paris Olympics. Neelam was very close to making it to the Asian Games but lost to Dipanshi Phogat in the last few seconds during the trials. "In the Asian Games trials, Neelam was leading 6-0 before she gave away the points. So, since then we have worked on her ground defence," Dahiya explained. "One should be ready to defend if there is a lead. So if you look today, she was strong in the last few minutes against the Kazakh giving her just one takedown," he said. Susaki's legend has grown in the wrestling world with just one blemish on her otherwise flawless record. She hasn't lost once after that defeat in Paris. Can Neelam do the unthinkable in Astana? Time will tell. But for now, Indian women's wrestling has witnessed one of its best days.

Proud families watch India stars thrash B'desh from stands



Sarabjit Singh (centre), father of India hockey captain Harmanpreet Singh, watching the match. NITIN SHARMA

Nitin Sharma
Jalandhar, October 27

AS A special montage featuring hockey legends Balbir Singh Senior, Ajit Pal Singh and Harmanpreet Singh was on display, there were several moist eyes in the stands.

One of the pairs belonged to Sarabjit Singh, father of the current India captain, who had come to watch his son play in the flesh for the first time. He was a witness to India's 13-0 romp against Bangladesh in their opening match of the Asian Champions Trophy at the Olympian Surjit Singh Hockey Stadium in Jalandhar on Tuesday.

"I still remember the day when I left a young Harmanpreet at the Surjit Hockey Academy. He would call us every day to tell us about his excitement at training in a stadium named after 1975 World Cup winner Surjit Singh," Sarabjit recalls while talking to *The Indian Express*.

"I had undergone a kidney transplant last year and rarely go out. But with Harman playing for the first time here in Jalandhar, I could not miss the moment," he added.

With Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann formally opening the tournament and later watching the match from the stands, Punjab Police Superintendent Varidnerpreet Singh Rai is busy overseeing the security for the dignitary.

Rai, the nephew of 1980 Moscow Olympics gold medallist Gurmail Singh, returns for a few seconds to the VIP stands to remind his wife to take pictures of their son, India vice-captain Hardik Singh, in action.

"Whenever I could watch the match, the occasion got saved in my mind forever. Whether training at Mohali or here at Surjit Hockey Stadium, Hardik always wanted to play for India and watching him play in the India jersey in Jalandhar makes this moment special for all of us," Rai told *The Indian Express*.

After Harmanpreet opened the scoring, Mandeep Singh got on the scoresheet moments later. Father Ravinder Singh was busy clicking selfies as well as pictures of the family.

"Whether it be our village Mithapur or the Surjit Hockey Stadium, whenever Mandeep played, we watched the match. He would come on a bike with me to train at the academy and today when he arrived at the same stadium in the official team bus, we got emotional," says Ravinder.

Family tradition

Former hockey player Ajit Singh, who played as right-half for Punjab Police, too is busy clicking pictures.

"Sukhjeet was four years old when I cut my hockey stick and gave it to him. I couldn't play for India. In 2018, he (Sukhjeet) was partially paralysed after a needling treatment went wrong and doctors told him he wouldn't be able to play. But I helped him recover and train and since his debut for India in 2022, we thank Waheguru for every match he plays," the proud father says.

Even though midfielder and former Indian captain Manpreet Singh missed the tournament due to a calf injury, wife Illi Najwa Saddique and their two daughters were in stands to cheer for the Indian team.

"Manpreet wanted us to see the special moment. It's unfortunate that he got injured but we hope he plays in Punjab wearing the India jersey in the future," says Saddique.

With the opening ceremony lasting more than an hour, Harmanpreet's elder daughter Ruhanat slept during the first few minutes of the match before waking up when the crowd erupted on her father scoring the opener for India.

He would score another, while Mandeep helped himself to three goals. Hardik would score two goals as did Dilpreet Singh. Shilanand Lakra, Abhishek Nain, Jugraj Singh and Nilakanta Sharma also found the target. "Ruhanat understands that when her father hits the ball with power, it's a goal most of the time," says Harmanpreet's wife Amandeep Kaur.

Priyanshu, with a habit of making big tons, scores 321 against Ranji champs J&K

Devendra Pandey
Mumbai, October 27

PRIYANSHU MOLIYA was unbeaten on 321 off 492 balls for Baroda against Jammu & Kashmir in the Ranji Trophy on Tuesday. At 21 years and 132 days, he is the seventh-youngest Indian to make a triple hundred in first-class cricket.

He is the second Baroda batter to reach 300, and his score passed Gul Mohammad's 319 against Holkar in the 1946-47 final. Moliya hit 36 fours and a six at the Reliance Cricket Ground in Vadodara. Baroda, who chose to bat, were all out for 616 in 169 overs, and J&K were 6 without loss at the end of Day 2.

Baroda had been 63 for 3 at one stage. Moliya and Mahesh Pithiya, added 232 for the seventh wicket. "I wanted to have a long partnership and take the team to a good position," Moliya said. He was 113 not out at the end of the first day, and on the second he spoke to the head coach, who told him to bat as long as possible. "That was my mindset." He does not hesitate to say that the pitch was good for batting. "I think the responsibility was big," he told BCCI.

Big innings are nothing new to him. At 13, in an Under-14 tournament in Vadodara, he made 556 not out, off 319 balls, with 98 fours and a six. At the Mohinder Lala Amarnath Cricket Academy, he made 1,100 and 1,500 runs in consecutive seasons. Despite making Ranji debut in 2022, he spent the last season with the Under-23 side before making his return.



Priyanshu Moliya was unbeaten on 321 off 492 balls. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

He comes from Rajkot. His father, Suresh, ran a construction business and was a cricket fanatic who had decided that if he ever had a son, he would make him a cricketer. When Moliya was about eight, Suresh sought the guidance of former India cricketers Karsan Ghavri and Yajurvindra Singh. On the advice of an early coach, Anil Thakral, the family moved to Baroda, and he joined the academy where Mohinder Amarnath became a mentor.

"My father wanted me to become a cricketer. He had a construction business but one day he decided to take me to Baroda. It was a fresh start. Now when I look back, it was a gamble. He took care of anything cricket related," said Moliya.

One line from those conversations has stayed with him. *"Sab log 100 marte hain, kuch bada karna hai toh bada run marna padega, tabhi* people will recognise you. I feel red ball is all about big runs and consistency."

Former Tamil Nadu batsman R Prasanna, who is the coach of Baroda, says Moliya's biggest strength is his game awareness. "He has shown already that he can soak in the pressure and play the situation. When it comes to red-ball cricket you can see old-school method in him. Even if mid-on and mid-off are up, he doesn't hit in the air. He beats them with drives," Prasanna said.

Everyone scores hundreds, his father told him; to do something big, you have to score big runs. His Ranji career began in December 2022, at 17, with 118 against Odisha and an unbeaten 144 against Haryana. He played for India at the 2024 Under-19 World Cup, and in the 2025-26 Vijay Hazare Trophy he made consecutive hundreds against J&K and Chandigarh. Earlier this month he made 132 against Bihar. "I just like to bat. You make me bat anytime, I will bat. My father is my coach, he gives me throwdowns and I just keep batting," he said.

The other factor that Prasanna feels impressed is Moliya's work ethics. "He reminds me a lot of Sai Sudharsan. Very studious on and off the field. He is always open to learn and listen. Which perhaps tells you why he plays the situation rather than his natural game. Also, he is a very good off-spinner, which we haven't used much because of Mahesh Pithiya," Prasanna said.

The message that meant the most came from Wasim Jaffer, who made a triple hundred at 18. "Wasim Jaffer *bhai* messaged me and congratulated me. He is a legend. He texted, 'Well done. Keep doing this.' It feels good."

BRIEF SCORES: Baroda 616 all out in 169 overs (Priyanshu Moliya 321 not out, Mahesh Pithiya 102; Sahil Lotra 4/160) vs J&K 6 for no loss in 4 overs.

Behind Badoni's double tons: India snub, quiet mental switch

Lalith Kalidas
New Delhi, October 27

GROWING UP, Ayush Badoni regularly faced throwdowns from his father Vivek on the cement pitch set up on the rooftop of their Delhi home.

Years later, Badoni's transformation on the senior circuit has all the makings of a fine script. Not the kind his father, a documentary filmmaker, is adept at, but one that takes the audience through a world of seesawing emotions; talent, rejection, rise, more despair, before the eventual comeback.

Badoni, 26, has nearly experienced the whole spectrum. He has felt the sting of rejection at every level. Once an India U-19 star, he waited four years for a senior debut, caught in the unending chaos that is Delhi cricket selections. He burst onto the IPL spotlight with some sizzling cameos four years ago, but hasn't owned the stage.

A regular for India A side until the Sri Lanka tour in August, the omission from the home series against Australia and the ongoing tour of New Zealand, though, has unlocked a new avatar. A run-making machine at the heart of Delhi's batting. On Tuesday in Ranchi, leading his team against Jharkhand, Badoni cracked his second successive Ranji Trophy double century, a joint First-Class world record. Only a couple of Delhi batsmen have achieved the feat – Gautam Gambhir in 2001-02 and Virat Kohli (for India) in 2017-18. Last week on a belter at Palam, Badoni waltzed to his career-best score, a flawless 217, against Gujarat. But there were no milestone celebrations, no over-the-top strokeplay at any juncture.



Ayush Badoni cracked another double ton on Tuesday. PTI

Devender Sharma, coach at Delhi's famous Sonnet Club, has seen Badoni's journey from close quarters. "He was very disappointed after being dropped from the India A side. I told him that if he performs this season, the India call-up will definitely come. Keeping that in mind, he had to score in every innings," Sharma told *The Indian Express*.

The weight of Delhi captaincy sits lightly on Badoni's shoulders. His unbeaten 210 on Tuesday was his third double century in 10 matches as Delhi captain, a run he began with a 205 not out against Jharkhand in November 2024 at the Arun Jaitley Stadium. "Among players from the North Zone, I feel only Shubman Gill has better technique. He has natural class. Whatever cricket Ayush has played, he has always performed this way; double hundreds in U-14, U-16 and U-19 cricket.

"At this level, it is not about any drills but controlling the mind," explained Sharma.

India wicketkeeper Rishabh Pant had also extended similar advice to his Delhi teammate. "Rishabh told me to tell Ayush that he has the potential to play for India for a long time," said Sharma.

Former India batter WV Raman, who briefly coached Badoni during his India U-19 days, has seen a staggered transition.

"It's good to see him getting double hundreds, because he primarily gave people the impression that he would get quick runs and toss his wicket away. He seemed indifferent, even impertinent. But he has a lot of talent," Raman said. After helping Delhi declare at 515 for five, Badoni snipped Jharkhand wicketkeeper Shresht Sagar. In the opening round against Bengal, he had a five-wicket haul.

BRIEF SCORES: Delhi 515/7d (Ayush Badoni 210 not out, Sumit Mathur 150 not out) vs Jharkhand 131/4 (Utkarsh Singh 53 batting)

• RANJI ROUND-UP

GROUP A

At Nagpur: Goa 220 in 93.5 overs (Yash Kasvankar 63 not out; Nachiket Bhute 5/48) vs Vidarbha 217/3 in 74 overs (Dhruv Shorey 63 not out).

At Baroda: Bihar 99 and 134 all out in 34 overs (Ayush Loharuka 76 not out; Saransh Jain 6/49) vs Madhya Pradesh 407 for 8 declared in 92.2 overs (Saksham Purohit 132, Rajat Patidar 109; Amod Yadav 3/54). MP won by an innings and 174 runs.

GROUP B

At Mysuru: Tripura 197 vs Karnataka 297/7 in 95 overs (Karun Nair 63, Rohan Patil 72, KV Aneesh 68; Abhijit Sarkar 3/59).

At Rajkot: Assam 281 vs Saurashtra 156/4 in 68 overs (Hetvik Kotak 65 batting, Ravindra Jadeja 21).

GROUP C

At Pune: Gujarat: 223 all out vs Maharashtra: 278 for 9 (Saurabh Nawale 95; Chintan Gaja 3/55, Sidharth Desai 3/40).

GROUP D

In Mumbai: Mumbai 430 in 130.3 overs (Angkrish Raghuvanshi 114; Samant Jakhar 3/41) lead Haryana 108/2 in 39 overs (Ankit Kumar 35; Musheer Khan 2/28) by 322 runs.

In Chennai: Railways 184 & 107/9 in 51 overs (Sahab Singh 42; R Sai Kishore 4/38) lead Tamil Nadu 165 in 63.1 overs (Baba Indrajith 59; Raj Choudhury 5/41) by 126 runs.

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